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# መጽሐፈ ሙታብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ♦ THE 1<sup>ST</sup> BOOK OF MEQABYAN

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## INTRODUCTION

The three *Books of Meqabyan* (also known as ‘Ethiopic Maccabees’) are found only in the (broad) canon of the Ethiopic Orthodox Tewahedo Church; despite the similarity in names, these books are entirely different (in content) from the more well-known ‘Books of Maccabees’ found in the *Septuagint* and in the Catholic and Eastern Orthodox Deuterocanon. The Maccabees referred to do not correspond to known martyrology and their identity is never fully clarified by the ancient author. Liturgically, they are read together within the seasons of the Ethiopian Orthodox Church.

The [Ethiopic \(Amharic\) text](#) here presented is adapted from the “Amharic Bible 81” Android app. The English text is original and based on both suggestions made by various online translators and the [Iyaric translation of Feqade Selassie](#) (2005) – it should be considered ‘provisional’ and treated with a degree of caution.

According to this book, a certain man from the territory of Benjamin called Maccabeus had three sons who opposed the tyrannical policies of the king and refused to worship his idols; their account consumes only a short section of the book, spanning Chs 1–4. A second group of brothers are introduced in Ch. 15. who are said to have led a successful revolt against the ruthless King of Midian.

The rest of the book contains no further narratives about the Maccabees and offers no further historical narrative, instead focusing on principles such as the primacy of God, the resurrection of the dead, the importance of good works, and the vanity of earthly power, often illustrated using examples from the Old Testament. Much of the text is interested in the judgment of God over the righteous and the unrighteous. Chs 18–19 seem to contradict 1 Enoch regarding the origin of the Nephilim, depicting them as descendants of Cain’s sons and Seth’s daughters, whereas 1 Enoch identifies their fathers, the Watchers, as fallen angels.

## AUTHORSHIP AND DATES

The three *Books of Meqabyan* are generally believed to have been written in the middle of the 4<sup>th</sup> Century CE, though their precise date and authorship are unknown. The *First Book of Meqabyan* is attributed to St Frumentius (or one of his disciples) by some.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፩

<sup>1</sup> ስሙ ጸሩጸይዳን የሚባል ኃጢአትንም የሚወዳት አንድ ሰው ነበር በፈረሶቹ ብዛት ከሥልጣኑ በታች በጭፍራዎቹም ጽናት ይመካ ነበር። <sup>2</sup> የሚያመልካቸውና የሚሰግድላቸው በሌሊት በመዓልትም መሥዋዕት የሚሠዋላቸው ጣዖታቱን የሚያገለግሉ ብዙ ካህናት ነበሩት። <sup>3</sup> እሱ ግን በልቡናው ድንቁርና እነሳቸው ጽናትና ኃይልን የሚሰጡት ይመስለው ነበር። <sup>4</sup> በልቡም በግዛቱ ሁሉ እነሳቸው ሥልጣንን የሚሰጡት የመስለው ነበር። <sup>5</sup> ዳግመኛም በሰለፍ ጊዜ እነሳቸው የተመኘውንም ሁሉ ሥልጣን የሚሰጡት የመስለው ነበር። <sup>6</sup> እርሱም ቀንና ሌሊት መሥዋዕት ይሠዋላቸው ነበር። <sup>7</sup> ጣዖታቱን የሚያገለግሉ ካህናትን ሾመ። <sup>8</sup> ከዚች ከረከሰች መሥዋዕት እነሳቸው እየበሉ ሌሊትና ቀን ጣዖቶቹ የሚበሉ አስመስለው ይነግሩት ነበር። <sup>9</sup> ዳግመኛ መሥዋዕት ሠውተው የበሉ ዘንድ ሰዎችን እንደነሳቸው ያተጉ ነበረ። ዳግመኛም

## 1 MEQABYAN 1

<sup>1</sup> There was a man named Ziruzaidan, and he loved sin, and he boasted of the multitude of horses under his authority, and in the strength of his armies. <sup>2</sup> He had many priests who served his idols, to whom he worshiped and bowed down, and to whom he offered sacrifices by day and by night. <sup>3</sup> But, in his ignorance, he thought that they were the ones who gave him strength and power. <sup>4</sup> And, in his heart, it seemed to him that they would give him authority throughout his entire kingdom. <sup>5</sup> And again, when they came to power, it seemed that they would grant him whatever he desired. <sup>6</sup> And he offered sacrifices to them day and night. <sup>7</sup> He appointed priests to serve his idols. <sup>8</sup> They would eat that from this impure sacrifice, day and night, pretending that the idols were eating it. <sup>9</sup> He was determined to bring people back to offer sacrifices and eat again. They would again offer

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### 1 MEQABYAN 1

<sup>1</sup> In place of 'Ziruzaidan', Selassie has 'Tseerutsaydan'.

<sup>2</sup> For 'offered sacrifices', Selassie has 'sacrifice sacrifice'.

<sup>3</sup> For 'ignorance', Selassie has 'heart dullness'.

<sup>4</sup> Selassie has 'Rule' in place of 'kingdom'.

<sup>5</sup> The translation, 'when they came to power', is uncertain; Selassie has 'in the formation time'.

<sup>6</sup> See #2.

<sup>7</sup> For 'to serve', Selassie has 'who serve'.

<sup>8</sup> The translation here loosely follows Selassie; the Amharic text uncertain, possibly reading, 'And they ate it day and night, as if they were eating the idols'.

<sup>9</sup> The translation here is uncertain.

እነሳቸው መስዋዕት ሠውተው እንደነሳቸው መስዋዕት ይሠው ዘንድ ሌሎች ሰዎችን ያተጉ ነበር።<sup>10</sup> እሱ ግን በማይረባ በማይጠቅም ጣዖቱ ይታመን ነበር።

<sup>11</sup> በውቀቱ ማነስና በልቡ ድንቁርና የፈጠሩት እነሳቸው የሚመግቡት እነሳቸውም የሚያነግሡት ይመስለው ነበር ካለመኖር ወደ መኖር አምጥቶ በነፍስ በሥጋ የፈጠረው ፈጣሪውን እንዳያውቅ አማልክት ሳይሆኑ አማልክት ካላቸው ከሱ ጋራ ተፈርዶባቸው ለዘለዓለም ወደ ገሃነመ እሳት ይሄዱ ዘንድ ካለመኖር ወደ መኖር አምጥቶ የፈጠረውን ፈጣሪውን እሱ ከወገኖቹ ጋራ እንዳያውቅ ሰይጣን ልቡናቸውን አደንቁሮታልና ይፈጠሩት ይመስለው ነበር።<sup>12</sup> መቼም መቼም ደኅነኞች አይደሉምና ሙታን ይላቸው ዘንድ ይገባል።<sup>13</sup> የሚያስታቸው የሰይጣን ሥልጣን በዚያ በጣዖቱ ምስል ያድራልና የልቡናቸውንም ፈቃድ ይነግራቸዋልና እንደ ወደዱም ይገልጥላቸዋልና ባመኑባቸው ልቡናቸውም እንደ አመድ የሆነ የአዳም ልጆች በሚታመኑባቸው በጣዖቶቹ ይፈረድባቸዋል።

<sup>14</sup> ያሰቡትንም እንደ ፈጸመላቸው ባዩ ጊዜ ያደንቃሉ እነርሳቸውም ከባሕርያቸው የተወለዱ ሴቶች ልጆቻቸውንና ወንዶች ልጆቻቸውን እስኪሠው ንጹሕ የሆነ የሴቶች ልጆቻቸውንና የወንዶች ልጆቻቸውን ደም እስኪያፈሱ ድረስ ደርሰው ፈቃዱን ያደርጉለታል።<sup>15</sup> እስከ ዘለዓለም ድረስ

sacrifices and invite other people to offer the same sacrifices as they had offered. <sup>10</sup> But he trusted in his idols, which neither profit nor benefit anyone.

<sup>11</sup> Through his lack of knowledge and through the ignorance of his heart, he thought that they had created him, and that they feed him, and that they had crowned him. For, Satan had dulled his reasoning, lest he should come to know the Creator who had brought him from non-existence into existence, and so that he might go down to the Gehenna of Fire forever, being judged with those who call those things gods that are not gods. <sup>12</sup> The dead must be healed, because they will never be saved. <sup>13</sup> And the power of Satan, who deceives them, dwells there among them in the form of his idols, and he tells them the desires of their hearts and reveals them what they wish to know, and the children of Adam, whose hearts are like ashes, will be judged by the idols in which they trust.

<sup>14</sup> And, when they see what he has accomplished and what he had intended, they will be astonished and will do his will, even to the point of shedding the blood of their innocent daughters and sons, so that they may make sacrifices of their daughters and of their sons, born to them naturally. <sup>15</sup> And they did not

<sup>10</sup> Online translators generally give, for this verse, “But he trusted in his worthless idols.”

<sup>11</sup> The translation here is based, very loosely, on that of Selassie (online translator tools do very poorly with text of this verse).

<sup>12</sup> For this verse, here following the ‘Amharic Teacher’ translation, Google Translate gives, “They should be called dead, for they are never safe.”

<sup>13</sup> It is not clear what ‘whose hearts are like ashes’ means.

<sup>14</sup> Selassie reverse the order of the clauses about shedding blood and sacrificing.

<sup>15</sup> Some read ‘hell’ for ‘Gehenna’ (here following Selassie, who has ‘Gehannem’).

መውጫ ወደ ሌላባት እሱ መከራ ወደሚቀበልባት እንደሱ ወደ ገሃነም ያወርዳቸው ዘንድ ሰይጣን ክፉ ፈቃደቸውን ለመፈጸም መሥዋዕቱን አጣጥሞላቸልና አላሳዘኗቸውም።

<sup>16</sup> ያ ጸረ-ጳይዳን ግን ትዕቢተኛ ነበር በወንዶች አምሳል የተሠሩ አምሳ በሴቶች አምሳል የተሠሩ ኻያ ጣዖቶች ነበሩት። <sup>17</sup> ጥቅም በሌላቸው በነዚያ በጣዖታቱም ይመካ ነበር ጧትና ማታ መሥዋዕት እየሠዋ ፈጽሞ ያከብራቸው ነበር።

<sup>18</sup> ሰዎችንም ለጣዖቱ መሥዋዕት ይሠው ዘንድ ያዛቸው ነበር እሱም ከዚያች ከረከሰች መስዋዕት ይባላ ነበር ከመስዋዕቱ ይበሉ ዘንድ ሌሎችንም ሰዎች ያዛቸው ነበር ይልቁንም ለክፋት ይተናኩል ነበር። <sup>19</sup> የብረትና የናስ የእርሳስም ለሆኑ ተመትተው ለተሠሩ ጣዖታቱ አምስት ቤት አሠራላቸው።

<sup>20</sup> በብርና በወርቅም አስጌጣቸው በቤቱ ዙሪያ መጋረጃ አስጋረደላቸው ድንኳንም አስተከለላቸው።

<sup>21</sup> በዚያ ጠባቂዎችን ሾመላቸው የሰቡ አሥር በሮችን አሥር መሲናዎች ላሞችን የሰቡ አሥር የበግ ሙክቶችን የመሰኑ አሥር ፍየሎችን ክንፍ ካላቸው ከወፎች ጋራ ለጣዖታቱ ዘወትር ዓርባ ይሠዋላቸው ነበር። <sup>22</sup> ለሱ ግን ጣዖታቱ የሚበሉ ይመስለው ነበር አምሳ ቀን ወይን በዘይት የታሸ

disappoint Satan, who had already tasted their sacrifice to fulfil their evil will, to cast them down to Gehenna, where they would suffer like him, and from where there would be no way to escape for eternity. <sup>16</sup> But that Ziruzaidan was arrogant. He had fifty idols made in the likeness of men and twenty made in the likeness of women. <sup>17</sup> He boasted about those useless idols and honoured them completely, offering sacrifices morning and evening.

<sup>18</sup> He would also command people to sacrifice to his idol, and he would call it a polluted sacrifice, and he command force others to eat from his sacrifice, and he would even more often deceive others for evil. <sup>19</sup> He built five houses for his idols, which were made of iron, of bronze, and of lead. <sup>20</sup> And he adorned them with silver and gold, and hung curtains around the house, and pitched a tent for them.

<sup>21</sup> There he appointed guards and made forty sacrifices to his idols: ten fattened oxen, ten fattened cows, ten fattened ewes, ten fattened goats, and winged birds. <sup>22</sup> But to him, it seemed as if his idols were eating, so he offered them fifty firkins of wine and fifty bushels of wheat mixed with oil. <sup>23</sup> And he said, “Take the priests

<sup>16</sup> In place of ‘Ziruzaidan’, Selassie has ‘Tseerutsaydan’.

<sup>17</sup> For ‘honoured them’, Selassie has ‘would totally glorify them’.

<sup>18</sup> Note that ‘idol’ is singular, here (though Selassie has a plural).

<sup>19</sup> Selassie has ‘brass’ in place of ‘bronze’.

<sup>20</sup> In place of ‘pitched’, Selassie has ‘planted’.

<sup>21</sup> The translation here (loosely following Selassie) is uncertain – the Amharic text may be corrupt.

<sup>22</sup> The word translated ‘firkins’ is uncertain; Selassie has ‘feeqen’.

<sup>23</sup> Here, ‘my creators’ refers to the idols.

አምሳ ወጪት ስንዴን ያቀርብላቸው ነበር። <sup>23</sup> ካህናቱንም ወስዳችሁ ስጧቸው ፈጣሪዎቼ ያረድሁላቸውን ሥጋ ይበሉ ያቀረብሁላቸውንም ወይን ይጠጡ ባይበቃቸውም እኔ እጨምርላቸዋልሁ አላቸው።

<sup>24</sup> ከዚያች ከረከሰች መሥዋዕትም ይበሉ ይጠጡ ዘንድ ሁሉን ያዝዝ ነበር። <sup>25</sup> እሱ ግን በክፉ ተንከሎ የማይሠዋም የማይሰግድም እንዳለ ለይተው አውቀው ያመጡት ዘንድ በፊቱም በእሳትና በሰይፍ ይቀጡት ዘንድ ገንዘቡን ይበረብሩት ዘንድ ቤቱንም በእሳት ያቃጥሉት ዘንድ ያለውን ገንዘቡን ሁሉ ይወስዱባት ዘንድ በግዛቱ ሁሉ የሚጎበኙ ጭፍራዎን ላከ። <sup>26</sup> እነሳቸው ደጋጎችና ታላላቆች ናቸውና በቸርነታቸውም እኛን ፈጥረዋልና ፈጣሪዎቼን ካላመለከ ለፈጣሪዎቼ መሥዋዕት ካልሠዋ ለርሱም እኔ ቅጣትና መከራን አሳየዋለሁ።

<sup>27</sup> ምድርና ሰማይን ሰፊ የሆነ ባሕርንም ጨረቃና ፀሐይንም ከዋክብትንም ዝናማትንና ነፋሳትንም ለኛ ምግብ ሊሆን ጽጋብም ሊሆንን በዚህ ዓለም የሚኖረውንም ፈጥረዋልና እሱንም እኔ ቅጣትና መከራን አሳየዋለሁ።

<sup>28</sup> የማያመልኳቸው ሰዎች ግን በፍጹም መከራ ይቀጣሉ አይራሩላቸውም።

and give it to them; and let my creators eat the meat I that have slaughtered for them, and let them drink the wine that I have prepared for them; but, if they do not have enough, I will increase it for them.”

<sup>24</sup> And he commanded everyone to eat and drink from that polluted sacrifice. <sup>25</sup> But he, knowing that they would not sacrifice to him or worship him, sent his troops throughout his dominion to bring them in, to punish them in his presence with fire and sword, and to rob him of his wealth, and to burn his house with fire, and to take away all the money they had on them.

<sup>26</sup> “For, they are kind and great, and they created us with their kindness. If they do not worship my creators and do not offer sacrifices to my creators, I will show them punishment and suffering.

<sup>27</sup> “I will show them punishment and suffering; for, they created the earth and the sky, the vast sea, the moon and the sun, the stars, the rains and the winds, to be our food and sustenance, and all that lives in this world. <sup>28</sup> But those who do not worship them will be punished with great suffering and will not be shown mercy.”

<sup>24</sup> Other readings for ‘polluted’ are ‘unclean’ and ‘defiled’.

<sup>25</sup> Throughout this verse, the Amharic text has singular pronouns in place of the 3<sup>rd</sup>-person plurals.

<sup>26</sup> See #25.

<sup>27</sup> For ‘vast’, Selassie has ‘wide’.

<sup>28</sup> Selassie has ‘firm tribulation’ in place of ‘great suffering’.



## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፪

<sup>1</sup> ከነገደ በንያም የተወለደ ስሙ መቃቢስ የሚባል <sup>2</sup> አንድ ሰው ነበረ መልክ መልካም ፈጽመውም አርበኞች የሆኑ ሦስት ልጆች ነበሩት በሰው ሁሉ ዘንድ በዚያች በጸረ-ጸይዳን ግዛት የምትሆን በምድርያምና በሜዶን አገር መወደድ ነበራቸው። <sup>3</sup> ባገኛቸውም ጊዜ ንጉሡ እንዳዘዘ ለጸረ-ጸይዳን ፈጣሪዎች አትሰግዱምን መሥዋዕትስ አትሠውምን። <sup>4</sup> እምቢ ብትሉ ግን ይዘን ወደ ንጉሡ እንወስዳችኋለን ንጉሡም እንዳዘዘ ገንዘባችሁን ሁሉ እናጠፋለን። <sup>5</sup> መልክ መልካም የሆኑ እነዚያ ጉልማሶች እኛስ የምንሰግድለት ምድርና ሰማይን በውስጧ ያለውንና ባሕርንም ጨረቃንና ፀሐይን ደመናትና ከዋክብትንም የፈጠረ ያባታችን ፈጣሪ አለ እኛ የምናመልከው የምናምንበትም እውነተኛ ፈጣሪ እርሱ ነው ብለው መለሱለት። <sup>6</sup> እነዚህም የንጉሡ ብላቴኖች አራት ናቸው ጋሻ ጦራቸውን የሚሸከሙ አሽከሮቻቸውም መቶ ናቸው። <sup>7</sup> እለዚህም ቅዱሳን ይይዟቸው ዘንድ በወደዱ ጊዜ ከጃቸው አመለጡ የነካቸውም የለም እነዚያ ጉልማሶች በኃይል ፈጽሞ አርበኞች ናቸውና ጋሻ ጦራቸውን ይዘው ሄዱ። <sup>8</sup> ከነርሳቸውም አንቆ

## 1 MEQABYAN 2

<sup>1</sup> There was a man named Maccabees, who was born of the tribe of Benjamin, <sup>2</sup> who had three sons who were handsome and brave men, and who were beloved by all the people of the land of Ziruzaidan and Media, which is in the province ruled by him. <sup>3</sup> And, when he found them, he did not bow down and offer sacrifices to the creators of Ziruzaidan, as the king had commanded. <sup>4</sup> But, if you refuse, we will take you to the king and destroy all your property as the king has commanded. <sup>5</sup> Those handsome young men replied to him, saying, “We worship the one who created the earth and the heavens, the sea, the moon, the sun, the clouds, and the stars. There is a Creator, our Father, whom we worship and in whom we believe. He is the true Creator.” <sup>6</sup> These are the king’s four young men, and their shield-bearers are a hundred. <sup>7</sup> And, when they were about to seize these saints, they escaped from their hands, and no one touched them, and they went away with their armoured spears; for, these men were powerful warriors. <sup>8</sup> Some of

### 1 MEQABYAN 2

- <sup>1</sup> For the two names in this verse, Selassie reads ‘Meqabees’ and ‘Binyam’.  
<sup>2</sup> In place of ‘Ziruzaidan’, Selassie has ‘Tseerutsaydan’. The verse division here (following Selassie) is not indicated by a separator (#).  
<sup>3</sup> The ‘creators’ here refers to the king’s idols.  
<sup>4</sup> For ‘destroy all your property’, some have ‘seize all your money’. There is no introduction as to who is speaking, here.  
<sup>5</sup> Another reading for ‘heavens’ is ‘sky’.  
<sup>6</sup> For ‘their shield-bearers’, Selassie has ‘those who carry shield and spear’.  
<sup>7</sup> Selassie has ‘shields and spears’ in place of ‘armoured spears’.  
<sup>8</sup> In place of ‘lion’, Selassie has ‘panther’ (as also in v. 9).

ግስላ የሚገድል ነበር የዚያን ጊዜም እንደ ዶሮ ያንቀው ነበር።<sup>9</sup> ከነርሳቸውም ባንዲት ደንጊያ ወይም ባንድ ጊዜ በበትር መትቶ አንበሳ የሚገድል ነበር።<sup>10</sup> ከነርሳቸውም በሰልፍ ጊዜ ባንድ ሰይፍ መትቶ መቶ ሰው የሚገድል ነበር ስማቸው አደናቸውም እንዲህ ነበር በባቢሎንና በሞዓብ አገር ሁሉ የተጠራ ነበር።<sup>11</sup> በኃይልም አርበኞች ነበሩ የነገር መወደድና ደም ግባትም ነበራቸው።

<sup>12</sup> ዳግመኛም የመልካቸው ደም ግባት ድንቅ ነበር ነገር ግን እግዚአብሔርን ስላመለኩት ሞትንም ስላልፈሩት ከሁሉ የምትበልጥ የልቡናቸው ደም ግባት ናት።<sup>13</sup> ጭፍሪዎችንም ባስፈሩዋቸው ጊዜ ይይዟቸው ዘንድ የቻለ የለም አርበኞች የሆኑ እነርሳቸው ግን ከፍ ወዳለ ተራራ ወጥተው አመለጡ።

<sup>14</sup> እነዚያም ጭፍሮች ወደ ከተማ ተመልሰው ያምባውን በር ዘጉ እነዚያን አርበኞች መቃብያንን ካላመጣችኋቸው ከተማችሁን በእሳት እናቃጥላታለን ወደ ንጉሡም ልከን አገራችሁን እናጠፋለን።<sup>15</sup> ብለው ሕዝቡን አስፈራሯቸው። የዚያን ጊዜም ያገሩ ሰዎች ባለጸጎችና ድኖች ሴቶችና ወንዶችም እናት አባቱ የሞቱበት ልጅና ባልቴቶችም ሁሉም ወጥተው አንድነት ጮሁ አንገታቸውንም ወደ ተራራ አቀኑ እኛን አታጥፋን አገራችንንም አታጥፋብን ብለው ወደነሳቸው

them would strangle a lion, and then they would strangle it like a chicken.<sup>9</sup> Some of them would kill a lion with a single blow or with a stick.<sup>10</sup> And one of them, in battle, could kill a hundred men with one blow of his sword. And this was the name of their hunt, and it was known throughout Babylon and the land of Moab.<sup>11</sup> They were fiercely patriotic, with a love of war and bloodshed.

<sup>12</sup> Again, the beauty of their appearance was amazing, but the beauty of their hearts was greater than anything else; for, they worshipped God and did not fear death.<sup>13</sup> And, when they had frightened the soldiers, no one was able to capture them; but they, being brave, climbed a high mountain and escaped.

<sup>14</sup> And those troops returned to the city and closed the gate of the fortress, saying, “If you do not bring those brave Maccabees, we will burn your city with fire and send them to the king and destroy your country.”<sup>15</sup> They threatened the people. At that time, the people of the land, the rich and the poor, the women and men, the orphans and the widows, all went out and shouted in unison, and turned their heads to the mountain and cried out to them, saying, “Do not destroy us and do not destroy our

<sup>9</sup> The translation, ‘with a single blow’, is uncertain; an alternative might be ‘with a (single) rock’.

<sup>10</sup> The precise meaning of the phrase, ‘the name of their hunt’, is uncertain.

<sup>11</sup> The translation, ‘with a love of war and bloodshed’, is uncertain.

<sup>12</sup> For ‘beauty’ (twice in this verse), Selassie has ‘comeliness’.

<sup>13</sup> Selassie has ‘lofty’ in place of ‘high’.

<sup>14</sup> The translation, ‘of the fortress’ (following Selassie), is uncertain; the Amharic text has ያምባውን (literally, ‘of Yamba’).

<sup>15</sup> Selassie has ‘They threatened the people’ in the middle of v. 14 (before ‘saying’).

ጮሁ። <sup>16</sup> የዚያን ጊዜ አንድነት አለቀሱ ከእግዚአብሔርም የተነሣ ፈሩ። <sup>17</sup> ፊታቸውን ወደ ምሥራቅ መልሰው እጃቸውንም ዘርግተው አንድነት ወደ እግዚአብሔር ለመኑ አቤቱ ትእዛዝህንና ሕግህን ያፈረሱ እነዚህን ሰዎች እንቢ እንበላቸውን።

<sup>18</sup> በብርና በወርቅ የሰው ልጅ በሠራው በደንጊያና በእንጨት አመነ እንጂ እኛ ግን ሕግህን ያላመነ የዚያን የወንጀለኛ ቃል እንሰማ ዘንድ አንወድም አሉ። <sup>19</sup> የምታድንና የምትገድል አንተ ፈጣሪው ሳለህ ራሱንም እነርሱ እንደፈጠሩት ያደርጋል እርሱስ የሰውን ደም የሚያፈስ የሰውንም ሥጋ የሚበላ ነው። <sup>20</sup> እኛ ግን የዚያን የወንጀለኛ ፊት እናይ ዘንድ ቃሉንም እንሰማ ዘንድ አንወድም አሉ። <sup>21</sup> ነገር ግን አንተ ካዘዝከን ወደሱ እንሄዳለን ባንተ ስላመን ሰውነታችንን ለሞት አሳልፈን እንሰጣለን ለፈጣሪዎቹ መሥዋዕት ሠው ባለ ጊዜም የዚን የወንጀለኛ ቃል አንሰማም። <sup>22</sup> ፈቃድህን ያደረጉ በሕግህም ጸንተው የኖሩ ኩላሊትና ልቡናንም የምትመረምር አቤቱ የአባቶቻችን የአብርሃም የይስሐቅ የያዕቆብ ፈጣሪ እኛ ግን አንተን አመን። <sup>23</sup> የሰው ልቡና መርምረህ ኃጥኡንና ጸድቁን ትረዳዋለህ የሚሠወርህም የለ የተሸሸገውም ባንተ ዘንድ

country.” <sup>16</sup> The people of that time wept together and they feared because of God. <sup>17</sup> They turned their faces toward the east and spread out their hands and prayed to God for unity: “O LORD, let us reject these people who have broken your commandments and laws.”

<sup>18</sup> They said, “We do not want to hear the words of the sinner who does not believe in your law but in the stone and wood made by a person, from silver and gold. <sup>19</sup> You are the Creator, the One who saves and kills, and yet he makes himself like they created him. He is the one who sheds human blood and eats human flesh. <sup>20</sup> But we do not want to see the face of that criminal or hear his words,” they said. <sup>21</sup> “But, if you command us, we will go to him. We will surrender our bodies to death because we believe in you. We will not listen to the words of this criminal, even if he says, “A sacrifice to my creator.” <sup>22</sup> O Lord, you who test the hearts and minds of those who do your will and keep your law, you who created our fathers, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, we have believed in you. <sup>23</sup> You examine the heart of man and discern the wicked and the righteous. Nothing is hidden from you and what is

<sup>16</sup> A more literal translation of ‘the people of that time’ is simply ‘they’; here, we (loosely) follow Selassie.

<sup>17</sup> The Divine Name here rendered as ‘O LORD’ is እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>18</sup> The literal translation of ‘person’ is ‘son of man’.

<sup>19</sup> In place of ‘human’, Selassie as ‘a person’s’ (twice in this verse).

<sup>20</sup> Another reading for ‘words’ is ‘voice’.

<sup>21</sup> Some capitalize ‘creator’ here – a reference to the idol(s) of the king.

<sup>22</sup> The word translated ‘Lord’ here is አቤቱ.

<sup>23</sup> For ‘and what is hidden’, Selassie has ‘and he who took refuge’.



የተገለጠ ነው። <sup>24</sup> እኛ ግን ካንተ በቀር ሌላ ፈጣሪ የለንም።  
<sup>25</sup> ስለ ከበረ ስምህ ሰውነታችንን ለሞት እንሰጥ ዘንድ ነገር  
 ግን በዚህ በምንገዛልህ ሥራ ኃይልን ጽናትን መጠጊያን  
 ሁነን።  
<sup>26</sup> እስራኤልም ወደ ግብጽ አገር በገቡ ጊዜ የያዕቆብን ልመና  
 ሰማህ አሁንም የከበርህ አምላክ እንለምንሃለን።  
<sup>27</sup> መልካቸው ፈጽሞ ያማረ ሁለቱም ሰዎች በፊታቸው  
 ቁመው በታይዋቸው ጊዜ እንደ መብረቅ የሚያስፈሩ የእሳት  
 ሰይፎች ወርደው አንገታቸውን ቆርጠው በገደሏቸው ጊዜ ያነ  
 ጊዜ እንደ ቀደመው ደኅነኞች ሁነው ተነሡ። <sup>28</sup> የመልካቸው  
 ደም ግባት ፈጽሞ ያማረ ሆነ ከፀሐይም ይልቅ አበሩ  
 ከቀደመውም ይልቅ ያማሩ ሆኑ።

hidden is revealed to you. <sup>24</sup> But we have no creator other than  
 you. <sup>25</sup> For the sake of your glorious name, we may give our  
 bodies to death; but, in this work that we serve you, grant us  
 strength, endurance, and refuge.  
<sup>26</sup> And now we pray to you, O God, who heard the supplication  
 of Jacob when Israel entered the land of Egypt. <sup>27</sup> When they saw  
 the two men, both of whom were extremely beautiful, standing  
 before them, fiery swords as terrifying as lightning descended  
 and cut off their heads and killed them, and they rose up as safe  
 as before. <sup>28</sup> The radiance of their beauty became absolutely  
 beautiful; they shone brighter than the sun and they became  
 more beautiful than before.

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<sup>24</sup> For the final ‘you’, Selassie here has the conventional ‘Thee-I’.

<sup>25</sup> In place of ‘strength, endurance, and refuge’, Selassie has ‘Power and Firmness and a Shelter’.

<sup>26</sup> Throughout his text, Selassie has ‘Gibts’ in place of ‘Egypt’.

<sup>27</sup> For ‘cut off their heads’, Selassie has ‘cut their necks’.

<sup>28</sup> Selassie has ‘comeliness’ in place of ‘beauty’.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፫

<sup>1</sup> የልዑል የእግዚአብሔር ባሮች አብያ ሲላ ፈንቶስ ሞተው የተነሡ እነዚህን በፊታችሁ እንዳያችሁ ከሞታችሁ በኋላ እንደዚሁ ትነሡ ዘንድ አላችሁ ፊታችሁም በመንግሥተ ሰማይ እንደ ፀሐይ ይበራል። <sup>2</sup> ከነዚያ ሰዎችም ጋራ ሂደው በዚያ ሰማዕትነትን ተቀበሉ። <sup>3</sup> የዚያን ጊዜ ለመኑ አመስገኑ ለእግዚአብሔርም ሰገዱ ሞት አላስፈራቸውም የንጉሡም ቅጣት አላስፈራቸውም። <sup>4</sup> ወደነዚያ ብላቴኖችም ሄዱ ክፋት እንደሌለው በግ ሆኑ እንጂ አላስፈሩባቸውም ወደነሱም በደረሱ ጊዜ ይዘው መቷቸው አሥረውም ገረፏቸው ወደ ንጉሡም አድርሰው በፊቱ አቆሟቸው። <sup>5</sup> ንጉሡም እናንተ እምቢተኞች ለፈጣሪዎቼ መሥዋዕት ሠውታችሁ እንዴት አትሰግዱላቸውም ብሎ መለሰላቸው።

<sup>6</sup> ከኃጢአት የነጹ የከበሩ የተመረጡ ደስ ያላቸው ዋጋው ድንቅ እንደ ሆነ እንደ ዕንቁም የሚያበሩ እነዚያ ወንድማሟኞች ሲላና አብያ ፊንቶስም ባንድ ቃል መለሱለት። <sup>7</sup> ቸነፈረ የሆነ ያንን ንጉሠ እኛስ ዕውቀትና ልቡና ለሌላቸው ለረከሱ ጣዖቶች አንሰግድም አንሠዋም አሉት። <sup>8</sup> ዳግመኛም ብርና ወርቅ የሰው እጅ ለሠራቸው

## 1 MEQABYAN 3

<sup>1</sup> As you see these servants of the Most High God, Abijah, Silas, and Pentos, who have died and risen, so you will rise after death, and your faces will shine like the sun in the kingdom of heaven. <sup>2</sup> They went with those men and received martyrdom there. <sup>3</sup> At that time, they prayed, thanked, and worshiped God. Death did not frighten them, nor did the king's punishment frighten them. <sup>4</sup> And they went to those young men, and they did not frighten them, but were like sheep without harm. And when they reached them, they seized them, beat them, bound them, and flogged them, and brought them to the king and stood them before him. <sup>5</sup> The king replied, "You rebellious men, why don't you offer sacrifices to my creators and bow down to them?" <sup>6</sup> Those brothers, Silas and Abijah and Phinehas, who were purified from sin, precious, chosen, and joyful, whose price was wonderful, and whose beauty shone like pearls, answered him with one word. <sup>7</sup> They said to that king, "We will not bow down or sacrifice to those filthy idols who have no knowledge or heart." <sup>8</sup> And they said, "We will not bow down to idols of silver

## 1 MEQABYAN 3

- <sup>1</sup> Selassie has 'slaves' in place of 'servants'.  
<sup>2</sup> Some read 'people' in place of 'men'.  
<sup>3</sup> In place of 'prayed, thanked', Selassie has 'them begged, them praised'.  
<sup>4</sup> Selassie has 'whipped' in place of 'flogged'.  
<sup>5</sup> Selassie has 'stubborn' in place of 'rebellious'.  
<sup>6</sup> For 'Phinehas', Selassie reads 'Fentos'.  
<sup>7</sup> Another reading for 'filthy' is 'polluted'.  
<sup>8</sup> For 'heart', Selassie as 'reasoning'.

ድንጋይና እንጨት ለሆኑ ልቡናና ነፍስ እውቀትም ለሌላቸው ወዳጃቸውን ለማይጠቅሙ ጠላቶቻቸውንም ለማይጎዱ ጣዖታት አንሰግድም አሉት።

<sup>9</sup> ንጉሡም እንዲህ ለምነ ታደርጋላችሁ እነሱም የሚሰድባቸውንና የሚበድላቸውን ያውቃሉና የከበሩ የሆኑ ፈጣሪዎችን ለምን ትሰድባላችሁ ብሎ መለሰላቸው።

<sup>10</sup> እነርሱ በእኛ ዘንድ እንደ ኢምንት ናቸውና እኛስ እንሰድባቸዋለን እናከብራቸውም ብለው መለሱለት።

<sup>11</sup> ንጉሡም እንደሥራችሁ ክፋት መጠን እቀጣችኋለሁ በግርፋትና በጽኑ መከራ በእሳትም ይመልካችሁን ደም ግባት አጠፋለሁ። <sup>12</sup> አሁንም ለፈጣሪዎቼ መሥዋዕት ትሰጡ እንደ ሆነ ወይም አትስጡ እንደ ሆነ ንገሩኝ ይህስ ካልሆነ በሰይፍ በግርፋት እቀጣችኋለሁ ብሎ መለሰላቸው።

<sup>13</sup> እኛስ ለረከሱ ጣዖታት መሥዋዕት አንሠዋም አንሰግድም ብለው መለሱለት ንጉሡም በወፍራም በትር ይመቷቸው ዘንድ ዳግመኛም በጅራፍ ይገርፍቸው ዘንድ ከሱም በኋላ ውስጥ አካላቸው እስኪታይ ይሰነጥቃቸው ዘንድ አዘዘ <sup>14</sup> ከዚያ በኋላ በሚቀጣቸው በሚገድላቸው ገንዘብ እስኪመክር ድረስ አሥረው በግዞት ቤት አዋሏቸው።

<sup>15</sup> ወስደው ያለ ርኅራሄ በእሥር ቤት ጽኑ እሥራትን አሠሩዋቸው እነርሱም በእሥር ቤት ሦስት ሌሊትና ሦስት

and gold, of stone and wood, made by the hands of men, which have no heart, soul, or knowledge, which cannot benefit their friends or harm their enemies.”

<sup>9</sup> And the king answered them, saying “Why do you blaspheme the glorious Creators? For, they know who it is that insults them and who it is that does them wrong.” <sup>10</sup> And they answered him, saying, “They are insignificant to us, and we will insult them and we will not honour them.” <sup>11</sup> And the king said, “The king will punish you according to the wickedness of your deeds, with scourges and with severe affliction, and I will consume your blood with fire. <sup>12</sup> Now, tell me whether you will offer sacrifices to my creators or not, or else I will punish you with the sword and with scourges.” <sup>13</sup> They answered him, saying, “We will not sacrifice or bow down to unclean idols.” The king ordered them to be beaten with a thick rod, whipped again with scourges, and then ripped apart until their internal organs were visible. <sup>14</sup> After that, he tied them up and put them in prison until he could decide on the amount of money to be paid for their deaths.

<sup>15</sup> They took them and threw them into prison without mercy, and they remained in prison for three nights and three days.

<sup>9</sup> The translation of this verse (especially the word order) is uncertain.

<sup>10</sup> The Amharic text appears to lack the word ‘not’ before ‘honour’.

<sup>11</sup> The Amharic text lacks ‘And the king said’, here following Selassie.

<sup>12</sup> A more literal reading of ‘scourges’ is ‘stripes’.

<sup>13</sup> The translation of the last part of this verse is uncertain.

<sup>14</sup> The verse division here (following Selassie) is not indicated by a separator (#).

<sup>15</sup> Selassie has ‘niceness’ in place of ‘mercy’.

መግልት ተቀመጡ። <sup>16</sup> ከዚህ ከሦስተኛውም ቀን በኋላ ንጉሡ አዋጅ ነጋሪ ይዘር ዘንድ መካሮችና መኳንንቶች ያገር ሽማግሌችና ሹማምንቱ ይሰበሰቡ ዘንድ አዘዘ። <sup>17</sup> ንጉሡ ጸሩጸይዳንም ባደባባይ በተቀመጠ ጊዜ እነዚን የከበሩ ሲላና አብያን ፈንቶስንም ያመጧቸው ዘንድ አዘዘ የቆስሉና የቸሠሩ ሁነው በፊቱ ቆሙ። <sup>18</sup> ንጉሡም ይኸንን ሦስቱን ቀን ስትቀመጡ በውኑ የተመለሳችሁት መመለስ አለን ወይስ እናንተ በቀደመው ክፋታችሁ አላችሁን አላቸው።

<sup>19</sup> የከበሩ እነዚያ የእግዚአብሔር ጭፍራዎችም እኛስ የጨከንን ኃጢአትና ክፋትን የተመላ አንተ የምታመልከውን ጦዖትን እናመልክ ዘንድ እንጂ አንልም ብለው መለሱለት።

<sup>20</sup> ያም ወንጀለኛ ተቆጥቶ ከፍ ባለ ቦታ ያቆማቸው ዘንድ ቁስላቸውንም ያድሱት ዘንድ አዘዘ ደማቸው በምድር ላይ ፈሰሰ። <sup>21</sup> ዳግመኛም በጭራሮ መብራት ያቃጠሏቸው ዘንድ ሥጋቸውም ያር ዘንድ አዘዘ አሽከሮቹም እንዳዘዛቸው አደረጉ እነዚም የከበሩ ሰዎች ሕገ እግዚአብሔርን የዘነጋህ አንተ ተናገር ቅጣታችንን በምታበዛብን መጠን ዋጋችን ይበዛል አሉት። <sup>22</sup> ዳግመኛም ሥጋቸውን ከአጥንታቸው ጋራ ፈጽመው ይበሏቸው ዘንድ ምግባቸውን ሳይበሉ ክፉ አውሬዎች የሆኑ ድብና ነብር አንበሳም አምተው ይሰዱባቸው ዘንድ አዘዘ።

<sup>16</sup> And it came to pass, on the third day, that the king commanded to gather the princes, and the nobles, and the elders, and the rulers, to make a proclamation. <sup>17</sup> When King Ziruzaidan was sitting in public, he ordered these nobles Silas, Abijah, and Phinehas to be brought in. They stood before him, being wounded and crippled. <sup>18</sup> The king said to them, “Since you have stayed these three days, have you changed your minds, or are you still in your former wickedness?”

<sup>19</sup> And those glorious hosts of God answered him, saying, “We will not say but we will not worship the idols that you worship, which are full of sin and wickedness.” <sup>20</sup> The criminal became angry and ordered them to be put on a high place and their wounds to be healed, and their blood spilled on the ground.

<sup>21</sup> He again ordered them to be burned with torches and their bodies to be burned. The soldiers did as he ordered. These noble men said, “You have forgotten the law of God. Speak, and the more you punish us, the greater our reward will be.” <sup>22</sup> Again, he ordered that bears, leopards, and lions, which were vicious beasts who had not been given any food, be sent to devour them, so that they might completely devour their flesh along with their bones.

<sup>16</sup> In place of ‘princes’, Selassie has ‘counsellors’.

<sup>17</sup> In place of ‘Ziruzaidan’, Selassie has ‘Tseerutsaydan’.

<sup>18</sup> Selassie has ‘bound’ in place of ‘crippled’.

<sup>19</sup> The translation ‘have you changed your minds’ is conjectural; the Amharic text has ‘have you come back’.

<sup>20</sup> Another reading for ‘glorious’ is ‘noble’.

<sup>21</sup> The meaning of the phrase, ‘their wounds to be healed’, is not clear.

<sup>22</sup> The translation ‘who had not been given any food’ is conjectural; the Amharic text has ‘without eating (their) food’.

<sup>23</sup> አውሬዎች የሚጠብቁ ሰዎችንም አውሬዎቹን ይሰዱባቸው ዘንድ አዘዘ እነርሳቸውም እንዳዘዛቸው አደረጉ የከበሩ እነዚያን ሰማዕታትንም የግርግሪት አሠሩዋቸው ዳግመኛም ተተንኩለው ካስማ መትተው አሠሩዋቸው። <sup>24</sup> እነዚያም አውሬዎች እያገሡ በላያቸው ተወረወሩ ወደ ሰማዕታቱም በደረሱ ጊዜ እጅ ነሥተው ሰገዱላቸው። <sup>25</sup> እያገሡ ወደ ጠባቂዎቻቸው ተመለሱ ጠባቂዎቻቸውንም አስፈሯቸው ወደ ንጉሡ ፊት እስኪያደርሷቸው ድረስ ወደ አደባባይ ወስዷቸው። <sup>26</sup> በዚያም ከወንጀለኞች ሠራዊት ሰባ አምስት ሰዎች ገደሉ። <sup>27</sup> ንጉሡ ዙፋኑን ትቶ እስኪሸሽ ድረስ በፍርሃት አንዱ ባንዱ ላይ ተጨናንቀው ብዙ ሰዎች ተሸበሩ አውሬዎቹንም በጭንቅ ይዘው ወደ ማደሪያቸው ወሰዱዋቸው። <sup>28</sup> የሲላና የአብያ የፈንቶስ ሁለቱ ወንድማዎቻቸው መጥተው ካሠሩዋቸው አሥራት ፈትተው እነዚህ ተጠራጣሪና ወንጀለኞች እንዳያገኙን ኑ እንሸሽ አሏቸው።

<sup>29</sup> እነዚያም ሰማዕታት ወንድማቸው ለምስክርነት ካቆምን በኋላ እንሸ ዘንድ አገባብ አይደለም እናንተ ፈርታችሁ እንደሆነ ሸሽታችሁ ሂዱ ብለው መለሱላቸው። <sup>30</sup> እነዚያም

<sup>23</sup> And he commanded the men who were guarding the beasts that they should send the beasts to them; and they did as he commanded. They tied those noble martyrs to a net, and again they were bound with tent-stakes. <sup>24</sup> And those beasts roared and rushed upon them; and, when they reached the martyrs, they raised their heads and bowed down before them. <sup>25</sup> And they roared and rushed back to their guards, frightened their guards, and took them to the square until they were brought before the king. <sup>26</sup> There, they killed seventy-five men from the criminal's army. <sup>27</sup> A great multitude of people were terrified, crowding one another in fear, until the king abandoned his throne and fled. They caught the beasts with difficulty and took them back to their lairs. <sup>28</sup> Then, two brothers of Silas and Abijah and Phinehas came and released them from their imprisonment and said, "Come, let us flee so that these suspicious and criminal men will not find us."

<sup>29</sup> And the martyrs answered their brothers, saying, "It is not right for us to flee after we have stood as witnesses. If you are afraid, flee and go." <sup>30</sup> And these younger brothers of theirs said,

<sup>23</sup> The meaning of the word translated as 'tent-stakes' (following Selassie) is uncertain.

<sup>24</sup> The translation of the end of the verse is uncertain.

<sup>25</sup> Another reading for 'square' is 'street'.

<sup>26</sup> An alternative reading for 'the criminal's army' is 'the army of criminals'.

<sup>27</sup> In the Amharic text, the last sentence is a clause in the middle of the 1<sup>st</sup>.

<sup>28</sup> The Amharic text seems to lack 'and released them from their imprisonment', here following Selassie.

<sup>29</sup> One could read 'testimony' in place of 'witnesses'.

<sup>30</sup> The words, 'of theirs', are not in the Amharic text but are here added for stylistic reasons.



ታናናሽ ወንድሞቻቸው እኛም በንጉሡ ፊት ከናንተ ጋራ እንቆማለን ብትሞቱም እኛ አብረን እንሞታለን አሉ።

<sup>31</sup> ከዚህም በኋላ ንጉሡ በጌትነቱ አዳራሽ ሰገነት ላይ ሁኜ እነዚህ የከበሩ ሰዎች እንደተፈቱ አምስቱም ወንድማማቾች ሁሉ አንድነት እንደቆሙ አየ ጭፍራዎችን የሚሠሩ የሚቀጡ እነዚያ አለቆች ወንድሞቻቸው እንደ ሆኑ ጠይቀው ለንጉሡ ነገሩት ንጉሡም ተቆጥቶ እንደ ምድረ በዳ እሪያ ጮኸ።

<sup>32</sup> ንጉሡም አምስቱን ወንድማማቾች ሁሉ በሚቀጣቸው ገንዘብ እስኪመክር ድረስ ይዘው በእሥር ቤት ይጨምሩዋቸው ዘንድ አዘዘ በተፈለፈለ ግንድ ያለ ርኅራኄ ጽኑ እሥራትን አሥረው በእሥር ቤት አኖሯቸው። <sup>33</sup> ንጉሡ ጸሩጸይዳንም እለዚህ የሳቱ ጉልማሶች አደከሙኝ የነዚህ ሰዎች ልቡናቸው ምን ይጸና የሥራቸውም ክፋት እንደ ኃይላቸው ጽናት ነው ይመለሳሉ ብል ልቡናቸውን ያከፋሉ።

<sup>34</sup> እኔም እንደ ሥራቸው ክፋት መጠን ፍዳውን አመጣባቸዋለሁ አርሮ አመድ ይሆን ዘንድ ሥጋቸውንም በእሳት አቃጥላለሁ ነፋስ ይወስዳቸው ዘንድ በዚያም የሥጋቸውን አመድ እንደ ትቢያ በተራራ ላይ እበትናለሁ አለ።

<sup>35</sup> ይኸንንም ከተናገረ በኋላ ሦስት ቀን ቆይቶ እነዚያን የከበሩ ሰዎች ያመጧቸው ዘንድ አዘዘ እነዚያም የከበሩ ሰዎች በቀረቡ ጊዜ በታላቁ ጉድጓድ ምድጃ ውስጥ እሳት ያነዱ ዘንድ እሳቱን

“We will stand with you before the king; if you die, we will die with you.” <sup>31</sup> After this, the king, standing on the roof of his palace, saw that these noble men had been released and that all five brothers were standing together. He ordered those chiefs who were forming and punishing the troops to ask if they were brothers, and they told the king. The king became angry and roared like a wild boar.

<sup>32</sup> And the king ordered that all five brothers be arrested and imprisoned until he could determine the amount of money to be paid. They were mercilessly tied to a split log and kept in prison. <sup>33</sup> And king Ziruzaidan said to them, “These young men who have gone astray have made me weary. How can the minds of these people be steadfast? The wickedness of their deeds is as great as their strength. They will return. And they will be troubled. <sup>34</sup> And I will bring upon them according to the evil of their deeds, and I will burn their flesh with fire, and I will scatter their flesh like dust upon the mountains, that the wind may carry them away.”

<sup>35</sup> After saying this, he waited for three days and then commanded that those noble men should be brought. When those noble men arrived, he ordered them to kindle a fire in the

<sup>31</sup> The Amharic text is somewhat confusing, here, but the general meaning seems clear enough.

<sup>32</sup> For ‘split log’, Selassie has ‘hollow stalk’; the meaning of the Amharic term is uncertain.

<sup>33</sup> In place of ‘Ziruzaidan’, Selassie has ‘Tseerutsaydan’.

<sup>34</sup> The source text has a paragraph break at the start of this verse.

<sup>35</sup> The source text does not have a paragraph break at the start of this verse (but cf. #34).

የሚያናድድና ድስት የሚያፈሉበት የተንኮል ሥራን ስቡንና እንዶድን የባሕር አረፉና ሙጫን ድኙንም በውስጡ ይጨምሩ ዘንድ አዘዘ። <sup>36</sup> በጉድጓዱም ያለ እሳት በነደደ ጊዜ መልክተኞቹ ያዘዝኩን አደረግን የሚጨምረውን ሰው ስደድ ሲሉ ወደ ንጉሡ ሄዱ።

<sup>37</sup> ተቀብለውም በእሳቱ ጉድጓድ ይጥሏቸው ዘንድ አዘዘ ብላቴኖቹም ንጉሡ እንዳዘዘቸው አደረጉ እነዚህም የከበሩ ሰዎች ወደ እሳቱ በገቡ ጊዜ ነፍሳቸውን ለእግዚአብሔር ሰጡ። <sup>38</sup> መላእክትም የጣሉዋቸው ሰዎች ሲያዩ ተቀብለው ነፍሳቸውን ይስሐቅና አብርሃም ያዕቆብ ወደ አሉበት ተድላ ደስታ ወደ ሚገኝበት ወደ ገነት ወሰዷቸው።

great pit furnace, and to add to it the cunning work of stirring the fire and boiling the pot, fat, sea salt, gum, and sulphur. <sup>36</sup> When the fire in the pit was burning, the messengers went to the king, saying, “We have done as you commanded, and we will send someone to add to it.”

<sup>37</sup> He received them and ordered them to be cast into the furnace. The young men did as the king had commanded them and, when these noble men entered the furnace, they gave up their lives to God. <sup>38</sup> When the angels saw the people who had been cast away, they welcomed them and took their souls to Paradise, where Isaac, Abraham, and Jacob lived, in happiness.

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<sup>36</sup> The translation of the end of the verse is uncertain; Selassie has ‘we will send the men who will be added’.

<sup>37</sup> The ‘young men’ here are the king’s servants.

<sup>38</sup> The literal translation of ‘Paradise’ is ‘the Garden of Delight’.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፬

<sup>1</sup> ያም ወንጀለኛ እንደ ሞቱ ባየ ጊዜ አመድ እስኪሆን ድረስ ሥጋቸውን በእሳት ያቃጥሉ ዘንድ በነፋስም ይበትኗቸው ዘንድ አዘዘ እሳቱ ግን ከፊሳቸው ወገን የሮሳውን ጠጉር ያቃጥል ዘንድ አልቻለውም ከጉድጓዱም አወጧቸው።  
<sup>2</sup> ዳግመኛው ከጧት ጀምረው እስከ ማታ ድረስ በላያቸው እሳት አነዳዱ አላቃጠላቸውም አሁንም ፊሳቸውን ኑ ወደ ባሕር እንጣለው አሉ። <sup>3</sup> ንጉሡም እንዳዘዛቸው አደረጉ በባሕር ላይ ጣሏቸው ምንም ታላላቅ ደንጊያዎችንና የብረት ጉልቻዎችን አህያ በመዘውር የሚፈጭበትን ወፍጮ ጨምረው ወደ ባሕር ቢጥሏቸው ባሕሩ ያስጠማቸው ማስጠም የለም የእግዚአብሔር መንፈስ ረድኤት አድሮባቸዋልና በባሕሩ ላይ ዋኙ እንጂ አልሰጠሙም በተተነኩለባቸው ተንኩል ሁሉ እነሳቸውን ማጥፋት ተሳነው።  
<sup>4</sup> ከሕይወታቸውም ይህ ሞታቸው አድክሞኛለና ይበሏቸው ዘንድ ፊሳቸውን ለአውሬዎች ልጣል እንጂ ምን አደርጋለሁ አለ። <sup>5</sup> ብላቴኖቹም እንዳዘዛቸው አደረጉ አሞሮችና አውሮዎች ፊሳቸውን አልነኩትም ወፎችና አሞሮች በፀሐይ ከመቃጠል በክንፋቸው ጋርደዋቸው ያምስቱ ሰማዕታት

## 1 MEQABYAN 4

<sup>1</sup> And, when the criminal saw that they were dead, he ordered their bodies to be burned until they were reduced to ashes and scattered in the wind. But the fire could not burn the corpse hair on their bodies, and they were taken out of the pit.  
<sup>2</sup> Again, they set a fire on them from morning until evening but it did not burn them. Now they said, “Come, let us throw their bodies into the sea.” <sup>3</sup> And they did as the king commanded them and cast them into the sea. Even if they had thrown them into the sea with great stones and iron bars, even a millstone that would be turned by a donkey for grinding, the sea would not have drowned them. For, the Spirit of God was with them, and they swam upon the sea, and they did not drown. All the deceit that was laid upon them failed to destroy their cause.  
<sup>4</sup> And he said, “This death of theirs has wearied me from life; what shall I do but throw their carcasses to the wild beasts to devour them?” <sup>5</sup> The young men did as he ordered but the vultures and ravens did not touch their bodies. The birds and vultures sheltered them with their wings from the sun. The five

### 1 MEQABYAN 4

- <sup>1</sup> The translation, ‘corpse hair’ (following Selassie), is uncertain; the Amharic text appears to read ‘pink hair’.  
<sup>2</sup> A more literal translation of ‘bodies’ is ‘carcasses’.  
<sup>3</sup> The terms, ‘drowned’ and ‘swam’, imply that the men were still alive, which is strange (cf. v. 1).  
<sup>4</sup> Selassie lacks the opening, “And he said.”  
<sup>5</sup> The meaning of the word translated ‘ravens’ is uncertain.

ፊሳቸው አሥራ አራት ቀን ተቀመጠ። <sup>6</sup> ባዩዋቸውም ጊዜ ሰውነታቸው እንደ ፀሐይ አበራ ብርሃን ድንኳኑን እንዲከብ መላእክትም ፊሳቸውን ከበቡት።

<sup>7</sup> ምክርን መከረ የሚያደርገውን አጣ ከዚህም በኋላ መቃብር ቆፍሮ ያምስቱን ሰማዕታት ፊሳቸውን ቀበረ። <sup>8</sup> ያንንም የእግዚአብሔር ሕግ የዘነጋ ንጉሥ ሌሊት ባልጋ ተኝቶ ሳለ አምስቱ ሰማዕታት ተቆጥተው ሰይፋቸውን ይዘው ሌሊት በፊቱ ቁመው ታዩት። <sup>9</sup> ሌሊት በወንጀል ወደ ቤቱ የገቡ መስሎታልና ከእንቅልፉ በነቃ ጊዜ ፈርቶ ከእልፍኝ ወደ አዳራሽ ይሸሽ ዘንድ ወደደ የወንጀሉትም መስለው የሚገድሉት መስሎታልና ፈርቶ ጉልበቱ ተንቀጠቀጠ።

<sup>10</sup> ስለዚህ ነገር ጌቶቹ ምን ትወዳላችሁ እኔስ ምን ላድርግላችሁ አለ። <sup>11</sup> በእሳት አቃጥለህ የገደልከን እኛንም በባሕረ ላይ ይጥሉ ዘንድ ያዘዝህ እኛ አይደለምን ብለው መለሱለት ስላመንበት እግዚአብሔር ሰውነታችንን ጠብቆናልና እኛን ማጥፋት ተሳነህ በሱ ያመነ ሰው አይጠፋምና ለእግዚአብሔር ክብር መስጋና ይግባውና ያመንበት እኛም በመከራው አላፈርንም። <sup>12</sup> እንደዚህ ያለ ትጣት አንዲያገኘኝ አላወቅሁምና ክፉ ነገርን ስላደርግሁባችሁ ፈንታ ምን ዋጋ ልስጣችሁ። <sup>13</sup> ሰውነቴን በሞት

martyrs' bodies remained there fourteen days. <sup>6</sup> When they saw them, their bodies shone like the sun and the angels surrounded their bodies like the light around the tent.

<sup>7</sup> He lost his way after taking advice. So, he dug a grave and buried the bodies of the five martyrs. <sup>8</sup> And while the king, who had forgotten the law of God, was fast asleep at night, the five martyrs, enraged, stood before him with their swords in their hands. <sup>9</sup> He thought that someone had broken into his house at night; so, when he woke up, he was afraid and wanted to flee from the room to the hall. He thought that they were going to kill him, so his knees trembled with fear.

<sup>10</sup> He said, "What do you want, my lords? What can I do for you?" <sup>11</sup> They said, "We are those you burned and killed and ordered to be cast into the sea. God has preserved our lives because we believed in him. You were unable to destroy us. Whoever believes in him will never perish. May God be praised and glorified! And we are not ashamed of our suffering." <sup>12</sup> "I did not know that such a punishment could happen to me; so, what recompense should I give you for the evil I have done to you?" <sup>13</sup> So that you do not take my body in death, and so you do not

<sup>6</sup> The meaning of the phrase, 'like the light around the tent' is unclear.

<sup>7</sup> The translation of the opening sentence is uncertain.

<sup>8</sup> Whether this was a dream on an actual appearance of the ghosts of the martyrs is not stated – the former seems more likely.

<sup>9</sup> For the pronoun, 'they', in the last sentence, Selassie has 'them that committed crime'.

<sup>10</sup> The Amharic text lacks the opening 'He said'.

<sup>11</sup> The translation here (especially the ordering of the clauses) is uncertain.

<sup>12</sup> In place of 'recompense', Selassie has 'reward'.

<sup>13</sup> Selassie has the last clause ('tell me the price ... now') at the start of the verse.

እንዳትወስዱ በሕይወት ሳለሁ ወደ ሲኦልም እንዳታወርዱኝ አሁንም የምሰጣችሁን ዋጋ ለዩልኝ።

<sup>14</sup> እኔ በድያችኋለሁና ያባታችሁ የእግዚአብሔር ሕግ ርኅራኄ ስለሆነ ኃጢአቴን ይቀር በሉኝ አላቸው።

<sup>15</sup> እነዚያም የከበሩ ሰማዕታት ክፉ ነገርን ስላደረግሁብን ፈንታ እኛስ ክፉ ነገርን አንከፍልህም በነፍስ ፈዳ የሚያመጣ እግዚአብሔር ነውና ፍዳንም የሚከፍልህ ፈጣሪያችን እግዚአብሔር አለ። <sup>16</sup> ነገር ግን ለውቀትህ ማነስና ስለ ልቡናህ ድንቁርና እኛ ደኅነኞች እንደሆንን ተገልጠን ታየንህ እኛንስ የገደልከን መስሎህ ደኅንነትን አዘጋጀህልን።

<sup>17</sup> የጣዖቶችህ ካህናትና አንተ ግን ለዘለዓለሙ መውጫ ወደ ሌለበት ወደ ገሃነም ትወዳርላችሁ። <sup>18</sup> ለምታመልኳቸው እንደ ምራቅ የተናቃችሁ ስትሆኑ ለፈጠራችሁ ለእግዚአብሔር መስገድ ትታችሁ ለምትሰግዱላቸው ለጣዖቶችህና ለናንተ ወዮላችሁ ካለመኖር ወደ መኖር አምጥቶ የፈጠራቸው እግዚአብሔርንም አታውቁም ዛሬ እንደ ጢስ ታይታችሁ ነገ የምትጠፉ አይደላችሁምን ብለው መለሱለት።

<sup>19</sup> ንጉሡም የወደዳችሁትን ሁሉ አደርግላችሁ ዘንድ ምን ታዝዙኛላችሁ ብሎ መለሰላቸው። <sup>20</sup> ወደ ገሃነም እሳት

bring me down to hell while I am still alive, tell me the price I must pay to you now.

<sup>14</sup> For, I have sinned against you, and the law of your father God is mercy; so, can you forgive my sin? <sup>15</sup> And those honoured martyrs said, “We will not repay you with evil for the evil you have done to us. For, it is God who brings salvation to the soul, and it is God, our Creator, who will repay you.” <sup>16</sup> But, because of your lack of knowledge and the ignorance of your mind, you think that we are safe and you have prepared salvation for us, even though you actually killed us. <sup>17</sup> But you and the priests of your idols will go down to Gehenna, from where there is no escape for eternity. <sup>18</sup> Woe to you, and to your idols, and to you who have abandoned the worship of God who created you, and you who have become as contemptible as spittle to those whom you worship. Do you not know the God who created you, bringing you from non-existence into existence? And do you not know that you are like smoke, seen today and perish tomorrow?

<sup>19</sup> And the king answered them, saying, “What do you command that I should do to you? Whatever you please.” <sup>20</sup> “We are

<sup>14</sup> Selassie has ‘niceness’ in place of ‘mercy’.

<sup>15</sup> Another reading for ‘honoured’ (following Selassie) is ‘glorious’.

<sup>16</sup> A more literal reading of ‘mind’ is ‘heart’.

<sup>17</sup> Some read ‘hell’ in place of ‘Gehenna’.

<sup>18</sup> Another option for ‘non-existence’ is ‘nothing(ness)’.

<sup>19</sup> This verse appears to be one long question in the Amharic text.

<sup>20</sup> The phrase, ‘Gehenna of Fire’, follows Selassie.



እንዳትገባ ራስህን ለማዳን ነው እንጂ የምናስተምርህ ራሳችንን ለማዳን አይደለም። <sup>21</sup> ጣዖቶቻችሁ ልቡናና ነፍስ ዕውቀት የሌላቸው የሰው እጅ የሠራቸው ብርና ወርቅ ደንጊያና እንጨት ናቸውና። <sup>22</sup> እነርሳቸው ግን አይገድሉም አያድኑም ወዳጃቸውን አይጠቅሙም ጠላታቸውን አይጎዱም አያዋርዱም አያከብሩም ባለጸጋ አያደርጉም አያደክዩም ክሰው አንዱ ይድን ዘንድ በማይወዱ በአጋንንት ሥልጣን እናንተን ያስታሉ እንጂ አይነቅሉም አይተክሉም።

<sup>23</sup> እናንተ የሠራችኋቸው ስትሆኑ እነርሳቸው የፈጠሩዎችሁ የሚመስሏችሁ እናንተ ልብ ደንቆሮዎች ይልቁንም እንደናንተ ያሉት ሰዎች ከሞት ይድኑ ዘንድ አይወዱም።

<sup>24</sup> የሰይጣናትና የአጋንንት ሥልጣን አድርባቸዋልና በባሕረ ገሃነም ውስጥ ያሰጥማችሁ ዘንድ እንደወደዳችሁ ነገርን ይመልሱላችኋል። <sup>25</sup> አንተ ግን ይኸንን ስሕተትህን ትተህ ፈጣሪያችን እግዚአብሔርን አምልከው ነፍሳችንን እንጠቅማት ዘንድ ይኸም ስለሞትን ፈንታ ዋጋችን ይሁን አሉት።

<sup>26</sup> እርሱ ግን ደንግጦ ፈጽሞ ያደንቅ ነበር አምስቱም ሁሉ ሰይፋቸው መዝዘው ታይተውታልና ፈራ ስለዚህም ነገር ሰገደላቸው። <sup>27</sup> እንግዲህስ ትቢያ የሆኑ ሙታን ከሞቱ በኋላ በውነት እንዲነሡ አወቅሁ እኔስ ልሞት ጥቂት ብቻ ቀርቶኝ

teaching you to save yourself from going to Gehenna of Fire, not to save ourselves. <sup>21</sup> For, your idols are silver and gold, stone and wood, the work of men’s hands, without understanding or knowledge. <sup>22</sup> But they neither kill nor save, neither benefit their friends nor harm their enemies, neither humiliate nor honour, neither enrich nor impoverish, but they deceive you by the power of demons, who do not want anyone to be saved. They neither uproot nor plant.

<sup>23</sup> “You are deaf in heart, who think that they created you when you were the ones who made them; they do not want people like you to be saved from death. <sup>24</sup> They have the power of Satan and of demons, so they will tell you whatever you want in order to drown you in the sea of Gehenna. <sup>25</sup> But you,” they said to him, “Turn from this error and worship our Creator God, and let this be our reward for our death, so that we may benefit our souls.”

<sup>26</sup> But he was shocked and completely amazed, and he was afraid because he saw all five with their swords drawn; and, because of this, he bowed down to them. <sup>27</sup> He said, “Now I know that the dead, who are made of dust, will rise again after they die, and I

<sup>21</sup> A more literal translation of ‘understanding or knowledge’ is ‘heart or soul’.

<sup>22</sup> The Amharic text has the last (short) sentence as a clause in the middle of the first.

<sup>23</sup> The phrase, ‘deaf in heart’, means ‘foolish’.

<sup>24</sup> The word ‘Gehenna’ (ገሃነም) is often translated as ‘hell’.

<sup>25</sup> The phrase, ‘Creator God’ translates ፈጣሪያችን እግዚአብሔርን.

<sup>26</sup> Another reading for ‘he saw ... swords drawn’ is ‘swords drawn and shown to him’.

<sup>27</sup> The Amharic text lacks the opening, “He said.”

ነበር።<sup>28</sup> ከዚህ በኋላ ከዚያ ከንጉሡ ፊት ተሠወሩ ከዚያች ቀን ወዲያ ፈጽሞ ትዕቢተኛ የሚሆን ያ ጸሩጸይዳን ፊሳቸውን ማቃጠል ተወ።<sup>29</sup> ብዙ ዘመን አስተውታልና በጣዖቶቹና በልቡናው ስሕተት ደስ ይለው ነበር የፈጠራቸው እግዚአብሔርን በአምልኮ መከተል እስኪተው ድረስ እንደርሱ ያሉ ብዙ ሰዎችንም አሳተ እንጂ እርሱ ብቻ የሳተ አይደለም።

<sup>30</sup> ሴቶች ልጆቻቸውንና ወንዶች ልጆቻቸውንም ለአጋንንት ይሠው ነበር እግዚአብሔር የማይወደው መዳራትን ሁከትን ያደርግ ዘንድ አባታቸው ሰይጣን ያስተማራቸው የልቡናቸው ፈቃድ የሚሆን መዳራትና ሁከትን ይሠራሉ እንጂ።

<sup>31</sup> እናታቸውን ያገባሉ አክስቶቻቸውንና እህቶቻቸውንም ያገቡባቸዋል ይህንን ያደፈ ሥራ የሚመስለውን ሁሉ እየሠሩ ሰውነታቸውን ያገቡባቸዋል ሰይጣን የነዚያን ጠማሞች ሰዎች ልቡናቸውን አጥንቶታልና አንመለስም አሉ።

<sup>32</sup> ፈጣሪው የማያውቅ ያ ጸሩጸይዳን ግን ፈጽሞ ትዕቢተኛ ነበር በጣዖቶቹም ይመጣ ነበር።<sup>33</sup> እግዚአብሔር በሕግ በአምልኮ ለማያውቁት ሰዎች መንግሥትን እንዴት ይሰጣል ቢሉ በንስሐ ፈጽመው ወደርሱ ይመለሱ እንደሁ ይፈትናቸዋልና ስለዚህ ነው።<sup>34</sup> እነሱ ግን ፈጽመው በንስሐ

myself was about to die.”<sup>28</sup> After this, they hid themselves from the king’s presence and, from that day on, the totally arrogant Ziruzaidan stopped burning their bodies.<sup>29</sup> For a long time, he delighted in the error of his idols and his own mind, and he led many people like him astray, until they abandoned the worship of God who created them. He was not the only one who was deceived.

<sup>30</sup> And they would sacrifice their daughters and their sons to demons, but they practiced the immoral desires of their hearts, which their father Satan had taught them to do, to do what God did not want.<sup>31</sup> They marry their mothers, they abuse their aunts and sisters, they abuse their bodies by doing everything that resembles this dirty work. And Satan has influenced the hearts of those perverted people, so they say, “We will not return.”

<sup>32</sup> But that Ziruzaidan, who did not know his Creator, was totally arrogant and would come with his idols.<sup>33</sup> For this reason, God will always test them, so that they will repent and turn to him, even if they say, “How can God give the kingdom to those who do not know the law and worship?”<sup>34</sup> But, if they truly repented,

<sup>28</sup> In place of ‘Ziruzaidan’, Selassie has ‘Tseerutsaydan’.

<sup>29</sup> The translation for the 1<sup>st</sup> part of this verse is uncertain.

<sup>30</sup> The description of the people as ‘children of Satan’ occurs often in this book.

<sup>31</sup> Selassie has ‘filthy’ in place of ‘dirty’.

<sup>32</sup> In place of ‘Ziruzaidan’, Selassie has ‘Tseerutsaydan’.

<sup>33</sup> Other readings for ‘totally’ (here following Selassie) are ‘extremely’ and ‘utterly’.

<sup>34</sup> Some read ‘hell’ in place of ‘Gehenna’.

ቢመለሱ ይወዳቸው ነበር መንግሥታቸውንም ይጠብቅ ነበር እምቢ ቢሉ ግን ለዘለዓለሙ በእሳተ ገሃነም እሳት ይቀጣቸዋል። <sup>35</sup> ንጉሥ ግን እንደ ጌትነቱ ገናናነት ፈጣሪው እግዚአብሔርን ሊፈራው ይገባው ነበር። ዳኛም እንደ ግዛቱ ገናናነት በጎ ፍርድ እየፈረደ ለፈጣሪው ሊገዛ ይገባ ነበር።

<sup>36</sup> ሽማግሌችና አለቆችም ራቅ ማሠሪያዎችንና ጥቃቅን ነገሥታትም እንደ ጌትነታቸው ብዛት መጠን ለፈጣሪያቸው ሊታዘዙ ይገባ ነበር። <sup>37</sup> ፍጥረቱን ሁሉ የፈጠረ የሰማይና የምድር ጌታ እሱ ነውና የሚያደክይ ባለጸጋ የሚያደርግ በምድረና በሰማይ ሌላ ፈጣሪ ስለሌለ የሚያከብርና የሚያዋርድ እሱ ነው።

he would love them and protect their kingdom. But if they refused, he would punish them forever in the fire of Gehenna.

<sup>35</sup> But a king, according to the greatness of his lordship, should fear God, his Creator. A judge should also submit to the Creator, passing good judgment according to the dignity of his realm.

<sup>36</sup> Elders and chiefs, as well as distant servants and petty kings, were to obey their Creator according to the extent of their lordship. <sup>37</sup> He is the Lord of heaven and earth, the Creator of all creation. He makes poor and rich. He is the One who honours and humiliates; for, there is no other Creator in heaven or on earth.

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<sup>35</sup> For the 2<sup>nd</sup> sentence, Selassie reads, “and it would be due a judge to be ruled by his Creator while he judges goodly judgement like unto him Rule fame.”

<sup>36</sup> In place of ‘distant servants’, Selassie has ‘envoys’.

<sup>37</sup> ‘Lord of Heaven’ sometimes translates a Divine Name (እግዚአብሔር.) but here it is a description rather than a proper name.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፭

<sup>1</sup> ከሰላው አርበኞች አንዱ አርበኛ ኮራ ባንዲት ማንካ ድኝ ከእግሩ ጀምሮ እስከ ራሱ ድረስ እግዚአብሔር ሰውነቱ እንዲያብጠ አደረገው ባንዲት ፊራ ሞተ። <sup>2</sup> ዳግመኛም ከኃይለኝነቱ ብዛት የተነሣ የብረት አልጋ ያሠራ ኪራም ኮራ እሱንም እግዚአብሔር በሞት ሸሸገው። <sup>3</sup> ዳግመኛም ናቡከደነፆር ያለኔ ሌላ ንጉሥ የለም በዚህ ዓለምም ፀሐይን የማወጣ ፈጣሪ እኔ ነኝ ብሎ ከትዕቢቱም ብዛት የተነሣ እንዲህ አለ። <sup>4</sup> እግዚአብሔርም ከሰው ለይቶ ሰባት ዓመት ወደ ምድረ በዳ ሰደደው የፈጠረው እግዚአብሔር እንደ ሆነ እስኪያውቅ ድረስ ዕድሉንም ከሰማይ ወፎችና ከምድረ በዳ አውሮዎች ጋራ አደረገው። <sup>5</sup> በአምልኮ ባወቀውም ጊዜ ዳግመኛ ወደ መንግሥቱ መለሰው ተደፋፍሮ በፈጠረው በእግዚአብሔር ላይ ኮርቶ መሬት ያልሆነ ማነው።

<sup>6</sup> ሕጉን ሥርዓቱንስ አፍርሶ መሬት ያልዋጠችው ማነው።

<sup>7</sup> ጺሩጻይዳን አንተም በፈጣሪህ ላይ ትኮራ ዘንድ ትወዳለህ አንተም ዳግመኛ ከትዕቢትህ የተነሣ እንደ እነሳቸው ያጠፋህ ዘንድ ወደ መቃብርም ያወርድህ ዘንድ አለህ። <sup>8</sup> ዳግመኛም

## 1 MEQABYAN 5

<sup>1</sup> One of the warriors, Korah Bandit Manka, died of a fever. God caused his body to swell from head to toe with one spoon of sulphur. <sup>2</sup> Again, Hiram Korah who, because of his great strength, had made himself a bed of iron, God also smote him with death. <sup>3</sup> Again, Nebuchadnezzar said, “There is no other king besides me, and I am the creator of the sun in this world.” And, in his great arrogance, he said, “I am the one who makes the sun rise.” <sup>4</sup> And God separated him from the man and sent him into the wilderness for seven years, until he knew that God had made him. And he placed him with the birds of the air and the beasts of the field. <sup>5</sup> And, when he learned of him through worship, he returned him to his kingdom – and who of the earth is not proud of the God who created it?

<sup>6</sup> Who has demolished his Law and his order and not been swallowed by the earth? <sup>7</sup> You, Ziruzaidan, love to boast about your Creator, and you, because of your arrogance, are destined to destroy you like them and bring you down to the grave. <sup>8</sup> And,

## 1 MEQABYAN 5

- <sup>1</sup> It is not certain whether ‘Korah Bandit Manka’ is actually a proper name.
- <sup>2</sup> Another possible reading for ‘smote him with death’ is ‘hid him from death’.
- <sup>3</sup> The use of the name, ‘Nebuchadnezzar’, here is strange: the author seems to be diverting to recount a different story.
- <sup>4</sup> Cf. Dn 4:25–35.
- <sup>5</sup> The translation of this verse, especially the latter part, is uncertain.
- <sup>6</sup> Selassie here capitalizes ‘Earth’.
- <sup>7</sup> In place of ‘Ziruzaidan’, Selassie has ‘Tseerutsaydan’.
- <sup>8</sup> Some have ‘hell’ in place of ‘Gehenna’.

ጥርስ ማፋጨትና ልቅሶ ወዳለበት የጨለማ ፍጻሜ ወደ ሆነ ወደ ሲኦል ከገቡም በኋላ ለዘለዓለሙ መውጫ ወደሌለበት ወደ ጥልቅ ጉድጓድ ወደ ገሃነም ያወርድህ ዘንድ አለህ።

<sup>9</sup> አንተስ እንዳንተ እንደ ነበሩ የዚህን ዓለም ኑሮ እንደ ተው እንደ ትዕቢተኞች ነገሥታት ነገ የምትሞት የምትፈርስ ሰው ነህ። <sup>10</sup> እኛስ አንተ ፈራሽ በሰባሽ ነህ እግዚአብሔር ግን ምድርና ሰማይን አንተንም የፈጠረ ነውና እግዚአብሔር አይደለህም እንላለን። <sup>11</sup> እርሱ ትዕቢተኞችን ያዋርዳቸዋል የተዋረዱትን ያከብራቸዋል እርሱ ለደከሙ ሰዎች ጽናትን ይሰጣቸዋል። <sup>12</sup> እርሱ ደኅነኞችን ይገድላል እርሱ በመቃብር ተቀብረው መሬት የሆኑትን የማቱትን ሰዎች ያስነሣቸዋል። <sup>13</sup> ባሮችንም ከኃጢአት አገዛዝ በሕይወት ነፃ ያወጣቸዋል። <sup>14</sup> ጺሩጻይዳን ንጉሥ ሆይ ጥቅም በሌላቸው በረከሱ ጣዖቶችህ ለምን ትመካለህ። <sup>15</sup> እግዚአብሔር ግን ምድርና ሰማይን ታላላቅ ባሕርንም ፈጠረ ጨረቃና ፀሐይን ፈጠረ ዘመኖችንም አዘጋጀ። <sup>16</sup> ሰው ውደ እርሻው ይሰማራል እስኪመሽም ድረስ ሲያርስ ይውላል የሰማይ ከዋክብትም በቃሉ ጹንተው ይኖራሉ።

after you have entered Sheol, the dark end where there is gnashing of teeth and weeping, you will be brought down to the bottomless pit of Gehenna, from which there is no exit for ever.

<sup>9</sup> You, like the arrogant kings who have abandoned the life of this world, as you have, are a person who will die tomorrow and be destroyed. <sup>10</sup> As for us, we say, “You are a scoundrel, but God is the one who created the earth and the heavens and you; therefore, you are not God.” <sup>11</sup> He will humble the arrogant, he will exalt the humiliated, and he will give strength to the weary. <sup>12</sup> He kills those who are healthy and raises up those who are earth, dead and buried in their graves. <sup>13</sup> He also sets free slaves from the power of sin in their lives. <sup>14</sup> O King Ziruzaidan, why do you boast in your filthy idols, which have no benefit? <sup>15</sup> But God created the earth and the sky and the great seas, he created the moon and the sun, and he set the seasons. <sup>16</sup> A man’s beloved field will be grazed, and he will plough it until the evening, and the stars of heaven will remain steadfast in his word.

<sup>9</sup> The words, ‘as you have’, are conjectural (loosely following Selassie).

<sup>10</sup> In place of ‘a scoundrel’, Selassie has ‘demolished ruins’.

<sup>11</sup> Selassie has ‘endurance’ in place of ‘strength’.

<sup>12</sup> A more literal translation of ‘those who are healthy’ is ‘the innocent’, which makes little sense in this context; Selassie has ‘the well ones’, which is somewhat ambiguous.

<sup>13</sup> Selassie has ‘rulership’ in place of ‘power’.

<sup>14</sup> In place of ‘Ziruzaidan’, Selassie has ‘Tseerutsaydan’.

<sup>15</sup> Another reading for ‘sky’ is ‘heaven’.

<sup>16</sup> The translation of this verse is uncertain; Selassie reads, “Man graze toward him field ~ an him while when him plough up til it dusk ~ an Heaven stars live firmed up by Him Word.”



<sup>17</sup> ሁሉንም በሰማይ ይጠራቸዋል እግዚአብሔር ሳያውቀው የሚደረግ ነገር የለም። <sup>18</sup> ያገለግሉት ዘንድ የከበረ ስሙንም ያመሰግኑ ዘንድ የሰማይ መላእክትን እርሱ አዘዘ መላእክትም ሕይወትን ወደሚወርሱ ሰዎች ሁሉ ይላካሉ። <sup>19</sup> አገልጋይ የሆነ ሩፋኤል ወደ ጦቢት ተላከ ጦብያንም በራጉኤል አገር ከሞት አዳነው። <sup>20</sup> ቅዱስ ሚካኤል የኢሎፍሊን ሰዎች በሚያጠፋፍቸው ገንዘብ ልብ ያስደረገው ዘንድ ወደ ጌዴዎን ተላከ እስራኤልንም የኤርትራን ባሕር ባሻገራቸው ጊዜ ወደ ነቢዩ ወደ ሙሴ ተላከ።

<sup>21</sup> እግዚአብሔር ብቻ መራቸው ብሏልና ከነርሳቸው ጋራ ልዩ ጣዖት አልነበረም። <sup>22</sup> በምድር ላይ ወዳለ አዝመራም አወጣቸው። <sup>23</sup> የኩዳዱንም እህል መገባቸው ፈጽሞ ወደቸዋልና እንደ ደንጊያ የጸናውን ማር መግባ ተከባከባቸው። <sup>24</sup> አንተም ወገኖቹን በሚገባ ፈጽመህ ትጠብቅ ዘንድ የፈጠረህ የእግዚአብሔርንም ፈቃዱን ታደርግ ዘንድ ባራቱ መንግሥት ላይ ሥልጣን ሰጥቶ አነገሠህ። <sup>25</sup> ከሁሉ ከፍ ከፍ አድርጎ አንግሦሃልና ፈጣሪህ እግዚአብሔርንም ትወደው ዘንድ ፈጽሞ አነገሠህ።

<sup>17</sup> And he calls everyone to heaven. And nothing is done without God's knowledge. <sup>18</sup> He has commanded the angels in heaven to minister to him and to praise his glorious name. And the angels are sent to all those who will inherit life. <sup>19</sup> Raphael, a servant, was sent to Tobit and saved Tobit from death in the land of Raguel. <sup>20</sup> Saint Michael was sent to Gideon to persuade him to repent of the money that the Philistine people were wasting, and he was sent to the prophet Moses when he led Israel across the Red Sea.

<sup>21</sup> They said that God alone guided them, and there was no special idol with them. <sup>22</sup> And he brought them out towards crops on the earth. <sup>23</sup> And he fed them the grain of the field, because he loved them very much, and they were nourished with honey, which was as strong as stone. <sup>24</sup> And to you, he has given the authority over the four kingdoms and made you king, so that you may perfectly protect your people and do the will of God, who created you. <sup>25</sup> And he has exalted you above all, and has made you reign forever, so that you may love God, your Creator.

<sup>17</sup> For this verse, the online translator on the 'Amharic Teacher' website gives, "There is nothing in heaven that God does not know."

<sup>18</sup> Selassie has 'all persons' in place of 'all those'.

<sup>19</sup> Cf Tb 5:7, 5:17.

<sup>20</sup> The tradition that Michael led the Exodus is found in a number of apocryphal books.

<sup>21</sup> In place of 'special', Selassie has 'different'.

<sup>22</sup> A more literal translation of 'crops' is 'harvest'.

<sup>23</sup> The meaning of 'which was as strong as stone' is unclear.

<sup>24</sup> It is not clear what the 'four kingdoms' refers to.

<sup>25</sup> For 'made you reign forever', Selassie has 'totally crowned thee'.

<sup>26</sup> እንደወደደህ በሕዝብ ላይ ሁሉ እንዳመነህ አንተም ፈጣሪህ እግዚአብሔርን ፈጽመህ ትወደው ዘንድ አግባብ ነው በዚህ ዓለም ዘመንህ ይበዛ ዘንድ ካንተም ጋራ በረድኤት ይኖር ዘንድ አንተም የእግዚአብሔር ፈቃዱን አድርግ።

<sup>27</sup> በጠላቶችህም ላይ ጥበቃ ሆኖ ይቆምልህ ዘንድ በዙፋነህም ያስቀምጥህ ዘንድ ራስህንም በክንፈ ረድኤቱ ይሠውርህ ዘንድ የእግዚአብሔርን ፈቃድ አድርግ። <sup>28</sup> ባታውቅስ እግዚአብሔር ሳኦልን ከእስራኤል ልጆች መርጦ ያባቱን አህዮች ሲጠብቅ በወገኖቹ በእስራኤል ላይ እንዳነገሠው አንተንም መርጦ በእስራኤል ላይ አነገሠህ እሱም ከእስራኤል ጋራ በዙፋኑ ላይ ተቀመጠ። <sup>29</sup> ከወንድሞቹ ለይቶ ከፍ ያለ ዕድልንም ሰጠው እግዚአብሔር በወገኖቹ ላይ አነገሠህ እንግዲህ ወዲህስ እነሆ ወገኖቹን ጠብቅ። <sup>30</sup> ትገድል ዘንድ ታድንም ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር በላያቸው ሾሞሃልና በጎ ነገር የሚሠሩትን በበጎ ነገር ክፉ ነገር የሚሠሩትንም በክፉ ነገር ጠብቋቸው አለው።

<sup>31</sup> እየገረፍክም እያንዳንክም ቢሆን ፈቃዱን ታደርግ ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር አንተን በሁሉ ላይ ሾሞሃልና በጎ ሥራ የሚሠሩትን በጎ ሥራ ክፉ ሥራ የሚሠሩትን ክፉ ሥራ ክፈላቸው። <sup>32</sup> አንተ በሰማይ ያለ ሁሉን የሚገዛ

<sup>26</sup> It is fitting that you should love your Creator God completely, as he loves you and has trusted you above all people, so that your time in this world may be prolonged and that he may be with you to support you.

<sup>27</sup> Do the will of the LORD, so that he may stand as a shield against your enemies, and so that he may set you on his throne, and so that he may hide you under the protection of his wings. <sup>28</sup> Do you not know, the LORD chose Saul from among the children of Israel and made him king over his people Israel, while he was tending his father's donkeys. So, he chose you and made you king over Israel, and he sat on his throne with Israel. <sup>29</sup> God separated him from his brothers and gave him a higher position than his brothers. He made him king over his people. <sup>30</sup> He said, "Reward those who do good with good and those who do evil with evil; for, God has set you over them to kill and to save." Now then, look after his people.

<sup>31</sup> For, God has appointed you over all things, that you may do his will, even as you are chastised. Therefore, repay those who do good for good and those who do evil for evil.

<sup>32</sup> You are a servant of the Almighty God in Heaven;

<sup>26</sup> A more literal translation of 'to support you' is 'in your help'.

<sup>27</sup> In place of 'under the protection of his wings', Selassie has 'in the Wing of Support'.

<sup>28</sup> Literally translated, this verse opens, "If you don't know."

<sup>29</sup> It is not completely clear who is being addressed in this paragraph.

<sup>30</sup> Selassie includes the last sentence as part of v. 29.

<sup>31</sup> In place of 'chastised', Selassie has 'whipped'.

<sup>32</sup> The title, 'Almighty God in Heaven', translates የእግዚአብሔር.

የእግዚአብሔር ባሪያ ነህና ባሰብኸው ሁሉ በፊቱ እየተለማመጥህ ባለመንከውም ሁሉ ፈቃድህን ያደርግልህ ዘንድ አንተም የእግዚአብሔርን ፈቃድ አድርግ። <sup>33</sup> እሱን የሚያገዛው የለም እሱ ግን ሁሉን ይገዛል። <sup>34</sup> እሱን የሚሾመው የለም እሱ ግን ሁሉን ይሾማል።

<sup>35</sup> እሱን የሚሸረው የለም እሱ ግን ሁሉን ይሸራል።

<sup>36</sup> እሱን የሚነቅፈው የለም እሱ ግን ሁሉን ይነቅፋል።

<sup>37</sup> እሱን የሚያተጋው የለም እሱ ግን ሁሉን ያተጋል የሰማይና የምድር አገዛዝ የሱ ነውና ከሥልጣኑ የሚያመልጥ የለም በሱ ዘንድ ሁሉ የተገለጠ ነው እንጂ ከፊቱ የተሠወረ የለም።

<sup>38</sup> ሁሉን ያያል እሱን ግን የሚያየው የለም ወደሱ አድነኝ ብሎ የሚጸልየውን ሰው ጸሎቱን ይሰማዋል ሰውን በሱ አምሳል ፈጥሮታልና ልመናውንም ይቀበለዋል። <sup>39</sup> እስከ ዘለዓለሙ የሚኖር ንጉሥ ነውና ከማይለወጥ ባሕርዩ ሁሉን ይመግባል።

therefore, do the will of God, so that he may do your will for you, practicing before him in all your thoughts and in all that you do not believe. <sup>33</sup> No one rules over him, but he rules over all things. <sup>34</sup> No one appoints him, but he appoints everyone.

<sup>35</sup> No one can overturn him, but he overturns everything. <sup>36</sup> No one criticizes him, but he criticizes everyone. <sup>37</sup> No one can surpass him, but he is the One who surpasses all. For, the kingdom of heaven and earth is his, and no one can escape his authority. Nothing is hidden from his sight, but all things are revealed to him. <sup>38</sup> He sees everything, but no one sees him. He hears the prayer of the person who prays to him, “Save me,” and he answers his supplication; for, he created man in his image. <sup>39</sup> He is the King who lives forever, and he nourishes all from his unchanging nature.

<sup>33</sup> Selassie ends the verse with ‘but he rules all’.

<sup>34</sup> Selassie opens the verse with, “There are none.”

<sup>35</sup> In place of ‘overturn’ (twice in this verse), Selassie has ‘dismiss’.

<sup>36</sup> In place of ‘criticise’ (twice in this verse), Selassie has ‘reproach’.

<sup>37</sup> Selassie has ‘his face’ in place of ‘his sight’.

<sup>38</sup> For ‘answers his supplication’, Selassie has ‘accepts his plea’.

<sup>39</sup> Another reading of ‘forever’ is ‘for eternity’.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፮

<sup>1</sup> ፈቃዱን የሚያደርግ ነገሥታቱን በውነት ያነግሣቸዋልና ነገሥታቱ ስለሱ የቀና ነገርን ጻፉ። <sup>2</sup> የእግዚአብሔርን ፈቃድ አድርገዋልና ይስሐቅና አብርሃም ያዕቆብም ስሎሞንና ዳዊት ሕዝቅያስም ማደሪያቸው ብርሃን የሆነች ያማሩ ነገሥታት ሁሉ ባሉበት በገነት ማደሪያቸውን በማይመረመር ብርሃን ያበራል። <sup>3</sup> የሰማይ አዳራሽ ፈጽሞ የበራ ነው እንጂ የምድር አዳራሽ አንደ ሰማይ አዳራሽ አይደለም መልኩ የብርና የወርቅ የዕንቁም መልክ የሚሆን ወልወሉ ንጹሕ ነው። <sup>4</sup> ፈጽሞ የሚያበራ መልኩም በሰው ልቡና የማይመረመር ነው የሰማይ አዳራሽ እንደ ዕንቁ የሚያበራ ነው። <sup>5</sup> የባሕርይ አዋቂ የሆነ እግዚአብሔር እርሱ እንዳወቀ የፈጠረው የሰማይ አዳራሽ የሰው ልቡና የማይመረምረው በፍጹም ብርሃን የሚያበራ ነው በብርና በወርቅ በዕንቁ በነጭ ሐርና በሰማያዊ ሐርም የተሠራ ወልወሉ ንጹሕ ነው። <sup>6</sup> እንደዚህ እጅግ ፈጽሞ ያማረ ነው። <sup>7</sup> በሃይማኖትና በመግባር የጸኑ ጸድቃን በእግዚአብሔር ቸርነትና ለይቅርታ የሚወርሱት ነው። <sup>8</sup> ከርሱም የሚፈስ

## 1 MEQABYAN 6

<sup>1</sup> The kings wrote good things about him; for, he who does his will truly crowns his kings. <sup>2</sup> Because they did the will of God, Isaac, Abraham, Jacob, Solomon, David, and Hezekiah, whose dwelling place was in the light, their dwelling place in Paradise, where all the beautiful kings are, will be illuminated with unsearchable light. <sup>3</sup> The heavenly hall is completely illuminated, but the earthly halls are not like the heavenly hall. Its appearance is like that of silver, gold, and pearls, and its features are pure. <sup>4</sup> Its appearance is so radiant that it is beyond human comprehension. The heavenly hall shines like a pearl. <sup>5</sup> God, who is the Knower of Nature, created the heavenly palace as he knew it, which the human mind cannot fathom, shining with perfect light. Its interior, which is made of silver and gold, pearls, white silk, and blue silk, is pure. <sup>6</sup> It is so absolutely beautiful like this. <sup>7</sup> The righteous who are steadfast in their faith and in their religion will inherit God's grace and forgiveness. <sup>8</sup> And there is a

## 1 MEQABYAN 6

- <sup>1</sup> A more literal ending is, "truly makes his kings king."
- <sup>2</sup> Selassie has 'the Garden' in place of 'Paradise'.
- <sup>3</sup> In place of 'appearance', Selassie has 'features'.
- <sup>4</sup> Selassie has 'jewels' in place of 'a pearl'.
- <sup>5</sup> For 'interior', Selassie has 'floor'.
- <sup>6</sup> In place of 'absolutely', Selassie has 'quite totally'.
- <sup>7</sup> For 'grace' and 'forgiveness', Selassie has, respectively, 'Charity' and 'Pardon'.
- <sup>8</sup> A more literal translation of 'tabernacle' is 'tent' (as Selassie).

የደኅንነት ውኃ አለ ፈጽሞም እንደ ፀሐይ ያበራል በውስጡም የብርሃን ድንኳን አለ በጸጋ ሽቱም የተከበበ ነው። <sup>9</sup> ያማረ የተወደደ የሆነ መልኩ ጣዕሙ ልዩ የሆነ የገነት ፍሬም በቤቱ ዙሪያ አለ በዚያ የዘይትና የወይን ቦታ አለ ፈጽሞም ያማረ ነው የፍሬውም መዓዛ የጣፈጠ ነው። <sup>10</sup> ሥጋዊ ደማዊ ሰው ወደሱ ሲገባ ከመዓዛው ጣዕም የተነሣ በርሱ ካልተድላ ደስታ ብዛት ነፍሱ ከሥጋው በተለየች ነበር። <sup>11</sup> የእግዚአብሔርን ፈቃድ ያደረጉ ያማሩ ነገሥታት በዚያ ደስ ይላቸዋል ክብራቸውና ቦታቸው ድኅነት በሚገኝበት ዘላለም ጸንቶ በሚኖር በመንግሥተ ሰማይ የታወቀ ነው።

<sup>12</sup> በምድር ያለ ጌትነታቸው የገነነ የከበረ እንደ ሆነ በሰማይ ያለ ጌትነታቸውም የገነነ የከበረ እንደ ሆነ አሳየ በዚህ ዓለም እንዲያከብሯቸው እንዲሰግዱላቸው በሰማይ ይከብራሉ ከፍ ከፍ ይላሉ በዚህ ዓለም በጎ ሥራ ቢሠሩ ደስ ይላቸዋል።

<sup>13</sup> እግዚአብሔር በሰጣቸው ግዛታቸውና መንግሥታቸው ክፉ የሆኑ ነገሥታት ግን በውነት በሚገባ አይፈርዱም የጦም አዳሪዎችና የድኖችን ጩኸት ቸል ብለዋልና ስደተኛውንና የተበደለውን አባት እናት የሞቱባትን ልጅ እውነት ፈርደው አያድኑም።

<sup>14</sup> ጦም አዳሪዎችና ድኖችን ከሚቀማቸው ከባለጸጋው እጅ አያድኗቸውም ከምግባቸው ከፍለው ሰጥተው የተራቡትን

water of salvation flowing from it, and it shines like the sun, and within it is a tabernacle of light, and it is surrounded by the fragrance of grace. <sup>9</sup> It is a beautiful, pleasant, and delicious garden, surrounded by a garden of olives and grapes. It is absolutely beautiful, and the aroma of its fruit is sweet. <sup>10</sup> When a flesh-and-blood man entered it, his soul would have been separated from his body if he had not enjoyed the taste of its fragrance. <sup>11</sup> The beautiful kings who do the will of God will rejoice there, their glory and place are known in the eternal Kingdom of Heaven, where salvation is found.

<sup>12</sup> He showed that, as their dominion on earth is glorious and exalted, so too is their dominion in heaven. They will be honoured and worshipped in this world; they will be honoured and exalted in heaven. They will be happy if they do good deeds in this world. <sup>13</sup> But wicked kings, in their dominion and kingdom given to them by God, do not judge truly and properly. They ignore the cries of the oppressed and the cries of the poor, and they do not truly judge and save the refugee and the wronged child whose father and mother are dead.

<sup>14</sup> They do not deliver the poor and the destitute from the hand of the rich, nor do they give their food to the hungry,

<sup>9</sup> For 'aroma', Selassie has 'fragrance'.

<sup>10</sup> A more literal translation of 'flesh-and-blood' is 'fleshy, bloody'.

<sup>11</sup> Selassie has 'welfare' in place of 'salvation'.

<sup>12</sup> In place of 'dominion', Selassie has 'lordship' (twice in this verse).

<sup>13</sup> For 'oppressed', Selassie has 'destitute'.

<sup>14</sup> After 'rich', Selassie has 'who robbed them'.



አያጠግቧቸውም ከመጠጣቸውም ከፍለው ሰጥተው የተጠሙትን ሰዎች አያጠግቧቸውም ጀሯቸውንም ወደ ድኃው ጩኸት አልመለሱም። <sup>15</sup> እነርሳቸውንም የጨለማ መጨረሻ ወደ ሆነ ወደ ገሃነም ይወስዳቸዋል እግዚአብሔር የሚመጣባት ያች ከፍ ያለች ቀን በደረሰችባቸው ጊዜ ዳዊት በምስጋናው አቤቱ በፍርድህ አትቅሠፈኝ በመቅሠፍትህም አትገሥፀኝ ብሎ እንደተናገረ መዓቱም በተደረገባቸው ጊዜ እንደ ገናንነታቸው ብዛት መጠን ችግራቸውን ውርድታቸው ይበዛል።

<sup>16</sup> መኳንንትና ነገሥታት በዚህ ዓለም ይህን ዓለም የሚገዙ ሲሆኑ ሕግህን ያልጠበቁ ሰዎች አሉ። <sup>17</sup> በሰማይ ግን ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር አለ የሰው ሁሉ ነፍስ የሰውም ሁሉ ድኅነት በሥልጣኑ ተይዟል ለሚያከብሩት ሰዎች ክብርን የሚሰጣቸው እሱ ነው ፈጽሞ ሁሉን ይገዛልና የሚወዱትንም ሰዎች ይወዳቸዋል። <sup>18</sup> እሱ የምድርና የሰማይ ጌታ ነውና ኩላሊት ያመላለሰውን ልቡና ያሰበውን መርምሮ ያውቃል ወደሱም በንጹሕ ልቡና ለለመነ ሰው የልመናውን ዋጋውን ይሰጠዋል። <sup>19</sup> እናት አባቱ በሞቱበት ልጁና በባልቱቶች ክፉ ሥራ የሚሠሩ የኃይለኞች ትዕቢትን ያጠፋል።

<sup>20</sup> ይህን መንግሥት የያዝከው በኃይልህ አይደለም ከዚህ ዙፋን ላይ የተቀመጥህ በመቻልህ አይደለም በዚያ ወራት

nor do they give their drink to the thirsty, nor do they turn their ears to the cry of the poor. <sup>15</sup> And he will take them to Gehenna, the end of darkness, when that great day of God's appearance will come upon them, as David said in his praise, "O LORD, do not rebuke me with your judgment, and do not admonish me with your chastisement." And, when wrath is upon them, according to the abundance of their glory, their affliction will increase, and their humiliation will increase.

<sup>16</sup> Princes and kings rule this world, but there are people who do not keep your laws. <sup>17</sup> But in heaven there is a God who rules over all. The soul of every man and the salvation of every man are held in his power. He gives honour to those who honour him. He rules over all and loves those who love him. <sup>18</sup> He is the Lord of the heavens and the earth, and he knows the thoughts of the heart and the thoughts of the mind, and he rewards the supplication of the one who asks him with a pure heart. <sup>19</sup> He destroys the pride of the powerful, who do evil deeds through the son whose father has died, and through the sons of the dead.

<sup>20</sup> It is not because of your power that you have taken possession of this kingdom; it is not because of your ability

<sup>15</sup> Cf. Ps 6:2.

<sup>16</sup> Selassie has 'Nobles' in place of 'Princes'.

<sup>17</sup> In place of 'those who love him', Selassie has 'the persons who love him'.

<sup>18</sup> The literal translation of 'heart' is 'kidneys'.

<sup>19</sup> The translation, 'sons of the dead', is uncertain; Selassie has 'old daughters', which could refer to widows.

<sup>20</sup> Both the translation and the meaning of this verse are somewhat unclear.

ወገኖቹን እንደ ገዛ እንደ ሳኦል መግዛት ይቻልህ እንደሁ ሊፈትንህ እርሱ ወዶ በመንግሥት ዙፋን ላይ አስቀመጠህ እንጂ ይኸን መንግሥት የያዝኸው በኃይልህ አይደለም የነቢዩ የሳሙኤልን ቃልና የእግዚአብሔርን ቃለ ቸል ብሎ ሠራዊቱንና ያማሌቅን ንጉሥ እንዳልገደለ እንደ ሳኦል ሲፈትንህ ነው እንጂ ይህን መንግሥት የያዝኸው በመቻልህ አይደለም። <sup>21</sup> እግዚአብሔርም ነቢዩ ሳሙኤልን ሔደህ ሕግ በማፍረስ ጣዖቶቹንም በማምለክ ለጣዖቱም በመስገድ በመስጊዳቸውም ጥቀም በሌለው በተጠላ ሥራቸውም ሁሉ አሳዝነውኛልና ሳኦልን ወደ አማሌት አገር ሔደህ ከሰው ጀምሮ እስከ ከብት ድረስ ሠራዊቶቻቸውንና ነገሥታቱን ሁሉ አጥፋ በለው አለው።

<sup>22</sup> እግዚአብሔርን ባሳዘኑት ስለዚህ ነገር ያጠፋቸው ዘንድ ሳኦልን ላከው። <sup>23</sup> እሱ ግን ንጉሣቸውን ከሞት አዳነው ብዙ ከብትንም ቆንጆዎችንና ሴቶችንም ያማሩ ጎለማሶችንም ከሞት አዳነ ነገሪን ንቋልና ትእዛዜንም አልሰማምና ስለዚህ ነገር እግዚአብሔር ነቢዩ ሳሙኤልን ሔደህ መንግሥቱን ክፈላት። <sup>24</sup> ስለሱ ፈንታ በአስራኤል ላይ ይነግሥ ዘንድ የዕሤይ ልጅ ዳዊትን ቀባው። <sup>25</sup> በእሱ ግን አንቆ የሚጥለው ጋኔን አሰናብትበት።

<sup>26</sup> ፈቃዴን ያደርግ ዘንድ መንግሥትን ብሰጠው እምቢ ብሏልና ፈቃዴን ማድረግ እምቢ ባለኝ ጊዜ ከሚገባው

that you have sat on this throne and that you have been able to rule over your people in those days, but because, as Saul did, he did not despise the word of the prophet Samuel and the word of the LORD and put you to the test, and he willingly set you on the throne of the kingdom to test you, and because, as Saul did not kill the army and the king of Amalek. <sup>21</sup> The LORD said to Samuel the prophet, “Go and tell Saul to go to the land of the Amalekites and completely destroy all their armies and their kings, both man and beast, because they have offended me by breaking the law and by serving their idols, and by bowing down to their idols, and by all their detestable practices that are worthless.”

<sup>22</sup> He sent Saul to destroy them because they had offended God in this matter. <sup>23</sup> But he saved their king from death, and many cattle, and beautiful women, and young men from death, because he despised my word, and did not obey my commandments. Therefore, the Lord said to Samuel the prophet, “Go and divide his kingdom.” <sup>24</sup> He anointed David the son of Jesse to be king over Israel in his place; <sup>25</sup> and, through him, he was cast out by the demon who was tormenting him

<sup>26</sup> If I had given him the kingdom to do my will, he would have refused. But, when he refused to do my will, I tore him out of the

<sup>21</sup> For ‘worthless’, Selassie has ‘without benefit’.

<sup>22</sup> Other readings for ‘offended’ are ‘saddened’ (as Selassie) and ‘grieved’.

<sup>23</sup> Cf. 1S 15:9 ff.

<sup>24</sup> Throughout, Selassie has ‘Daweet’ in place of ‘David’.

<sup>25</sup> Another reading for ‘tormenting’ is ‘strangling’ (as Selassie).

<sup>26</sup> For ‘made you king’, Selassie has ‘crowned you king’.

ከመንግሥቱ ሻርሁት አንተ ግን ሂደህ በወገኖቹ በእስራኤል ላይ ያነገሠህን በጌትነቱ ዙፋን ላይ ያስቀመጠህ እግዚአብሔርን እንዲህን ቸል ትለዋለህን ብለህ ንገረው አለው።<sup>27</sup> አንተ ግን ይህን ያህል ብዙ ክብርን ገናኘነትንም የሰጠህ እግዚአብሔርን አላወቅህም በለው አለው።<sup>28</sup> ነብዩ ሳሙኤልም ወደ ንጉሡ ወደ ሳኦል ሂዶ በማዕድ ተቀምጦ የአማሌቅ ንጉሥ አጋግም በግራው ተቀምጦ ሳለ ወደሱ ገባ።<sup>29</sup> ከብቱንና ሰውን ታጠፋ ዘንድ ያዘዘህ እግዚአብሔርን ፈጽመህ ለምን ቸል አልከው አለው።

<sup>30</sup> የዚያን ጊዜው ንጉሡ ፈርቶ ከዙፋኑ ተነሥቶ ሳሙኤልን ተመለሰልን ልብሱን ያዘው ሳሙኤልም መመለስን እምቢ አለው የሳሙኤል ልብስ ተቀደደ።<sup>31</sup> ሳሙኤልም ሳኦልን እግዚአብሔር መንግሥትህን ከፈላት አለው።<sup>32</sup> ዳግመኛም ሳኦል ሳሙኤልን በሕዝቡ ፊት አክብረኝ ይቅር ይለኝም ዘንድ በእግዚአብሔር ፊት ኃጢአቱን አስተሥርይልኝ አለው የፈጠረው የእግዚአብሔርን ቃለ ፈርቷልና የሚሞት ንጉሡን ግን አልፈራውምና ሳሙኤልም በቃሉ መመለስን እምቢ አለ።

<sup>33</sup> ስለዚህ ነገር ያላመጠውን ሳይውጠው የአማሌቅ ንጉሥ አጋግን ወጋው።<sup>34</sup> ሕገ እግዚአብሔርን ያፈረሰ ያንንም

kingdom, which is his due. But go, tell the LORD, who made you king over his people Israel, who set you on the throne of his kingdom, “Is this how you will despise the LORD, who made you king over his people Israel? <sup>27</sup> But you, do you not know God, who has given you so much honour and glory?” <sup>28</sup> The prophet Samuel went to King Saul, and he sat at the table, with Agag, the king of Amalek, sitting at his left. <sup>29</sup> He said, “Why have you completely ignored the LORD, who commanded you to destroy both livestock and people?”

<sup>30</sup> At that moment, the king was afraid and rose from his throne and went back to Samuel, holding onto his clothes. But Samuel refused to go back, and Samuel’s clothes tore. <sup>31</sup> And Samuel said to Saul, “The LORD has divided your kingdom.” <sup>32</sup> And Saul said again to Samuel, “Honour me before the people, and forgive me my sin before the LORD.” For, he feared the voice of the LORD who made him, but he did not fear a king who will die. And Samuel refused to return his word.

<sup>33</sup> So, he stabbed Agag, the king of Amalek, before he could swallow his food. <sup>34</sup> The demon possessed Saul, who broke God’s

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<sup>27</sup> Another reading for ‘glory’ is ‘fame’.

<sup>28</sup> Selassie has ‘dinner table’ in place of ‘table’ – but tables almost certainly weren’t used for dining in those days.

<sup>29</sup> Another possible reading for ‘ignored’ is ‘neglected’.

<sup>30</sup> Torn clothes were a sign of distress or anger.

<sup>31</sup> The division of the kingdom came later, after the time of Solomon.

<sup>32</sup> The phrase, ‘return his word’, most likely means to fulfil the request that Saul had made.

<sup>33</sup> Literally translated, this verse reads, “And he stabbed Agag, the king of Amalek, without swallowing it.”

<sup>34</sup> For ‘All-Powerful Emperor’, Selassie has ‘King of Kings who rules all’.

ሳኦልን ጋኔን ያዘው እሱ ሁሉን የሚገዛ ንጉሠ ነገሥት ስለሆነ እግዚአብሔር ኃጢአት የሠራ ንጉሥን አያፍረውም ራሱንም መታው። <sup>35</sup> የማይፈሩት የመኳንንቱንና የነገሥታቱን ሥልጣን ሁሉ የሚሸር እሱ የፍጥረቱ ሁሉ ጌታ ነውና እሱን ግን የሚገዛው የለም። <sup>36</sup> የዳዊት ወገን እየገነነ እየከበረ ይሄዳል የሳኦል ወገን ግን እየተዋረደ ይሄዳል ብሎ እንደ ተናገረ ከልጁና ከሳኦል መንግሥት አጠፋ።

<sup>37</sup> ስላሳዘነው በክፉ ሥራቸው ያሳዘኑት ወንጀለኞችንም ስለ አጠፋ እግዚአብሔር ተበቅሎ የሳኦልን ወገን ልጆች አጠፋ የእግዚአብሔርን ጠላት የማይበቀል ሰው እሱ የእግዚአብሔር ጠላት ነውና። <sup>38</sup> ተበቅሎ ማጥፋት ሲቻለው ሥልጣንም ሳለው ኃጢአተኛውን ተበቅሎ የማያጠፋው የእግዚአብሔርንም ሕግ የማይጠብቅ ሰውን ተበቅሎ የማያጠፋ ሰው እሱ በውነት የእግዚአብሔር ጠላት ነውና የሳኦልን ወገን ልጆች አጠፋ።

law, and because he is the All-Powerful Emperor, God does not shame a king who sins but strikes him on the head. <sup>35</sup> He abolishes all authority of princes and kings who do not fear him; for, he is the Lord of all creation and no one can rule over him.

<sup>36</sup> As he had said, “The house of David will grow stronger and stronger, but the house of Saul will grow weaker and weaker,” he took away the kingdom from his son and Saul.

<sup>37</sup> Because he had made us angry, and because he had destroyed the wicked, the LORD turned and destroyed the sons of Saul’s house. For, he who does not avenge the enemy of the LORD is the enemy of the LORD. <sup>38</sup> He who, while he had the power to destroy the wicked, would not destroy the wicked, and would not destroy the man who did not keep the law of God, he was truly an enemy of God, and he destroyed the descendants of Saul’s family.

<sup>35</sup> Selassie ends, “but there are none who rule him.”

<sup>36</sup> Saul was not only killed but his line (son) did not inherit the throne.

<sup>37</sup> Throughout this section, Selassie has ‘JAH’ in place of ‘the LORD’.

<sup>38</sup> This verse essentially repeats previous content, for emphasis.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፯

<sup>1</sup> አንተ ንጉሥም ብትሆን ገዢም ብትሆን አንተ ምን ቁም ነገር ነህ። <sup>2</sup> ፈቃዱን ታደርግ ዘንድ በትእዛዙም ጸንተህ ትኖር ዘንድ ፍርዱንም ትፈራ ዘንድ ካለመኖር ወደ መኖር አምጥቶ የፈጠረህ እግዚአብሔር አይደለምን አንተ ባሮችህን እንድትቆጣቸው በላያቸውም እንደ ሠለጠንህ እንደዚሁም ሁሉ አንተንም የሚቆጣህ በላይህንም የሚሠለጥን እግዚአብሔር አለ። <sup>3</sup> አንተ ኃጢአት የሠሩ ሰዎችን ያለ ርኅራኄ እንድትመታ እንደዚህም ሁሉ አንተንም የሚመታህ እስከ ዘለዓለም ድረስ መውጫ ወደሌለበት ወደ ገሃነምም የሚያወርድህ እግዚአብሔር አለ። <sup>4</sup> ያልተገዛልህን እጅ መንሻም ያላመጣልህን አንተ እንድትገርፍ አንተ ለእግዚአብሔር እጅ መንሻ የማታገባ ለምንድነው። <sup>5</sup> አንተ ይፈሩህ ዘንድ እንድትወድ የፈጠረህ ወገኖቼንም በውነት ትጠብቅ ዘንድ በፍጥረቱ ሁሉ ላይ ያነገሠህ አሱ ነውና ፈጣሪህ እግዚአብሔርን የማትፈራው ለምንድነው።

<sup>6</sup> እግዚአብሔር እንደ ሾመህ በሚገባውና በውነት ፍረድ እንጂ ፊት አይተህ ለታናሽና ለታላቅ አታድላ ያለሱ ማንን ትፈራለህ አምልኮቱንና ዘጠኙን ትእዛዝም ጠብቅ። <sup>7</sup> ውኅና እሳትን አቀረብሁልህ እጅህን ወደ ወደድኸው ጨምር ብሎ

## 1 MEQABYAN 7

<sup>1</sup> Even if you are a king or a ruler, what are you worth? <sup>2</sup> Is it not God who created you from non-existence to existence, that you may do his will, abide in his commandments, and fear his judgment? Just as we have made you angry with your servants and have made you govern them, so also is there a God who will make you angry and govern you. <sup>3</sup> There is a God who will strike you in the same way as you strike people who have sinned, without mercy; and he will cast you down to Gehenna, from which there is no escape for eternity. <sup>4</sup> Why don't you offer a tribute to God, so that you can whip a servant who is not governed by you and has not brought you a tribute? <sup>5</sup> Why do you not fear God, your Creator? For, he created you to be loved and feared, and he made you king over all his creation, that you might guard my people in truth.

<sup>6</sup> Judge with justice and truth, as God has appointed you. Do not show partiality to the small or the great. Whom will you fear besides him? And keep his worship and the Nine Commandments. <sup>7</sup> As Moses commanded the children of Israel, saying, "I

## 1 MEQABYAN 7

<sup>1</sup> Selassie ends, "what important thing are thou?"

<sup>2</sup> The translation of the last sentence is somewhat doubtful.

<sup>3</sup> In place of 'escape', Selassie has 'exits'.

<sup>4</sup> Here, 'tribute' follows Selassie (twice in this verse); another reading is 'gift'.

<sup>5</sup> The translation of this verse is very uncertain.

<sup>6</sup> This is the 1<sup>st</sup> mention of the 'Nine Commandments' – the Ethiopian Orthodox Church traditionally merges the first two commandments.

<sup>7</sup> It is unclear what the 'water and fire' here refer to.



ሙሴ የእስራኤልን ልጆች እንዳዘዛው ወደ ቀኝም ወደ ግራም አትሂድ።<sup>8</sup> ቃሉን ትሰማ ዘንድ ትእዛዙንም ታደርግ ዘንድ የምነግርህን ቃሉን ስማ በባሕር ማዶ ወይም በጠልቁ ማዶ ወይም በወንዙ ማዶ አለች አያት ዘንድ ቃሉንም እሰማ ዘንድ የእግዚአብሔርንም ትእዛዙን አደርግ ዘንድ ማን ያመጣልኛል እንዳትል።

<sup>9</sup> ሰምቼ አደርጋት ዘንድ ዳግመኛም ወደ ሰማይ ወጥቶ ያቺን የእግዚአብሔር ቃል ማን ያወርድልኛል እንዳትል ባፍህ ልታስተምራት በጁህ ልትመጸውትባት እነሆ የእግዚአብሔር ቃል የቀረበ ነው።<sup>10</sup> መጽሐፍንም ካልሰማኸው ፈጣሪህ እግዚአብሔርን አልሰማኸውም ሕጉንም ካልጠበቅህ እሱን አልወደድኸውም ትእዛዙንም አላደረግህም።<sup>11</sup> አንተም ለዘለዓለሙ ወደ ገሃነም ትገባ ዘንድ አለህ ትእዛዙንም ካልወደድህ በውነት ትጠብቃቸው ዘንድ ከወገኖችህ ሁሉ ለይቶ ያከበረህ ያገነነህ የእግዚአብሔርንም ፈቃድ ከላደረግህ ለዘለዓለሙ ወደ ገሃነም ትገባ ዘንድ አለህ።

<sup>12</sup> ከሁሉ በላይ አደረገህ የፈጠረህ መንግሥትን የሰጠህ የፈጣሪህን ስም እያሰብክ በውነት በሚገባ ወገኖቼን ትገዛ ዘንድ በወገኖቼም ሁሉ ላይ አነገሡህ።<sup>13</sup> አንተን ከበደሉህ ሰዎች የምትገርፋቸው አሉ የእግዚአብሔርን ሥራ እያሰብክ የምትምርውም አለ ልቡናህንም እንቅተህ በሚገባ የምትፈርድለት አለ።

have brought you water and fire; stretch out your hand wherever you wish; do not turn to the right or to the left.”<sup>8</sup> Hear the words that I speak to you, that you may hear his voice, whether on the other side of the sea or the river, and do my commandments, lest you say, “Who shall bring me to you, that I may hear his voice and do his commandments?”

<sup>9</sup> Behold, the word of the LORD is near, that you may teach it with your mouth, and that you may keep it in your hand, lest you should go up to heaven and say, “Who will bring it down to me?”

<sup>10</sup> If you do not listen to the Book, you have not listened to God, your Creator; and, if you do not keep his law, you have not loved him and have not kept his commandments. <sup>11</sup> You too will go to Gehenna forever; and, if you do not love his commandments, who has set you apart from all your people, so that you may keep them in truth, and if you do not do the will of God, you will go to Gehenna forever.

<sup>12</sup> He has made you king over all his people, so that you may rule his people in truth and honour, remembering the name of your Creator, who created you and gave you the kingdom. <sup>13</sup> There are those who beat those who wrong you, and there are those who forgive while thinking about the work of God, and there are those who judge them well, with their minds open.

<sup>8</sup> The ‘sea’ and the ‘river’ here are not specified.

<sup>9</sup> In place of ‘bring it down’, Selassie has ‘lower the Word of JAH’.

<sup>10</sup> The ‘Book’ is, presumably, the Torah.

<sup>11</sup> The repetitive nature of this verse is no doubt intended as emphasis.

<sup>12</sup> Selassie has ‘crowned’ in place of ‘made’.

<sup>13</sup> Another, more literal translation for the end of the verse is, “those who judge your heart with justice.”

<sup>14</sup> በፊትህም በተከራከሩ ጊዜ ፊት አይተህ አታድላ ምድር ሁለንተናዋ ያንተ ገንዘብ ናትና ኃጢአተኛውን ሰው ትምረው ንጹሐን ሰው ትበድለው ዘንድ ማማለጃ አትቀበል።  
<sup>15</sup> ፈቃዱን ካደረግህ እግዚአብሔር በዚህ ዓለም ዘመንህን ያበዛልሃል ብታሳዝነው ግን ዘመንህን ያሳንሰዋል።  
<sup>16</sup> ከሞትህ በኋላ እንድትነሣ በጎም ቢሆን ክፉም ቢሆን በሠራኸው ሥራ ሁሉ በፊቱ ቁመህ እንድትመረመር አስብ።  
<sup>17</sup> በጎ ሥራ ብትሠራ ደጋግ ነገሥታት በሚኖሩባቸው ብርሃን በመላባቸው ቤት በገነት በመንግሥተ ሰማይ ትኖራለህ። እግዚአብሔር የጎትነትህን ሥልጣን አያፍርምና ክፉ ሥራ ብትሠራ ግን ክፉዎች ነገሥታት በማኖሩበት በሲኦል በገሃነም ትኖራለህ።  
<sup>18</sup> አንተ ግን የመፈራትህን ገሃነነት ርበኞችህን ሽልማት የተሰቀለ ጋሻ ጦርህንም ባየህ ጊዜ ፈረሶችህንም ከሥልጣንህ በታች ያሉ ጭፍሮችህንም ነጋሪትንም የሚመቱ በፊትህ በበገና የሚጫወቱትን ሰዎችን ባየህ ጊዜ።  
<sup>19</sup> አንተ ግን ይኸንን ሁሉ ባየህ ጊዜ ልቡህን ከፍ ከፍ ታደርጋለህ ክሣደ ልቡናህንም ታጸናለህ ይኸን ሁሉ ክብር የሰጠህ እግዚአብሔርንም አታስበውም ነገር ግን ይኸን ሁሉ ተው ባለህ ጊዜ አንተ የምትተወው አይደለህምን።  
<sup>20</sup> የሾመህን ሹመት ፈጽመህ ችል ብለሃልና ጌትነትህንም ለሌላ

<sup>14</sup> Do not show partiality when they argue before you. The whole earth is yours, and you shall spare the wicked man; but do not take a bribe to wrong the innocent man. <sup>15</sup> If you do his will, God will prolong your life in this world; but, if you displease him, he will shorten your life.  
<sup>16</sup> Think about the resurrection after death, when you will stand before him and be judged for all your deeds, whether good or bad. <sup>17</sup> If you do good deeds, you will live in Paradise, in the kingdom of heaven, in a house filled with light, where good kings live. God is not ashamed of your power. However, if you do evil, you will live in Sheol, the Gehenna where evil kings rule. <sup>18</sup> But, when you saw your fearsome majesty, your warriors, your hanging shield and your spear, your horses, and your troops under your command, and the people playing harps before you, <sup>19</sup> and when you see all this, you lift up your heart and harden your heart, and you do not remember God, who has given you all this glory, but you say, “Give up all this,” they aren’t you the one who gives up? <sup>20</sup> For, you have completely neglected the appointment of the one who appointed you, and he shall give your lordship to another.

<sup>14</sup> For ‘the innocent man’, Selassie has ‘a clean person’.

<sup>15</sup> In place of ‘prolong your life’, Selassie has ‘multiply thy era’.

<sup>16</sup> Selassie has ‘examined’ in place of ‘judged’.

<sup>17</sup> For ‘Paradise’, Selassie has ‘a Garden’.

<sup>18</sup> The meaning of ‘hanging’ (here following Selassie) is uncertain.

<sup>19</sup> In place of ‘harden your heart’, Selassie has ‘firm up thy collar of reasoning’.

<sup>20</sup> Another reading for ‘lordship’ is ‘authority’.

ይሰጠዋል። <sup>21</sup> ድንገት ሞት ይመጣብሃልና በትንሣኤም ጊዜ ፍርድ ይደረጋልና የሰውም ሥራ ሁሉ ይመረመራልና ፈጽሞ ተመራምሮ ይፈረድብሃል።

<sup>22</sup> የዚህን ዓለም ነገሥታት የሚከብራቸው የለም እርሱ የውነት ዳኛ ስለሆነ በፍርድ ጊዜ ድኃና ባለጸጋ አንድነት ይቆማሉና። የዚህ ዓለም መኳንንት የሚመኩበት ዘውዳቸው ይወድቃል። <sup>23</sup> ፍርድ የተዘጋጀ ነው ነፍስም ትንቀጠቀጣለች የዙያነ ጊዜ የኃጥአንና የጻድቃን ሥራ ይመረመራል።

<sup>24</sup> የሚሠወረውም የለም። ሴት ለመውለድ በደረሰች ጊዜ በሆዷም ያለ ፅንሰ ለመወለድ በደረሰ ጊዜ ማኅፀኗን ለመከልከል እንዳትችል ምድርም በርሷ ላይ ያለ አዳሪዋን መከልከል አትችልም ትመልሳለች።

<sup>25</sup> ደመናዎችም እግዚአብሔር ወዳዘዛቸው ቦታ ወስደው እንዳያዘንሙ ዝናምን መከልከል እንዳይችሉ የእግዚአብሔርም ቃል ሁሉን ካለመኖር ወደ መኖር አምጥቶ ፈጥሮታልና ዳግመኛም የእግዚአብሔር ቃል ሁሉን ወደ መቃብር አግብቶታልና እንደዚሁም ሁሉ የትንሣኤ ጊዜ ከደረሰ በኋላ የሞቱ ሰዎች እንዳይነሡ መሆን አይቻልም።

<sup>26</sup> ከእግዝአብሔር አንደበት በሚወጣ ቃል ነው እንጂ ሰው የሚድን በእህል ብቻ አይደለም ብሎ ሙሴ እንደ ተናገረ ዳግመኛም የእግዚአብሔር ቃል ሰውን ሁሉ ከመቃብር ያስነሣዋል።

<sup>21</sup> Death will come to you suddenly; and, at the resurrection, judgment will be made and all of man's deeds will be examined and judged.

<sup>22</sup> No one respects the kings of this world; for, he is the true judge and, in the judgment, the poor and the rich will stand together. The crowns of the princes of this world will fall, in which they boast. <sup>23</sup> Judgment is ready and the soul trembles. At that time, the work of the wicked and the righteous will be examined.

<sup>24</sup> There is nothing hidden. When a woman is about to give birth, and when she is about to give birth without a foetus in her womb, she responds, just as the earth cannot withhold its host from her, so the womb cannot withhold its host from her.

<sup>25</sup> And the clouds cannot stop the rain from falling, nor can they stop the rain from falling where it was commanded, and the word of God has brought all things into existence from non-existence and has brought all things into the grave again, so it is impossible that the dead will not rise again after the time of resurrection has come.

<sup>26</sup> As Moses spoke, saying, "Man shall not live by bread alone but by every word that proceeds from the mouth of God." Again, the word of God will raise everyone from the grave.

<sup>21</sup> Selassie ends the verse, "he shall totally investigate and judge upon thee."

<sup>22</sup> In place of 'princes', Selassie has 'nobles'.

<sup>23</sup> For 'ready', Selassie has 'prepared'.

<sup>24</sup> For the 2<sup>nd</sup> instance of 'the womb', the Amharic text has just 'it'.

<sup>25</sup> The repetition of 'stop the rain from falling' is possibly a dittography.

<sup>26</sup> Cf. Dt 8:3 & Mt 4:4.

<sup>27</sup> እነሆ የሞቱ ሰዎች በእግዚአብሔር ቃል እንዲነሡ ታወቀ።  
<sup>28</sup> መኳንንትና ነገሥታት ስለሚሆኑ ፈቃዱን ስለሚያደርጉ ሰዎች ደግመኛም እግዚአብሔር በዳግም ሕግ እንዲህ አለ ለጥፋት የሚቈጠሩበት ቀን ደርሷልና ፍርድ በሚፈረድበት ቀን እግራቸውም በሚሰነካከልበት ጊዜ ተበቅዬ አጠፋቸዋለሁ አለ።  
<sup>29</sup> ዳግመኛም እግዚአብሔር ፍርዱን የሚያውቁ ሰዎችን ፈጣሪያችሁ እግዚአብሔር እኔ እንደ ሆንሁ እኔ እንድንደል እንዳድን እወቁ እወቁ አላቸው።  
<sup>30</sup> በመከራው እቀሥፋለሁ ይቀር እላለሁ ወደ ሲኦል አወርዳለሁ ዳግመኛም ወደ ገነት አወጣለሁ ከሥልጣኔም የሚያመልጥ የለም አላቸው።  
<sup>31</sup> ሕጉን ስላልጠበቁ መኳንንትና ነገሥታት እግዚአብሔር እንዲህ አለ ምድራዊ መንግሥት ኃላፊ ነውና ከጧት እስከ ማታም ድረስ ያልፋልና ዘለዓለም ጸንቶ ወደሚኖር ወደ መንግሥተ ሰማይ ትገቡ ዘንድ ሥርዓቱን ሕጌን ጠብቁ አለ።  
<sup>32</sup> እግዚአብሔር ጻድቃን መጥራቱ ለክብር ኃጥአንንም ለመከራ ነውና ኃጢአተኛውን የጐሳቁላል ጻድቃንን ግን ያከብራል።  
<sup>33</sup> ፈቃዱን ያላደረገ ሰውን ይሽረዋል ፈቃዱን ያደረገ ሰውን ግን ይሾመዋል።

<sup>27</sup> Behold, it was known that the dead are raised by the word of God. <sup>28</sup> And, concerning those who do his will, who will be princes and kings, God again says in the law, “For, the day of their reckoning has come, and I will rise up and destroy them in the day of judgment; and, when their feet stumble, I will destroy them.” <sup>29</sup> Again, God said to those who know his judgment, “Know that I am the God who created you, and that I can kill, and that I can save.”  
<sup>30</sup> I will destroy him in the tribulation, I will say, “Let him go.” I will bring him down to Sheol and bring him up again to heaven. No one will escape my power. <sup>31</sup> Because the princes and kings did not keep the law, God said, “Keep the law, that you may enter the kingdom of heaven, which will last forever; for, it is the ruler of the earthly kingdoms, and they pass from morning to evening.” <sup>32</sup> God calls the righteous to glory and the sinner to misery, but he honours the righteous. <sup>33</sup> He will remove the one who did not do his will, but he will appoint the one who did his will.

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<sup>27</sup> For the opening ‘Behold’, Selassie has ‘Check’.  
<sup>28</sup> It is not certain if the Amharic word translated ‘feet’ is singular or plural.  
<sup>29</sup> For the pronoun, ‘I’, Selassie uses the Rastafarian term, ‘I-man’.  
<sup>30</sup> In place of ‘heaven’, Selassie has ‘the Garden’.  
<sup>31</sup> The last clause refers to the ‘earthly kingdoms’.  
<sup>32</sup> Literally translated, the verse ends, “but he honours the sinner and the righteous.”  
<sup>33</sup> Selassie has ‘dismiss’ in place of ‘remove’.



## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፰

<sup>1</sup> የሞቱ ሰዎች የሚነሡበትን ነገር ስማች ልንገርህ ተክልን ይተክላሉ ይለመልማሉ ወይም አረግ ያወጣል እግዚአብሔር ፍሬውን አምገበ አልቦ ያመጣዋልና ከሱ ጠጅ ይጥላሉ።  
<sup>2</sup> ያች የተከልካት ተክል ታናሽ እንደ ነበረች ዛሬ ጫፎችን ፍሬና ቅጠልን እንደወጣች አስተውል። <sup>3</sup> እግዚአብሔር ከመሬትና ከውኃ ከሁለቱ ሥርዋን ያጠጣዋል። <sup>4</sup> እንጨቷን ግን ከእሳትና ከነፋስ ይመግባቸዋል ሥር ለቅጠል ውኃን ታጠጣለች መሬትም ለእንጨቶች ጽናትን ትሰጣለች።  
<sup>5</sup> እግዚአብሔር የፈጠረውን ነፍስ ግን በመካከላቸው ፍሬን እንዲያፈሩ ያደርጋል የሞቱ ሰዎችም መነሣት እንደዚሁ ነው። <sup>6</sup> ነፍስ ከሥጋ በተለየች ጊዜ እየራሱ ሂደልና ከመሬትና ከውሃ ከነፋስና ከእሳት ካራቱ ባሕርያት ነፍሳትን ሰብስብ አለ።  
<sup>7</sup> መሬት ባሕርይ ግን በባሕርይዋ ጸንታ ኖረች መሬትንም ሆነች ውሃ ባሕርይም በባሕርይዋ ጸንታ ኖረች ውሀ ሆነች።  
<sup>8</sup> ነፋስ ባህሪም በባህሪዋ ፀንታ ኖሮች ነፋስ ሆነች እሳት በባህሪዋ በባህነዋ ፀንታ ኖረች የሚሞቅ እሳት ሆነች።

## 1 MEQABYAN 8

<sup>1</sup> Listen to what the dead will say when they are raised. They plant a plant and it grows, or they make a vine, and God brings forth its fruit [*imhibe 'albo*] and they shall drink wine from it. <sup>2</sup> Notice that that planted plant, which was small, has now sprouted fruit and leaves. <sup>3</sup> God gives its roots water both from the earth and from the waters. <sup>4</sup> But he nourishes its wood with fire and wind, and the roots water the leaves, and the earth gives strength to the trees. <sup>5</sup> But God causes the soul that he created to bear fruit among them and, likewise, is the resurrection of the dead. <sup>6</sup> When the soul separates from the body, it goes on its own, so he said, “Gather souls from the four elements of earth, water, wind, and fire.”  
<sup>7</sup> But the nature of the earth remained steadfast, and the nature of the water remained steadfast, becoming land and water. <sup>8</sup> The wind, having remained steadfast in its nature, became the wind. The fire, having remained steadfast in its nature, became a

### 1 MEQABYAN 8

- <sup>1</sup> Selassie notes that the meaning of the words አምገበ አልቦ (after ‘its fruit’) is uncertain and just transcribes them as ‘*imhibe 'albo*’.
- <sup>2</sup> In place of ‘Notice’, Selassie opens with ‘Understand’.
- <sup>3</sup> Selassie ends with a singular noun, ‘water’.
- <sup>4</sup> For ‘strength’, Selassie has ‘firmness’.
- <sup>5</sup> The meaning and context of this verse is unclear.
- <sup>6</sup> Selassie has ‘Natures’ in place of ‘elements’.
- <sup>7</sup> After ‘steadfast’ (twice in this verse), the Amharic text adds ‘in its nature’ – but this repetition is redundant in contemporary English.
- <sup>8</sup> In place of ‘burning’, Selassie has ‘hot’.



<sup>9</sup> እግዚአብሔር ከሥጋ የለያት ነፈሰ ግን ወደ ፈጣሪዋ ተመለሰች በወደደ ጊዜ ከሥጋ አዋሕዶ እስኪያነሣት ድረስ በወደደው ቦታ በገነት ያኖራታል። <sup>10</sup> የጻድቃንን ነፍሶች በብርሃን ቤት በገነት ያኖራቸዋል የኃጢአተኞች ነፍሶችን ግን ያወጣቸው ዘንድ እስከ ወደደበት ጊዜም ድረስ በጨለማ ቤት በሲኦል ያኖራቸዋል። <sup>11</sup> ተሰብስበው አንድ አካል ይሆኑ ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር ነቢዩ ሕዝቅኤልን ካራቱ ማዕዘን ነፋሳትን ጥራ አለው።

<sup>12</sup> እንዲህ ብሎ ባንድ ቃል በተናገረ ጊዜ ነፋሳት ካራቱ ማዕዘን ተሰበሰቡ። <sup>13</sup> ውኃ ባሕርይም ልምላሜን አመጣ ዳግመኛም እሳት ባሕርይ አሳትን አመጣ። <sup>14</sup> መሬት ባሕርይም ዳግመኛው መሬትን አመጣ ነፋስ ባሕርይም ነፋስን አመጣ። <sup>15</sup> እግዚአብሔርም ነፍሱን ካኖረባት ቦታ ከገነት አመጣ ባንድ ቃል ተሰበሰቡ ትንሣኤም ተደረገ። <sup>16</sup> ዳግመኛም ባንተ ዘንድ ያለ ምሳሌን አሳይሃለሁ ቀኑ ይመኛል ትተኛለህ ሌሊቱ ይነጋል ከመኝታህም ትነሣለህ አንተ ግን በተኛህ ጊዜ የሞትህ ምሳሌ ነው።

<sup>17</sup> በነቃህም ጊዜ የመነሣትህ ምሳሌ ነው ጨለማ ሸፍኗቸዋልና ሁለንተናው ጨለማ የሆነ ሰው ሁሉ የሚተኛበት ሌሊቱ ግን

burning fire. <sup>9</sup> God did not separate her from the body, but she returned to her Creator, and he placed her in Paradise in a place he pleased until he reunited her with the body and raised her up. <sup>10</sup> He places the souls of the righteous in the house of light in Paradise, but he places the souls of the wicked in the house of darkness in Sheol until he wants to bring them out. <sup>11</sup> God told the prophet Ezekiel to call upon the four winds of the heavens so that they might gather together and become one body.

<sup>12</sup> When he spoke, the winds gathered from the four corners.

<sup>13</sup> The nature of water brought forth light, and again the nature of fire brought forth darkness. <sup>14</sup> The nature of the earth brought forth earth, and the nature of the wind brought forth wind.

<sup>15</sup> And God brought the soul from where it had been placed, from Paradise; and, with one word, they were gathered and resurrection took place. <sup>16</sup> Again, I will show you a parable that is like you: The day dusks, you lie down, the night dawns, and you rise from your bed; but, when you sleep, it is a parable of your death.

<sup>17</sup> It is a symbol of your awakening when you wake up; for, darkness has covered them; but the night, when everyone (*whose*

<sup>9</sup> The referent of the feminine pronouns in this verse is the soul (if we follow Selassie, and cf. v. 10).

<sup>10</sup> In place of 'Paradise', Selassie reads 'a Garden'.

<sup>11</sup> Selassie has 'limb' in place of 'body'.

<sup>12</sup> The translation, 'from the four corners', is uncertain.

<sup>13</sup> For 'light', Selassie has 'verdure'.

<sup>14</sup> Note that 'earth' and 'wind' can refer to either the elements or the physical aspects thereof.

<sup>15</sup> In place of 'Paradise', Selassie reads 'a Garden'.

<sup>16</sup> For 'parable' (twice in this verse), Selassie has 'example'.

<sup>17</sup> The Amharic text lacks 'whose bodies are dark', here (loosely) following Selassie.

የዚህ ዓለም ምሳሌ ነው። <sup>18</sup> ጨለማ የሚወገድበት በዓለሙም ሁሉ ብርሃን የሚሆንበት ሰውም ተነሥቶ ወደ እረሻው የሚሠማራበት የጧት ብርሃን ግን የሞቱ ሰዎች ምሳሌ ነው። <sup>19</sup> ሰው የሚታደስባት ይህች መንግሥተ ሰማይም እንደዚህ ናት የሞቱ ሰዎች ትንሣኤ እንደዚህ ነው ይህ ዓለም ኃላፊ ነውና የሌሊቱ ምሳሌ ነው። <sup>20</sup> ዳዊትም ምሳሌውን በፀሐይ አኖረ ብሎ እንደ ተናገረ ፀሐይ በወጣ ጊዜ ያበራልና የመንግሥተ ሰማይ ምሳሌ ነው። <sup>21</sup> ዛሬ በዚህ ዓለም ፀሐይ እንዲያበራ እሱ ክርስቶስም በመጣ ጊዜ ሐዲሶ በሚሆን በመንግሥተ ሰማይ እንደ ፀሐይ ያበራ የማይገባ ፀሐይ የማይጠፋም ፋና እኔ ነኝ ብሏልና እሱ እግዚአብሔር ብርሃንዋ ነው።

<sup>22</sup> ዳግመኛም የሞቱትን ሰዎች ፈጥኖ ያስነሣቸዋል ከምትዘራው አንተም ከምትድንበት ከምግብህ ደግመኛም አንዲት ምሳሌ አመጣልሃለሁ የስንዴም ቅንጣት ቢሆን የገብስም ቅንጣት ቢሆን የምስርም ቅንጣት ቢሆን በምድር የሚዘራ የሰውም ዘር ሁሉ ካልፈረሰ ካልበሰበሰ የሚበቅል የለም። <sup>23</sup> እንደምታየው እንደ ሰው ሥጋ በፈረሰም በበሰበሰም ጊዜ ግዘፍን ከቁርባቱ ጋራ መሬት ይበላዋል።

<sup>24</sup> ግዝፉንም መሬት በበላው ጊዜ የቅንጣት ሰባተኛ ያህል ሆኖ ይበቅላል እግዚአብሔር እንደ ወደደ ዝናም የያዘ ነፋስን

*bodies are dark*) sleeps, is a symbol of this world. <sup>18</sup> The light of the morning, when darkness is dispelled and light becomes the whole world, and where man rises and goes to work in the field, is a parable of the dead. <sup>19</sup> This is the kingdom of heaven, where people are renewed. This is the resurrection of the dead. This is the example of the night; for, this world is in charge. <sup>20</sup> And David said, “He set the parable by the sun;” for, the sun shines when it rises and it is a parable of the kingdom of heaven. <sup>21</sup> Today, just as the sun shines in this world, so when Christ comes, he will shine like the sun in the new kingdom of heaven; for, he said, “I am the unfailing sun, the unquenchable light.” He is God’s light.

<sup>22</sup> And he will raise the dead again quickly. And I will give you another parable about your food: whether it is a grain of wheat or a grain of barley or a grain of lentils, or any seed of man that is sown in the earth, it will not sprout unless it is broken down and rots. <sup>23</sup> As you can see, just like human flesh, when it decomposes and rots, the earth eats its substance along with its skin.

<sup>24</sup> And, when the earth has eaten the grain, it grows as much as a seventh of a grain. And the LORD gives a wind that brings rain as

<sup>18</sup> The ‘parable of the dead’ here most likely refers to resurrection (cf. v. 19).  
<sup>19</sup> For ‘this word is in charge’, Selassie has (conjecturally) ‘this world is passing’.  
<sup>20</sup> It is not clear where David’s quote comes from.  
<sup>21</sup> In place of the 1<sup>st</sup> instance of ‘light’, Selassie has ‘Torch’.  
<sup>22</sup> Selassie has ‘example’ in place of ‘parable’.  
<sup>23</sup> For ‘substance’, Selassie has ‘stoutness’.  
<sup>24</sup> The meaning and significance of ‘a seventh of a grain’ are unclear.

ይሰጣል ሥርም በምድር ላይ በቅላ ቅጠልን ታወጣለች።  
<sup>25</sup> እርሷም ከፈረሰች ከበሰበሰች መብቀል አትችልም ከበቀለች በኋላ ግን ብዙ ዝርዝር ታወጣለች። <sup>26</sup> ላደረገ ለዚያ ለዝርዝሩም በእግዚአብሔር ፈቃድ ፍሬ ይሰጠዋል ግዘፉንም ገለባ ያለብሰወል። <sup>27</sup> የዘራኸው ዘር ቅንጣቱ እንደበዛ መጠን እይ እንጂ ብሩና ቅጠሉ ምርቁና ገለባው አይቆጠርልህም።  
<sup>28</sup> የማያውቅ ደንቆሮ አትሁን ዘርህንም እንደበዛ አይ እንደዚህም ሁሉ የሞቱ ሰዎች የሚነሡትን መነሣት እንደ ሥራቸውም ፍዳቸውን አንዲቀበሉ አስብ። <sup>29</sup> ስንዴ ብትዘራው ገብስ ሆኖ ገብስ ብትዘራው ስንዴ ሆኖ እንዳይበቅል ስማኝ ልንገርህ ዳግመኛም እንዳይበቅል ስንዴ ብትዘራ ገብስ ትሰበስባለህን ፌጦ ብትሠራ ተልባ ትሰበስባለህን። <sup>30</sup> ከተክልሰ ወገን በለስ ብትተክል በውኑ ለውዝ ሆኖ ይበቅልልሃልን ገውዝስ ብትተክል ወይን ሆኖ ይበቅልልሃልን። <sup>31</sup> የጣፈጠውን ፍሬ ብትተክል የመረረ ሆኖ ይበቅልልሃልን የመረረውንስ ፍሬ ብትተክል የጣፈጠውን መሆን ይቻለዋልን።  
<sup>32</sup> እንደዚሁስ ሁሉ ኃጢአተኛ ቢሞት በትንሣኤ ጊዜ ጻድቅን ሆኖ መነሣት ይቻላልን ጻድቅ ሰውስ ቢሞት በትንሣኤ ጊዜ

he pleases, and it puts forth roots and shoots in the earth. <sup>25</sup> If it is broken and rotten, it cannot sprout; but, after it sprouts, it produces many buds. <sup>26</sup> And according to the will of God, fruit is given to the buds that grow, and he will clothe the plant with straw. <sup>27</sup> You will see the abundance of the seed that you sowed but the ears and the straw are counted for you.  
<sup>28</sup> Do not be ignorant and foolish, and do not think that your descendants will be multiplied, but that the dead will be raised and will receive their reward according to their works. <sup>29</sup> If you sow wheat, it will not grow into barley. If you sow barley, it will not grow into wheat. Listen, let me tell you, so that it will not grow into wheat again. If you sow wheat, will you harvest barley? If you sow watercress, will you gather linseed? <sup>30</sup> If you plant a fig tree, will it grow into a nut? If you plant an almond, will it grow into a grape? <sup>31</sup> If you plant a sweet fruit, will it grow into a bitter fruit? If you plant a bitter fruit, will it grow into a sweet fruit?  
<sup>32</sup> In the same way, if a sinner dies, is it possible for him to rise again as a righteous person in the resurrection? And if a

<sup>25</sup> The 3P pronouns in this verse are actually feminine.

<sup>26</sup> The translation of this verse (here loosely following Selassie) is very uncertain.

<sup>27</sup> The translation of this verse (here loosely following Selassie) is very uncertain.

<sup>28</sup> Selassie has ‘dull’ in place of ‘ignorant’.

<sup>29</sup> The last sentence here follows Selassie; the Amharic text appears to read, “If you sow barley, will you gather flax?”

<sup>30</sup> ‘Almond’ follows Selassie; the Amharic text is uncertain.

<sup>31</sup> Though the text is often uncertain, the general sense of vv. 29–31 is clear.

<sup>32</sup> Here, the point of the previous questions is addressed.

ኃጢአተኛ ሆኖ መነሣት ይቻላልን ሁሉም እንደሥራው ፍዳውን ይቀበላል እንጂ እንደ ኃጢአቱ እንደ እጁም ሥራ ፍዳውን ይቀበላል እንጂ በባልንጀራው ኃጢአት የሚፈረድበት የለም። <sup>33</sup> የደጋ ዛፍ ይተከላል ረጃጅም ቅርንጫፎችንም ያወጣል ፈጽሞ ይደርቃል አንጂ የሰማይ ዝናም ካልዘነመ ቅጠሉ አይለመልምም። <sup>34</sup> ዝግባውም የክረምት ዝናም በርሱ ካልወረደ ከሥሩ ይነቀላል። <sup>35</sup> እንደዚሁም ሁሉ ከእግዚአብሔር ታዝዞ የደኅንነት ጠል ካልወረደላቸው የሞቱ ሰዎች አይነሡም።

righteous person dies, is it possible for him to rise again as a sinner in the resurrection? No one will be judged for the sins of his neighbour but everyone will receive what he has done. He will receive what he has done and what his hands have done. <sup>33</sup> A highland tree is planted and produces tall branches; but it will wither and, if the rain from heaven does not fall, its leaves will not grow. <sup>34</sup> Even a cedar tree, if the winter rains do not fall on it, will be uprooted. <sup>35</sup> Likewise, the dead will not rise unless the dew of salvation descends upon them at God's command.

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<sup>33</sup> In place of 'grow', Selassie has 'be verdant'.

<sup>34</sup> Selassie has 'summer' in place of 'winter'.

<sup>35</sup> For 'salvation', Selassie reads 'welfare'.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፱

<sup>1</sup> የደጋ ተራሮችና የጌላቡሄ አውራጃዎች ከእግዚአብሔር ታዝዞ ይቅርታ ዝናም ካልዘነመላቸው ለአውራጃዎችና ለእንስሶች ሣርን አያበቅሉም። <sup>2</sup> የኤላም ተራራዎችና የገለዓድ ተራራዎችም ለሚሠመሩ ለበጎችና ለፍየሎች ለፌቆና በምድረ በዳ ላሉ እንስሳትም ለዋሊያዎችና ለቶራትም የለመለመ ቅጠልን አይሰጡም። <sup>3</sup> እንደዚሁም ስሕተትና ወንጀልን አስቀድሞ ገንዘብ ያደረጓት ተጠራጣሪና ወንጀለኞች ከእግዚአብሔር ታዝዞ ይቅርታና ጠል አልወረደላቸውም የሞቱ ሰዎች አይነሡም ጣዖት የሚያመልኩና ሥር የሚምሱ ነገር ሠርተው የሚያጣሉ ዲማስና ቆጵሮስም። <sup>4</sup> ሥር የሚምሱና ጥንቄላንም የሚጠነቁሉ ሰውንም የሚያጋድሉ። <sup>5</sup> ከሕግም ወጥተው የሚሰከኩ በጣዖታቸው የሚያምኑ የሚዶንና የአቴና ሰዎችም መሰንቆንና ከበሮን እየመጡ በገናም እየደረደሩ የሚጫወቱላቸውና የሚዘፍኑላቸውም ከእግዚአብሔር ታዝዞ የይቅርታ ጠል ካልወረደላቸው አይነሡም። <sup>6</sup> የሞቱ ሰዎች በሚነሡባት ቁርጥ ፍርድ በሚደረግባት ቀን የሚፈረድባቸው እነዚህ ናቸው እንጂ ራሳቸውን የሚያድኑ

## 1 MEQABYAN 9

<sup>1</sup> The highlands and the districts of Gelabue, if God does not forgive them and command rain to fall on them, will not grow grass for the beasts and animals. <sup>2</sup> The mountains of Elam and the mountains of Gilead will not yield green leaves to the flocks and the goats that graze, to the pheasants, and to the wild beasts of the field, to the wild oxen and to the wild goats. <sup>3</sup> Likewise, those who have previously made money out of errors and crimes, who are doubtful and criminals, have not received forgiveness and dew from God. The dead do not rise. Demas and Cyprus, who worship idols and practice what is rooted in evil, have lost everything. <sup>4</sup> Those who dig roots, practice witchcraft, and bewitch people. <sup>5</sup> The Medes and Athenians, who have abandoned the law and are worshipping their idols, who come with harps and lyres, and who play and sing to them, will not rise until the dew of forgiveness descends upon them by the command of God.

<sup>6</sup> These are the ones who will be judged on the Day of Judgment when the dead will be raised. Those who save themselves by

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### 1 MEQABYAN 9

- <sup>1</sup> It is not clear what the 'districts of Gelabue' are.
- <sup>2</sup> The meaning of the word/phrase translated 'pheasants' is uncertain.
- <sup>3</sup> For 'Cyprus', Selassie reads 'Qophros'.
- <sup>4</sup> It is unclear what the practice of digging roots refers to.
- <sup>5</sup> In place of 'lyres', Selassie has 'drums and violins'.
- <sup>6</sup> For 'will be led astray', Selassie has 'err'.



በጃቸው ሥራ የሚሰሱ ሰዎች በጣዖታቸው ይስታሉ።  
<sup>7</sup> አንተ ልበ በካና ደንቆሮ የሞቱ ሰዎች የማይነሡ ይመስልሃልን።  
<sup>8</sup> ሙታን ሊነሡባት በመላእክት አላቃ በቅዱስ ሚካኤል አንደበት መለኸት በተነፋ ጊዜ ሳትነሣ በመቃብር አትቀርምና እንዲህ ያለ ነገር አታስብ።  
<sup>9</sup> ኮረፍቶችና ተራሮች ይተከከላሉ ጥርጊያ ጐዳናም ይሆናሉ።  
<sup>10</sup> ለሥጋዊ ሁሉም ተንሣኤ ይደረጋል።

their own deeds will be led astray by their idols. <sup>7</sup> You ignorant people; do you think that those who died will never be resurrected? <sup>8</sup> Do not think of such things! For, when the Chief of Angels, Michael, blows the trumpet, you will not remain in the grave without being raised. <sup>9</sup> Hills and mountains will be levelled and become paved roads. <sup>10</sup> There will be a resurrection for all those of flesh and blood.

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<sup>7</sup> Another possible reading is, “Do you think that those who died in the wilderness of Cana will never be resurrected?”  
<sup>8</sup> A more literal reading of ‘Chief of Angels’ (following Selassie) is ‘Saint’.  
<sup>9</sup> In place of ‘paved roads’, Selassie has ‘a clear path’.  
<sup>10</sup> For ‘those of flesh and blood’, Selassie has ‘fleshy ones’.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፲

<sup>1</sup> ነገር ግን እንዲህ ካልሆነ የቀደሙ ሰዎች ከአዳም ጀምሮ ከሴትና ከአቤል ከሴምና ከኖኅ ከይስሐቅና ከአብርሃም በዮሴፍና ከያዕቆብ ከአሮንና ከሙሴም ጀምሮ በአባቶቻቸው መቃብር ይቀበሩ ዘንድ ነው እንጂ በሌላ ቦታ ይቀበሩ ዘንድ ያልወደዱ ለምንድነው። <sup>2</sup> በትንሣኤ ጊዜ ከዘመዳቸው ጋራ አንድነት ሊነሡ አይደለምን አጥንታቸውስ ጦዖት ከሚያመልኩ ከክፉዎች ከአረማውያንም አጥንት ጋራ እንዳይቈጠር አይደለምን በሌላ ቦታ ይቀበሩ ዘንድ ያልወደዱ ለምንድነው።

<sup>3</sup> አንተ ግን እልፍ እልፍ ሆነው ባንድ መቃብር የተቀበሩ ሰውነታቸውም የፈረሰ የበሰበሰ የሞቱ ሰዎች ከሞቱ በኋላ እንዴት ይነሣሉ እያልህ ልቡናህን አታስት። <sup>4</sup> ወደ መቃብርም ባየህ ጊዜ እፍኝ ሙሉ መሬት አይገኝም የሞቱ ሰዎች እንዴት ይነሣሉ እያልክ በልቡናህ ድንቁርና ይህንን ትናገራለህ። <sup>5</sup> አንተ የዘራኸው ዘር አይበቅልም ትላለህን አንተ የዘራኸው ዘር ስንኳ ይበቅላል።

<sup>6</sup> እንደዚሁም ሁሉ እግዚአብሔር የዘራቸው ነፍሳት ፈጥነው ይነሣሉ እሱ ሰውን በውነቱ ካለመኖር ወደ መኖር አምጥቶ ፈጥሮታልና በምታድን ቃሉ ፈጥኖ ያስነሣቸዋል ማስነሣቱን

## 1 MEQABYAN 10

<sup>1</sup> However, if this is not the case, why did the ancient people not want to be buried somewhere else, from Adam, from Seth, from Abel, from Shem, from Noah, from Isaac, from Abraham, from Joseph, from Jacob, from Aaron, and Moses, but to be buried in the graves of their fathers? <sup>2</sup> Why didn't they want to be buried somewhere else, so that they wouldn't be buried with their relatives in the resurrection, and their bones wouldn't be counted with the bones of the wicked who worship idols and pagans?

<sup>3</sup> But do not mislead your mind by wondering, "How can thousands of people buried in one grave, their bodies decaying and decomposing, ever rise again after death." <sup>4</sup> And, when you look at the grave, you will not find a handful of earth. You will think this in your heart of ignorance, saying, "How can the dead be raised?" <sup>5</sup> Do you say that the seed you sow will not grow? Even the seed you sow will grow.

<sup>6</sup> In the same way, all the souls that God has sown will quickly arise. In truth, he created man out of non-existence into existence, and he will quickly raise them up with his saving word, and he

## 1 MEQABYAN 10

<sup>1</sup> The order of the 'Patriarchs' listed here, and the names included, seems somewhat arbitrary.

<sup>2</sup> At the end of this verse, Selassie adds, "*Fe what are it that them didn't love that them might be buried ina another place?*"

<sup>3</sup> For 'decaying and decomposing', Selassie has 'demolished and rotten'.

<sup>4</sup> The literal translation of 'think' is 'say'.

<sup>5</sup> Another (possibly more literal) translation of 'grow' (twice in this verse) is 'germinate'.

<sup>6</sup> For 'raise them up', Selassie has 'arouse them'.

አያዘገይም። <sup>7</sup> ዳግመኛም ከመኖር በሞት ወደ መቃብር  
መልሶታልና ደግመኛስ ከሞት ወደ ሕይወት መመለስ  
አይቻለውምን። <sup>8</sup> እግዚአብሔር ማዳን ማንሳት ይቻለዋል።

will not delay in raising them up. <sup>7</sup> And, since he returned from  
life to the grave in death, how can he not return from death to life  
again? <sup>8</sup> The LORD is able to save.

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<sup>7</sup> The referent here appears to be God (i.e., Christ).

<sup>8</sup> The word used for ‘*the LORD*’ here is እግዚአብሔር.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። 1፩

<sup>1</sup> አርሞን ጠፋች አምባዎቿም ፈረሱ እግዚአብሔር እንደ ክፋታቸው በእጃቸውም እንደ ሠሩት ሥራ ፍዳውን አምጥቶባቸዋል። በኤዶምያስና በዛብሎን ጦዖቶቹን የሚያመልኩ ሰዎች ያን ጊዜ ይዋረዳሉ በሕፃንነታቸው በሠሩት እስኪያረጁም ድረስ ባልተውት ስለ ጣዖታቸውና ስለ ክፋታቸው የሚፈርዳባቸው እግዚአብሔር ቀርቧልና ሲዶናና ጢሮስ ያለቅሳሉ።

<sup>2</sup> ኃጢአትንና መዳራትን ዝሙትን ስለ ሠሩ ጣዖትንም ስላመለኩ ስለዚህ ነገር እግዚአብሔር ተበቅሎ ያጠፋቸዋል። በፈጣሪያቸው በእግዚአብሔር ትእዛዝ ጸንተው አልኖሩምና የይሁዳም ሴቶች ልጆች ይጎሳቁላሉ። <sup>3</sup> ነቢያትን በመግደልና በተድላ በደስታ ጸንታ ኖረች እንጂ በዘጠኙ ሕግጋትና በአምልኮቱ ጸንታ አልኖረችምና ሙታን በሚነሡባት ጊዜ የኢየሩሳሌም ኃጢአቷ ይገለጣል።

<sup>4</sup> የዚያን ጊዜ እግዚአብሔር በባሕርይ ጥበቡ ይመረምራታል በሕፃንነቷ ዘመን በሠራችው ኃጢአቷ ሁሉ ተበቅሎ ያጠፋታል ከቆንጅነቷ ዘመን ጀምሮ እስክታረጅ ድረስ ኃጢአት መሥራቷን አልተወችም። <sup>5</sup> በኃጢአታቸው ጸንተው እንደ ኖሩ እንደ ቀደሙ አባቶቿ ወደ መቃብር ገብታ

## 1 MEQABYAN 11

<sup>1</sup> Hermon is destroyed, and her towers are broken down. The LORD has punished them according to their wickedness and the work of their hands. The idolaters of Edom and Zebulun will be humiliated at that time. They will mourn over their idols and their wickedness, which they have not abandoned even to old age. Sidon and Tyre will mourn over their idols and their wickedness.

<sup>2</sup> Because they have committed sin, debauchery, and whoredom, and have worshipped idols, the LORD will rise up and destroy them; and the daughters of Judah will be disgraced, because they have not kept the commandments of the LORD their Maker. <sup>3</sup> Jerusalem's sins will be revealed when the dead are resurrected; for, she did not abide by the Nine Commandments and worship, but rather by killing the prophets and living in pleasure.

<sup>4</sup> At that time, the LORD will examine her in his natural wisdom and destroy her for all the sins she committed in her childhood. From the time of her beauty until she was old, she did not stop sinning. <sup>5</sup> Like her fathers who persisted in their sins, she went to the grave and turned to dust; and he will rise up and destroy

## 1 MEQABYAN 11

<sup>1</sup> In place of 'towers', Selassie has 'fortress'.

<sup>2</sup> The word used for 'the LORD' here (twice) is እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>3</sup> On the 'Nine Commandments', see #7:6.

<sup>4</sup> For 'childhood', Selassie has 'infancy'.

<sup>5</sup> Selassie has 'demolished' in place of 'broke'.

ትቢያ ሆነች የእግዚአብሔርንም ሕግ ያፈረሱ ሰዎችን በትንሣኤ ጊዜ ተበቅሎ ያጠፋቸዋል። <sup>6</sup> የሕጋቸው ማደሪያ ልቡናቸው የሰዶም ሕግ ማደሪያ ሆነ ብሎ ሙሴ ስለነርሳቸው ተናግሯልና ይፈረድባቸዋል። <sup>7</sup> ወገናቸውም የገሞራ ወገን ነው ሕጋቸውም የሚያጠፋ ነው ሥራቸውም ክፉ ነው። <sup>8</sup> ሕጋቸውም የሚያጠፋ የባብ መርዝ ከዚያውም ዘንድ የሚያጠፋ የፉኝት መርዝ ነው።

those who broke God’s law at the time of the resurrection. <sup>6</sup> And they will be judged; for, Moses spoke of them, saying, “The dwelling place of their law has become the dwelling place of the law of Sodom.” <sup>7</sup> Their people are like those of Gomorrah, their laws are destructive, and their deeds are evil. <sup>8</sup> Their law is the poison of the snake that destroys, and the poison of the viper that destroys alongside it.

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<sup>6</sup> Some transpose ‘and they will be judged’ to the end of the verse.

<sup>7</sup> Selassie ends, “and their work is evil.”

<sup>8</sup> The exact meanings of the words translated ‘snake’ and ‘viper’ (following Selassie) are uncertain.



## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ፡ ፲፪

<sup>1</sup> የኢየሩሳሌም ልጅ ይህ ኃጢአትሽ እንደ ገሞራና እንደ ሰዶም ኃጢአት ነውና የኢየሩሳሌም ልጅ በነቢይ የተነገረ መከራሽ ይህ ነው። <sup>2</sup> መከራሽም እንደ ገሞራና እንደ ሰዶም መከራ ነው የሕግ ማደሪያ ልቡናቸውም በዝሙትና በትዕቢት ጸና። <sup>3</sup> ያለዝሙትና ያለትዕቢት ዝናም በቀር ያለኃጢአትና ያለበደል የሰው ደም ከማፍሰስና ከመቀማት የፈጣሪያቸው የእግዚአብሔርንም ስም ከመዘንጋት በቀር የሕግ ልቡና ማደሪያቸው በሚለመልም ገንዘብ የይቅርታና የትሕትና ዝናም ከልቡናቸው አልዘነመም።

<sup>4</sup> ከክፉ ሥራቸውና ከጣያታቸው በቀር ፈጣሪያቸው እግዚአብሔርንም አላወቁም በእጃቸውም ሥራ ደስ ይላቸዋል በወንድና በከብትም ይሰስናሉ። <sup>5</sup> ምሥጢር እንዳያዩ ዓይን ልቡናቸው ታውሯልና እንዳይሰሙ እግዚአብሔር የሚወደው ፈቃዱንም እንዳያደርጉ ጆሯቸውም ደንቁሯልና በሥራቸው እግዚአብሔርን አላወቁም ልቡናቸውም አንደ ሰዶም ሕግ ማደሪያ ነው። ወገናቸውም የጣፈጠ ፍሬን የሚያፈራ የገሞራ ወይን ወገን።

<sup>6</sup> ከተሠራበት ቀን ጀምሮ በርግማን ጸንቷልና መሠረቱም በጥፋት ዘመን ሆኗልና ሥራቸውንም ቢመረምሩት የሚገድል

## 1 MEQABYAN 12

<sup>1</sup> This is the calamity the prophet spoke of, O son of Jerusalem; for, your sin is like the sin of Gomorrah and Sodom. <sup>2</sup> And your suffering is like the suffering of Gomorrah and Sodom, the dwelling place of the law, where hearts were hardened by fornication and pride. <sup>3</sup> Without the fame of fornication and pride, without sin and injustice, without shedding and avenging human blood, and without forgetting the name of their Creator, God, their heart of law and their dwelling place, forgiveness and humility did not rain on them.

<sup>4</sup> They do not know God their Maker, except in their evil deeds and their idols. They delight in the works of their own hands and lust on men and animals. <sup>5</sup> They have not known God by their deeds; for their eyes have been blinded, and their hearts have been deaf, so that they cannot see the mystery, and their ears have become dull, so that they cannot do what God wants them to do. Their hearts are like Sodom, the dwelling place of the law. Their people are the vines of Gomorrah, which produce sweet fruit.

<sup>6</sup> For, the curse was established since the day it was built and its foundation was laid in the time of destruction; and, if they

### 1 MEQABYAN 12

<sup>1</sup> Selassie has 'child' in place of 'son' and repeats the phrase, 'child of Jerusalem' at the start of the verse.

<sup>2</sup> In place of 'fornication and pride', Selassie has 'adultery and arrogance'.

<sup>3</sup> The phrase, 'did not rain on them', (loosely) follows Selassie.

<sup>4</sup> Here, 'lust on' follows Selassie; the Amharic text is uncertain and may read, 'are rich in'.

<sup>5</sup> The phrase, 'dwelling place of the law', applied to Sodom (here and elsewhere) seems strange.

<sup>6</sup> For 'deadly poison', Selassie has 'poison that kill(s)'.

መርዝ ሆነ። <sup>7</sup> የሕጋቸው ማደሪያ ልቡናቸው በኃጢአት ሥራ ጸንቷልና ሰውነታቸው ኃጢአት ለማሠራት በሚናደድ በሰይጣን ሥራ ጸንቷልና ለሕጋቸው ማደሪያ ለልቡናቸው ሁለ ጊዜ በጎ ሥራ የለውም። <sup>8</sup> አፍርቶም በተጠመቀ ጊዜ /በተመሪ/ ለመቅሠፍትና ለጥፋት ሆነ የጠጡትንም ሰዎች ልቡናቸውንም ያጸናዋል እኔንም የሚያጠፉ የሚያጸይፉ ከእግዚአብሔር የራቁ ሰዎችን ያደርጋቸዋል። <sup>9</sup> ክፉ በሆነ ሥራው ጸንተው ይኖራሉና የዲያብሎስም ማደሪያ ያደርጋቸዋል ቤተ እስራኤልም ለጣዖቱ የተሠዋውን መብላት ተጀመረባት ወደ ተራራዎችም ወደ ዛፎችም ትወጣለች።

<sup>10</sup> በዙሪያዋ ያሉ አሕዛብ የሚያመልኩት ጣዖቱንም ታመልከዋለች ከክፉ ለይተው በጎ ሥራን ለማያውቁ ለአጋንንትም ሴቶች ልጆቿንና ወንዶች ልጆቿን። <sup>11</sup> ንጹሕ ደምንም ፈሳሉ ከሰዶም ወይን ለዘላለም ፍልቅ አድርገው ለጣዖቱ ያፈርሳሉ። <sup>12</sup> ኢሎፍላውያን የሚያመልኩት ደጉንንም አክብራ ታመልካለች ልትሠዋላቸውም አጋንንት ባስተማሯት በስንፍናቸውና ወይኑን ፍልቅ አድርገው በማፍሰሳቸው ደስ ይላት ዘንድ ከመንጋዎቿና ከሰቡት ላሞቿ ትሠዋለታለች ፈቃዳቸውንም ታደርግ ዘንድ። <sup>13</sup> በየጊዜው የሚመጣባት ከሕፃንነቷ ጀምሮ እስከ ቁንጅናዋ ዘመን ድረስ

examine their work, it has become a deadly poison. <sup>7</sup> For, the dwelling place of the law is not always good for their minds; for, their minds are always strong in the works of sin and their bodies are strong in the works of Satan, who is angry with sin. <sup>8</sup> When he was baptized, he hardened the hearts of those who were destined for punishment and destruction, and he made those who would destroy me and hate me far from God. <sup>9</sup> They will continue in their evil deeds and will make them a dwelling place for the devil. The house of Israel will begin to eat what was sacrificed to idols and will go to the mountains and to the trees.

<sup>10</sup> She worships the idols that the nations around her worship, and she gives her daughters and sons to demons, who do not know how to distinguish good from evil. <sup>11</sup> They will shed innocent blood and pour out the wine of Sodom forever, destroying it for its idols. <sup>12</sup> She also worships the gods worshipped by the Philistines, and, having been taught by the demons to sacrifice to them, she sacrifices from her flocks and fattened cows, in order to please them with their foolishness and the pouring of wine, and to do their will. <sup>13</sup> She is constantly being fed, from her

<sup>7</sup> In place of ‘angry’, Selassie has ‘burning’.

<sup>8</sup> The mention of Satan being ‘baptized’ is peculiar.

<sup>9</sup> Going to the mountains and the trees implies the worship of idols in their ‘sacred places’.

<sup>10</sup> After ‘good’, Selassie adds ‘work’.

<sup>11</sup> Selassie has ‘clean’ in place of ‘innocent’.

<sup>12</sup> For ‘Philistines’, Selassie reads ‘Iloflans’.

<sup>13</sup> The translation is here uncertain, with a number of phrases possibly being repeated in the Amharic text.

ደግመኛም እስከ እርጅናዋ ዘመን ድረስ ደግመኛም እስከ እርጅናዋ እስከምትሞትበት ቀን ድረስ ተከባክቦ ያሳደጋት ፈጣሪዋ እግዚአብሔርን እንዲታውቅ አጋንንት ባስተማሯት በስንፍናቸው ደስ ይላት ዘንድ ትሠዋለታለች።

<sup>14</sup> ዳግመኛም ተበቅዬ በትንሣኤ ጊዜ እፈርድበታለሁ ወደ ሕጌም አልተመለሰችምና በትእዛዜም ጸንታ አልኖረችምና በገሃነም የምትኖርበት ጊዜዋ እስከ ዘለዓለም ድረስ ይሆናል።

<sup>15</sup> በውነት ፈጣሪዎች ከሆኑ እሷን ተቈጥቼ ባጠፋሁ ጊዜ ከሷም ጋር የሚሰስኑ ካህናት ጣዖቱን ሁሉ ባራቅሁ ጊዜ ጦዖቶቿ ከሷ ጋራ ተነሥተው ወደ ገሃነም ወርደው ያድኗት።

<sup>16</sup> በንዋየ ቅድሳትና በማደሪያዬ በቤተ መቅደስ ኃጢአትና ስድብ እንዳደረገች በዚህ ሁሉ የጐሰቁለችን አደረግኳት።

<sup>17</sup> እነሆ ይህች የእግዚአብሔር ወገን ናት የእስራኤል ፈጣሪ እግዚአብሔርም ወደራያ ናት ከተለዩ የተለየች የገናናው ንጉሥ አገር ኢየሩሳሌምም የልዑል እግዚአብሔር የስሙ ማደሪያ ናት ሲሷት በሷ የተጠራ ስሜን እንዳሳዘነች የጐሰቁለችን አደረግኳት። <sup>18</sup> እሷ ባርያዬ እንደ ሆነች እኔም ጌታዋ እንደ ሆንኩ በኔ ትመካለች እንደ ወንጀለኛ ትጠቃቀስብኛለች እንጂ ጌታዋ አንደ መሆኔ የምትፈራኝ ፈቃዴንም የምታደርግ አይደለችም። <sup>19</sup> ከኔ ያርቋት ዘንድ ለማሳት መሰናክል ሆኑባት እንጂ ለማይመግቧት ለማያለብሷት

childhood to her beauty, and again to her old age, and again to the day of her death, and she is being sacrificed so that the demons may delight in their foolishness, lest she should learn to know God, the Creator who raised her.

<sup>14</sup> And I will rise again and judge her at the resurrection, and her time in Gehenna will be for eternity, because she did not return to my law and did not abide by my commandments. <sup>15</sup> If they are truly the creators, when I destroy her in anger and remove all the idols of the priests who are with her, her idols will rise up with her and descend into Gehenna to save her. <sup>16</sup> I have made her miserable in all this, just as she sinned and blasphemed in my holy places and in my dwelling place, in the Temple.

<sup>17</sup> Behold, this is the people of God, and the Creator of Israel is a vision of God, a land separated from those who are separated, a land of the King of the Gentiles, and Jerusalem is the dwelling place of the name of the Most High God. I have made her a desolation, because she has grieved my name, by which she is called. <sup>18</sup> She boasts of me as if I were her slave and she were my master; but she treats me like a criminal, not as if I were her master, nor as if she fears me and does my will. <sup>19</sup> She will worship other idols who do not feed her or clothe her, but who

<sup>14</sup> Some read 'hell' in place of 'Gehenna'.

<sup>15</sup> There is a distinct, sarcastic tone to this verse.

<sup>16</sup> Selassie has 'wretched' in place of 'miserable'.

<sup>17</sup> The translation, 'by which she is called', is uncertain.

<sup>18</sup> For 'treats me like a criminal', Selassie has 'winks upon me as if I were a criminal'.

<sup>19</sup> For 'stumbling block', Selassie has 'obstacle'.

ለሌሎች ጦቶች ትገዛለች። <sup>20</sup> መሥዋዕት ትሠዋላቸዋለች መሥዋዕቱንም ትበላለች ደምም ታፈስላቸዋለች ከወይኑም ፍልቅ አድርጋ ትጠጣለች ዕጣን ታጥንላቸዋለች የዕጣኑንም መዓዛ ታሸትላቸዋለች ጣቶቿ ያዝዟታል እሷም ትታዘዝላቸዋለች።

<sup>21</sup> ዳግመኛም ሴት ልጆቿን ወንዶች ለጆቿንም ትሠዋላቸዋለች ስለ ፍቅራቸውም ምስጋና ታቀርብላቸዋለችና ባንደበቷ በተናገረች ነገርና በእጇቿ ሥራ ደስ ይላታል።

<sup>22</sup> ቁርጥ ፍርድ በሚደረግባት ቀን ለሷ ወዮላት ለምትወዳቸው ለምትዋህዳቸው ለጣቶቿም ወዮላቸው ትሉ ወደማያንቀላፋበት እሳቱ ወደማይጠፋበት ከለሳቸውም ጋራ ከሲኦል በታች ወዳለ ወደ ሃገንም ትወርዳለች።

<sup>23</sup> የፈጠርኩሽ እኔን ትተሽ ልዩ የሆኑ ጦቶችን አምልከሻልና የጎብኤልሽ የኢየሩሳሌም ልጅ ወዮልሽ። <sup>24</sup> እኔም እንደ ሥራሽ ፍዳውን አመጣብሻለሁ አሳዝነሽኛልና ቃሌንም ቸል ብለሽዋልና በጎ ሥራንም አልሠራሽምና ወደ ተግዳሮትሽ እፈርድብሻለሁ።

<sup>25</sup> አንቺ ቃሌን አሳዝነሽዋል ሕጌን ትጠብቂ ዘንድ እኔም ካንቺ ጋራ በረድኤት እኖር ዘንድ ከሚጣሉሽም ሁሉ አድንሽ ዘንድ አንቺም ያዘዝኩሽን ሥርዓቴንም ትጠብቂ ዘንድ ከኔ ጋራ በተማማልሽበት ሕጌም ጸንተሽ አልኖርሽምና እኔም ቸል

have become a stumbling block to her in order to lead her away from me. <sup>20</sup> She sacrifices to them, and eats the sacrifices, and pours blood upon them, and drinks the wine, and burns incense on them, and smells the fragrance of incense on them. Her idols command her, and she obeys them.

<sup>21</sup> Again, she sacrifices her daughters and sons to her hands, and she gives thanks to them for their love, and is pleased with the words of her mouth and the works of her hands.

<sup>22</sup> On the day of judgment, woe to her, to those she loved, and to her idols, and she will go down with them to the worm that doesn't sleep and to the unquenchable fire, to Gehenna beneath Sheol. <sup>23</sup> Woe to you, son of Jerusalem, who have become corrupt; for, you have forsaken me, who created you, and have worshiped strange idols. <sup>24</sup> I will repay you according to your deeds, because you have grieved me and have ignored my words and have not done good. I will judge you according to your pretensions.

<sup>25</sup> You have despised my word, and have not kept my covenant, which I swore to you, that you would keep my statutes, and that I would be with you to help you, and that I would deliver you from all enemies. Thus, I will also forsake you and will not

<sup>20</sup> Obviously, the statement that the idols command her is sarcastic and metaphorical.

<sup>21</sup> Child sacrifice was practised by the early inhabitants of Canaan.

<sup>22</sup> Another reading for 'Gehenna beneath Sheol' (following Selassie) is 'the lowest hell'.

<sup>23</sup> For 'son', Selassie has 'child'; it is also possible to read 'daughter'.

<sup>24</sup> Selassie has 'convict' in place of the 2<sup>nd</sup> instance of 'judge'.

<sup>25</sup> In place of 'trouble', Selassie has 'tribulation'.



እልሻለሁ ፈጥኜም ከመከራው አላድንሽም። <sup>26</sup> ይህን ሁሉ አልጠበቅሽም እኔም ቸል አልሁሽ እኔ ፈጥሬሻለሁና ትእዛዜና ቃሌንም አልጠበቅሽምና በፍርድ ጊዜ እፈርድብሻለሁ የኔም ወገን ትሆኒ ዘንድ አከበርሁሽ። <sup>27</sup> ገሞራና ሰዶም ከኔ እንደ ተለዩ አንቺም ከኔ ተለየሽ።

<sup>28</sup> እኔም ፈርጄ አጠፋኅቸው ሰዶምና ገሞራ ከኔ እንደ ተለዩ አንቺም ከኔ ተለየሽ አሁንም ተቈጥቼ እንዳጠፋቸው አንቺንም ተቈጥቼ አጠፋሁሽ እኔ ካጠፋኋቸው ከሰዶም ከገሞራ ወገን ነሽና አጠፋሁሽ ወደ ጉልማሳ ሚስት በመሔድ ከሴቶች ጋር እንደ መድረስ ከእንስሳና ከወንድ ጋራ ያለ ሕግም በመሰሰን የፈጠርኅቸው እኔን አሳዝነውኛልና በተድላ በደስታቸው እንዳይኖሩ ስም አጠራራቸውን ከዚህ ዓለም አጠፋሁ።

<sup>29</sup> ከሕንፃ ጀምሮ እስከ ሽማግሌ ድረስ በፊታቸው እግዚአብሔርን መፍራት የለም በክፉ ሥራ ሁሉ ይረዱታል እንጂ እሷን መሥራት ይተው ዙንድ አንዱ አንዱን አይቈጣውም ሥራቸው ክፉ ነውና ኃጢአትንና በደልን የጠገቡ ናቸው። <sup>30</sup> ክፉ ሥራ ሁሉ ቅሚያና ትዕቢት ስስትም በልቡናቸው የተዘጋጀ ነው። <sup>31</sup> ስለዚህም ነገር እግዚአብሔር ቸል አላቸው አገሮቻቸውንም አጠፋቸው ሥር መሠረታቸው እስኪጠፋ ድረስ በእሳት ያቃጠላቸውም አሉ እስከ ዘለዓለሙ

deliver you quickly from trouble. <sup>26</sup> You did not keep all this, so I ignored you. I created you, and you did not keep my commandments and my words. So, I will judge you in the time of judgment; I honoured you, that you may be my people. <sup>27</sup> You have departed from me, just like Gomorrah and Sodom.

<sup>28</sup> I have destroyed them in judgment; just like Sodom and Gomorrah, you departed from me, and I have destroyed them in anger and destroyed you in anger, because you are of the same race as Sodom and Gomorrah that I destroyed. I have destroyed you. They have grieved me by going to adulterous wives, and by lying with women, and by lying with animals and men, and by lying with them without a law, and I have destroyed their name from this world, so they may not live in their pleasures and joys.

<sup>29</sup> From the youngest to the oldest, there is no fear of God in their eyes; and they do not provoke one another to anger, to abandon their evil practices; for, their deeds are evil and they are full of sin and iniquity. <sup>30</sup> All evil deeds are prepared in their hearts by greed, and by pride, and by covetousness. <sup>31</sup> Therefore, God ignored them, and destroyed their countries, and burned them with fire, until their very foundations were destroyed; and

<sup>26</sup> Selassie has 'convict' in place of 'judge'.

<sup>27</sup> At the end of this verse, the Amharic text repeats 'departed from me'.

<sup>28</sup> After 'Gomorrah', the Amharic text repeats 'departed from me'.

<sup>29</sup> In place of 'full of', Selassie has 'sated with'.

<sup>30</sup> For 'youngest to oldest', Selassie has 'infant to elder'.

<sup>31</sup> For 'greed, and pride, and covetousness', Selassie has 'robbery and greed and arrogance'.



ድረስ ፈጽመው ጠፉ እንጂ ከነርሳቸው አንድ ስንኳ አላስቀረም።

<sup>32</sup> በኃጢአት ጸንተዋልና ቁርጥ ፍርድ እስከ ከሚደረግባት እስከ ዕለተ ምጽአት ድረስ ለዘለዓለሙ በጥፋት ይቈያሉ በክፉ ሥራቸው አሳዝነውኛልና እኔም አልምራቸውም ይቅር አልላቸውም። <sup>33</sup> እኔም ቸል አልኋቸው ሥራሽ ሁሉ ቅያሜና ኃጢአት ዝሙትና ስስት ሐሰት መናገርም የስሕተት ሥራ ሁሉ እኔም የማልወደው መሰናክል ስለ ሆነ ተቈጥቼ ቢያዝኩሽ ጊዜ ምክንያት አታገኘምና የጎስቄልሽ አንቺም የኢየሩሳሌም ልጅ እንደነሳቸው ፍርድ በሚደረግበት ቀን በፍርድ ትያዣለሽ።

<sup>34</sup> እኔ ለክብር አድርጌሽ ነበር አንቺ ግን ራስሽን አዋረድሽ እኔ የኔ ገንዘብ ብየሽ ነበር አንቺ ግን ለሌላ ሆንሽ። <sup>35</sup> እኔ ለክብር አጭቼሽ ነበር አንቺ ግን ለዲያብሎስ ሆንሽ እኔም እንደ ክፉ ሥራሽ ተበቅዬ አጠፋሻለሁ። <sup>36</sup> ቃሌን ሁሉ ስላልሰማሽ በወደድሁሽም ጊዜ ያዘዝሁሽን ትእዛዝ ስላልጠበቅሽ የፈጠርሁሽ እግዚአብሔር እኔ ነኝና ጽኑ በቀልን አብዝቼ አመጣብሻለሁ እንዳንቺ ባለ በኃጥአንም ሁሉ እፈርዳለሁ እንደ ክፉ ሥራቸውም ፍርድ በሚፈረድበት ቀን ፍዳውን አመጣባቸዋለሁ።

<sup>37</sup> ቃሌን አልጠበቅሽምና ፍርዴንም ቸል ብለሻልና ከነርሱ

they were utterly destroyed for ever. He left not one of them alive.

<sup>32</sup> They persist in their sins and they will remain in eternal destruction until the Day of Judgement, when they will be judged. I will not spare them or forgive them; for, they have grieved me with their evil deeds. <sup>33</sup> I have ignored all your works, your rebellion, your sin, your adultery, your covetousness, your lying, and all the wrongdoings that I do not like. If I were to seize you in anger, you would not find any reason. You, wretched one, will be seized in judgment on the Day of Judgment, just as the son of Jerusalem did.

<sup>34</sup> I honoured you but you humiliated yourself. I considered you my money but you became someone else's. <sup>35</sup> I had chosen you for glory, but you have become for the devil, and I will destroy you according to your evil deeds. <sup>36</sup> Because you have not obeyed all my words, and have not kept the commandments that I commanded you when I loved you, I, the LORD, who created you, will bring upon you a great vengeance, and I will judge all the wicked like you, and I will repay them according to their wicked deeds on the day of judgment.

<sup>37</sup> I will judge you with them, because you have not kept my

<sup>32</sup> For 'Day of Judgement', Selassie has 'Day of Advent'.

<sup>33</sup> For 'son', Selassie has 'child'; it is also possible to read 'daughter'.

<sup>34</sup> The comparison to 'money' is unusual.

<sup>35</sup> In place of 'the devil', Selassie has 'Deeyablos'.

<sup>36</sup> The word used for 'the LORD' here is እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>37</sup> Selassie has 'convict' in place of 'judge'.

ጋራ እፈርድብሻለሁ።<sup>38</sup> በልቡናችሁ እግዚአብሔርን መፍራት የሌለባችሁ ገሞራና ሰዶም ወዮላችሁ።<sup>39</sup> በእሳት ገሃነም ካንቺ ጋራ ባንድነት የሚፈረድባት እትሽ የኢየሩሳሌም ልጅ እንደዚሁ ሁሉ ወዮላት ለዘለዓለሙ መውጫ ወደሌለበት ወደ ተዘጋጅላችሁ ወደ ገሃነም አንድነት ትወርዳላችሁና ያንቺንም ኃጢአት የሠሩ ኃጢአተኞች ሁሉ ወዮላቸው።<sup>40</sup> ትእዛዜንና ቃሌን አልጠበቃችሁምና ትእዛዜንና ቃሌን ያልጠበቃችሁ አንቺና እርሷ ፍርድ በሚፈረድበት ቀን ባንድነት ወደ ሲኦል ትወርዳላችሁ።<sup>41</sup> ትእዛዜንና ቃሌን የጠበቁ ደጋጎች ሰዎች ግን ኃጢአተኞች ሰዎች ያደለቡትን ገንዘብ ይበላሉ ክፉዎች ሰዎች የማረኩትንም ምርኮ እግዚአብሔር እንዳዘዘ ደጋጎች ሰዎች ይካፈላሉ ደጋጎች ሰዎችም ፈጽመው ደስ ይላቸዋል።<sup>42</sup> በደለኞችና ኃጢአተኞች ሰዎች ግን ያለቅሳሉ ከትእዛዜ ወጥተው ስለ በደሉት ኃጢአታቸውም ሁሉ ያዝናሉ።<sup>43</sup> ቃሉን የሚጠብቁ በትእዛዜም ጸንቶ የሚኖር በረከቴን የሚያገኝ በኔ ዘንድ የሚከበር እርሱ ነው።<sup>44</sup> ቃሌን የሚጠብቅ በትእዛዜም ጸንቶ የሚኖር ሰው ሁሉ ከምድር የተገኘውን ድልብ ይበላል ቅን ልቡና ያላቸው ደጋጎች ነገሥታት ወደ ገቡበት ወደ ገነትም ገብቶ ይኖራል።

words and have ignored my judgment.<sup>38</sup> Woe to you, Gomorrah and Sodom! For, you did not fear God in your hearts.<sup>39</sup> Woe to you, daughter of Jerusalem, who will be judged together with you in the fire of hell. Woe to all the sinners who have committed your sins; for, you will descend together into hell, from which there is no escape for eternity.<sup>40</sup> You and she, who have not kept my commandments and my words, will go down together to Sheol on the Day of Judgement, because you have not kept my commandments and my words.

<sup>41</sup> But the righteous, who keep my commandments and my words, shall eat the riches of the wicked; and the righteous shall divide the spoil of the wicked, as the LORD has commanded; and the righteous shall be exceedingly glad.<sup>42</sup> But the wicked and sinful people will weep and mourn over all their sins, because they have transgressed against my commandments.<sup>43</sup> He who keeps my word and abides in my commandments will receive my blessing; he is honoured by me.<sup>44</sup> Whoever keeps my word and walks in my commandments will eat the good of the earth and live in Paradise, where the kind kings and the righteous will dwell.

<sup>38</sup> In place of 'hearts', Selassie has 'reasoning'.

<sup>39</sup> Here, the word translated 'daughter' is clearly feminine (cf. #23, #33).

<sup>40</sup> Throughout the text, Selassie has 'See'ol' in place of 'Sheol'.

<sup>41</sup> The word translated 'the LORD' here is እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>42</sup> For 'wicked', Selassie has 'wrongdoers'.

<sup>43</sup> Selassie has 'alongside I' in place of 'by me'.

<sup>44</sup> In place of 'Paradise', Selassie has 'the Garden'.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፲፫

## 1 MEQABYAN 13

<sup>1</sup> በየዝኃቸው ጊዜ በመዓቴ ይጎሳቁላሉና ይጠፋሉና ዛሬ ራሳቸውን ለሚያሽታ ብዩ ለጢሮስና ለሲዶና ለይሁዳ አገር አውራጃዎች ሁሉ ወዮላቸው። <sup>2</sup> አሸናፊ እግዚአብሔር እንዲህ አለ ፈጽሞ ትዕቢተኛ የሚሆን ያዲያብሎስ ልጅ ሰውነት ነገር ጠላቷ የሚሆን ክሣደ ልቡናውን የሚያጸና የሚመካ ፈጣሪውን የማያውቅ ሐሳዊ መሲሕ ከነሱ ይወለዳል ብልና ወዮላቸው አለ ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔርም በሱ ኃይሉን እገልጽ ዘንድ ለቀጣዩ አምሳለ አደረግሁት አለ። <sup>3</sup> ይቺም ቅፍርናሆም ሰማርያና ገሊላ ደማስቆና ሶርያም አክያና ቆጵሮስና የዮርዳኖስም አውራጃ ሁሉ ከሣደ ልቡናቸውን ያጸኑ በኃጢአታቸው ጸንተው የሚኖሩ የሞት ጥላና ጨለማም የሸፈናቸው ወገኖች ናቸው ዲያብሎስ ልቡናቸውን በኃጢአት ሸፍኖታልና ለዚህም ለትዕቢተኛ ለዲያብሎስ የታዘዙታልና እግዚአብሔርንም ወደ መፍራት አይመለሱም። <sup>4</sup> ለአጋንንት የሚታዘዙላቸው በስማቸውም መሥዋዕት የሚሠውላቸው ሰዎች የዚያን ጊዜ ወዮላቸው የፈጠራቸው እግዚአብሔርን ክደውታልና አእምሮ የሌላቸው እንስሳትን ይመስላሉ የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ የዘነጋ የዲያብሎስ ልጅ የሚሆን ሐሳዊ መሲሕ በቦታው ሁሉ ምስሉን ያቆማልና

<sup>1</sup> Woe to Tyre and Sidon and all the provinces of the land of Judaea, who are arrogant today, because they will be humiliated and destroyed in my wrath when I call on them. <sup>2</sup> The Almighty God said, “Woe to them! For, they will be born of a false Messiah, a son of the devil, who will be completely arrogant, a son of the flesh, an enemy of the flesh, a scoundrel, an arrogant one, a boaster who does not know his Creator.” And the Almighty God said, “I have made him a model for their successors, that I may show my power through him.” <sup>3</sup> This is Capernaum, and Samaria, and Galilee, and Damascus, and Syria, and Achaia, and Cyprus, and all the region beyond the Jordan, who are covered with the shadow of death and darkness, and they do not turn to the fear of God, because the devil has blinded their minds with sin. <sup>4</sup> At that time, woe to those who are commanded by demons and offer sacrifices in their names; for, they are like animals without minds – and they have denied God, who created them. For, the false Messiah, the son of the devil, who has forgotten the law of God, will set up

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### 1 MEQABYAN 13

<sup>1</sup> For ‘humiliated and destroyed’, Selassie has ‘wretched and perish’.

<sup>2</sup> The title, ‘Almighty God’, translates እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>3</sup> In place of ‘Capernaum and Samaria’, Selassie has ‘Qifirnahom Semarya’.

<sup>4</sup> For ‘offer sacrifices’, Selassie has ‘sacrifice sacrifices’. The words in parentheses, here following Selassie, see missing from the Amharic text.

/አምላክ ነኝ ብሏልና/ በልቡናው ፈቃድና በእጁ ሥራ በቅሚያና በኃጢአቱም ሁሉ በክዳትና በበደልም በቅሚያና ሰው በሚሠራው ዝሙት ሁሉ በሐሰት ነገርም ደስ ይለዋል።  
<sup>5</sup> ይህንን እንዲሠራ በእግዚአብሔር ዘንድ የተቈጠረ ስለ ሆነ ኃጢአት እንዲሠሩ ዘመኑ ይታወቃልና። <sup>6</sup> ፀሐይ ትጨልማለች ጨረቃም ደም ትሆናለች ከዋክብትም ከሰማይ ይረግፋሉ ምድርን ያሳልፋት ዘንድ በውስጧም በሚኖሩ ሰዎች ኃጢአት የሚኖረውን ሁሉ ያሳልፈው ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር በፍጻሜ ዘመን በሚያመጣው ተአምራት ሥራው ሁሉ ያልፋል።

<sup>7</sup> እግዚአብሔር በፈጠረው ፍጥረት ላይ ኮርቷልና ፈጥኖም የወደደውን ሁሉ ባንድ ሰዓት አድርጓልና ታናሽ ጠላት ዲያብሎስን የጌታ ሞት ያጠፋዋል። <sup>8</sup> ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር እኔ ፈርጄ አጠፋለሁ ብሏልና ከምጽአት በኋላ ግን ለዲያብሎስ ሥልጣን የለውም። <sup>9</sup> እሱም በቁጣዬ በተያዘበት ቀን ደጅ የሚጠናላት ጽኑ መከራ ወዳላት ወደ ገሃነም ይወርዳል ከሱ ጋራ ያሉትን ሁሉ ወደ መቅሠፍትና ወደ ጥፋት ወደ ክህደትም ይወስዳልና ከገሃነም የማወጣ ወደ ገሃነምም የሚገባ እኔ ስለ ሆንኩ ወደ ገሃነም ይወርዳል።

<sup>10</sup> እሱ ለደከሙ ሰዎች ጽናትና ኃይልን ይሰጣልና ደግመኛም ለኃይለኞችና ለፅኑ ሰዎች ድካምን ይሰጣልና ኃይለኛ በኃይሉ

his image everywhere (*for, he has said, "I am a god"*). <sup>5</sup> For, the time is known for them to sin, because it has been ordained by God that they should do this. <sup>6</sup> The sun will be turned into darkness, and the moon shall become blood, and the stars will fall from heaven. All the miracles that God will bring about in the end times will pass away, to bring judgment on the earth and all that is in it, through the sins of the people who live in it.

<sup>7</sup> God is proud of his creation, and he quickly does whatever he wants in one hour, so the Lord's death destroys the lesser enemy, the devil. <sup>8</sup> But, after the coming of the Lord, the Almighty God has said, "I will judge and destroy." But, after the coming of the Lord, the Devil will have no power. <sup>9</sup> He will descend to Hell, whose gates are closed, and to severe torment on the Day of my wrath. He will lead all those with him into torment, destruction, and disbelief. He will descend to Hell; for, I am the One who brings him out of Hell and the One who enters Hell.

<sup>10</sup> Let not the strong boast in his strength; for, he gives strength and power to the weak, and weakness to the strong and vigorous.

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<sup>5</sup> The translation of this verse is uncertain.  
<sup>6</sup> For 'end times', Selassie has 'Fulfilment Era'.  
<sup>7</sup> The 'Lord' here refers to Jesus Christ.  
<sup>8</sup> The title, 'Almighty God', translates እግዚአብሔር.  
<sup>9</sup> Nothing prevents God from entering Hell, should he choose to do so.  
<sup>10</sup> Selassie has 'firmness' in place of 'strength'.



አይመካ። <sup>11</sup> እሱ ገዥ ነውና የሚበደሉትንም ሰዎች ከሚበድሏቸው ሰዎች እጅ ፍርድዶ ያድናቸዋልና የባልቴቶችና አባት እናቱ የሞቱበትን ልጅ በቀል ይመልሳል።

<sup>12</sup> ለምትመኪ ከሣደ ልቡናሽንም ለምታጸኚ የማልገዛሽ ፈርጄም የማላጠፋሽ ለሚመስልሽ ላንቺ ወዮልሽ በመመካቱና በትዕቢቱ ዙፋኔን በከዋክብትና በሰማይ ላይ እዘረጋለሁ ከፍ እንዳለ እንደ እግዚአብሔርም እሆናለሁ ብሏልና።

<sup>13</sup> ከሁሉ አስቀድሞ የተፈጠረ እንደ አጥቢያ ኮከብ የሚያበራ ዲያብሎስ ከሰማይ እንዴት ወረደ ብሎ እንደ ተናገረ ላንቺም ወዮልሽ። <sup>14</sup> ይኸንንም በትዕቢትህ ደፍረህ ተናገርህ ፈጽሞ በሥልጣኑ የፈጠረህ እግዚአብሔርንም አላሰብኸውም በልቡና ጽናት ወደ ገሃንም ትወርድ አንተ ራስክን ለምን አኮራህ።

<sup>15</sup> ከእሳት ከነፋስ የፈጠራቸው እሱ እንደሆነ ስላወቁ እነሳቸው በተዋረደ ልቡና ፈጣሪያቸውን ያመሰግኑታልና ከትእዛዙም አይወጡምና ከትእዛዙም ፈጽመው እንዳይወጡ ልቡናቸውንም ከክህደት ይጠብቃሉና እንዳንተ ካሉ ከመላእክት ሁሉ ተለይተህ ተዋረድህ።

<sup>16</sup> አንተ ግን በልቡናህ ትዕቢት ጽኑ ክህደትን አደረግህ ካንተ ወገንን የሚሆን እንዳንተም የሚወነጅሉ ኃጢአትን በምታስተምርበት በትእዛዝህና በፈቃድህም ሁሉ ጸንተው የሚኖሩ የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ የዘነጉ ሰዎችና እንዳንተ ያሉ

<sup>11</sup> He is the ruler, and he will judge and save the oppressed from the hand of those who oppress them. He will avenge the widows and the fatherless and the son who has lost his mother. <sup>12</sup> Woe to you who are proud and arrogant, who think that I will not judge you or destroy you; for, he said, “I will set my throne above the stars and the heavens, and I will be like God, who is on high.”

<sup>13</sup> Woe to you, as he said, “How the devil, created before all, fell from heaven, shining like a morning star.” <sup>14</sup> And you dared to say this in your arrogance, and you did not think of God, who created you by his power. You will descend to Gehenna in the stubbornness of your heart. Why exalt yourself? <sup>15</sup> Knowing it was he who created them from fire and wind, they praise their Creator with humble hearts and do not deviate from his command. They guard their hearts from disbelief, lest they deviate from his command. You, and those like you, have been separated from the angels and have become humble.

<sup>16</sup> But you, in the pride of your heart, have committed a great apostasy, and have become a wretched man, separated from your companions; for, you have nurtured all sin, and iniquity, and extortion, and apostasy, in which you have taught

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<sup>11</sup> In place of ‘oppressed’, Selassie has ‘wronged’.

<sup>12</sup> It is not entirely clear what is meant when God says he will ‘be like God’.

<sup>13</sup> The translation of this verse is not completely certain.

<sup>14</sup> Another reading for the last question is, “Why did you exalt yourselves?”

<sup>15</sup> This verse refers to the angels.

<sup>16</sup> It is unclear who the individual being addressed here is.



ኃጢአተኞች ጸንተው የሚኖሩባት ኃጢአትንና በደልን ቅሚያንና ክህደትን ሁሉ አንተ ትከባከበዋለህና ከባልንጀሮችህ ተለይተህ የጐሰቁለ ሰውን ሆንህ። <sup>17</sup> በተንኩልህ ያሳትካቸው አጋንንትና አንተ አንድነት ወደ ገሃነም ትወርዳላችሁና ወዮልህ።

<sup>18</sup> በሚያስት በዚያ በወንጀለኛ በዲያብሎስ የሳታችሁ የእግዚአብሔር ልጆች ሆይ ወዮላችሁ እሱ ባስተማራችሁ ሠራዊቱም ባስተማሯችሁ ገንዘብ እንደሱ ስታችኋልና ለዘለዓለም መውጫ ወደሌለበት ወደ ገሃነም ባንድነት ትወርዳላችሁ። <sup>19</sup> ቀድሞም የእግዚአብሔር ባሪያ ሙሴ ሳለ ክርክር በተደረገበት ውኃና በኮሬብ በአማሌቅና በደብረ ሲናም እግዚአብሔርን አሳዘናችሁት።

<sup>20</sup> ዳግመኛም ወደ ከነዓን ጉበኛ በላካችሁ ጊዜ ጐዳናው ሩቅ ነው እስከ ሰማይ የሚደርስ ቅጽራቸውም አምባቸውም ጽኑ ነው አርበኞችም በዚያ ይኖራሉ ብለው ይህንን በነገሩዋችሁ ጊዜ የሚያስጨንቅ ሥራ ወደምትሠሩባት ወደ ግብጽ አገር ትመለሱ ዘንድ ተቈጥታችሁ የእግዚአብሔርን ቃለ አሳዘናችሁ። <sup>21</sup> ከመከራው ያዳናችሁን በግብፅም ታላላቅ ታመራት ያደረገ በመልአኩም ሥልጣን የመራችሁን እግዚአብሔርን አላስባችሁትም። ፀሐይ እንዳያቃጥላችሁ ቀን በደመና ይጋርዳችሁ ነበር እገራችሁም በጨለማ እንዳይሰነከል ዓምደ እሳት ሌሊት ያበራችሁ ነበር። <sup>22</sup> ሠራዊቱና ፈርዖንም

your people, who are like you, to sin, and who have forgotten the law of God, and who have been steadfast in all your commandments and wills. <sup>17</sup> Woe to you; for, you and the demons you deceived with your deceit will descend together into Gehenna.

<sup>18</sup> Woe to you, children of God, who have been deceived by that wicked one, the devil, who has deceived you, because you have been deceived by the money he has taught you and by his army has taught you; and you will descend into hell, from which there is no escape for ever. <sup>19</sup> You provoked the LORD to anger at the waters of strife, at Horeb, at Amalek, and at Mount Sinai, when Moses was the servant of the LORD.

<sup>20</sup> And, when I sent you again to spy out Canaan, and said to you, “The way is long, and their height is high, and their walls are strong, and the people dwell there,” you were angry and provoked the LORD to anger, to return to the land of Egypt, to the land of your hard labour. <sup>21</sup> You did not remember the LORD, who delivered you from your affliction and led you with the power of his angel, who made you great in Egypt. By day, the cloud covered you so that the sun would not scorch you; and by night, the pillar of fire gave you light so that your land would not be plunged in darkness. <sup>22</sup> When the

<sup>17</sup> The meaning of this verse is unclear – who was deceiving the demons? Are vv. 16–17 addressed to Satan? (Cf. v. 18.)

<sup>18</sup> The meaning of being taught money is unclear.

<sup>19</sup> Here, the author makes a short summary of some of the sins of the Israelites during the Exodus.

<sup>20</sup> Cf. Nb 14:1–5.

<sup>21</sup> In place of ‘*affliction*’, Selassie has ‘*tribulation*’.

<sup>22</sup> The tradition that the angel, Michael, led the Exodus is mentioned a number of times in this book.

ባስፈሩዋችሁ ጊዜ ፈጽማችሁ ወደ ሙሴ ጫካችሁ ሙሴም ፈጽሞ ወደ እግዚአብሔር ጮኽ ከፈርዖንም ጋራ እንዳትገናኙ በመልእኩ አድሮ ጠበቃችሁ።

<sup>23</sup> እነሳቸውን ግን በመከራ ወደ ኤርትራ አገባቸው እግዚአብሔር እስራኤልን ብቻውን መራቸው ከነሱም ጋራ ልዩ ጦዖት አልነበረም ብሏልና ጠላቶቻቸውን ግን አንድ ጊዜ በባሕር ቀበራቸው ከነሳቸውም የሚሸሸውን አላስቀረም።

<sup>24</sup> እስራኤልንም በባሕሩ መካከል በእግር አሻገራቸው ከግብፃውያን የተነሣ ምንምን ያገኛቸው መከራ የለም ወደ ደብረ ሲና አደረሳቸው በዚያም አርባ ዘመን መናውን መገባቸው። <sup>25</sup> የእስራኤል ልጆች እግዚአብሔርን ሁሉ ጊዜ ያሳዝኑታልና ይህን ሁሉ በጎ ነገር አድርጎላቸው እግዚአብሔርን ማምለክ ቸል አሉ።

<sup>26</sup> ከልጅነታቸው ጀምሮ እስኪያረጁ ድረስ ክፋትን በልቡናቸው አኖሩ የእግዚአብሔር አፋ የአበው ልደት በተጻፈበት በአሪት እንዲህ ብሎ ተናግሯልና የእዳም ልጆች ልቡናቸው አመድ ነው ሥራቸውም ሁሉ ወደቅሚያ ነው ወደ ክፋትም ይሮጣሉ በግፍ የሰውን ገንዘብ ከሰብሰብ በሐሰትም ከመማል በልንጀራንም ከመበደል ከመቀማትና ከመሥረቅ በቀር ከነሳቸው የቀናች ሥራን የሚወዳት የለም ብሎ ተናግሯልና ክፋትን በልቡናቸው አኖሩ። <sup>27</sup> ሁሉም በሕይወት በሚኖሩባት ዘመን ወደ ክፉ ሥራ ይሄዳሉ

army and Pharaoh had gathered you together, you cried out to Moses, and Moses cried out to God, and God sent an angel to protect you from Pharaoh.

<sup>23</sup> But God brought them to Eritrea with hardship. He led Israel alone, and there was no special totem with them. But he buried their enemies in the sea once, and he did not leave anyone who fled when He took them away. <sup>24</sup> And he led Israel through the midst of the sea on foot, and there was no distress to them from the Egyptians. He brought them to Mount Sinai, and there he fed them with manna for forty days. <sup>25</sup> The children of Israel continually provoked the LORD to anger; for, they neglected to serve the LORD, who had done all these good things for them.

<sup>26</sup> From their childhood until they are old, they have put evil in their hearts. For, the mouth of God has said in the Torah, where the births of their fathers is recorded, it is written, “The hearts of the children of Adam are ashes, and all their works are for robbery, and they run after evil.” He has raised them up, saying, “There is no one among them who loves good works except to oppress others, and to swear falsely, and to oppress their neighbours, and to take advantage of others, and to steal.” They have put evil in their hearts. <sup>27</sup> All of them

<sup>23</sup> Referring to the Sinai Peninsula as ‘Eritrea’ is using a degree of geographical licence.

<sup>24</sup> It may be better to read (conjecturally) ‘*forty years*’ in place of ‘*forty days*’.

<sup>25</sup> In place of ‘the LORD’ (twice in this verse), Selassie has (unsurprisingly) ‘JAH’.

<sup>26</sup> This is the 1<sup>st</sup> time the ‘Torah’ (አሪት) is mentioned in this book (Selassie has ‘Oreet’). The words, ‘among them’, loosely follow Selassie.

<sup>27</sup> For ‘end of time’, Selassie has ‘Fulfilment Era’.

የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ ያፈረሱ የእስራኤል ልጆች ከጥንት ጀምሮ እስከ ፍጻሜ ዘመን ድረስ እግዚአብሔርን ፈጽመው አሳዘኑት።

will do evil while they live. The children of Israel, who broke God's law, have greatly offended God from ancient times to the end of time.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፲፬

<sup>1</sup> እግዚአብሔርም የቀደመ ወገኖች የቃየንን ልጆች ስለ ኃጢአታቸው በጥፋት ውኃ ባጠፋቸው ጊዜ ምድርን በማየ አይህ አጠመቃት ከቀያል ልጆችም ኃጢአት ሁሉ አነፃት።

<sup>2</sup> ሰውን ስለ ፈጠርሁት አዘንሁ ብሏልና በደለኞችን ሁሉ አጠፋ ከስምንት ሰዎች በቀር አላስቀረም ሁሉን አጠፋ ከዚህ በኋላ እነሱን አበዛቸው ምድርንም መሷት ያባታቸው የአዳምን ርስት ተካፈሉ።

<sup>3</sup> ኖሳ ግን ከእግዚአብሔር ጋራ ተማማለ መሐላን እግዚአብሔር ምድርን ዳግመኛ በጥፋት ውሀ እንዳያጠፋት የኖሳም ልጆች የበከተውንና ሙቶ ያደረውን እንዳይበሉ ከፈጠራቸው ከእግዚአብሔር በቀር ልዩ የሆነ ጣዖቶችን እንዳያመልኩ እርሱም የፍቅር አባት ይሆናቸው ዘንድ በከንቱ ኃጢአታቸውም አንድ ጊዜ እንዳያጠፋቸው የሳተኑንና የበልጉንም ዝናም እንዳይከለክላቸው ለከብትና ለሰዎች በየጊዜውም ምግባቸውን ይሰጣቸው ዘንድ ሣሩንና የእህሉን ፍሬ ተክልንም ይሰጣቸው ዘንድ እነርሳቸውም እግዚአብሔር በሚወደው ሁሉ በጎ ሥራን ይሠሩ ዘንድ ከእግዚአብሔር ጋራ መሐላን ተማማሉ። <sup>4</sup> ይኸንንም ሥርዓት ከሰጣቸው በኋላ የእስራኤል ልጆች በኃጢአታቸው እግዚአብሔርን አሳዘኑት የፈጣሪያቸውን የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ እንዳላፈረሱ

## 1 MEQABYAN 14

<sup>1</sup> When God destroyed the children of Cain by the flood for their sins, he looked upon the earth and he baptized it and cleansed it from all the sins of the children of Cain. <sup>2</sup> He said, "I regret that I have created man." He destroyed all the wicked, leaving only eight people. He destroyed them all. After that, he multiplied them and filled the earth. They shared the inheritance of their father Adam.

<sup>3</sup> But Noah swore an oath with God, that God would not destroy the earth again with a flood, and that the children of Noah would not eat anything that was polluted and dead, and that they should not worship idols other than God, whom created them, and that he would be their father of love, and that he would not destroy them again because of their vain sins, and that he would not withhold the rain of the dew and the spring rain, and that he would give them food for cattle and men at the proper time, and that he would give them grass, grain, and plants, and that they should do good in all that the LORD willed. <sup>4</sup> After he had given them this commandment, the children of Israel offended God with their sins and did not remain steadfast in the law, as their fathers,

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### 1 MEQABYAN 14

<sup>1</sup> Selassie has 'baptized the Earth in Water of destruction' in place of 'baptized and cleansed it'.

<sup>2</sup> For 'I regret', Selassie has 'I was sad'.

<sup>3</sup> A more literal translation of 'destroy them again' is 'destroy them once'. In place of 'the rain of the dew', Selassie has 'the first (rain)'.

<sup>4</sup> In place of 'commandment', Selassie has 'order'.

እንዳባቶቻቸው እንደ ይስሐቅና እንደ አብርሃም እንደ ያዕቆብም በሕጉ ጸንተው አልኖሩም።

<sup>5</sup> ከታናናሾቹም ጀምረው እስከ ታላላቆቹ ድረስ የእግዚአብሔርን ሕጉን ያልጠበቁ እነዚህ የእስራኤል ልጆች በሥራቸው ጠማሞች <sup>6</sup> ናቸው ካህናቶቻቸውም አለቆቻቸውም ጸሐፊዎቻቸውም ቢሆኑ ሁሉም የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ ያፈርሳሉ። <sup>7</sup> በፍጹም ሰውነትህና በፍጹም ልቡናህ ፈጣሪህ እግዚአብሔርን ውደደው ብሎ በዳግም ሕግ ሙሴ ባዘዛቸው በእግዚአብሔር ሥርዓትና ሕጉ ጸንተው አይኖሩም። <sup>8</sup> ባልንጀራህን እንደ ሰወኑትህ ውደድ ልዩ የሆኑ ጣዖቶችንም አታምልክ ወደ ጉልማሳ ሚስትም አትሂድ ነፍስ አትግደል አትስረቅ።

<sup>9</sup> በሐሰትም አትመስክር አህያውም ቢሆን በሬውም ቢሆን የባለንጀራህን ገንዘብ ወንድምህ የገዛውንም ሁሉ አትውደድ ብሎ ሕግ በተጻፈበት መጽሐፍ ሙሴ ባዘዛቸው በእግዚአብሔር ሥርዓትና በሕጉ አይጸኑም። <sup>10</sup> ነገር ግን ይኸን ሁሉ ካዘዛቸው በኋላ ክፉዎች የሆኑ የእስራኤል ልጆች ወደ ክዳትና ወደ ኃጢአት ወደ ቅሚያና ወደ በደል ወደ ጉልማሳ ሚስት ወደ ሐስትና ወደ መስረቅም ጣዖቶችንም ወደማምለክ ይመለሳሉ። <sup>11</sup> ወደ ሣር የሚሠማራ ላምን

Isaac, Abraham, and Jacob had done, and who did not break the law of God their Creator.

<sup>5</sup> From the least to the greatest, these children of Israel are corrupt in their deeds, who have not kept the Law of the LORD; <sup>6</sup> and whether they were their priests, or their leaders, or their scribes, they all transgress the Law of the LORD. <sup>7</sup> They do not abide by the statutes and laws of God, which Moses commanded them in the Deuteronomy, saying, “Love the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul. <sup>8</sup> Love your neighbour as yourself, and do not worship idols, do not go to a prostitute, do not murder, do not steal.”

<sup>9</sup> They do not abide by the statutes and the law of God, which Moses commanded them in the book of the law, saying, “You shall not bear false witness, whether it be for donkeys or oxen, or for anything that is your neighbour’s property, or for anything that your brother has bought.” <sup>10</sup> But, after all this was commanded them, the wicked children of Israel returned to treachery and sin, to extortion and wrongdoing, to adultery and fornication, to theft and idolatry. <sup>11</sup> The children of Israel angered

<sup>5</sup> Note that there is no separator (#) at the end of this verse; the division here follows Selassie.

<sup>6</sup> For ‘the Law of the LORD’, Selassie has ‘JAH LAW’ (as also in v. 6).

<sup>7</sup> Cf. Dt 6:5 & Mt 22:37.

<sup>8</sup> Cf. Lv 19:18 & Mt 22:39.

<sup>9</sup> The author here seems to conflate 2 commandments.

<sup>10</sup> Selassie has ‘robbery’ in place of ‘extortion’ and ‘lies’ in place of ‘theft’.

<sup>11</sup> Referring to the golden calf statue as one ‘that would eat grass’ is strange.



በመሥራት የእስራኤል ልጆች በኮሬብ እግዚአብሔርን አሳዘኑት እነሆ ከግብፅ ያወጡን ፈጣሪዎቻችን እነዚህ ናቸው ብለው ሰገዱ።

<sup>12</sup> በጃቸውም ሥራ ደስ አላቸው በልተው ጠጥተውም ቢጠግቡ ሊዘፍኑ ተነሡ። <sup>13</sup> እግዚአብሔር አገዛዝ ካለበት ከግብፅ አገር ያወጣህቸው ወገኖችህ ከሕግ ወጥተው በደሉ የላም ምስልም ሠርተው ለጣዖቱ ሰገዱ ብሎታልና ስለዚህ ነግር ሙሴ ተቈጥቶ ከሲና ተራራ ወረደ። <sup>14</sup> ሙሴ ወገኖቹን እየተቈጣቸው ከባለሟሉ ከኢያሱ ጋራ ወረደ ኢያሱም በሰማ ጊዜ እነሆ በእስራኤል ሰፈር ያርበኞች ድምፅ እሰማለሁ አለ።

<sup>15</sup> ሙሴም ኢያሱን እስራኤል ያልፈላውን ጠጅ ጠጥተው ሊጫወቱ ነው እንጂ ያርበኛስ ድምጽ አይደለም አለው ወርዶም ምስላቸውን ሰበረው እንደ ትቢያም እስኪሆን ድረስ ፈጽሞ አደቀቀው የእስራኤል ልጆች በተራራው አጠገብ በሚጠጡት ውኃ ውስጥ በጠበጠው። <sup>16</sup> ከዚህም በኋላ በእግዚአብሔር ፊት ስለሠሩት ኃጢአት ካህናቱን እርስ በሳቸው ይጋደሉ ዘንድ አዘዛቸው።

<sup>17</sup> እነሳቸውን ከመግደል አባቶቻቸውንም ከመግደል እግዚአብሔርን መገዳደር እንዲበልጥ አውቀው እንዳዘዛቸው አደረጉ። <sup>18</sup> ሙሴም የመገባችሁን የተከባከባችሁን ከአገዛዝም

God at Horeb by making a calf that would eat grass. They worshiped and said, “These are our creators who brought us out of Egypt.”

<sup>12</sup> They rejoiced in their labours and, when they ate and drank their fill, they rose up to sing. <sup>13</sup> God said to him, “Your people, whom you brought out of Egypt, have transgressed the law and have made a molten calf and bowed to its idol.” Moses was angry and went down from Mount Sinai. <sup>14</sup> Moses, being angry with his people, went down with Joshua. And when Joshua heard it, he said, “Behold, I hear the sound of the camp of Israel shouting.”

<sup>15</sup> And Moses said to Joshua, “It is not the voice of warriors but of the children of Israel, after they have drunk unfermented wine, and play.” And he went down, and broke their images, and ground them to powder, and submerged them in the water which the children of Israel drank by the mountain. <sup>16</sup> After this, he ordered the priests to fight against each other for their sins against God.

<sup>17</sup> They did as he commanded, knowing that it was a greater offence to defy God than to kill their fathers.

<sup>18</sup> And Moses said to them, “You have made the LORD

<sup>12</sup> For ‘their labours’, Selassie has ‘the work of their hands’.

<sup>13</sup> The pronoun, ‘him’, in the opening clause, refers to Moses.

<sup>14</sup> Selassie has ‘warriors’ in place of ‘camp’.

<sup>15</sup> The literal translation of ‘unfermented’ is ‘not boiled’.

<sup>16</sup> Cf. Ex 32:27.

<sup>17</sup> The literal translation of ‘a greater offence’ is just ‘greater’.

<sup>18</sup> For ‘nourished’, Selassie reads ‘cherished’.

ቤት ያወጣችሁን ለነሳቸው ከነሳቸው በኋላ ለልጆቻቸው ይሰጣቸው ዘንድ ላባቶቻችሁ የማለላቸው ርስትንም ያወረሳችሁ እግዚአብሔርን ስላሳዘናችሁት ስለዚህ ነገር እግዚአብሔርን ደስ አሰኛችሁት አላቸው።<sup>19</sup> ወደ ኃጢአትና ወደ ክፉ ነገር ይሄዳሉና በዚያም እግዚአብሔርን ማሳዘን አልተውም።

<sup>20</sup> ከሕፃንነታቸው ጀምረው እስከ ጉልማስነታቸው እስከ እርጅናቸውም ድረስ በምድር ላይ ያለውን በሰማይም ለሚወዱት ሰዎች ያዘጋጀውን ይሰጣቸው ዘንድ በበጎ ሥራቸው እግዚአብሔርን ደስ እንዳሰኙት እንዳባቶቻቸው እንደ ይስሐቅና አንደ አብርሃም እንደ ያዕቆብም አይደሉም በዚህ ዓለም ተድላ ደስታ የሚገኝባት ምድር ርስትን በወዲያውም ዓለም ለደጋግ ሰዎች የተዘጋጀች ደስ የምታሰኝ ገነትን ዓይን ያላየውን ጆሮም ያልሰማውን በሰው ልቡናም ያልታሰበውን እግዚአብሔርን በባሕይወት ሳሉ ደስ ላሰኙት ለሚወዱት ለአብርሃም ለይስሐቅ ለያዕቆብ ያዘጋጀውን ይሰጣቸው ዘንድ በሥራቸው ደስ እንዳሰኙት እንደ አብርሃም እንደ ይስሐቅ እንደ ያዕቆብ አይደሉም።

<sup>21</sup> እግዚአብሔርን የካዱ ክፉዎችም የሆኑ በልቡናቸው ፈቃድ ጸንተው የሚኖሩ የነሳቸው ልጆችም የመገባቸውን የተከባከባቸውን ከሕፃንነታቸውም ጀምሮ የጠበቃቸውን የእግዚአብሔርን ትእዛዝ አልሰሙም።<sup>22</sup> ከግብፅ ምድር ያወጣቸውን ከጡብ ሥራ ከጽኑም አገዛዝ ያዳናቸው

angry, who has fed you and nourished you, who has brought you out of the house of slavery, and has bequeathed to you the inheritance that he swore to your fathers, to give to their children after he had brought you out.”<sup>19</sup> For, they continued in sin and evil, and they did not cease to grieve God there.

<sup>20</sup> They were not like their fathers, Isaac and Abraham and Jacob, who made the LORD happy with their good works, that he might give them what is on the earth and what he prepared for persons who love him in heaven, from their infancy, through their youth and up until their old age; they aren't like Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, who made him happy with their work, that he might give them the earth as an inheritance, where joy is found in this world, and a Paradise of happiness prepared for kind persons in the hereafter – what he prepared for Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, who made the Lord happy when they were alive and who loved him whom an eye didn't see nor an ear hear, nor heard in the hearts of men.

<sup>21</sup> Those who rejected God and were wicked, who lived in the desires of their own hearts, did not listen to the commandments of God, whom he had fed, nurtured, and protected from their childhood.<sup>22</sup> They did not remember God, who had brought them out of the land of Egypt, who had delivered them from the

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<sup>19</sup> This verse *may* be part of Moses' speech.  
<sup>20</sup> The online translation tools have great difficulty with this verse; here, we present a version loosely based on the Iyoric version of Selassie.  
<sup>21</sup> For 'nurtured', Selassie reads 'cherished'.  
<sup>22</sup> Selassie has 'firm rulership' in place of 'oppressive rule'.

እግዚአብሔርን አላሰቡትም። <sup>23</sup> እነሳቸው ግን ፈጽመው  
አሳዘኑት እሱም በዙሪያቸው ያሉ አሕዛብን ያስነሣባቸው ነበር  
እነሳቸውም በጠላትነት ተነሥተውባቸው እንደ ወደዱም  
ያስገብሯቸው ነበር።

labour of bricks and from the oppressive rule. <sup>23</sup> But they greatly  
upset him, and he stirred up the nations around them against  
them, and they rose up against them in hostility and subjected  
them to whatever they pleased.

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<sup>23</sup> In place of ‘hostility’, Selassie has ‘enmity’.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፲፭

<sup>1</sup> የዚያን ጊዜም የምድያም ሰዎች በጠላትነት ተነሡባቸው እስራኤልንም ይወጓቸው ዘንድ ሠራዊቶቻቸውን አስነሡባቸው የንጉሣቸውም ስሙ አክራንድስ ይባላል በኪልቅያና በሶርያ በደማስቆም ያሉ ብዙ ሠራዊትን ፈጥኖ ሰበሰበ። <sup>2</sup> በዮርዳኖስም ማዶ ሰፍሮ ገንዘባችሁንም እማርክ ዘንድ ወደ እስራኤል ግብር ገብሩልኝ ብሎ መልክተኞች ላከ ባትገብሩኝ ግን እናንተን እቀጣችሁ ዘንድ ከብቶቻችሁን እማርክ ባዝራችሁን እወስድ ልጆቻችሁንም እማርክ ዘንድ መጣሁ አላቸው።

<sup>3</sup> ወደማታውቁት አገር ማርኬ እወስዳችኋለሁ በዚያም ውኃ ቀጂዎችን እንጨት ለቃሚዎችን አደርጋችኋለሁ አላቸው።

<sup>4</sup> አኛ የእግዚአብሔር ወገኖች ነን የሚችለንም የለም እያላችሁ አትመኩ አጠፋችሁ ዘንድ ገንዘባችሁንም እዘርፍ ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር የላከኝ አይደለምን ወገኖችሁንም ሁሉ እሰበስብ ዘንድ የላከኝ አይደለሁምን። <sup>5</sup> እኔ ያጠፋኋቸውን ሌሎች ወገኖች በውኑ ልዩ ጣዖቶቻቸው ያዳኗቸው ማዳን አለን ባዝራቸውንና ፈረሳቸውን ማረክሁ እነሳቸውንም ገደልኩ ልጆቻቸውንም ማረክሁ። <sup>6</sup> ያዘዝኳችሁን ግብር ካላገባችሁልኝ እናንተንም እንደነሳቸው አደርጋችኋለሁ አለ

## 1 MEQABYAN 15

<sup>1</sup> And, at that time, the Midianites rose up against Israel and gathered their armies to fight against them. Their king, whose name was Akrandis, quickly gathered a large army from Cilicia, from Syria, and from Damascus. <sup>2</sup> And, camping beyond the Jordan, he sent messengers to them, saying, “Send tribute for me to Israel, that I may take your money and your goods. But, if you do not pay me, I will come to punish you, and I will take your cattle, and take your possessions, and take your children as slaves.”

<sup>3</sup> And he told them, “I will lead you into a land that you do not know and, there, I will make you drawers of water and gatherers of wood. <sup>4</sup> Do not boast, saying, “We are God’s people, and there is nothing we can do.” Was it not God who sent me to destroy you and to plunder your wealth? Was it not God who sent me to gather all your people? <sup>5</sup> I destroyed other nations, and their various idols did not save them. I captured their cattle and their horses, and I killed them, and I took their children as captives. <sup>6</sup> And, if you do not pay me the tribute that I command you, I will do to you as I did to them.” And he

### 1 MEQABYAN 15

<sup>1</sup> For ‘Cilicia’, Selassie has ‘Keeliqyas’.

<sup>2</sup> Selassie has ‘mares’ in place of ‘possessions’.

<sup>3</sup> The opening words, ‘And he told them’, here loosely following Selassie, are not in the Amharic text.

<sup>4</sup> The story here resembles that of Nebuchadnezzar and his conquest of Israel and Judah.

<sup>5</sup> The Amharic text has ‘saved’ in place of ‘did not save’ but this seems inappropriate.

<sup>6</sup> For ‘tribute’, Selassie here has ‘tax’.

ከብቶቻቸውንና ነገዘባቸውን ይዘርፉ ሚስቶቻቸውንም ይማርክ ዘንድ ዮርዳኖስም ተሻገረ።

<sup>7</sup> ከዚህም በኋላ የእስራኤል ልጆች ወደ እግዚአብሔር ጽኑ ልቅሶን አለቀሱ ፈጽመውም ጮሁ ነገር ግን የሚረዳቸው አጡ። <sup>8</sup> ስለዚህም ነገር ለሦስቱ ወንድማማቾች እግዚአብሔር ጽናትን ሰጣቸው ስማቸውም እንደዚህ ነው መልካቸውም ያማረ በኃይላቸውም አርበኞች የሆኑ ይሁዳና መብክዩስ መቃቢስ ናቸው።

<sup>9</sup> የእስራኤልም ልጆች ፈጽመው በዚያ አለቀሱ በሰሙ ጊዜ ከእስራኤል ልጆች ሁሉ ጩኸት የተነሣ ልቡናቸውን አሳዘናቸው እናቱና አባቱ የሞቱበት ልጅና ባልቴቶች ሹማምቶቻቸውና ካህናቶቻቸውም የእስራኤል ወገን ሁሉ ሴቶችና ወንዶችም ልጆችም ሁሉ በራሳቸውም ላይ አመድ ነስንሰው ያለቅሱ ነበር መኳንንቶቻቸውም ማቅ ለብሰው ነበር። <sup>10</sup> መልክ መልካም ደመ ግቡ የሆኑ እነዚህ ወንድማማቾች ግን ሒደው ያድኗቸው ዘንድ ተስማሙ ሒደን ስለነዚህ ሰዎች ሰውነታችንን ለሞት እንስጥ ብለው ተማከሩ።

<sup>11</sup> አይዞህ አይዞህ ተባብለው በወገባቸው ሰይፋቸውን ታጥቀው በእጃቸውም ጦራቸውን ይዘው ሔዱ አርበኛውንም ይወነጅሉት ዘንድ ተዘጋጅተው ሔዱ። <sup>12</sup> ወደ ሰፈራቸውም ደረሱ በማዕድ ተቀምጦ ሳለ መብክዩስ አርበኛውን /ንጉሡን/

crossed the Jordan to plunder their livestock and their money, and to take their wives as captives.

<sup>7</sup> And, after this, the children of Israel cried bitterly to the LORD with a loud cry; however, there was no one to help them. <sup>8</sup> For this reason, the LORD gave strength to the three brothers, and these were their names: Judas and Mebikyias and Maccabeus, who were handsome in appearance and were warriors of great strength.

<sup>9</sup> And the children of Israel wept there exceedingly, when they heard it, and their hearts were grieved for the weeping of all the children of Israel, for the sons whose mother and father were dead, the widows, their princes, their priests, and all the house of Israel, and all the women, and the men, and the children; they put ashes on their heads and their princes were girded with sackcloth. <sup>10</sup> But these brothers, who were of good character, agreed to go and save them. They consulted together, saying, “Let us go and give up our bodies to death for these people.”

<sup>11</sup> Telling one another, “Take heart, take heart,” they went out, girded with swords and spears, ready to attack the warriors. <sup>12</sup> When they reached their camp, Mebikyias stabbed the king while he was sitting at the table; and, while he was

<sup>7</sup> Here and in v. 8, ‘the LORD’ translates እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>8</sup> The name, ‘Mebikyias’, follows Selassie; the exact transliteration is not certain.

<sup>9</sup> Selassie has ‘nobles’ in place of ‘princes’.

<sup>10</sup> In place of ‘of good character’, Selassie has ‘attractive and comely’.

<sup>11</sup> The word translated ‘warriors’ is singular in the Amharic text.

<sup>12</sup> On the name, ‘Mebikyias’, see #8.



ወጋው በአፋ መብል ሳለ በአንዲት አመታት አንገቱን ቈረጠው መቃብዮስና ይሁዳም በንጉሡ ግራና ቀኝ ያሉ ሠራዊቱን በሰይፍ መትተው ገደሉዋቸው። <sup>13</sup> ንጉሣቸውም ድል በተነሣ ጊዜ ወደ ጦሮቻቸው በባልንጀራቸው ልብ ገቡ ሁሉም ፈጽመው ሸሹ ቀስታቸውም ተሰበረ እነርሳቸውም ድል ተነሡ።

<sup>14</sup> መልክ መልካም ደመ ግቡ የሚሆኑ እነዚያ ወንድማማቾች ግን ከሞት ዳኑ ምንም ምን ክፋት ነገር ያገኛቸው የለም እግዚአብሔር መቅሠፍትን ወደነርሳቸው መልሶታልና እነርሳቸው ግን እርስ በርሳቸው ተቀራደው አለቁ። <sup>15</sup> ድል ተነሡ ሞቱ ዮርዳኖስንም ተሻገሩ እስኪሻገሩም ድረስ ገንዘባቸውን ሁሉ ጣሉ ገንዘባቸውም ሁሉ ቀረ የእስራኤልም ልጆች ጠላቶቻቸው እንደሸሹ ባዩ ጊዜ ወደ ሰፈራቸው ሂደው የዘረፉትንም ገንዘባቸውንም ለራሳቸው ወሰዱ።

<sup>16</sup> በወንድሞቹና በመብክዩ እጅ እግዚአብሔር እስራኤልን እንዲህ አድርጎ አዳናቸው።

<sup>17</sup> የእስራኤል ልጆች እግዚአብሔርን ደስ እያሰኙት ጥቂት ቀን ተቀመጡ። <sup>18</sup> ከዚያ በኋላ ግን ዳግመኛ ወደ ኃጢአታቸው ተመለሱ የእስራኤል ልጆች እግዚአብሔርን በሚገባ ማምለክን ችለው አሉ። <sup>19</sup> እርሱም በማያውቋቸው

eating, he cut off his head in one stroke. Maccabeus and Judas killed the soldiers on the king's left and right with their swords. <sup>13</sup> When their king was defeated, their spears pierced through the hearts of their fellow soldiers, and they all fled in complete terror, their bows were broken, and they themselves were victorious.

<sup>14</sup> But those brothers, who were destined for a beautiful future, were saved from death. No evil thing befell them. God returned chastisement to them, but they were separated from each other and perished. <sup>15</sup> And they prevailed; and they died, and they crossed the Jordan, and they threw away all their money until they crossed, and all their money remained. When the children of Israel saw that their enemies had fled, they returned to their camp and took the plunder and the money for themselves.

<sup>16</sup> Thus, God saved Israel by the hand of his brothers and of Mebikyias.

<sup>17</sup> The children of Israel stayed there for a few days, while they were pleasing the LORD. <sup>18</sup> But, after that, they again returned to their sins and the children of Israel neglected to worship God properly. <sup>19</sup> And he shall again punish them

<sup>13</sup> 'In complete terror' is a conjectural translation; the Amharic text has 'they all fled completely'.

<sup>14</sup> The meaning of the last sentence is unclear.

<sup>15</sup> There appear to be two different referents to the pronouns in this verse – the defeated enemies and the victorious brothers.

<sup>16</sup> Here, Selassie has 'Mebikyu' in place of 'Mebikyias'.

<sup>17</sup> In place of 'stayed', Selassie has 'sat'.

<sup>18</sup> Selassie has 'JAH' in place of 'God'.

<sup>19</sup> For 'punish', Selassie has 'sadden'.

የእርሻቸውን አዝመራ በሚሰበሰቡ የወይናቸውንም ቦታ በሚያጠፉ መንጋቸውንም በማዘርፉ ከብቶቻቸውንም በፊታቸው አርደው በሚያበሏቸው።<sup>20</sup> ሚስቶቻቸውን ሴቶች ልጆቻቸውንና ወንዶች ልጆቻቸውን በሚማርኩ ወገኖች እሱም ዳግመኛ ያሳዝናቸዋል ሁለ ግዜ እግዚአብሔርን የሚያሳዝኑት ስለሆነ እነሳቸው ሕጉን ያፈረሱ ወገኖች ናቸውና ልጆቻቸውን በፊታቸው ራስ ራሳቸውን ይቀጠቅጧቸዋል አያድኗቸውም።

by people they do not know reaping the harvest of their fields, and destroying their vineyards, and plundering their flocks, and slaughtering their cattle in front of them and eating them.<sup>20</sup> And he will take their wives, and their daughters, and their sons captive, because they are the ones who will grieve God every time. They are the ones who have broken the law and he will crush their children before their eyes, and he will not save them.

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<sup>20</sup> Selassie has ‘hammer’ in place of ‘crush’.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፲፮

<sup>1</sup> ይኸንን የሚያደርጉ የጢሮስና የሲዶና በዮርዳኖስም ወንዝ ማዶና በባሕር ዳርቻ የሚኖሩ የከራንና የገለዓድ የኢያቡሲዎንና የከናኔዎን የኤዶምና የጌርጌሴውን የአማሌቅ ሰዎች ናቸው። <sup>2</sup> በየነገዳቸውና በየሀገራቸው በየአውራጃቸውና በየሥራቸውም በየሀገራቸውም ቋንቋ ጸንተው የሚኖሩ አሕዛብ ሁሉ እንዲህ ያደርጋሉ ሁሉም እግዚአብሔር እንደሠራቸው ጸንተው ይኖራሉ። <sup>3</sup> ከነሳቸውም እግዚአብሔርን የሚያውቁት ሥራቸው ያማረ ሰዎች አሉ። <sup>4</sup> ከነሳቸውም ሥራቸው ክፉ የሆነ የፈጠራቸው እግዚአብሔርንም የማያውቁት ሰዎች አሉ ኃጢአት እንደሠሩ በሶርያ ንጉሥ በስልምሶንም እጅ ገዛቸው። <sup>5</sup> የደማስቆን ገንዘብ ዘርፎ ይወስዳልና በግብፅ ንጉሠ ፊት ያለ የሠማርያንም ምርኮ ያካፍላልና በስልምናሶር እጅ ገዛቸው። <sup>6</sup> የጌላቡሄ አውራጃና በገለዓድም አምባ የይሁዳ ምድረ ክፍል በምትሆን ፓስጦስም በምዕራብ ተራራ የማኖሩ በፋርስና በሜዶን በቀዶቅያና በሴውሲግያ ሰዎች። <sup>7</sup> በአውራጃቸውም የሚኖሩ እነዚህ ናቸው እግዚአብሔርንም የማያውቁት ትእዛዙንም

## 1 MEQABYAN 16

<sup>1</sup> The people who will do this are those of Tyre and Sidon, and those who live on the other side of the Jordan River and along the coast of the sea – the people of Keren and of Gilead – and the Jebusites, and the Canaanites, and the Edomites, and the Girgashites, and the Amalekites. <sup>2</sup> All the nations, each according to their tribe, their clan, their territory, their occupation, and their language, will do this, each one living as God created them. <sup>3</sup> And there are people among them who know God and whose deeds are good. <sup>4</sup> And there were some people who had sinned, and who did not know God, and he delivered them into the hand of Shalmaneser, king of Syria. <sup>5</sup> He will plunder the wealth of Damascus and divide the spoils of Samaria before the king of Egypt, and he will sell them to Shalmaneser. <sup>6</sup> The people of Persia, Media, Cedocia, and Seuss, who live in the region of Gelabucheh, and in the hill country of Gilead, in the western mountains of Judaea, in the region of Pastos. <sup>7</sup> These are the people who live in their province, a people whose hearts are

## 1 MEQABYAN 16

- <sup>1</sup> Selassie has variant forms for most of the nations listed here.  
<sup>2</sup> The term, ‘*occupation*’, is here used in the sense of location, rather than any professional trade or craft.  
<sup>3</sup> In place of ‘*good*’, Selassie ends with ‘*beautiful*’.  
<sup>4</sup> For ‘*he delivered them*’, Selassie has ‘*he ruled them*’.  
<sup>5</sup> The Amharic text has ‘*buy ... from*’ in place of ‘*sell ... to*’.  
<sup>6</sup> Neither ‘*Cedocia*’ nor ‘*Gelabucheh*’ can be readily identified.  
<sup>7</sup> For ‘*hearts are hardened*’, Selassie has ‘*collar of reasoning is firm*’.

የማይጠብቁ ከሣደ ልቡናቸው የጸና ወገኖች ናቸው።<sup>8</sup> እሱም እንደ ሥራቸው ክፋት እንደ እጃቸውም ሥራ ፍዳቸውን ይከፍላቸዋል።

<sup>9</sup> የገለጻድ ወገኖችና የቂሣርያ አውራጃ አማሌቅም እውነት ነገርን የተመላች ከከበሩ የከበረ አሸናፊ የሚሆን በኪሩቤል ሠረገላት የብዙ ብዙ የሚሆኑ መላእክት በፊቱ የሚቆሙ ፈርተው ቱንቀጥቅጠው የሚገለግሉት የእስራኤል ፈጣሪ በውስጡ የሚመሰገንበት የእግዚአብሔርን አገር ያጠፏት ዘንድ አንድ ሆነውበታልና እሱም እንደ ሥራቸው ክፋት እንደ እጃቸውም ሥራ ፍዳቸውን ይከፍላቸዋል።

hardened, who do not know God and do not keep his commandments. <sup>8</sup> He will repay them according to the evil of their deeds and according to the work of their hands.

<sup>9</sup> For, the families of Gilead, Amalek, and the region of Caesarea, have been united to destroy the land of the LORD, in the chariots of the cherubim, full of truth and glorious, and many angels standing before him, and serving in fear and trembling, to destroy the land of God, in which the Maker of Israel is to be praised; and he will repay them according to the evil of their deeds, and according to the work of their hands.

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<sup>8</sup> For 'repay them', Selassie has 'pay them hardship' (as also in v. 9).

<sup>9</sup> For 'Maker of Israel', Selassie has 'Israel's Creator'.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ፡ ፲፯

<sup>1</sup> የአማሌቅና የኤድሞያስን ሰዎች የምድርና የሰማይ አገዛዝ በሥልጣኑ የተያዘ እግዚአብሔርን አያመልኩትም እነሳቸው በውነት ሥራ ጸንተው የማይኖሩ ወንጀለኞች ናቸውና ማደሪያው ቤተ መቅደስን ማፍረስ አይፈሩም። <sup>2</sup> ደም ከማፍሰስና ከዝሙት የተመታውንና ለጣዖት የተሠዋውን ሙቶ ያደረውንም የሚመስለውን ሁሉ ከመብላት በቀር በፈታቸውም እግዚአብሔርን መፍራት የለም እነዚሁም የተናቁ ኃጢአተኞች ናቸው። <sup>3</sup> ምግባር ሃይማኖት የላቸውም በጎ ሥራን የጠሉ ናቸውና እግዚአብሔርንም አያውቁትምና የሰው ገንዘብ ከመቀማትና ከኃጢአት በቀር ሰውን ከማወክና ከሚጠላም ሥራ ሁሉ በቀር አባታቸው ዲያብሎስ እንዳስተማራቸው ከጨዋታና ከዘፈን በቀር የፍቅርንም ሥራ አያውቁምና ምግባር ሃይማኖት የላቸውም።

<sup>4</sup> እሱ ከሠራዊቱ ከአጋንንት ጋራ ገዝቷቸዋልና ለየራሱ የሆነ የክፉ ሥራ ሁሉ የቅሚያና የኃጢአትን የስርቆትንና የሐሰት ገንዘብ የመቀማትን አባላ የተመታውንና ሙቶ ያደረውን መብላትንም የዝሙትንም ሥራ ሁሉ ያስተምራቸዋል።

<sup>5</sup> ይኸንንም የሚመስለውን ሁሉ ወደ ጎልማሳ ሚስት መሔድንም ደም ማፍሰስንም ለጣዖት የተሠዋውን ሙቶ ያደረገውን መብላት የሰው ነፍስንም በግፍ መግደል

## 1 MEQABYAN 17

<sup>1</sup> The people of Amalek and Edom do not worship the LORD, by whose command the heavens and the earth were created, and they are not afraid to destroy the temple of the LORD, because they are criminals who do not live in the truth. <sup>2</sup> There is no fear of God before them, except the shedding of blood, and to fornicate, and to eat things strangled, and things sacrificed to idols, and anything that resembles a dead body. These are the very ones who are despised and sinners. <sup>3</sup> They have no morality and no religion; for, they hate good works and do not know God. They do not know the works of love except for the stealing of people's wealth and all the evil and hateful works, as their father the devil has taught them.

<sup>4</sup> He has ruled over them with his army of demons, and he teaches them to commit all kinds of evil deeds, including greed, and sin, and theft, and false money-making, and to eat what was strangled and what was beaten to death, and to commit all kinds of sexual immorality. <sup>5</sup> And he teaches them all that resembles this: to go to a virgin bride, the shedding of blood, eating what has been sacrificed to idols, to kill the

## 1 MEQABYAN 17

- <sup>1</sup> Selassie has 'seized' in place of 'created'.  
<sup>2</sup> For 'despised and sinners', Selassie has 'scorned sinners'.  
<sup>3</sup> In place of 'morality', Selassie has 'virtue'.  
<sup>4</sup> For 'all kinds of sexual immorality', Selassie has just 'adultery'.  
<sup>5</sup> Another reading for 'virgin bride' is 'mature wife'.



ምቀኝነትንና መጠቃቀስንም ስስትንም እግዚአብሔር የማይወደውን ክፉ ሥራንም ሁሉ ያስተምራቸዋል ዓለሙን ሁሉ ከሚገዛ ከእግዚአብሔር ሕግ ያርቃቸው ዘንድ ጠላታቸው የሆነ ዲያብሎስ ይኸንን ትምህርት ያስተምራቸዋል።

<sup>6</sup> የእግዚአብሔር ሥራ ግን የዋህነትና ትሕትና ወንድምን አለማበሳጨትና ባለንጀራን መውደድ ከሰው ሁሉ ጋራ መስማማትና መፋቀር ነው። <sup>7</sup> ለሰው ፊት ለማዳላት ግብዞችን አትሁን በደለኞችንም ፈጽማችሁም ቀማኞች ወደ ጉልላ ሚስት የሚሔዱ ሰዎችንም በባልንጀራቸው ላይ በደልንና ክፉ ሥራን የሚሠሩ በግፍ ባለንጀራቸውንም ይበድሉ ዘንድ የሚሸነግሉ ሰዎችንም አትሁኑ። <sup>8</sup> ይጠቃቀሳሉ ራሳቸውንም ይነቀንቃሉ ለክፋትም ይተነኩላሉ ሰዎችን ወደ ዘለዓለም ቁርጥ ፍርድ ያወርዷቸው ዘንድ ለማሳት ያሟርታሉ።

soul of a man with violence, to jealousy, and to slander, and to covetousness, and to every evil deed that God does not like. The devil, who is their enemy, teaches them this doctrine, that he may turn them away from the law of God, who rules over the whole world.

<sup>6</sup> But the work of God is gentleness and humility, not offending one's brother, loving one's neighbour, and being in harmony with and loving all people. <sup>7</sup> Do not be hypocrites who show partiality, nor be like wrongdoers, nor robbers, nor be like those who go to adulterous wives, nor be like those who commit injustice and wickedness against their neighbours, nor be like those who deceive their neighbours to do wrong. <sup>8</sup> They will scold and shake their heads, and they will be moved to do evil, and they will deceive people to bring them down to eternal damnation.

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<sup>6</sup> Selassie has 'innocence' in place of 'gentleness'.

<sup>7</sup> In place of 'neighbours', Selassie has 'companion' (twice in this verse).

<sup>8</sup> For 'damnation', Selassie has 'Definite Judgement'.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ፡ ፲፰

<sup>1</sup> ሁሉ በእጁ ወዳለ በሞት ወደ እግዚአብሔር እንድትሔድ አስብ በሠራኸውም ኃጢአት በፊቱ ይፈርድብህ ዘንድ አንተ በፊቱ ትቆማለህ። <sup>2</sup> ትዕቢተኞችና ክፉዎች የሚሆኑ ከነሳቸውም የሚበልጥ የሚበረታ የሌለ የኃይለኞች ልጆች ቀድሞ እንደዚሁ ነበርና ቁመታቸውንና ኃይላቸውን ጽኑ ሥልጣናቸውንም ስላዩ እግዚአብሔርን በፊታቸው አላደረጉትም እሱ ካለመኖር ወደ መኖር አምጥቶ የፈጠራቸው ፈጣሪያቸውም እንደ ሆነ አላወቁም።

<sup>3</sup> አባቶቻቸውም እንደ መላእክት ሁነው ከመላእክት ጋራ በደብር ቅዱስ ሲያመሰግኑ ፈቃዳቸው ባሳታቸው ጊዜ ለዘለዓለሙ ቁርጥ ፍርድ ወደሚደረግበት ወደዚህ ዓለም ወረዱ። <sup>4</sup> ስለ ልቡናቸው ትዕቢት ያስታቸው ዘንድ ሕጉንና ትእዛዙንም ይጠብቁ እንደ ሆነ ይፈትናቸው ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር ጥንቱን የሰው ሥጋ ፈጥሮላቸዋልና ከቃየል ልጆች ሚስት አገቡ። <sup>5</sup> እነሳቸው ግን ሕጉን አልጠበቁም ካባታቸው ከዲያብሎስ ጋራ ወደ ገሃነም እሳት አወረዳቸው እግዚአብሔር እንደ ሰው የበደሉ ደቂቀ ሴትን ተቈጥቷቸዋልና ስለነሳቸውም ኃጢአት የሰው ዘመኑ አነሰ።

<sup>6</sup> የአዳንምን ልጆች ከነሳቸው ጋራ ወደ ኃጢአት ወስዷቸው እነሳቸው መቻያ ወደ ሚቀበሉበት ወደ ሲኦል አወረዷቸው።

## 1 MEQABYAN 18

<sup>1</sup> Think of going in death to the LORD, in whose hands everything is held, and you will stand before him to be judged for the sins you have committed. <sup>2</sup> Those who were the sons of the mighty, who were arrogant and wicked, and there was no one stronger than them, saw their height, their power, and their strength. They did not set God before them, nor did they know that he was their Creator, who had brought them into existence from non-existence.

<sup>3</sup> And their fathers, who were like angels, were praising God with the angels in the Holy Land; but, when their will led them astray, they descended into this world, where they will be judged for eternity. <sup>4</sup> They married wives from the sons of Cain; for, God created the flesh of the first man for them, to tempt them because of the pride of their hearts, and to test them to see if they would keep the law and commandments. <sup>5</sup> But they did not keep the law, and their father, the devil, cast them into the fire of Gehenna. God was angry with their offspring, who had sinned like a man, and because of their sin, the life of man was shortened.

<sup>6</sup> They took the children of Adam with them into sin and brought them down to Sheol, where they will receive their punishment.

## 1 MEQABYAN 18

<sup>1</sup> As in most places, Selassie has 'JAH' in place of 'the LORD'.

<sup>2</sup> Selassie ends, "brought them from not living into living."

<sup>3</sup> The last part of this verse refers to the 'angels' who fell from heaven to the earth.

<sup>4</sup> Cf. Gn 6: 1-4.

<sup>5</sup> The translation, 'their offspring', is conjectural; the Amharic text seems to read 'the little woman' and Selassie has 'the offspring of Seth'.

<sup>6</sup> Note the use of 'Sheol' here, rather than 'Gehenna'.

<sup>7</sup> የሴት ልጆች በቃየል ልጆች ስለ ሳቱ የሰው ዘመኑ ተከፍሏልና ጥንቱን የሰው ዘመኑ ዘጠኝ መቶ ሲሆን መቶ ሐያ ዘመን ወደ መኖር ተመለሱ። <sup>8</sup> አነሳቸውም ሥጋውያን ደማውያን ናቸውና እግዚአብሔር መንፈስ ረድኤቴ በነሳቸው ጸንቶ አይኖርም አለ። <sup>9</sup> ስለዚህም ነገር ዘመናችን ተከፈለ ስለኃጢአታችንና ስለ በደላችን ዘመናችን ከቀደሙ አባቶቻችን ተከፍልና ዳግመኛም በሕፃንነት ሳሉ የሚሞቱ አሉ።

<sup>10</sup> ሕጉን ስለ ጠበቁ እግዚአብሔርንም ስለ አላሳዘኑት የአባቶቻችን ዘመን ግን በዝቶ ነበር። <sup>11</sup> ያስተምሯቸው ዘንድ ሴቶች ልጆቻቸውን ስለ ተቈጡ የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ እንዳያፈርሱ ወንዶች ልጆቻቸውንም ስለ ተቈጧቸው ያባቶቻችን ዘመን ግን በዝቶ ነበር። <sup>12</sup> ከሴቶች ልጆቻቸውን ከወንዶች ልጆቻቸው ጋራ የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ ስላላ ፈረሱ ስለዚህ ነገር በውነት ዘመናቸው በዝቶ ነበር።

<sup>7</sup> Because the sons of Cain were deceived, the human race was divided; and men originally lived nine hundred years but they were reduced to live for one hundred and twenty years. <sup>8</sup> And he said, “For, they are flesh and blood, and the Spirit of God will not abide in them because he has taken it away.” <sup>9</sup> For this reason, our time is divided; because of our sins and iniquities, our time is divided from our fathers, and there are those who die again in infancy.

<sup>10</sup> But the days of our fathers were prosperous because they kept the law and did not displease God. <sup>11</sup> But the days of our fathers were long, because they were angry with their daughters, and they were angry with their sons, lest they should break the law of God, to teach them. <sup>12</sup> For, they had not broken the law of God by their daughters and their sons, and this was a matter of great truth in their days.

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<sup>7</sup> In place of ‘sons’, Selassie has ‘children’.

<sup>8</sup> Selassie has ‘Spirit of Support’ in place of ‘Spirit of God’.

<sup>9</sup> The meaning of this verse (and possibly the translation) is uncertain.

<sup>10</sup> For ‘were prosperous’, Selassie has ‘abounded’.

<sup>11</sup> Selassie has ‘male children’ in place of ‘sons’, as he does in most cases in this book.

<sup>12</sup> The translation of the latter part of this verse is uncertain.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፲፱

## 1 MEQABYAN 19

<sup>1</sup> የቃየን ልጆች በበዙ ጊዜ ከበሮና በገናን ሳንቲንና መሰንቆን ሠሩ ዘፈንና ጨዋታውንም ሁሉ አደረጉ። <sup>2</sup> እርሷ መልክ መልካም ነበረችና ስለእርሷ ከገደለው ከደግ ሰው ከአቤል ሚስት መልክ መልካሞች ደመ ግቡዎች የሚሆኑ ልጆች ዳግመኛ ለቃየን ተወለዱለት ወንድሙንም ከገደለው በኋላ የርሱ ገንዘብ የሆነች ያቺንና እሷን ወሰደ። <sup>3</sup> ከአባቱም ተለይቶ እነሳቸውን ይዞ በምዕራብ በኩል ወዳለ ወደ ቂፋዝ አውራጃ ሄደ የዚያች የመልክ መልካም ልጆችም እንደ እናታቸው መልክ መልካሞች ሆኑ።

<sup>4</sup> ስለዚህም ነገር የሴት ልጆች ወደ ቃየን ልጆች ወረዱ ካይዋቸውም በኋላ አንዲት ሰዓት አልቆዩም የመረጧቸውንም ሴቶች ለራሳቸው ሚስት አደረጉ። <sup>5</sup> ስለ ስሕተታቸው ከነሳቸው ጋራ አንድነት ወደ ስሕተት ወስደውናልና ስለዚህ ነገር እግዚአብሔር እኛን ተቈጣን እነሳቸውንም ተቈጣቸው።

<sup>6</sup> ዲያብሎስም እንደ ፈጣሪያችሁ እንደ እግዚአብሔር ፈጣሪዎችን ትሆናላችሁ ብሎ ሸንጋሎ እናታችን ሔዋንን አባታችንን አዳምን ወደርሱ ስሕተት ወሰዳቸው።

<sup>7</sup> እነርሳቸው ግን በድንቁርናቸው እውነት መስሏቸው

<sup>1</sup> When the children of Cain multiplied, they made tambourines, harps, lutes, and violins, and they played all kinds of music and dances. <sup>2</sup> She was beautiful and, from the wife of Abel, the good man whom he killed for her, beautiful children were born to Cain again, who was to be his reward. After he killed his brother, he took both her and his property. <sup>3</sup> He separated from his father and took his children with him and went to the western region of Cephas. The children of that beautiful woman became as beautiful as their mother.

<sup>4</sup> And so, the daughters [of Seth] went down to the sons of Cain and, after they had seen them, they did not stay even an hour, and they took for themselves as wives the women they chose. <sup>5</sup> For this reason, God was angry with us and angry with them, because they led us into error by joining together with them because of their error. <sup>6</sup> And the devil deceived our mother Eve, our father Adam, and led them into sin, saying, “You will be like God, the Creator of the universe.” <sup>7</sup> But they, in their ignorance, thought it was true, and

## 1 MEQABYAN 19

<sup>1</sup> Selassie notes that the meaning of the word here translated as ‘lutes’ (ሳንቲንና) is uncertain.

<sup>2</sup> The referent of the 1PF pronouns here is not clearly stated but is probably Abel’s wife.

<sup>3</sup> The identity and location of ‘Cephas’ is not known.

<sup>4</sup> The words, ‘of Seth’, here following Selassie, are not in the Amharic text.

<sup>5</sup> The translation of this verse is uncertain but the Amharic text is somewhat repetitive.

<sup>6</sup> For ‘Creator of the universe’, Selassie has ‘your Creator’.

<sup>7</sup> Selassie has ‘from not living toward living’ in place of ‘from non-existence to existence’.

ይሰግዱ ዘንድ የከበረ ስሙንም ያመሰግኑ ዘንድ ካለመኖር ወደ መኖር አምጥቶ የፈጠራቸውን የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ አፈረሱ።

<sup>8</sup> አምላክነትን ለራሳቸው ያደረጉ እነዚያን ሔዋንና አዳምን ግን እሱ ፈጣሪያቸው አወረደቸው ትዕቢተኛ የሚሆን እሱንም አወረደው። <sup>9</sup> ዳዊት በኃጢአተኛ ዲያብሎስ ትዕቢት አዳም ይጠፋል ብሎ እንደተናገረ አባታችን አዳም በዲያብሎስ ትዕቢት ከእግዚአብሔር በታዘዘ በውነተኛ ፍርዱ ተፈርዶበታልና አጎሳቁላቸው። <sup>10</sup> በቃየል ልጆች የሳቱ የሴት ልጆችም እንዲሁ ወደ ኃጢአታቸው ወሰዱን ስለዚህ ነገር እግዚአብሔር የሰጠን ዘመናችን ከአባቶቻችን ዘመን አነሰ። <sup>11</sup> እነሳቸው ግን በጎ ሥራ ሠርተው ነበር ልቡናቸውን በእግዚአብሔር አጽንተው ነበርና ካስተማሯቸው ከእግዚአብሔር ሕግ እንዳይወጡ ሴቶች ልጆቻቸውንና ወንዶች ልጆቻቸውንም አስተምረው ነበርና የሚቀርባቸው ክፋ ጠላትም አልነበረ። <sup>12</sup> እነሳቸው ግን በጎ ሥራ ቢሠሩ ለልጆቻቸውን ካልነገሩ ካላስተማሯቸው የሚጠቅማቸው የለም።

<sup>13</sup> ዳዊት ከልጆቻቸው ለሌላ ልጅ አልሠወሩም የእግዚአብሔርን ምስጋና ያደረገውን ድንቅ ታምራትና ኃይሉንም አስተማሩ ብሎ እንደ ተናገረ እነሳቸው እንዳወቁ

broke the law of God, who created them from non-existence to existence, so that they might worship and praise his glorious name.

<sup>8</sup> But those two, Eve and Adam, who took godhood for themselves, were brought down by their Creator, and he brought down the one who was arrogant. <sup>9</sup> Just as David said that Adam perished through the pride of the wicked devil, our father Adam was condemned by God through the pride of the devil; for, he disobeyed God and was judged by his true judgment. <sup>10</sup> The daughters of Cain, who were led astray by the sons of Cain, also led us into their sins. Therefore, our days that God has given us are shorter than were the days of our fathers. <sup>11</sup> But they did good works, and they strengthened their hearts in God, and they taught their daughters and their sons not to depart from the law of God, which they had taught them, and there was no evil enemy that could approach them. <sup>12</sup> But if they do good deeds, if they do not tell their children or teach them, it will not benefit them.

<sup>13</sup> As David had said to them, they did not hide from their children the wondrous miracles that God had done, and his power, and they taught them the praises of God. It

<sup>8</sup> Throughout the book, Selassie has ‘Hiewan’ in place of ‘Eve’.

<sup>9</sup> A more literal translation of ‘Adam perished’ is ‘Adam would perish’.

<sup>10</sup> Selassie has ‘Seth’ in place of the 1<sup>st</sup> instance of ‘Cain’ – which here follows the Amharic text.

<sup>11</sup> Selassie ends, “who approach(ed) them.”

<sup>12</sup> The meaning of this verse is not entirely clear.

<sup>13</sup> The translation of this verse is uncertain but the Amharic text is somewhat repetitive.



ልብ ሊያደርጉ ለልጆቻቸው ያስተምሩ ዘንድ አወቀውም ፈቃዱን ያደርጉ ዘንድ የእግዚአብሔር ሕጉንም አደራ ይሏቸው ዘንድ ባማረ ሥራቸው እግዚአብሔርን ደስ እንዳስኙት እንደ አባቶቻቸውም ሕጉን ይጠብቁ ዘንድ ለልጆቻቸው ካላስተማሩ የሚጠቅማቸው የለም።

<sup>14</sup> ካባቶቻቸው በሕፃንነታቸው አደራ ያልዋቸው ትእዛዙንም አላፈረሱም አባቶቻቸው ካባቶቻቸው የእግዚአብሔርን አምልኮት ዘጠኙንም ሕግጋት እንደ ተማሩ። <sup>15</sup> በጎ ሥራ ይሠሩ ዘንድ ለፈጣሪያቸውም ምስጋናን ያቀርቡ ዘንድ ልጆቻቸው ከባቶቻቸው ተማሩ ሕጉን ጠብቀዋልና እሱንም ወደውታልና። <sup>16</sup> እሱም ጸሎታቸውን ይሰማቸዋል ልመናቸውንም ቸል አይልም እሱ ግን ይቅር ባይ ነው። <sup>17</sup> መዓቱን አብዝቶ ይመልስላቸዋል በመቅሠፍቱም ሁሉ አያጠፋም ነበር።

is of no benefit to them if they do not teach their children – so that they make take heart teach their children to keep the law, as their fathers did, that they should be mindful of God’s glory, and that they should keep the law as their fathers did.

<sup>14</sup> And they did not disobey his commandments, just as their fathers had learned from their fathers the worship of God and the Nine Commandments. <sup>15</sup> And their children learned from their fathers, that they might do good works and to give thanks to their Creator; for, they kept the law and they loved it. <sup>16</sup> He hears their prayers and does not ignore their pleas, but he is Forgiving. <sup>17</sup> He would repay them with great wrath and would not destroy them with all the plagues.

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<sup>14</sup> Selassie has ‘the Nine Laws’ in place of ‘the Nine Commandments’ (cf. #7:5).

<sup>15</sup> In place of ‘loved it’, Selassie ends with ‘loved Him’.

<sup>16</sup> Selassie has the verbs in the first two clauses in the future tense.

<sup>17</sup> The meaning of this verse is unclear.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፳

<sup>1</sup> ወንድሞቻችን አስቡ እግዚአብሔር በጎ ሥራ የሚሠሩ ሰዎችን እውነተኛ ሥራቸውን እንዲጠብቅ ቀድሞ የነገሩዋችሁን አትርሱ። <sup>2</sup> ልጆቻቸውንም በዚህ ዓለም ያበዛል ስም አጠራራቸውም ለበጎ ነገር እስከ ዘለዓለሙ ድረስ ጸንቶ ይኖራል ልጆቻቸውም በዚህ ዓለም እህልን አይቸገርም። <sup>3</sup> ስለነሳቸው ይከራከርላቸዋልና በጠላታቸውም እጅ አይጥላቸውምና ከሚጠሏቸው ከጠላቶቻቸው እጅ ያድናቸዋል። <sup>4</sup> ስሙን ለሚወዱ ሰዎችም በመከራቸው ጊዜ ረዳት ይኖራቸዋል ይጠብቃቸዋል ኃጢአታቸውንም ሁሉ ይቅር ይላቸዋል።

## 1 MEQABYAN 20

<sup>1</sup> Remember, brothers, do not forget what we told you before, that God will protect those who do good and keep their true works. <sup>2</sup> He will multiply their children in this world, and their name will endure for good things forever, and their children will not lack for food in this world. <sup>3</sup> He will defend them because he has raised them up and will not abandon them to the hand of their enemies; he will save them from the hand of their enemies who hate them. <sup>4</sup> He will be a helper to those who love his name in time of trouble, and he will protect them and forgive them all their sins.

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### 1 MEQABYAN 20

<sup>1</sup> For 'protect', Selassie has 'keep the true work'.

<sup>2</sup> Selassie has 'grain' in place of 'food'.

<sup>3</sup> In place of 'defend them', Selassie has 'dispute for them'.

<sup>4</sup> Selassie has 'pardon' in place of 'forgive'.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፳፩

<sup>1</sup> ዳዊት እግዚአብሔር አመነ በሱ አምኗልና መጠጊያ ሆነው ከንጉሡ ከሳኦልም እጅ አዳነው። <sup>2</sup> ልጁ አቤሴሎም በተነሣበት ጊዜ ኢሎፍላውያንም በተነሡበት ጊዜ ኤዶማውያንና አማሌቃውያንም በተነሡበት ጊዜ ካራቱ ራፋይን አንዱ በተነሣበት ጊዜ በሱ አምኗልና ሕጉንም ጠብቋልና የተከራከሩት ጠላቶች ካመጡበት ከዚህ ሁሉ መከራ እግዚአብሔር ዳዊትን አዳነው። <sup>3</sup> ድል መንሣት በእግዚአብሔር ፈቃድ ነውና በጠላቶቻቸው እጅ ድል ተነሡ እንጂ ያላመኑበት ክፉ የሆኑ ነገሥታቱን ግን እግዚአብሔር አላዳናቸውም። <sup>4</sup> ሕዝቅያስም በእግዚአብሔር አመነ ትዕቢተኛ ከሆነ ከሰናክሬም እጅ አዳነው።

<sup>5</sup> መቃመኑን በእግዚአብሔር አላደረገምና ልጅ ምናሴ ግን በጠላቱ እጅ ድል ተነሣ መቃመኑን በእግዚአብሔር አላደረገምና ፈጽሞ ያከበረው ያገነነው እግዚአብሔርንም አልፈራውምና አሥረው ወደ አገራቸው ወሰዱት እንጂ ምናሴን ድል የነሡት እነዚያ ጠላቶቹ ግን እንደሱ አልሆኑም። <sup>6</sup> ዘመኑ ይበዛ ዘንድ ጠላቱንም የከራከርለት ዘንድ በኋላና በፊትም ኃይልን ጽንዕን ይሆነው ዘንድ በፈጣሪው በእግዚአብሔር ፊት በጎ ሥራን አልሠራምና

## 1 MEQABYAN 21

<sup>1</sup> David trusted in God; and, because he trusted in him, he became his refuge and delivered him from the hand of King Saul. <sup>2</sup> When his son Absalom rose up, when the Philistines rose up, when the Edomites and the Amalekites rose up, when the Carthaginians rose up, when one of the giants rose up, God delivered David from all the troubles that his enemies brought on him, because he trusted in him and kept the law. <sup>3</sup> Since victory is God's will, God did not save the wicked kings who did not believe in him, but they were defeated by their enemies. <sup>4</sup> And Hezekiah believed in God, and God delivered him from the hand of Sennacherib, though he was proud. <sup>5</sup> But the son of Manasseh was defeated by his enemies because he did not trust in God. But those enemies who defeated Manasseh were not like him, but they took him captive and carried him to their land, because he did not trust in God, and he did not fear God. <sup>6</sup> He took away the kingdom that was given to him at that time, because he did not do what was right in the sight of God his Creator, that he might prolong his days, and that he might contend with his enemies, and that he might

### 1 MEQABYAN 21

- <sup>1</sup> Selassie has 'believed' in place of 'trusted' (twice in this verse).  
<sup>2</sup> Here, 'Philistines' is a conjectural translation.  
<sup>3</sup> Selassie transposes 'they were defeated by their enemies' to the middle of the verse.  
<sup>4</sup> Cf. 2K 18:13-19:37.  
<sup>5</sup> The author here seems to confuse the attitude and fate of the son Manasseh (Amon) with that of his successor, Josiah.  
<sup>6</sup> For 'took away the kingdom', Selassie has 'denied him the kingdom'.

የሰጠውን መንግሥት የዚያን ጊዜ ነሳው። <sup>7</sup> ከብዙ ሠራዊት በእግዚአብሔር ማመን ይሻላልና በፈረሶች በቀስትና በጋሻ ከማመን።

<sup>8</sup> በእግዚአብሔር ማመን ይበልጣል በሱ ያመነ ሰው ይጸናል ይከብራል ፈጽሞም ከፍ ከፍ ይላል። <sup>9</sup> እግዚአብሔር ለፊት አያደላምና በእግዚአብሔር ያላመኑ በገንዘባቸው ብዛት ያመኑ ሰዎች ግን ከሰጣቸው ጸጋና ክብር የወጡ ሆኑ። <sup>10</sup> ያመኑበትን ሰዎች ይጠብቃቸዋል ያላዋቂ የሚሉትን ሰዎች ግን ያላዋቂ ያደርጋቸዋል እግዚአብሔርን ለመከተል ሕጉንም ለመጠበቅ ልቡናቸውንም አላስጨከኑምና በመከራቸው ጊዜ ጠላቶቻቸውም በተከራከሩዋቸው ጊዜ ፈጥኖ አይረዳቸውም።

<sup>11</sup> እግዚአብሔርን በማምለክ ሕጉንም ለመጠበቅ ለጨከነ ሰው ግን በመከራው ጊዜ መጠጊያን ይሆነዋል። <sup>12</sup> ጠላቱን በማጥፋት የጠላቱንም ከብት በመዝረፍ የጠላቱን አገር ሰውም በመማረክ የዘመኖች ዝናምንም በማዝነም ቡቃያንም በማብቀል የእህሉንም ክምር በማግባት በተክሉ ፍሬ።

<sup>13</sup> የሳተኑንና የበልጉንም ዝናም በማዝነም ሣሩንም በማለምለም ከሥልጣንህ በታች ያሉ ወገኖችህ ደስ ይላቸው ዘንድ በየጊዜውም የሚዘንመውን ዝናም በመስጠት ደስ ያሰኘዋል።

be strong and powerful before and behind. <sup>7</sup> It is better to trust in God than in a large army, than believing in horses, bows, and shields.

<sup>8</sup> Believing in God is greater. Whoever believes in him will be established, honoured, and exalted forever. <sup>9</sup> God is impartial so, those who did not believe in God but trusted in their abundant wealth were deprived of the grace and glory he gave them. <sup>10</sup> He protects those who believe in him but he makes ignorant those who call him ignorant; as they have not hardened their hearts to follow God and keep his law, he does not quickly help them in their time of trouble and when their enemies argue with them.

<sup>11</sup> But, for a person who is diligent in worshipping God and keeping his law, he will be a refuge in times of trouble. <sup>12</sup> By destroying the enemy, by plundering the enemy's cattle, by capturing the enemy's land and people, by bringing the seasonal rain, by making the sprouts grow, and by gathering the grain heaps and the fruit of the plants, <sup>13</sup> he also makes the people under your rule happy by sending the autumn and spring rains, and by making the grass green, and by giving them the rain that falls at regular intervals, so that they may rejoice.

<sup>7</sup> Selassie has 'believe' in place of 'trust'.

<sup>8</sup> In place of 'exalted forever', Selassie has 'totally lofty'.

<sup>9</sup> For 'wealth', Selassie has 'money'.

<sup>10</sup> In place of 'argue', Selassie has 'dispute'.

<sup>11</sup> The translation here given is very similar to that of Selassie.

<sup>12</sup> Although this verse is clumsy in translation, it is difficult to see how to adjust it to make it more in line with contemporary English.

<sup>13</sup> Selassie has 'first' in place of 'autumn'.

<sup>14</sup> የሌላውን ገንዘብ ይበሉ ዘንድ ከጠላታቸው የዘረፉትን ገንዘብ በልተው ይጠግቡ ዘንድ እንስሳትን በጎችንና ላሞችንም ይዘርፉ ዘንድ የሌላውንም ማዕድ ይበሉ ዘንድ የጠላቶቻቸውንም ልጆች ምርኮ ይወስዱ ዘንድ ደስ ያሰኘዋል። <sup>15</sup> እግዚአብሔር ይኸን ሁሉ ለሚወደው ሰው ያደርግለታል የሚጠላውን ሰው ግን ለጠላቱ ብዝበዛ ያደርገዋል። <sup>16</sup> እግሩንና እጁንም ያሥረዋል በጠላቱም እጅ ይጥለዋል ለጠላቶቹም መዘባበቻ ያደርገዋል የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ ያፈረሰ ደም አፍሳሽም ሆኗልና በቤቱ ዘር ደስ አያሰኘውም። <sup>17</sup> በፍርድም ጊዜ አይጸናም ኃጢአትንም ለማሠሩ ሰዎች ፍዳውን ያመጣባቸዋል ዘንድ ክፉ ሥራን ለማሠሩ ሰዎችም የኃጢአታቸውን ፍዳ ይሰጣቸዋል። <sup>18</sup> በሥልጣኑ ይጠብቃቸው ዘንድ በጎ ሥራ ለማሠሩ ሰዎች ግን ዋጋቸውን ሊሰጣቸው ከእግዚአብሔር ዘንድ ታዘዘ። <sup>19</sup> በጎ ሥራን ያደርግ ዘንድ የዘለዓለም ድኅነትንም ይሰጣቸው ዘንድ እነሳቸውም የፈጠራቸው እግዚአብሔርን ያመሰግኑት ዘንድ እሱ በፈጠረው ፍጥረት ሁሉ ላይ ከሀሊ ነውና እሱም ሕጉን ይጠብቅ ዘንድ አዘዘ ከሰው ብቻ በቀር ከፈጠረው ፍጥረት ሁሉ ከትእዛዙ የወጣ የለም። <sup>20</sup> እግዚአብሔር በየሥራቸው ጸንተው የሚኖሩትን ሁሉ እንዳዘዛቸው ሁሉም አውቀው በሕጉ ይጠበቃሉ። <sup>21</sup> ሰው

<sup>14</sup> They delight to devour the wealth of others, to devour the spoils of their enemies, to plunder animals, sheep, and cattle, and to eat at the tables of others, and to take their enemies' children captive. <sup>15</sup> God does all these things for those he loves, but he makes those who hate him a prey for their enemies. <sup>16</sup> And he will bind him hand and foot, and he will deliver him into the hand of his enemies, and he will make him a reproach to his enemies. He will not be pleased with the offspring of his house, because he has transgressed the law of God, and has become a shedder of blood. <sup>17</sup> And he will not stand in judgment when he will repay those who do wrong according to their sins, so that they may receive their reward. <sup>18</sup> But he was commanded by God to reward those who did good, so that he might protect those who were under his authority. <sup>19</sup> He commanded all creatures to keep his law; for, he is sovereign over all creatures he created, so that they may do good works and attain eternal salvation, and that those whom he created might praise God. No creature, except man, has ever disobeyed his command. <sup>20</sup> Everyone knows that God commands all who live steadfastly in their work to be protected by the law. <sup>21</sup> But man rebels

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<sup>14</sup> A more literal translation of 'devour' is 'eat'.  
<sup>15</sup> One could read 'who he hates' in place of 'who hate him'.  
<sup>16</sup> This verse is really one long sentence in the Amharic text.  
<sup>17</sup> The referent of the 1<sup>st</sup> instance of 'he' is the wrongdoer of the previous verses.  
<sup>18</sup> The referent now shifts to the diligent, lawful ruler.  
<sup>19</sup> The last sentence is an interesting observation that does not occur elsewhere in canonical scripture.  
<sup>20</sup> For this verse, Selassie has, "Like unto JAH commanded all who live firmed up in each of them Works ~ them all know and are kept in His LAW."  
<sup>21</sup> Selassie has 'heaven' in place of 'sky'.



ግን በየፈጠራቸው በእንስሳና በአራዊት ላይ በሰማይም ወፎች ላይ ሁሉ ባነገሠው በእግዚአብሔር ላይ ይደፋፈራል።

<sup>22</sup> በባሕር ያለውን በየብስ ያለውንም ሁሉ ቢሆን የፈጠረውን ፍጥረት ሁሉ እግዚአብሔር ላባታቸው ለአዳም ሰጠው የወደደውን ያደርግ ዘንድ በምድርም እንደ በቀለ እህል ይበሏቸው ዘንድ ገዝተውም ያስገብሯቸው ዘንድ አራዊትም ቢሆኑ እንስሳት ቢሆኑ ለሰው ይታዘዙ ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር ሰጣቸው የነገሡ ሰዎችም ክብርን ለሰጣቸው ለእግዚአብሔር የታዘዙ ዘንድ ያደሉለትም ዘንድ በፈጠረው ሁሉ ላይ ሾማቸው።

<sup>23</sup> ከሕጉ ቢወጡ ግን እሱ ከሰጣቸው ጌትነት ይለያቸዋል ምድርንና ሰማይን የሚገዛ ነውና ፈቃዱን ለሚያደርግ ይሰጠዋል። <sup>24</sup> ሊሾመው የወደደውን ይሾመዋል ሊሸረው የመወደደውን ግን የሸረዋል ይገድላል ያድናል በመከራ ይገርፋል ይቅር ይላል። <sup>25</sup> እንደሱ ያለ ፈጣሪ ሌላ የለም ለፈጠረው ፍጥረት ሁሉ እሱ ገዥ ነውና ከምድር በላይ ባለ ከሰማይ በታች ባለ በምድር ያለሱ ፈጣሪ ሌላ የለምና የሚነቅፈው የለም። <sup>26</sup> ይሾማል ይሸራል ይገድላል ያድናል በመከራ ይገርፋል ይቅር ይላል ያደኽያል ያከብራል።

<sup>27</sup> የሚለምኑትን ሰዎች ልመናቸውን ይሰማቸዋል በንጽሕ ልቡና ፈቃዱን የሚያደርግን ሰው ለምናውን ይቀበለዋል

against God, who has made him ruler over all the animals and wild beasts and birds of the sky. <sup>22</sup> And God gave to Adam every creature that is in the sea, and every creature that is on dry land, that he might do whatever he pleased, and that they might eat of them as the grain that grew up on the earth, and that they might be bought and subservient, and that they should be obedient to men, whether beasts or animals, should be obedient to men; and that men who reigned should be obedient to God, and that they should be partial to him, to whom he had given glory.

<sup>23</sup> But, if they depart from the law, he will separate them from the dominion he has given them; for, he rules heaven and earth and he gives it to whomever does his will. <sup>24</sup> He appoints whom he wills and he dethrones whom he wills. He kills, saves, scourges, and forgives. <sup>25</sup> There is no other Creator like him; for, he is the ruler of all creation, and there is no other Creator, above the earth, under the heavens, and on the earth. There is no one to criticise him. <sup>26</sup> He appoints, he revokes, he kills, he saves, he scourges with suffering, he forgives, he impoverishes, he honours.

<sup>27</sup> He hears the prayers of those who pray. He accepts the prayers of those who do his will with a pure heart. He hears their prayers

<sup>22</sup> The distinction between ‘beasts’ and ‘animals’ is not entirely clear.

<sup>23</sup> The ‘it’ in the 2<sup>nd</sup> part of the verse refers to the ‘dominion’ in the 1<sup>st</sup> part.

<sup>24</sup> Selassie has ‘whips’ in place of ‘scourges’.

<sup>25</sup> Selassie ends the 1<sup>st</sup> sentence, “in Heaven above Earth nor upon Earth beneath Heaven.”

<sup>26</sup> In place of ‘revokes’, Selassie has ‘dismiss(es)’.

<sup>27</sup> For this verse, Selassie has, “Him hear persons who beg Him ina them plea ~ Him accept a person plea who do Him Accord with a clean reasonin; an Him hear them ina them priah ~ an Him do them accord fe them ina all that them begged Him.”

እሱም ጸሎታቸውን ይሰማቸዋል በለመኑትም ሁሉ ፈቃዳቸውን ያደርግላቸዋል። <sup>28</sup> ታላቁንና ታናሹንም እንዲታዘዙላቸው ያደርጋል በኮረብታና በተራራ ላይ በዛፎች ሥርና በዋሻም በምድር ጐድጓድም በደረቅና በባሕርም ያሉ ወገኖቻቸውንም ሁሉ ይህ ሁሉ ይነሳቸው ገንዘብ ነው።

<sup>29</sup> የፈጣሪያቸውንም ፈቃድ ለሚያደርጉ ሰዎች ይህ ሁሉ ገንዘባቸው ነው ካበረከቱም አያስቸግራቸውም የምስጋናቸውንም ዋጋ ይሰጣቸዋል። <sup>30</sup> በሰማይም ላባቶቻቸው ለይስሐቅና ለአብርሃም ለያዕቆብም ያዘጋጀውን ክብር ይሰጣቸዋል ከሕጉና ከትእዛዙ ላልወጡ ለሕዝቅያስና ለዳዊት ለሳሙኤልም ያዘጋጀውን ይሰጣቸዋል። <sup>31</sup> በጌትነቱ ደስ ይላቸው ዘንድ ከጥንት ጀምሮ ላገለገሉት ርስትን ሊሰጣቸው ለማለላቸው ለአባቶቻቸው ለይስሐቅና ለአብርሃም ለያዕቆብም ያዘጋጀውን ክብር ይሰጣቸዋል።

and fulfils their will in all their requests. <sup>28</sup> And he makes the great and the small obedient to him, on the hills and mountains, under the trees, in caves and in the caves of the earth, on the land and in the sea, and all their people, and all this is money that he will raise for them.

<sup>29</sup> And for those who do the will of their Creator, all this wealth is theirs, and he will not burden them with it, and he will reward them for their gratitude. <sup>30</sup> And, in heaven, they will be given the glory he made for their fathers, Isaac, Abraham and Jacob; and, for those who did not depart from his law and commandments, he will give the glory he made for Hezekiah, David, and Samuel. <sup>31</sup> He will give them the glory he made for their fathers, Isaac, Abraham, and Jacob, to whom he swore to give the inheritance he had served from of old, so they can rejoice in his sovereignty.

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<sup>28</sup> The use of the term, 'money', here seems unusual ('wealth' is used in v. 29 and elsewhere).

<sup>29</sup> The 'burden' of wealth can lead people astray.

<sup>30</sup> Selassie has 'honour' in place of 'glory' (twice in this verse).

<sup>31</sup> The order in which the three Patriarchs are named here and in v. 30 is unusual.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፳፪

<sup>1</sup> በጎ ሥራን የሚሠሩትን ሰዎች ስም እስኪ አስብ ሥራቸውንም አትዘንጋ። <sup>2</sup> የእግዚአብሔርን ፈቃድ ላደረጉ ደጋግቶ ሰዎች ለሆኑ ለመኳንንትና ለነገሥታት ባዘጋጃት የብርሃን ማደሪያ በሆነች በመንግሥተ ሰማይ ከነሳቸው ጋራ ደስ ይልህ ዘንድ ስምህ እንደ ሰማቸው እንዲጠራ ቅና።

<sup>3</sup> ዳግመኛም እንዲፈረድባቸው ከሞቱም በኋላ በሰው ዘንድ እንዲያሟቸው ክፉዎች የመኳንንትና የነገሥታትን ሰማቸውን ዕወቅ ተረዳ። <sup>4</sup> እያዩ እየሰሙ ሥራቸውን አላሠመሩምና የእግዚአብሔርን ፈቃድ ካላደረጉ ከወንጀለኞችና የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ ከዘነጉ ሰዎች በመንግሥተ ሰማይም እንዲፈረድባቸው ዕወቅ ተረዳ። <sup>5</sup> ቸር የሆነ ቅን ሁን እንጂ አንተም ስለ ክፉ ሥራቸው እግዚአብሔር በተቈጣቸው የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ በዘነጉ ሰዎች ጐዳና አትሒድ።

<sup>6</sup> እውነትን ፈርደህ እናት አባቱ የሞቱበት ልጅንና ባለቴቲቱን ከሚቀሟቸው ከኃጢአተኞች ሰዎች ልጅ አድን።

<sup>7</sup> ከሚቀማው ከባለጠጋው እጅ ታድነው ዘንድ እናት አባቱም ለሞቱበት ልጅ እንደ አባቱ ጠበቃ ሁነው ቁምለትም ንስሐ ያልገቡ ኃጢአተኞችን ሰዎች በሚቀጡበት በእሳት ባሕር

## 1 MEQABYAN 22

<sup>1</sup> Remember the names of those who do good deeds and do not forget their deeds. <sup>2</sup> Hope that your name may be called with their names, that you may rejoice with them in the kingdom of heaven, which is a dwelling place of light prepared for princes and kings, who are good people who do the will of God.

<sup>3</sup> He learned the names of the wicked princes and kings, so that they might be judged again, alongside other men, after their death. <sup>4</sup> And if, having seen and heard, they do not do the will of God, they will be judged in the kingdom of heaven along with other criminals and with those who have forgotten the law of God. <sup>5</sup> Be kind, gentle, and upright, and do not walk in the path of those who have forsaken the law of God, who have incurred God's wrath because of their evil deeds.

<sup>6</sup> Judge truthfully and save the child whose mother and father are dead and the child of the widow from the wicked men who oppress them. <sup>7</sup> Be a father to the orphan, and stand up for him, so that he may be saved from the hand of the oppressor. And be afraid when the tears of the orphan flow before you, lest you be

## 1 MEQABYAN 22

- <sup>1</sup> Selassie has 'Work' in place of 'deeds' (twice in this verse).
- <sup>2</sup> In place of 'princes', Selassie has 'nobles'.
- <sup>3</sup> The translation, 'alongside other men', loosely following Selassie, is conjectural.
- <sup>4</sup> For 'along with', Selassie has 'more than'.
- <sup>5</sup> In place of 'gentle and upright', Selassie has 'innocent ~ honest'.
- <sup>6</sup> Selassie has 'rob' in place of 'oppress'.
- <sup>7</sup> Selassie ends, "where sinner persons who didn't enter repentance are punished."

እንዳትደነግጥ እናት አባቱ የሞቱበት ልጅ እንባም በፊትህ በፈሰሰ ጊዜ ደንግጥ።

<sup>8</sup> እግርህንም ወደ ፍቅር አንድነት ጐዳና አቅና የእግዚአብሔር ዓይኖች ወዳጆቹን ይመለከታሉና ጆሮውም ልመናቸውን ይሰማልና ፍቅርን ፈልጋት ተከተላት።

<sup>9</sup> የእግዚአብሔር ገጸ መዓቱ ግን ስም አጠራራቸውን ከዚህ ዓለም ያጠፋ ዘንድ ክፉ ሥራን ወደሚሠሩ ሰዎች ነው በቅጥርና በተራራ ላይ ያለ የሚጠጋ ሰውንም አያስቀርም።

<sup>10</sup> በአምላክነቱ የምቀና እግዚአብሔር ነኝና የሚጠሉኝ ቃሌንም የማይጠብቁ ሰዎችን ተበቅዬ የማጠፋ ፈጣሪ ነኝና ቃሌን የማይጠብቅ ሰውን እስካጠፋው ድረስ ደርሴ ገጸ ረድኤቴን አልመልስም። <sup>11</sup> የሚያከብሩኝንም ቃሌንም የሚጠብቁ ሰዎችን አከብራቸዋለሁ።

terrified by the lake of fire where unrepentant sinners are punished.

<sup>8</sup> And straighten up your feet to the path of unity and love. Seek love and follow it; for, the eyes of God are on his friends, and his ears are open to their supplication. <sup>9</sup> But the face of God's wrath is upon those who do evil, those who would blot out his name and reputation from this world. He will not spare anyone who takes refuge behind a wall or on a mountain. <sup>10</sup> For, I am a jealous God, and I will not turn back until I have destroyed those who hate me and do not keep my word. <sup>11</sup> And I shall honour those people who honour me and keep my word.

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<sup>8</sup> Selassie personifies 'love' and uses feminine pronouns when referring to it.

<sup>9</sup> In place of 'a wall', Selassie has 'ramparts'.

<sup>10</sup> Using the usual Rastafarian language, Selassie opens, "As I-man am JAH Who am jealous upon I Godhood."

<sup>11</sup> @@@@

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ፡ ጳጉ

<sup>1</sup> ወንድሙ የሚወደው መስሎት በየዋህነት የተከተለው ወንድሙን በገደለው በቃየል ሥርዓት ጸንተህ አትኑር።  
<sup>2</sup> እርሱም በሴት ቀንቶ ወንድሙን ገደለው ቅናትና በደልን በባልንጀራቸውም ክዳትን የሚያደርጉ ሰዎች እንደሱ ናቸው።  
<sup>3</sup> አቤት ግን እንደ በግ የዋህ ነውና ደሙም በንጹሕ ልቡና ለእግዚአብሔር እንደሠውት እንደ ንጹሕ በግ ደም ነውና በአቤል ጎዳና ያይደለ በቃየል ጐዳና ሄዱ። <sup>4</sup> በየዋህነት የሚኖረውን ሰው ሁሉ እግዚአብሔር እንደ ደግ ሰው እንደ አቤል የሚወደው ሰው ስለሆነ እንደ አቤል የዋሆችን ሆነዋልና የዋህ በሆነ በአቤል ሥራ ጸንተው የሚኖሩ እሊያ ሰዎች ግን እግዚአብሔርን ይወዱታል።  
<sup>5</sup> ክፉዎችን ግን እግዚአብሔር ቸል ይላቸዋል ቁርጥ ፍርዳቸውም በሰውነታቸው ደጅ ይጠናቸዋል በመትከፈ ልቡናቸውም የተጻፈ ነው ፍርድም በሚፈረድበት ጊዜ በሰውና በመላእክት ፊት በፍጥረቱም ሁሉ ፊት ያነጋታል።  
<sup>6</sup> የዚያን ጊዜ ያፍራሉ የእግዚአብሔርን ፈቃድ ያላደረጉ በደለኞችና እምቢተኞች ያፍራሉ። <sup>7</sup> እስከ ዘለዓለሙ ድረስ መውጫ በሌለባት በገሃነም አኑሯቸው የሚል የሚያስደነግጥ ቃልም ይሰጣቸዋል።

## 1 MEQABYAN 23

<sup>1</sup> Do not continue in the way of Cain, who killed his brother, who meekly followed his brother, thinking that he loved him. <sup>2</sup> He was jealous of a woman and killed his brother. People who commit jealousy, and injustice, and treachery against their neighbours are like him. <sup>3</sup> But behold, he is as gentle as a lamb, and his blood is as pure as the blood of a lamb offered to God with a pure heart. Therefore, they went in the way of Cain, not in the way of Abel. <sup>4</sup> Because God loves everyone who lives in meekness, just as he loves Abel. Therefore, they become meek like Abel, and those who live in meekness and persevere in Abel's work love God.  
<sup>5</sup> But God ignores the wicked, and their final judgment is firmly pronounced on them at the gates of their bodies, and it is written in their hearts; and, when the judgment is pronounced, he reads it before men and in the presence of angels, and in the presence all his creation. <sup>6</sup> At that time, the wicked and rebellious who did not do God's will shall be ashamed. <sup>7</sup> They are also given the terrifying promise that they will be condemned to Gehenna, from which there is no exit for eternity.

## 1 MEQABYAN 23

- <sup>1</sup> The 2<sup>nd</sup> 'who' clearly refers to Abel – Cain's brother.
- <sup>2</sup> The story in Genesis does not say that Cain was jealous of Abel's wife (though that claim is made several times in this book).
- <sup>3</sup> It is not clear who are the people referred to in vv. 3–4.
- <sup>4</sup> Selassie has 'innocence' in place of 'meekness'.
- <sup>5</sup> The precise meaning of the phrase, 'the gates of their bodies', is unclear.
- <sup>6</sup> For 'wicked', Selassie has 'wrongdoers'.
- <sup>7</sup> Some read 'hell' in place of 'Gehenna'.



## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፳፬

## 1 MEQABYAN 24

<sup>1</sup> ጌዴዎን ግን እግዚአብሔርን በታመነው ጊዜ በጥቂት ሠራዊት እልፍ የብዙ ብዙ የሆኑ እንዳንበጣም ቁጥር የሌላቸው ያልተገረዙ የእሕዛብን ሠራዊት ድል ነሣ። <sup>2</sup> ያለኔ ፈጣሪ የለምና መኳንንትና ነገሥታት ሆይ ልዩ የሆኑ ጣዖታትን አትመኑ። <sup>3</sup> ከናታችሁ ማኅፀን ያወጣኋችሁ ያሳደግኋችሁ የመገብኋችሁ ያለበስኋችሁ እኔ ፈጣሪያችሁ እኔ እግዚአብሔር ነኝና ለምን ታመካኛላችሁ ያለኔስ ሌላ ጣዖትን ለምን ታመልካላችሁ። <sup>4</sup> ይኸን ሁሉ አደረግሁላችሁ ምን ሰጣችሁኝ በሕጌ በሥርዓቴ በትእዛዜ ጸንታችሁ ትኖሩ ዘንድ እኔም የሰውነታችሁ ድኅነት እሰጣችሁ ዘንድ ነው እንጂ ከናንተ ምን እሻለሁ።

<sup>5</sup> ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር አንዲህ አለ ጣዖት ከማምለክ ጥንቄላም ከማስጤንቁል ሚርትም ከማሟረት ራሳችሁን አድኑ አለ። <sup>6</sup> በነዚህ ይህን በሚያደርጉ በሚሰሟቸውም ፈቃዳቸውን በሚያደርጉ ወዳጅም በሚሆኗቸው በትእዛዛቸውም ጸንተው በሚኖሩ የእግዚአብሔር መቅሠፍት ይመጣልና ራሳችሁን ጣዖት ከማምለክ አድኑ። <sup>7</sup> የማያውቋችሁ የማይራሩላችሁ አሕዛብ ይነሡባችኋልና

<sup>1</sup> But, when Gideon trusted God, he defeated an army of uncircumcised Gentiles, countless in number, with an army of thousands upon thousands. <sup>2</sup> O princes and kings, do not believe in various idols; for, there is no creator besides me. <sup>3</sup> I am the one who took you out of your mother's womb, who raised you, who fed you, who clothed you. I am your Creator. Why do you make excuses to worship other gods besides me? <sup>4</sup> I have done all these things for you. What do you give me? What do I require of you, but that you abide in my law, in my ordinances, and in my commandments, and I give you the salvation of your body?

<sup>5</sup> Thus says the Lord GOD who rules all: "Save yourselves from worshipping idols, from practising sorcery, and from divination. <sup>6</sup> Save yourselves from practising idolatry; for, the wrath of God will come upon those who do this, those who listen to them, those who do their will, those who are friends with them, and those who remain steadfast in their commandments. <sup>7</sup> For, nations that have not known you and

## 1 MEQABYAN 24

<sup>1</sup> After 'countless in number', Selassie adds 'like unto locusts'.

<sup>2</sup> Selassie has 'nobles' in place of 'princes'.

<sup>3</sup> The translation, 'make excuses', is uncertain.

<sup>4</sup> For 'salvation', Selassie has 'welfare'.

<sup>5</sup> Here, 'Lord GOD' translates እግዚአብሔር. In place of 'divination', Selassie has 'discouraging pessimism'.

<sup>6</sup> Selassie has 'chastisement' in place of 'wrath'.

<sup>7</sup> Selassie lacks the references to 'Samuel' and 'Ezekiel' and repeats 'will eat up the money you have worked for' at the end of the verse.

የፈራችሁ የእግዚአብሔርን ፈቃድ ካላደረጋችሁ የደከማችሁበትን ገንዘብ ይበላሉ ከነቢዩ ከሳሙኤል ጀምሮ አገልጋዩቹ ነቢያት እንደ ተናገሩ ዳግመኛም ሕዝቅኤል እንደ ተናገረ ሄኖክም እንደ ተናገረ አሳፍም እንደ ተናገረ የእግዚአብሔርን ፈቃድ ካላደረጋችሁ የደከማችሁበትን ገንዘብ ይበላሉ።<sup>8</sup> ክፉ ሰዎች ልብሳቸውን ለውጠው ይመጣሉ አለ ከመብላት ከመጠጣት በብርና በወርቅም ከማጌጥ እግዚአብሔርም የማይወደውን ሥራ ሁሉ በኃጢአት ጽንቶ ከመኖር በቀር በነሳቸው ዘንድ ሌላ ሕግ የለም።<sup>9</sup> እነሳቸው ግን ወደ መጠጥና ወደ መብል ለመሄድ የተዘጋጁ ናቸው ከንቅልፋቸው ከተቀሰቀሱ በኋላ ከጧት ጀምሮ እስከ ማታ ወደ ክፉ ሥራ ይሄዳሉ በጎዳናቸው ጉስቁልና መከራ አለ እንጂ ለእግራቸው የፍቅር ጎዳና የለውም።

<sup>10</sup> የፍቅር አንድነት ሥራንም አያውቋትም በፊታቸውም እግዚአብሔርን መፍራት የለም ሃይማኖትና ምግባር የሌላቸው ጠማሞች ክፉዎች ናቸው ብቻቸውን የሚበሉ የሚጠጡ ስስታሞች ናቸው የሚሰክሩ ናቸው ኃጢአታቸውም ያለ ሕግ ያለ መጠን ነው ወደ መዳራት ደም ወደ ማፍሰስ ወደ ስርቆሽ ወደ መክዳትም በግፍ የሌላውንም ገንዘብ ወደ መቀማት የሚሄዱ ናቸው።<sup>11</sup> ያለ ፍርድና ያለ ሕግም የሚወቅሱ ናቸው የፈጠራቸው እግዚአብሔርን አይፈሩትምና በፊታቸውም ፍራት የለም።<sup>12</sup> በሚያዩት የሰውን ፊት

will not have pity on you will rise up against you, and they will eat up the money you have worked for, if you do not do the will of the LORD your God, as his servants the prophets have spoken, beginning with Samuel the prophet, and again as Ezekiel, Enoch, and Asaph have spoken.<sup>8</sup> Evil people come in disguise, and there is no other law that can prevent them from eating, and drinking, and adorning themselves with silver and gold, and from continuing to live in sin, and doing all the things that God does not like.<sup>9</sup> But they are ready to go to drink and eat and, after being awakened from their slumber, they go to evil deeds from morning until evening. There are misery and suffering in their path but there is no path of love for their feet.”

<sup>10</sup> They do not know the unity of love and the work of it, and there is no fear of God before them. They are wicked, without religion and morality, gluttons, drunkards, and their sins are without measure, without law, leading to adultery, to shedding blood, to stealing, to betraying, and to unjustly seizing other people’s property.<sup>11</sup> They are reprovers without judgement and without law; for, they do not fear the God who made them, and neither is there any fear before them.<sup>12</sup> They do not show any shame to the people they see, nor do

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<sup>8</sup> For ‘in disguise’, Selassie has ‘having changed their clothes’.  
<sup>9</sup> Selassie has ‘tribulation’ in place of ‘suffering’.  
<sup>10</sup> In place of ‘betraying’, Selassie has ‘perfidy’.  
<sup>11</sup> For ‘judgement’, Selassie has ‘Love’.  
<sup>12</sup> The referent of the pronoun ‘it’ in the last sentence (twice) is unclear.

አያፍሩም የሽበታም የሽማግሌ ፊትንም አያፍሩም በዚህ ዓለምም ገንዘብ አለ ሲሉ በስሙ ጊዜ ባይናቸው ሳያዩ የራሳቸው ገንዘብ ያደርጉታል በፊታቸው እግዚአብሔርን መፍራት የለምና ባይናቸው ባዩት ጊዜ ባፋቸውም የበሉት ይመስላቸዋል።

<sup>13</sup> መኳንንቶቻቸውም ያደራ ገንዘብ ይበላሉ የሚበሉ ናቸው እነሱ አሉተኞች ናቸውና ባንደበታቸውም የቀና ነገር የለምና ጧት የተናገሩትን ማታ አይደግሙትም። <sup>14</sup> የጦም አዳሪዎችን የድኖችን ጩኸት ቸል ይላሉና ስደተኞችንም ከሚቀሟቸው ከባለጠጎች እጅ አድኗቸው ሰውን የሚያውኩ ንጉሦቻቸው ለክፋት ይፋጠናሉ። <sup>15</sup> የተበደለውንና ስደተኛውን ያድኗቸው እንጂ ስለዚህ ነገር ነገሥታቱ ፍርድን የሚነፍጉ አይሁኑ። <sup>16</sup> እነሳቸው ግን ግብር የሚያስገብሩ ናቸው የሰው ገንዘብ የሚቀመጡ ናቸው ወንጀለኞችም ናቸው ሥራቸውም ክፉ ነውና እምቦሳዩቱ ከናቷ ጋራ ወፍን ከዕቁላሏ ጋራ ሲበሉ አይራሩም ያዩትን የሰሙትን ሁሉ የራሳቸው ገንዘብ ያደርጋሉ።

<sup>17</sup> እነሳቸው ለራሳቸው ይሰበስቡ ዘንድ ይወዳሉ እንጂ ለሕመምተኞችና ለድኖች አይራሩም በግፍ የሌላውንም ገንዘብ ይቀማሉ በቤታቸው ያደልቡ ዘንድ በሱም ደስ ይላቸው ዘንድ ያገኙትንም ሁሉ ይሰበስባሉ። <sup>18</sup> ከጉድጓዱ

they show any shame to the elder or to the white-haired man. They say that there is money in this world, but when they see it, they make it their own money. There is no fear of God before them, and when they see it with their eyes, they think that they have eaten it with their mouths.

<sup>13</sup> And their princes are the ones who eat and drink the money that was entrusted to them; they are negativists and they do not repeat at night what they say in the morning, because there is nothing straight in their tongues. <sup>14</sup> They ignore the cries of the hungry and the thirsty; and their kings fight for evil and destroy those who have saved the refugees from the hands of the rich who rob them. <sup>15</sup> Do not let the kings deny justice in this matter but deliver the oppressed and the exiled. <sup>16</sup> But they are tax collectors, they are thieves, and they are criminals, and their deeds are evil. They do not spare the calf with its mother and the bird with its egg. They make everything they see and hear their own money.

<sup>17</sup> They love to accumulate wealth for themselves but they have no compassion for the sick and the poor. They unjustly seize the wealth of others, and they hoard everything they find, so that they may be rich in their homes and enjoy it. <sup>18</sup> Woe to them when

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<sup>13</sup> The clause, 'they are negativists', follows Selassie.  
<sup>14</sup> The words, 'who rob them', are added following Selassie.  
<sup>15</sup> For 'the oppressed and the exiled', Selassie has 'the wronged and the refugee'.  
<sup>16</sup> Before 'calf', Selassie adds 'newborn'.  
<sup>17</sup> For 'rich', Selassie has 'fattened'.  
<sup>18</sup> The clause, 'like a scarab leaving its', loosely follows Selassie.

እንደ ወጣ ፍለጋውም እንደማይገኝ ወደ ቤቱም እንደማይመለስ አሽን ፈጥነው ይጠፋሉና በሕይወታቸውም ሳሉ በጎ ሥራን ስላልሠሩ እግዚአብሔር ተቈጥቶ በያዛቸው ጊዜ ለሰውነታቸው ወዮላት። <sup>19</sup> እግዚአብሔር ቸል ባላቸው ጊዜ ባንድ መቅሠፍት እንዳሉ እንደ ሆነ ይጠፋሉ ወደ ንስሐ ይመለሱ እንደ ሆነ ብሎ ይታገሣቸዋል እንጂ ፈጥኖ አያጠፋቸውምና በሚጠፉበትም ጊዜ ይጠፋሉ።

<sup>20</sup> ወደ ንስሐ ባይመለሱ ግን ከነሳቸው አስቀድሞ እንደ ነበሩ የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ በሚገባ እንዳልጠበቁ እንደ ቀድሞ ሰዎች ፈጥኖ ያጠፋቸዋል። <sup>21</sup> የሰው ሥጋ የሚበሉ የሰው ደም የሚጠጡ ናቸው ወደ ኃጢአት ለመሄድ ግፍን ይታጠቃሉና ይሠራሉና በፊታቸው ሁለጊዜ እግዚአብሔርን መፍራት የለም ከመኝታቸውም ከተነሡ በኋላ ኃጢአት ለመሥራት አያርፉም። <sup>22</sup> በዚህ ዓለም የብዙ ሰዎች ሰውነትን ያጠፉ ዘንድ ሥራቸውም መጠጥና መብል ወደ ጥፋትና ወደ ኃጢአት መሄድ ነው።

God is angry and takes them away; for, they will quickly perish, like a scarab leaving its pit, as if they were never found, and will never return to their homes. <sup>19</sup> When God neglects them, they will perish as if they were plagues in them; but, if they return to repentance, he will not destroy them quickly but will be patient with them. When they are destroyed, they will perish.

<sup>20</sup> But, if they do not repent, he will quickly destroy them, just as he did to the people who went before them, because they did not keep God's law properly. <sup>21</sup> They are those who eat human flesh and drink human blood. They are dressed to work violence and to commit sin. There is no fear of God before them at all times. They do not cease to sin after they rise from their sleep. <sup>22</sup> In this world, many people's bodies are destroyed, and their work leads them towards destruction and sin through food and drink.

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<sup>19</sup> Literally translated, the last sentence reads, “*When the perish they will perish.*”

<sup>20</sup> For ‘properly’, Selassie has ‘*by what are due*’.

<sup>21</sup> Selassie has ‘*beds*’ in place of ‘*sleep*’.

<sup>22</sup> The precise nuance of this verse is unclear.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፳፭

## 1 MEQABYAN 25

<sup>1</sup> ሥራቸው ጠማማ ነውና ሁሉም በሚያስት በሰይጣንም ሥራ ጸንተው የሚኖሩ ናቸውና ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር ተቈጥቼ በያዝኋት ጊዜ ለሰውነታችሁ ወዮላት አለ።  
<sup>2</sup> የእግዚአብሔርን ሥራ ግን አያውቁምና ወደ ኋላቸው መልሰውታልና ሕጌንም ቸል ብለዋልና። <sup>3</sup> እኔም ኋላ በፍጻሜ ዘመን እንደ ሥራቸው ክፋት መጠን ፍዳውን አመጣባቸዋለሁ ኃጢአታቸው በኔ ዘንድ እንደ ተጻፈ ፍርድ በሚፈረድበት ቀን ተበቅዬ አጠፋቸዋለሁ የምገድል የማድን በመከራ የምገርፍ ይቅር የምል እኔ እግዚአብሔር ነኝና ከሥልጣኔ አያመልጡምና። <sup>4</sup> እኔ እግዚአብሔር ከአድማስ እስከ አድማስ ምሉኑ ነኝና ፍጥረቱም ሁሉ በሥልጣኔ ተይዟልና በሰማይና በምድረ በጥልቅና በባሕርም ከሥልጣኔ የሚያመልጥ የለም።  
<sup>5</sup> በምድር በታች ያለ እባብን አዘዋለሁ በባሕርም ውስጥ ያለ ዓሣን አዘዋለሁ በሰማይ ያሉ ወፎችንም አዛቸዋለሁ በምድረ በዳ ያለ የበረሃ አህያውንም አዘዋለሁ ከአድማስ ጀምሮ እስከ አድማስ ድረስ የኔ ገንዘብ ነውና። <sup>6</sup> በፊቴ ድንቅ ሥራን የምሠራ ታመራትን የማደርግ እኔ ነኝና በምድርና በሰማይ ከሥልጣኔ የሚያመልጥ የለም ወዴት ትሄዳለህ ምንስ

<sup>1</sup> For, their works are perverse and they all stand firm in the work of Satan, who deceives. The Almighty God said, “Woe to your flesh,” when I was angry and seized it. <sup>2</sup> But they do not know the works of God; for, they have turned their backs on him and have neglected my law. <sup>3</sup> And I will bring upon them in the latter days according to the evil of their deeds; and I will rise up and destroy them in the day of judgment, according to the judgment written by me; for, I am the Lord, who kills, who saves, who smites with affliction, who forgives; and they shall not escape from my power. <sup>4</sup> For, I am the LORD from horizon to horizon, and all creation is held in my power. There is nothing in heaven or on earth or in the depths or in the sea that escapes my power.  
<sup>5</sup> I command the serpents under the earth, I command the fish in the sea, I command the birds in the sky, I command the wild donkeys in the desert; for, they are mine from the horizon to the horizon. <sup>6</sup> For, I am the One who does wondrous things before me, who does what is pleasing to me. There is no one in heaven or on earth who can escape my power. No one can say to me,

## 1 MEQABYAN 25

- <sup>1</sup> The title, ‘Almighty God’, translates እግዚአብሔር.
- <sup>2</sup> Note the confusion of pronouns (1P & 3P) in this verse.
- <sup>3</sup> Selassie lacks ‘and they shall not escape from my power’.
- <sup>4</sup> Here, ‘the LORD’ translates እግዚአብሔር.
- <sup>5</sup> For ‘wild donkeys in the desert’, Selassie has ‘desert donkey in the wilderness’.
- <sup>6</sup> For the 2<sup>nd</sup> question, Selassie reads, “How about what do thou Work?”



ትሠራለህ የሚለኝ የለም። <sup>7</sup> እኔም በመላእክት አለቆችና ሠራዊት ላይ አዛለሁ ስሙ የሚጠራው ሁሉ ፍጥረት የኔ ገንዘብ ነው በምድረ በዳ ያሉ አውሬዎችና በሰማይ ያሉ ወፎችም ሁሉ ከብቶችም የኔ ገንዘቦች ናቸው።

<sup>8</sup> ከአዜብ ነፋሰ ይነሣል በመስዕም ያለ ድርቅ ይጸናል ኋላ በፍፃሜ ዘመን ወደሷ የሚመጣ ከእገዚአብሔር መፈራት ገናንነትም የተነሣ የኤርትራ ባሕር ተሰምታ ትጠፋለች።

<sup>9</sup> በእሱ የሞቱትንና ያሉትን ሰዎች ይገዛልና ከሰባ እና ከኖቫ ከንዴኬና ከኢትዮጵያም ወስናቸውና አውራጃቸውም ጋራ ሁሉ ተሰምታ ትጠፋለች። <sup>10</sup> ከፍ ባለ ሥልጣንም በየዋህነት ሁሉን ይጠብቃል ከሥልጣኑ ሁሉ የሱ ሠልጣን ይበልጣልና በሥልጣኑም ምዕመናንን ይጠብቃል። <sup>11</sup> ሥልጣኑም ከሥልጣኑ ሁሉ ይጸናልና መንግሥቱም ከመንግሥቱ ሁሉ ይበልጣልና ሥልጣኑም ዓለሙን ሁሉ የሚገዛ ነውና ሁሉን ይችላልና የሚሳነውም የለምና። <sup>12</sup> በሰማይ ያሉ ደመናዎችን ሁሉ ይገዛል በምድር ላሉ ከብቶች ሣርን ያበቅላል በዝርዝሩም ላይ ፍሬን ይሰጣል።

<sup>13</sup> እንደ ወደደ ለሁሉ በየወገኑ ይመግባል በየፍሬው በየምግቡም የፈጠረውን ሁሉ ይመግባል ለገብረ ጉንዳንም በምድር በታች ላለ ለኩኩባንም በምድር ላይ ላሉ ከብቶችም

“Where are you going?” or “What are you doing?” <sup>7</sup> I command the chiefs of the angels and their hosts. Every creature that is called by name is mine. The beasts of the field and the birds of the air, and all the cattle, are mine.

<sup>8</sup> A wind will rise from the east and a drought will prevail in the desert. Later, in the end times, the fear of God will come to her, and the Eritrean Sea will disappear because of the greatness of her spirit. <sup>9</sup> He will rule over those who are dead and alive, and all their borders and districts, from Seba and Nova, from India and Ethiopia, will be destroyed. <sup>10</sup> He protects all with great authority and meekness. His authority is greater than all authority, and he protects the faithful with his authority. <sup>11</sup> For, his power is stronger than all power, and his kingdom is greater than all kingdoms, and his power rules over the whole world, and he is able to do all things, and nothing can be prevented.

<sup>12</sup> He rules over all the clouds in the sky, makes grass grow for the animals on the earth, and gives fruit on the trees.

<sup>13</sup> He feeds everyone according to his own kind and, with his own food, he feeds all that he has created. He feeds the ants and the locusts that are under the earth, the cattle that are on

<sup>7</sup> For ‘mine’ (twice in this verse), Selassie has ‘my money’.

<sup>8</sup> The ‘Eritrean Sea’ is almost certainly a reference to the Red Sea.

<sup>9</sup> The identity of many of the regions/countries listed here are uncertain.

<sup>10</sup> The multiple repetitions of ‘authority’ here is no doubt intended for emphasis.

<sup>11</sup> The multiple repetitions of ‘power’ here is no doubt intended for emphasis.

<sup>12</sup> Selassie has ‘buds’ in place of ‘trees’.

<sup>13</sup> The word translated ‘locusts’ (following Selassie) may have a more general sense than any specific type of insect.

ለአውሬዎችም ይመግባቸዋል ለጸለየ ሰውም ጸሎቱን ይሰጠዋል እናት አባቱ የሞቱበት ልጅንና ባለቴቶችንም ለምናቸውን ቸል አይልም። <sup>14</sup> የክፉ ሰዎች አመፃቸው እንደ ጥቅል ነፋስ የበደለኞች ጉባኤያቸውም እንደ ጉም ሽንት ነውና ይልቁንም በየጊዜው ወደሱ የሚለምኑ የንጹሐንን ልመና ይቀበላል። <sup>15</sup> ሰውነታቸውም እንደምትበር ወፍ ነውና የብርና የወርቅ የሚሆን የመልካቸውም ደም ግባት በዚህ ዓለም ጠፊ ነውና የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ የዘነጉ ሰዎች መመርመሪያቸው እንጂ ወርቃቸው አይጠቅማቸውም ልብሳቸውንም ብል ይበላዋል።

<sup>16</sup> የሰንዴውንና የገብሱንም ድልብ ፈጽሞ ነቀዝ ይበላዋል ሁሉም ትናንትና እንደለ ፈችቱ ቱ ቀን ያልፋል ካፍ የወጣ ቃልም እንዳይመለስ የኃጢአተኞች ሰዎች ገንዘብም እንደሱ ነው ያማረ አኗኗራቸውም እንደሚያልፍ ጥላ ነው የኃጢአተኞች ሰዎች ገንዘባቸው በእግዚአብሔር ፊት እንደ ውሰት ልብስ ነው። <sup>17</sup> ለድኃ እየራሩ ከብረዋልና የጦም አዳሪዎችንና እናት አባቱ የሞቱበት ልጅ ፍርድን ይሰማሉና ደጋግ ሰዎች ግን ቢከብሩ እግዚአብሔር ቸል አይላቸውም ከቤታቸው ልጆች ቸል ሳይሉ ለስደተኛው ለጦም አዳሪው ይሰጡ ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር ከሰጣቸው ልብስ ለተራቆቹ እያለበሱ ያከብረዋልና እግዚአብሔር አይላቸውም። <sup>18</sup> የታመኑ ሰዎችን ፈርድ አያደሉም የምንደኞችንም ደመወዝ

the earth, and the wild animals. He answers the prayer of the one who prays. He does not neglect the child whose father and mother are dead and the widows who are in need. <sup>14</sup> The rebellion of the wicked is like a whirlwind, and the assembly of the wicked is like the urine of the mist. But he hears the prayer of the innocent who call on him from time to time. <sup>15</sup> For, their bodies are like flying birds, and the beauty of their silver and gold is fleeting in this world. For those who forget the law of God, their gold will not profit them but their garments will be moth-eaten.

<sup>16</sup> The wheat and the barley shall be totally eaten up by weevils. All is as yesterday, and as a day that passed away, and the word that is spoken is not repeated. The wealth of the wicked is just like that, and their beauty is like a fleeting shadow. The wealth of the wicked is as a garment borrowed before God. <sup>17</sup> They are honoured when they show mercy to the poor, and they hear the judgment of the poor and the orphans; but, if the righteous are honoured, God will not neglect them. They will not neglect their children from their homes but will clothe the naked with the clothes that God has given them, so that they may give to the homeless and to the poor. <sup>18</sup> They do not judge the faithful, nor do they withhold the wages of the

<sup>14</sup> The meaning of the phrase, 'urine of the mist', is unclear.

<sup>15</sup> Selassie ends, "and moths shall eat their clothes."

<sup>16</sup> Another possible reading for 'by weevils' is 'with a gnawing sound'.

<sup>17</sup> Selassie ends with 'refugee' in place of 'poor'.

<sup>18</sup> In place of 'judge', Selassie has 'favour'.

አያሳድሩም የእግዚአብሔር ነገር አፋ ሁለት እንደ ሆነ ሰይፍ እውነት ነውና የከበረ ነውና በወራቶቻቸው ቁጥር በሚዛናቸው ልክ በደልን አያደርጉም።

wicked. For, the word of God is double-edged, and the sword is true and noble, and they do not do wrong according to the number of their months.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፳፮

<sup>1</sup> ድሆች ግን ዳግመኛ በመኝታቸው ያስባሉ ባለ ጠጎች ባይቀበሏቸው ግን ልምላሜ እንደሌለው እንደ ደረቅ እንጨት ይሆናሉ ርጥበትም ከሌለ ዘንድ ሥራ አይለመልምም ሥርም ከሌለ ቅጠሉ አይለመልምም። <sup>2</sup> ቅጠል ለፍሬ ጌጠ ለሚሆን አበበ ያገለግላልና ቅጠሉ ከካልለመለመ ፍሬ አያፈራም የሰው ፈጻሚው ሃይማኖት ነውና ሃይማኖት ለሌለው ሰሙ ምግባር የለውም። <sup>3</sup> ሃይማኖትን ካጸና ምግባርን ሠራ እግዚአብሔርም እውነትን የቀና ሥራን በሚሠራ ሰው ደስ ይለዋል። <sup>4</sup> ለለመነውም ሰው የልመናውን ያንደበቱንም ዋጋ ይሰጠዋል እውነተኛውንም ሰው ስለ ሠራው እውነተኛ ሥራው አይበድለውም። <sup>5</sup> እግዚአብሔር እውነተኛ ነውና እውነት ነገርን ወዷልና ኃጢአተኛውን ሰው ስለሠራው ሥራ ክፋት ያለ ንስሐ አያጸድቀውም ምድርና ሰማይን የሚገዛ ስለ ሆነ የሰውም ሁሉ ነፋስ በሥልጣኑ ተይዟልና በፍርድ ጊዜ ከድኃው ለባለጠጋው አያደላምና ያለ ንስሐ አያጸድቀውም።

## 1 MEQABYAN 26

<sup>1</sup> But the poor will think again in their sleep. But if the rich do not receive them, they will be like dry wood that has no green. Without moisture, work will not flourish; and without roots, the leaves will not flourish. <sup>2</sup> A leaf serves as a decoration for a flower that bears fruit; and if the leaf is not green, it will not bear fruit. The essence of a person is religion, and a person without religion has no morals. <sup>3</sup> If he establishes faith and practices morality, God will be pleased with the one who does the truth and does righteous deeds. <sup>4</sup> And he will give to the one who asks what he has asked for; and he will not wrong the honest man because of his honest deeds. <sup>5</sup> For, God is true, and loves truth, and will not justify the wicked without repentance in their deeds of wickedness. For, he is the Lord of heaven and earth, and the winds of all men are in his power, and he will not show partiality in judgment, between the poor and the rich.

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### 1 MEQABYAN 26

<sup>1</sup> In place of 'flourish', Selassie has 'be fertile'.

<sup>2</sup> Selassie has 'ornament' in place of 'decoration'.

<sup>3</sup> For 'faith', Selassie has 'religion'.

<sup>4</sup> For 'asks/asked', Selassie has 'begs/begged'.

<sup>5</sup> The words, 'without repentance', here follow Selassie.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፳፯

<sup>1</sup> ዓለሙን ሁሉ ካለ መኖር ወደ መኖር አምጥቶ ፈጠረ ኮረብቶችንና ተራሮችንም ፈጽሞ አዘጋጀ ምድርንም በውኃ ላይ አጸናት ባሕርም እንዳትነዋወጥ ባሸዋ ወሰናት እግዚአብሔር በመጀመሪያ ቃሉ ብርሃን ይፈጠር ብሏል።

<sup>2</sup> ይህ ዓለም በጨለማ ተሸፍኖ ሳለ ብርሃን ተፈጠረ እግዚአብሔር ፍጥረቱን ሁሉ ፈጠረ ይኸንንም ዓለም አዘጋጀ በሚገባም በሚቀናም ገንዘብ ይችን ዓለም አጸናት ምሺት ጨለማ ይሁን አለ። <sup>3</sup> ዳግመኛም እግዚአብሔር ብርሃን ይፈጠር አለ ነጋ ብርሃንም ሆነ የላይኛውንም ውኃ ወደ ሰማይ ከፍ ከፍ አደረገው።

<sup>4</sup> እንደ ድንኳንም ዘረጋው በነፋስም አጸናው የታችኛውንም ውኃ በጉድጓድ ውስጥ አኖረው። <sup>5</sup> የባሕሩንም ቁልፍ ባሸዋ ዘጋው በውኃውም እንዳይሰጥሙ በሥልጣኑ አጸናቸው እንስሳትንና አራዊትንም በውስጧ አኖራቸው ታላላቆች አውሬዎች የሆኑ ሌዋታንና ብሔሞትንም በውስጧ አኖራቸው ቁጥር የሌላቸው የሚታዩት የማይታዩት አውሬዎችንም በውስጡ አኖራቸው። <sup>6</sup> በሦስተኛው ቀን እግዚአብሔር በምድር ላይ አትክልትን ሥሩን ሁሉ እንጨቶችንም በየወገናቸው የሚያፈሩ ፍሮዎችንም ሊያዩት ያማረ የደኅንነት እንጨትንም ፈጠረ።

## 1 MEQABYAN 27

<sup>1</sup> He created the whole world from nothingness to existence, he established the hills and mountains, he established the earth upon the waters, he established the sea upon the firmament, that it should not be moved. For, in the first word, God said, “Let there be light.” <sup>2</sup> While this world was covered in darkness, light was created. God created all of his creation, prepared this world, and established this world with a well-earned wealth. He said, “Let there be darkness.” <sup>3</sup> And God said again, “Let there be light.” And God made the light and the waters above the firmament to rise up to the heavens.

<sup>4</sup> He spread it out like a tent, and he made it strong against the wind, and he put the lower waters in a pit. <sup>5</sup> And he shut the door of the sea with a rod; and, with his power, he kept them from drowning in the waters, and he placed in it the beasts and the wild beasts, and he placed in it the great beasts, the leviathan and the behemoth, and he placed within it all the beasts, both seen and unseen, without number. <sup>6</sup> On the third day, God created on the earth all kinds of plants, trees that produce fruit according to their kinds, and the tree of life that is pleasant to the eye.

## 1 MEQABYAN 27

<sup>1</sup> Selassie has ‘sand’ in place of ‘firmament’.

<sup>2</sup> For ‘Let there be darkness’, Selassie has ‘Make evening dark’.

<sup>3</sup> The account here differs somewhat from that of Gn 1.

<sup>4</sup> For ‘lower waters’, Selassie has ‘lower Water’.

<sup>5</sup> Selassie opens with, “And he locked the se shut in sand.”

<sup>6</sup> For ‘the tree of life’, Selassie has ‘welfare wood’.



<sup>7</sup> ሊያዩትም ያማረ ሊበሉትም የጣፈጠ የደኅንነት እንጨትንም ፈጠረ ሣርንም ዘሩ ከውስጡ የሚገኝ ተክልንም ሁሉ ለወፎችና ለከብቶች ላውሬዎችም መብል ሊሆን ፈጠረ ለፈጠረውም ሁሉ ምግብን ሰጠ። <sup>8</sup> መሸ ነጋ ባራተኛዩቱም ቀን ጠፈር በሚባል ሰማይ ብርሃን የፈጠር አለ እግዚአብሔር ጨረቃና ፀሐይን ከዋክብትንም ፈጥሮ በዚህ ዓለም ያበሩ ዘንድ መዓልትና ሌሊትንም ይመግቧቸው ዘንድ ጠፈር በሚባል ሰማይ አኖራቸው። <sup>9</sup> ከዚህ በኋላ ጨረቃና ፀሐይ ከዋክብትም በሌሊትና በመዓልትም ተፈራረቁ። <sup>10</sup> ባምስተኛዩቱም ቀን እግዚአብሔር በውኃ ውስጥ የሚኖሩ እንስሳና አውሬዎችን ሁሉ በሰማይ ላይ የሚበሩ ወፎችንም ሁሉ የሚታየውንና የማይታየውን ሁሉ ይኸንን ሁሉ ፈጠረ። <sup>11</sup> በስድስተኛዩቱም ቀን ከብቶችንና አውሬዎችን ሌሎችንም ፈጠረ ሁሉንም ፈጥሮ አዘጋጅቶ አዳምን በምሳሌውና በመልኩ ፈጠረው። <sup>12</sup> የፈጠራቸው እንስሳትና አውሬዎችን ሁሉ ይነግሥባቸው ዘንድ ሰጠው ዳግመኛም እንስሳትንና አራዊትን ሁሉ ዓሣዎችንም ሁሉ በባሕር ያሉ ሌዋታንና ብሔሞትንም። <sup>13</sup> በዚህ ዓለም የሚኖሩ ላሞችን ሁሉና በጎችንም የማይታየውንና የሚታየውን እንስሳ ሰጠው።

<sup>7</sup> He created the tree of life, beautiful to look at and delicious to eat, and the grass with its seed and every plant in it, for food for the birds and the cattle and the wild animals. He gave food to all that he had created. <sup>8</sup> And on the fourth day, God created the sun, and the moon, and the stars, and placed them in the firmament, so that they might give light to the world and to govern the day and the night. <sup>9</sup> After this, the moon, and the sun, and the stars alternated between the night and the daylight. <sup>10</sup> On the fifth day, God created all living creatures that move in the water, all the, and all the birds that fly in the sky, and every kind of beast, both visible and invisible creatures. <sup>11</sup> On the sixth day, he created cattle, wild animals, and other creatures. He created and prepared all of them, and he created Adam in his own image and likeness. <sup>12</sup> He gave him dominion over all the animals and wild beasts he had created, and over all the cattle and wild animals, and over all the fish in the sea, even Leviathan and Behemoth. <sup>13</sup> He gave him all the cows and sheep that live in this world – all animals, invisible and visible. <sup>14</sup> And

<sup>7</sup> For ‘the tree of life’, Selassie has ‘welfare wood’.

<sup>8</sup> At the start of this verse, Selassie adds, “It dusked ~ it dawned.”

<sup>9</sup> See #3.

<sup>10</sup> The Amharic text (probably) transposes the words translated ‘birds’ and ‘beast’.

<sup>11</sup> For ‘image’ and ‘likeness’, Selassie has ‘Example’ and ‘Appearance’, respectively.

<sup>12</sup> For ‘Leviathan’ and ‘Behemoth’ (ሌዋታንና ብሔሞትንም), Selassie has ‘Liewatan’ an ‘Biehiemot’.

<sup>13</sup> For ‘(in)visible’, Selassie has ‘(not) sight up’.

<sup>14</sup> See #11.

<sup>14</sup> በምሳሌውና በመልኩ የፈጠረው አዳምንም በገነት አኖረው ይበላ ዘንድ ተክልንም ይኩተኩታት ዘንድ በዚም እግዚአብሔርን ያመሰግነው ዘንድ።

<sup>15</sup> ትእዛዙንም እንዳያፈርስ ከዚህ ከዕፅ በለስ በበላችሁበት ጊዜ ሞትን ትሞታላችሁ ብሏል። <sup>16</sup> ሞትን ከሚያመጣ ክፉና በጎን ልብ ከሚያስደርግ ሞትን ከሚያመጣ ከዕፅ በለስም እንዳይበላ አዘዘው። <sup>17</sup> እናታችን ሔዋን በእባብ ማሳት ተሽንግላ ከዚያ ከዕፅ በለስ በለታ ላባታችን ለአዳም ሰጠችው።

<sup>18</sup> አዳምም ከዚያ ከዕፅ በለስ በልቶ በልጆቹና በራሱ ሞትን አመጣ። <sup>19</sup> ትእዛዙን አፍርሷልና እግዚአብሔር ከርሷ አትብላ ብሎ ካዘዘው ከዚያም ከዕፅ በለስ በልቷልና እግዚአብሔር በአባታችን በአዳም ተቈጣ ከገነትም አስወጥቶ ሰደደው ያርሳት ዘንድ ጽሮ ግሮም የድካሙን ዋጋ ይበላ ዘንድ ትእዛዙን በፈረስ ጊዜ ስለሱ ረገማት አሜከላና እሾህን የምታበቅል ያችንም ምድር ሰጠው። <sup>20</sup> እግዚአብሔርም ወደዚህ ምድር ባወጣው ጊዜ አዳም ወደ ፍጹም ኃዘን ተመለሰ ምድርንም ያርሳት ዘንድ ጽሮ ግሮም በድካምና በትዕግልትም ይበላ ጀመር።

he created Adam in his own image and likeness, and placed him in the garden, that he might eat of the fruit of the field, and dress it, and thereby praise God.

<sup>15</sup> For, he said, “When you eat figs from this tree, you will surely die.” <sup>16</sup> He commanded him not to eat the fruit that brings death, that gives understanding between evil and good, and the fig that brings death. <sup>17</sup> Our mother Eve was deceived by a serpent and then gave a fig from the fig tree to our father Adam. <sup>18</sup> Then Adam ate from the forbidden tree and brought death upon himself and upon his children. <sup>19</sup> Because he broke the commandment, God was angry with our father Adam and he expelled him from the Garden of Eden and sent him to till the earth; and he ate figs from it, so he cursed the ground for him, which produced thorns and thistles, so that he would eat the fruit of his labour. <sup>20</sup> And it came to pass, when the LORD brought him forth into this land, that Adam returned to utter sorrow, and began to plough the earth, and to eat with fatigue and endurance.

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<sup>15</sup> For ‘figs from this tree’, Selassie has ‘Herb of Fig’.

<sup>16</sup> There is possibly a lacuna in the text, here, as the Tree of Knowledge is not named or introduced in any way.

<sup>17</sup> Other readings for ‘deceived’ are ‘cajoled’ (as Selassie) and ‘seduced’.

<sup>18</sup> For ‘the forbidden tree’, Selassie has ‘that Herb of Fig’.

<sup>19</sup> The order of clauses in the Amharic text is clumsy and this is reflected in the translation.

<sup>20</sup> For ‘fatigue and endurance’, Selassie has ‘weariness and struggles’.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፳፰

## 1 MEQABYAN 28

<sup>1</sup> ልጆቹም በዝተው ከኖሩ በኋላ ከነርሳቸው እግዚአብሔርን የሚያመሰግኑት የሚያከብሩት ትእዛዙንም የማያፈርሱ ነበሩ።

<sup>2</sup> የተደረገውን እንግዲህም የሚደረገውን የሚናገሩ ነቢያት ነበሩ ከልጆቹም ሐሰት የሚናገሩ ሰውንም የሚበድሉ ኃጢአተኞች ነበሩ የአዳም የበክር ልጁ ቃያል ክፉ ሆነ ወንድሙ አቤልንም ገደለው። <sup>3</sup> ወንድሙን አቤልን ስለ ገደለ እግዚአብሔር በቃየል ፍርድን ፈረደ ደሙንም ስለ ጠጣች እግዚአብሔር ምድርን ተቈጣት። <sup>4</sup> እግዚአብሔርም ቃየልን ወንድምህ አቤል ወዴት አለ አለው ቃያልም በልቡ ትዕቢት የወንድሜ የአቤል ጠባቂ እኔ ነኝን አለ።

<sup>5</sup> አቤል ንጹሕ ሰውን ሆነ ቃየል ግን ደግ ሰው ወንድሙ አቤልን በመግደል ኃጢአተኛን ሆነ። <sup>6</sup> ዳግመኛ ደግ ልጅ ሴት ተወለደ አዳም ስድሳ ልጆችን ወለደ ከነሳቸው ደጋጎች ሰዎች ክፉዎች ሰዎች አሉ። <sup>7</sup> ከነሳቸውም ደጋጎች ሰዎች አሉ ነቢያት የሆኑ ከዳተኞችና ኃጢአተኞች የሆኑ ሰዎችም አሉ። <sup>8</sup> ደጋግ ሰዎች የሆኑ የአባታቸው የአዳምን ፈቃድ ከአዳም ጀምሮ የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ እስከ ጠበቀ ደግ ሰው

<sup>1</sup> And, after his children had multiplied, there were among them those who praised and honoured God and did not break his commandments. <sup>2</sup> There were prophets who told what had happened and what would happen, and there were sinners among their children who told lies and wronged people. Adam's firstborn son, Cain, became wicked and killed his brother Abel. <sup>3</sup> God judged Cain because he killed his brother Abel, and God was angry with the earth because it drank his blood. <sup>4</sup> And the LORD said to Cain, "Where is your brother Abel?" And Cain thought proudly in his heart, "Am I my brother Abel's keeper?"

<sup>5</sup> Abel became a righteous man, but Cain became a sinner by killing his good brother Abel. <sup>6</sup> Again, a good son, Seth, was born. Adam gave birth to sixty children. Among the good people he raised, there were some bad people. <sup>7</sup> Among those who have risen, there are good people who are prophets, and there are also people who are traitors and sinners. <sup>8</sup> There are righteous people who do the will of their father, Adam, and who do everything he

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<sup>1</sup> In place of 'break', Selassie has 'demolish'.

<sup>2</sup> For 'Cain' and 'Abel', Selassie has, respectively, 'Qayel' and 'Abiel'.

<sup>3</sup> Cf. Gn 4:11.

<sup>4</sup> Here, 'and the LORD' translates እግዚአብሔርም.

<sup>5</sup> For 'righteous', Selassie has 'clean'.

<sup>6</sup> For 'Seth', Selassie reads 'Seit'.

<sup>7</sup> Selassie has 'kind' in place of 'good'.

<sup>8</sup> The correct arrangement of clauses in the English translation here is uncertain.

እስከሚሆን እስከ ኖሳ ድረስ ለልጁ ለሴት የነገረውንም ሁሉ የሚፈጽሙ የተመረቁ ሰዎች አሉ።

<sup>9</sup> እሱም ለልጆቹ የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ አስጠበቃቸው የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ እንዳያፈርሱ አባታቸው ኖሳ እንደ ነገራቸው እነሳቸውም ለልጆቻቸው ይነግሩ ዘንድ የእግዚአብሔርንም ሕግ ይጠብቁ ዘንድ ጠብቁ አላቸው።

<sup>10</sup> እነሳቸውም ከነሳቸው በኋላ ለተወለዱ ሰዎች ለልጆቻቸው እያስተማሯቸው ኖሩ። <sup>11</sup> ሰይጣን ግን አባቶቻቸውን ለመቃብር በደረሱ ሥዕል ባለባቸው ጣዖታት አድሮ እሺ የሚሉትን ሰዎች ድል ነሥቶ ሲናገራቸው ኖረ እነሳቸውም የኃጢአት መምር የሚሆን ዲያብሎስ ያዘዛቸውን ሁሉ ሲያደርጉ።

<sup>12</sup> የእግዚአብሔርን ፈቃድ የሚፈጽም ደግ ሰው አብርሃም እስኪነሣ ድረስ እንደ ሥርዓታቸው ጣዖታቱንም ሲያመልኩ ኖሩ። <sup>13</sup> ከዘመዶቹ ተለይቶ አስቀድሞ በሕጉ ጸንቶ ኖሯልና እግዚአብሔርም በነፋስና በእሳት አድሮ ከርሱ ጋራ መሐላን ተማማለ። <sup>14</sup> ለሱ ምድረ ርስትን ይሰጠው ዘንድ ለልጆቹም እስከ ዘለዓለሙ ድረስ ይሰጣቸው ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር ማለለት። <sup>15</sup> ያባቱ የአብርሃምና ርስት ይሰጠው ዘንድ ለይስሐቅም እንደሱ ማለለት ያባቱ የይስሐቅን ርስት ይሰጠው

told his son Seth; from Adam to Noah, who became a righteous man who kept God's law.

<sup>9</sup> And he kept the law of the LORD unto his sons, that they might not transgress the law of the LORD, as their father Noah had commanded them, and that they might tell their children, and that they might keep the law of the LORD, so that they might not transgress the law of the LORD. <sup>10</sup> And they lived and taught them to their children, who were born after them. <sup>11</sup> But Satan continued to win over those who were willing to accept idols, with images of their fathers in their graves, and they continued to do whatever the devil, who was the teacher of sin, commanded.

<sup>12</sup> And they continued to worship their idols according to their traditions until Abraham, a righteous man who did God's will, arose. <sup>13</sup> Because he had previously remained steadfast in the law, separated from his relatives, God swore an oath to him by wind and fire. <sup>14</sup> God swore to him that he would give him the land as an inheritance and to his children forever. <sup>15</sup> He swore to Isaac, to give him the inheritance of his father Abraham, and to Jacob, like he swore to Isaac, to

<sup>9</sup> Thrice in this verse, 'the LORD' translates እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>10</sup> Another possible reading for 'who were born after them' is 'after they were born'.

<sup>11</sup> In place of 'the devil', Selassie repeats 'Satan'.

<sup>12</sup> Selassie has 'kind' in place of 'righteous'.

<sup>13</sup> The swearing of an oath 'by wind and fire' appears to be unique to this book.

<sup>14</sup> In place of 'forever', Selassie has 'until Eternity'.

<sup>15</sup> For 'Isaac', Selassie reads 'Yis'haq'.

ዘንድ ለያዕቆብም ማለለት እንደ ይስሐቅ ማለለት።

<sup>16</sup> ከነሳቸውም በኋላ ከያዕቆብ የተወለዱ ልጆቻቸውን ከሥራ ሁለቱ ነገደ እስራኤል ለይቶ ካህናትንና ነገሥታትን አደረጋቸው ብዙ ፈጽማችሁም የብዙ ብዙ ሁኑ ብሎ መረቃቸው።

<sup>17</sup> የአባቶቻቸውንም ርስት ሰጣቸው ነገር ግን እየመገባቸው እየወደዳቸው እግዚአብሔርን ማሳዘን በሁሉም አልተውም።

<sup>18</sup> ባጠፋቸውም ጊዜ ያን ጊዜ በአምልኮ ይፈልጉታል ከኃጢአትም ተመልሰው ወደ እግዚአብሔር ይሄዳሉ ይወዳቸዋልና እግዚአብሔርም ይቅር ይላቸዋል።

<sup>19</sup> የፈጠረውን ሁሉ ራርቶ ይቅር ይላልና የሚወዳቸውም ስለ አባቶቻቸው ሥራ ነው እንጂ ስለ ራሳቸው ሥራ አይደለም።

<sup>20</sup> የተራበች ሰውነትን ያጠግብ ዘንድ በበረከትም ቀኝ እጁን ይዘረጋል ለምግብ እህልን ያበዛ ዘንድ ይቅር ለማለትም ዓይኑን ይገልጣል።

<sup>21</sup> ለቈራዎች ጫጩቶች ለሚለምኑት ለአውሬዎችም ምግብ ይሰጣቸዋል ወደርሱ በጮሁ ጊዜ የእስራኤል ልጆች ከጊዜው ከዘገዩት ጠላቶቻቸው እጅ ያድናቸዋል። <sup>22</sup> ያሳዝኑት ዘንድ ዳግመኛም ወደ ኃጢአት ይመለሳሉ እርሱም በዙሪያቸው ያሉ ጠላቶቻቸውን አሕዛብን ያስነሣባቸዋል ያጠፏቸዋል

give him the inheritance of his father Isaac. <sup>16</sup> After he had raised them up, he separated their children, who were born of Jacob, from the two tribes of Israel, and made them priests and kings. He blessed them, saying, “Be fruitful and multiply, and become many.”

<sup>17</sup> He gave them the inheritance of their fathers, however, while he fed them and loved them, they did not stop grieving God in many ways. <sup>18</sup> And, when he destroys them, then they will seek him with worship, and they will turn from their sins and come to God, and God will forgive them, because he loves them. <sup>19</sup> He loves and forgives all that he has created, and he loves them not because of their own deeds but because of the deeds of their fathers. <sup>20</sup> He stretches out his right hand with blessing to satisfy the hungry, and opens his eyes to forgive, to increase the grain for food.

<sup>21</sup> He gives food to the young ravens and to the wild animals that beg for food. When they cry to him, he saves the children of Israel from the hand of their enemies who are late in coming. <sup>22</sup> They will turn back to sin to grieve him and he will raise up against them their enemies, the nations around them, to destroy them,

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<sup>16</sup> More literally translated, this verse ends, “Be abundant totally be many, many.”

<sup>17</sup> For ‘in many ways’, Selassie has ‘in all’.

<sup>18</sup> Selassie has ‘pardon’ in place of ‘forgive’.

<sup>19</sup> In place of ‘deeds’ (twice in this verse), Selassie has ‘Work’.

<sup>20</sup> For ‘opens his eyes’, Selassie has ‘reveal his eye’.

<sup>21</sup> For ‘young ravens’, Selassie has ‘crows’ chicks’.

<sup>22</sup> In place of ‘grieve’, Selassie has ‘sadden’.



ይገድሏቸዋል ይማርኳቸዋል። <sup>23</sup> ዳግመኛም በልቅሶና በኃዘን ወደ እግዚአብሔር ይጮኻሉ እሱም ረዳትን ልኮ በነቢያት እጅ እነሳቸውን ያዳነበት ጊዜ አለ። <sup>24</sup> በመሳፍንትም እጅ ያዳነበት ጊዜ አለ እግዚአብሔርም ባሳዘኑት ጊዜ ጠላቶቻቸው አስገብሯቸው ማርኳቸው። <sup>25</sup> ዳዊትም ተነሥቶ ከኢሎፍላውያን እጅ አዳናቸው ዳግመኛም እግዚአብሔርን አሳዘኑት እግዚአብሔርም የሚያስጨንቋቸው አሕዛብን አስነሣባቸው። <sup>26</sup> በዮፍታሔም እጅ እነሳቸውን ያዳነበት ጊዜ አለ ዳግመኛም በመከራቸው ጊዜ ያዳናቸው እግዚአብሔርን ዘነጉት። እግዚአብሔር ፍዳውን አምጥቶባቸዋልና ክፉ የሆኑ መከራ የሚያጸኑባቸውን ፈጽመውም የሚማርኳቸው ጠላቶችን ያስነሣባቸዋል። <sup>27</sup> በመከራ በተጨነቁ ጊዜ ተይዘውም ዳግመኛ ወደሱ ጮሁ እሱም በጌዴዎን እጅ አዳናቸው ዳግመኛም በእጃቸው ሥራ እግዚአብሔርን አሳዘኑት። <sup>28</sup> እሱም ዳግመኛ መከራ የሚያጸኑባቸውን አሕዛብ አስነሣባቸው ተመልሰውም ወደ እግዚአብሔር አለቀሱ ጮሁ። <sup>29</sup> ዳግመኛም በሶምሶን እጅ ከአሕዛብ አዳናቸው ከመከራውም ጥቂት አረፉ። በቀደመውም ኃጢአታቸው እግዚአብሔርን ያሳዘኑት ዘንድ ተነሡ። <sup>30</sup> እሱም ዳግመኛ የሚያስጨንቋቸው ሌሎች አሕዛብን

kill them, and take them captive. <sup>23</sup> And again, they cry out to God with weeping and mourning, and he sends help and saves them by the hand of prophets. <sup>24</sup> There was a time when he delivered them by the hand of judges; and when they grieved God them, their enemies took them captive. <sup>25</sup> And David arose and delivered them out of the hand of the Philistines; and they angered the LORD again and the LORD raised up against them nations to afflict them. <sup>26</sup> There was a time when God saved them by the hand of Jephthah, but again they forgot God, who had saved them in the time of their distress. Just as God brought them their reward, he will raise up enemies against them who will inflict evil on them and completely subdue them. <sup>27</sup> When they were oppressed by affliction and were taken captive, they cried out to him again, and he delivered them by the hand of Gideon. And they again provoked the Lord to anger with the work of their hands. <sup>28</sup> He again raised up nations to afflict them and they returned and cried out to God. <sup>29</sup> And again, he delivered them from the heathen by the hand of Samson, and they were relieved of their affliction for a while. And they rose up to grieve God with their former sins. <sup>30</sup> He again stirred up

<sup>23</sup> The tenses of the verbs in this verse, here translates as present, could also be taken as a combination of future and past.

<sup>24</sup> The author here takes the Judges to be forerunners of the prophets rather than of the later kings.

<sup>25</sup> For ‘Philistines’, Selassie reads ‘Iloflans’.

<sup>26</sup> On ‘Jephthah’, see Jg 11.

<sup>27</sup> On ‘Gideon’, see Jg 6–8.

<sup>28</sup> The words of this verse are almost a ‘refrain’ in this section of the book.

<sup>29</sup> On ‘Samson’, see Jg 16.

<sup>30</sup> On ‘Barak and Deborah’, see Jg 4:1–5:31.

አስነሣባቸው ዳግመኛም ረዳትን ይስድላቸው ዘንድ ወደ እግዚአብሔር ጮሁ አለቀሱ በባርቅና በዲቦራም እጅ ከአሕዛብ አዳናቸው።

<sup>31</sup> ዳግመኛ እግዚአብሔርን እያመለኩት ጥቂት ወራት ኖሩ ዳግመኛም በቀደመው ኃጢአታቸው እግዚአብሔርን ዘነጉት አሳዘኑት። <sup>32</sup> እሱም የሚያስጨንቋቸው ሌሎች አሕዛብን አስነሣባቸው ዳግመኛም በዮዲት እጅ አዳናቸው ዳግመኛም ጥቂት ወራት ተቀምጠው አንደ ቀደመው እግዚአብሔርን በኃጢአታቸው ያሳዘኑት ዘንድ ተነሡ። <sup>33</sup> እሱም የሚገዟቸው አሕዛብን አስነሣባቸው እነሳቸውም ወደ እግዚአብሔር ጮሁ አለቀሱ የይሁዳን አገር ይወጋ ዘንድ የመጣ አርበኛ የሆነ አቤሜሌክን ራሱን መትቶታልና።

<sup>34</sup> በዙሪያው ባሉ በልጆቹና በማታትዩም እጅ አዳናቸው ያም አርበኛ በሞተ ጊዜ ሠራዊቱ ሸሹ ተበተኑ የእስራኤልም ልጆች እስከ ኢያቦቅ ድረስ ተከትለው ወጓቸው ከነሳቸውም አንድ ሰውን ስንኳ አላስቀሩም።

<sup>35</sup> ከዚህ በኋላ ጥቂት ቈይተው እግዚአብሔርን ያሳዘኑት ዘንድ ተነሡ እሱም የሚገዟቸው አሕዛብን አስነሣባቸው ዳግመኛም ፈጽመው ወደ እግዚአብሔር ጮሁ እግዚአብሔርን ሁለጊዜ አሳዘነውታልና ሕጉንም አፍርሰዋልና እግዚአብሔርም ጩኸታቸውንና ልቅሷቸውን ቸል አለ። <sup>36</sup> ማርከበውም ከካህናቶቻቸው ጋራ ወደባቢሎን

other nations to oppress them, and again they cried out to God for help, and he delivered them from the nations by the hand of Barak and Deborah.

<sup>31</sup> They lived for a few months again, worshipping God, but again they forgot God and grieved him with their previous sins. <sup>32</sup> He raised up other nations against them, who were troubling them, and again he rescued them by the hand of Judith. After they had sat down for a few months, they rose up again, as before, to grieve God with their sins. <sup>33</sup> He stirred up the nations that were under his dominion, and they cried out to God, saying, “He has struck down Abimelech, a warrior who came to invade Judah.” <sup>34</sup> He saved them by the hands of his sons and Mattathias, who were around him. When that warrior died, his army fled and was scattered. The Israelites pursued them as far as the Jabbok and struck them down, leaving not a single man alive.

<sup>35</sup> After a while, they rose up to provoke the LORD to anger, and he stirred up the nations that were around them to rule over them. And they cried out again and again to the LORD, because they had provoked the LORD to anger continually and had broken his law. And the LORD turned away from their cry and their mourning. <sup>36</sup> And they took them captive,

<sup>31</sup> The chronology of vv. 31–32 is not congruent with either the Book of Judges or the Book of Judith.

<sup>32</sup> Note that the Book of Judith is included in the Canon of the Ethiopic Orthodox Tewahedo Church.

<sup>33</sup> The name, ‘Abimelech’, could be applied to a number of characters in the Bible.

<sup>34</sup> The only ‘Mattathias’ mentioned in the Bible lived during the Maccabean Period – which fits with the title of this book but not in this context.

<sup>35</sup> Throughout this verse, ‘the LORD’ translates እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>36</sup> The narrative now jumps to Nebuchadnezzar’s conquest of Israel and Judah, and the start of the Babylonian Exile.

ሰዎች አገር ወሰዷቸው።<sup>37</sup> ከዚያም ኃጢአትን እየሠሩ ጣዖትንም እያመለከቱ ከዳተኞች የሆኑ የእስራኤል ልጆች እግዚአብሔርን ማሳዘን አልተውም።<sup>38</sup> እግዚአብሔር በዚያ በኃጢአታቸው አንድ ጊዜ ያጠፋቸው ዘንድ ተቈጣ ሐማ በንጉሡ ሣጥን እልፍ ወርቅን አግብቶ በታወቀባት ቀን ያጠፋቸው ዘንድ በነገረው ጊዜ ከሕንደኬ ጀምሮ እስከ ኢትዮጵያም ድረስ በፋርስ አገር ልጆቻቸውን እንዳያስቀር በንጉሡ በአርጤክስስ ልቡና ቁጣን አሳደረ።<sup>39</sup> እንዲህ አደረገ በንጉሡም ሥልጣን መልክት የተጻፈበትን ደብዳቤ ጻፈ ወደፋርስም አገር ያደርስ ዘንድ በእጁ ያለ ማኅተምን ሰጠው።

<sup>40</sup> ንጉሥ እንዳዘዘ ሊያጠፏቸው በወደደባት ባንዲት ቀን ያጠፋቸው ዘንድ ማኅተምን ሰጠው ገንዘባቸው ወርቁን ብሩን ግን ወደ ንጉሡ ሣጥን ያገቡ ዘንድ አዘዘ።<sup>41</sup> የእስራኤልም ልጆች ይህንን ነገር በሰሙ ጊዜ ወደ እግዚአብሔር ፈጽመው ጮሁ አለቀሱ ለመርዶክዮስም ነገሩት መርዶክዮስም ለአስቴር ነገራት።<sup>42</sup> አስቴርም ጹሙ ለምኑ የእስራኤል ልጆች ወገኖችም ሁሉ ባላችሁበት ቦታ ወደ እግዚአብሔር ጩሁ አለች።<sup>43</sup> መርዶክዮስም ማቅ ለበሰ በራሱም ትቢያን ነሰነሰ የእስራኤልም ልጆች ባለበት አገር ጸሙ ለመኑ ንስሐ ገቡ።

along with their priests, to the land of the Babylonians.<sup>37</sup> Then the treacherous children of Israel continued to offend God by committing sins and worshiping idols.<sup>38</sup> God was angry with them for their sin, and, when Haman had taken a thousand talents of gold from the king’s treasury and told him to destroy them on the day it was announced, he stirred up the anger of King Ahasuerus, so that he would not let any of their children remain in the land of Persia, from India to Ethiopia.<sup>39</sup> He did so and wrote a letter with the king’s authority and gave it to him with a seal in his hand, to be sent to Persia.

<sup>40</sup> He gave him a seal to destroy them on a day when the king wanted to destroy them, as he had ordered. But he ordered the money, the gold and silver, to be put in the king’s treasury.<sup>41</sup> When the sons of Israel heard this, they cried out to God and wept. They told Mordecai, and Mordecai told Esther.<sup>42</sup> And Esther said, “Fast and supplicate, and cry to the LORD, all you tribes of the sons of Israel, in all your places.”<sup>43</sup> And Mordecai put on sackcloth and dust on his head, and the sons of Israel fasted and prayed and repented in the land where they were.

<sup>37</sup> Selassie has ‘sadden’ in place of ‘offend’.

<sup>38</sup> The author here seems to conflate stories from the Maccabean Period with those from the time of Exile.

<sup>39</sup> For ‘Persia’, Selassie here has ‘the Fars country’.

<sup>40</sup> The translation and meaning of this verse are unclear.

<sup>41</sup> The narrative now shifts to the Book of Esther.

<sup>42</sup> Note that God (or ‘the LORD’) is not mentioned in the (Hebrew) Book of Esther.

<sup>43</sup> For ‘Mordecai’, Selassie reads ‘Merdokyos’.

<sup>44</sup> አስቴርም ፈጽማ አዘነች ንግሥትም ሁናማቅ ለበሰች ትቢያን ነሰነሰች ራሷንም ተላጮች የፋርስም ነግሥታት ሽቱን እንዲቀቡ ሽቱን አልተቀባችም በጥልቅ ልቡናዋም ወደ አባቶቿም ፈጣሪ ወደ እግዚአብሔር <sup>45</sup> ጮኸች አለቀሰች ስለዚህ ነገር በፋርስ ንጉስ በአርክስስ ዘንድ መወደድን ሰጣት ለአባቶችዋም ፈጣሪ ደግ ምሳን አደረገች። <sup>46</sup> ሐማና ንጉሡም አስቴር ወደ አዘጋጆችው ምሳ ገቡ በመርዶክዮስም ያደርግ ዘንድ እንደወደደ እግዚአብሔር በዚያ ሐማን ፍዳውን ከፈለው በረጅም እንጨት ላይም ሰቀሉት።

<sup>47</sup> በፈቃዳቸው ሁሉ እንዳሉ እስራኤልን ይተዋቸው ዘንድ እንዳያስገብሯቸውም እንዳይቀጧቸውም እንዳይበድሏቸውም ገንዘባቸውንም እንዳይወስዱባቸው የንጉሡ ደብዳቤ ታዘዘ።

<sup>48</sup> ንስሐ ገብተው በጮሁ ጊዜ እግዚአብሔር እንዲህ አድርጎ እስራኤልን ይቅር ይላቸዋልና በኖሩበት በፋርስ አገር ይወዷቸው ያከብሩዋቸው ዘንድ ነው እንጂ አገራቸውን እንዳያጠፉ ከብቶቻቸውንም እንዲይዘርፉ የንጉሥ ደብዳቤ ታዘዘ። <sup>49</sup> ባሳዘኑትም ጊዜ የሚያስጨንቋቸው አሕዛብን ያስነሣባቸው ረዳታቸውን ይሰድላቸው ዘንድ መከራ ከሚያጸኑባቸው ከአሕዛብም እጅ ያድናቸው ዘንድ የዚያን ጊዜ ፈጽመው ያለቅሳሉ ይጮኻሉ።

<sup>44</sup> And Queen Esther was greatly grieved, and put on sackcloth, and put on dust, and shaved her head, and anointed herself not with perfume, as Persia queens anoint themselves with perfume; and she cried with all her heart to God, the Creator of her fathers, and wept. <sup>45</sup> And, for this, she found favour with Ahasuerus king of Persia and made a feast to the Creator of her fathers. <sup>46</sup> So, Haman and Queen Esther went to the banquet that Esther had prepared. And there God punished Haman, and they hanged him on the gallows, just as he had planned to do to Mordecai.

<sup>47</sup> The king's letter was given to them, so that they would not force them to leave Israel, nor oppress them, nor wrong them, nor take their money, as they would have wanted.

<sup>48</sup> When they repented and cried out, God forgave Israel, so that they would be loved and honoured in the land of Persia where they lived, and the king's letter was issued to them not to destroy their country or plunder their livestock. <sup>49</sup> And, when they are afflicted, they will cry out with a loud voice, that he may send them help from the nations that oppress them, and that he may save them from the hand of the nations that afflict them.

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<sup>44</sup> Cf. the Greek addition to Esther (Est 4:17k).

<sup>45</sup> For 'Ahasuerus', Selassie has 'Arthieksis'.

<sup>46</sup> Cf. Est 7:10.

<sup>47</sup> Selassie has 'tax' in place of 'oppress'.

<sup>48</sup> For 'land of Persia', Selassie has 'Fars country'.

<sup>49</sup> In place of 'afflict', Selassie has 'firm up tribulation on'.



## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፳፱

<sup>1</sup> የግብጽም ሰዎች የእስራኤልን ልጆች በጭንቅ ጡብ በማሠራት ባሠሯቸውም ጊዜ ሥራውን ሁሉ ያለገለባም ጭቃ በመርገጥ ጡብንም በመተከስ ባስጨነቋቸው ጊዜ።  
<sup>2</sup> ሠሪዎችን የሚያፋጥኑ አለቆችንም በነርሳቸው ሾመው ባሠሯቸውም ጊዜ የግብጽን ጡብ ሁሉ ከመሥራት ያድናቸው ዘንድ ወደ እግዚአብሔር ጮሁ።  
<sup>3</sup> የዚያን ጊዜ የሚረዷቸው አሮንና ሙሴን ሰደደላቸው ከፈርዖን አገዛዝ ቤት ወገኖቹን ያወጡ ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር ልኳቸዋልና ከጡብም ሥራ አዳኛቸው እንዳይገዙ ለእግዚአብሔርም በምድረ በዳ መሥዋዕት እንዳይሠው በትዕቢቱ እስራኤልን ማሰናበት እምቢ ስላለ ወገኖቹን እስራኤልን ከግብጽ ንጉሥ ከፈርዖን አገዛዝ ቤት ያወጧቸው ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር ልኳቸዋልና አዳኛቸው።  
<sup>4</sup> እግዚአብሔር ትዕቢተኞችን ቸል ይላቸዋልና ፈርዖንንም ስለ ትዕቢቱ ከሠራዊቱ ጋራ በኤርትራ ባሕር አሰጠመው።  
<sup>5</sup> መኳንንትና ነገሠታት ሲሆኑ የእግዚአብሔርን ቃል ቸል የሚሉ ፈቃዱንም ይፈጽሙለት ዘንድ በበጎም ነገር ለሚያገለግሉ ሰዎች ደሞዛቸውን ይሰጧቸው ዘንድ ገናና ስሙንም ያከብሩ ዘንድ በሾማቸው በነገሣቸው መንግሥት

## 1 MEQABYAN 29

<sup>1</sup> And it came to pass that the Egyptians made the children of Israel work by making bricks under oppression, and maltreated them by making them work hard - treading mortar without straw, and baking bricks under duress;  
<sup>2</sup> and they appointed over them foremen to speed up the workers; and, as they wrought, they cried to God, that he would deliver them from all the burdens of making bricks in Egypt.  
<sup>3</sup> At that time, he sent Aaron and Moses to help them, and they delivered them from the brickworks, because God had sent them to bring his people out of Pharaoh's house, because, in his arrogance, he had refused to let Israel go, so that they could not leave to offer sacrifices to God in the desert.  
<sup>4</sup> God ignores the proud and, because of his pride, he drowned Pharaoh, along with his army, in the Red Sea.  
<sup>5</sup> He will destroy those who neglect the word of God and do not do good in all the kingdoms in which he has appointed them, so that they may honour his name and give their wages to those who serve him in good works, so that they

## 1 MEQABYAN 29

- <sup>1</sup> For 'under oppression', Selassie has 'in difficulty'.  
<sup>2</sup> Selassie has 'chiefs' in place of 'foremen'.  
<sup>3</sup> Like many modern translations, Selassie has 'wilderness' in place of 'desert'.  
<sup>4</sup> In place of 'Red Sea', Selassie has 'Eritrean Sea'.  
<sup>5</sup> Selassie has 'honour' in place of 'bring glory to'.



ሁሉ በጎ ሥራ ያልሠሩትን እንደሱ ያጠፋቸዋል። <sup>6</sup> ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር መንግሥቱን ቢያቀኑ ግን መንግሥታቸውን አቀናላቸዋለሁ አለ። <sup>7</sup> በጎ ሥራ ሥሩለኝ እኔም በጎ ሥራ እሠራላችኋለሁ ሕጌን ጠብቁ እኔም ሰውነታችሁን እጠብቃችኋለሁ በሕጌ ጸንታችሁ ኑሩ እኔም እንደ ለቡናችሁ ቅንነትን አሳድሬባችሁ እኖራለሁ። <sup>8</sup> እኔን ውደዱ እኔም ደኅንነታችሁን እወዳለሁ ወደኔ ተጠጉ እኔም አድናችኋለሁ።

<sup>9</sup> ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር በኔ እመኑ እኔም ከመከራው አድናችኋለሁ አለ። <sup>10</sup> ባጠገብ ባጠገብ አትኑሩ ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር የቀና ሥራን ይወዳልና እናንተ ወደኔ ቅረቡ እኔም ወደናንተ እቀርባለሁ አለ ኃጢአተኞች ከዳተኞች የምትሆኑ ሰዎች እጃችሁ ከኃጢአት አንጹ ልቡናችሁንም ከክፋት አርቁ። <sup>11</sup> እኔም ቁጣየን ከናንተ አርቃለሁ በቸርነትና በይቅርታም እመለስላችኋለሁ። <sup>12</sup> በደልን የሚሠሩ ወንጀለኞች ጠላቶችንም ከናንተ አርቃለሁ ባሪያዬ ዳዊትን ከተገናኙት ከጠላቶቹ ከብዙ ተንኮላቸው አርበኛ ከሆነ ከጎልያድም እጅ ይገዳለውም ዘንድ ከፈለገው ከሳኦልም እጅ መንግሥቱን ይወስድ ዘንድ ከወደደ ከልጁ ከአቤሴሎም እጅ እንዳዳንኩት። <sup>13</sup> ሕጌን የሚጠብቁ ፈቃዴንም የሚፈጽሙ

may do his will and bring glory to his famous name. <sup>6</sup> The Almighty GOD said, “If they will establish my kingdom, then I will establish their kingdom for them. <sup>7</sup> Do good deeds for me, and I will do good deeds for you. Keep my laws, and I will keep your bodies. Live according to my laws, and I will live with you in righteousness, according to your hearts. <sup>8</sup> Love me, and I will love your safety. Draw close to me, and I will save you.”

<sup>9</sup> The Almighty GOD said, “Believe in me and I will deliver you from the trouble. <sup>10</sup> Do not dwell near one another; for, the Almighty GOD loves upright works. Draw near to me, and I will draw near to you. Cleanse your hands from iniquity, you who are unfaithful, and remove your hearts from evil. <sup>11</sup> I will turn away my anger from you and return to you with kindness and forgiveness. <sup>12</sup> I will remove from you criminals and the wicked who work evil against you, just as I saved my servant David from the hand of his enemies, from the hand of Goliath, who was a warrior, and from the hand of Saul, who sought to kill him, and from the hand of Absalom his son, who sought to take the kingdom away from him. <sup>13</sup> Those people who keep my law and

<sup>6</sup> Here, ‘Almighty GOD’ translates እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>7</sup> For ‘hearts’, Selassie has ‘reasoning’.

<sup>8</sup> Selassie has ‘welfare’ in place of ‘safety’.

<sup>9</sup> For ‘trouble’, Selassie has ‘tribulation’.

<sup>10</sup> Selassie opens, “Don’t live side by side;” the meaning of this instruction is unclear.

<sup>11</sup> In place of ‘kindness’, Selassie has ‘Charity’.

<sup>12</sup> Selassie has ‘enemies’ in place of ‘the wicked’.

<sup>13</sup> For ‘I shall make them kings’, Selassie has ‘I shall crown them’.

ሰዎችን እንደሱ አድናቸዋልሁ ከብርን አወርሳቸዋለሁ በወዲህም ዓለም በሚመጣውም ዓለም በወዲያኛው ደስ ይላቸዋል ደስ ይላቸው ዘንድ በሁሉ ላይ አነግሣቸዋለሁ።

<sup>14</sup> እርሱ ሕፃን ሆኖ ሳለ ከሕፃንነቱ ጀምሮ ባማረ አኗኗሩ እግዚአብሔር የመረጠው ነቢዩ ሳሙኤል እንዳገለገለው ባማረ አኗኗራቸው እግዚአብሔርን ካገለገሉ ከከበሩ ነገሥታት ጋራ አንድ ይሆናሉ። <sup>15</sup> አገልጋይ ሽማግሌ ለሆነ ለኤሊ ይነግረው ዘንድ ነገረው በእግዚአብሔርም ማደሪያ በቤተ መቅደስ ሲያገለግል የሳሙኤልም ሥራው የማረ የተወደደ ነበር። <sup>16</sup> በእግዚአብሔር ማደሪያ በቤተ መቅደስም ሲያገለግሉ ባደገ ጊዜ ሕዝቡን ይሾም ዘንድ ነገሥታቱንም በእግዚአብሔር ፈቃድ ይቀባ ዘንድ እንዲሾም እንዲቀባ አደረገው። እግዚአብሔር ከአስራኤል ልጆች የመረጠው ወገን ይሾም ዘንድ ወዶታልና የፈጠረው የእግዚአብሔርን ፈቃድ በፈጸመ ጊዜ በእጁ ቅብዓ መንግሥትን ሰጠው። <sup>17</sup> ሳኦልም በመንግሥቱ ሳለ እግዚአብሔር ነቢዩ ሳሙኤልን ሂደህ ከይሁዳ ወገን የተወለደ የዕሤይ ልጅ ዳዊትን ወድጄዋለሁና ቅባው አለው።

do my will, I will save them like him, and I will give them glory, and I will make them kings over all, that they may rejoice both in this world and in the world to come.”

<sup>14</sup> They will be united with the glorious kings who served God with their good conduct, just as Samuel, the prophet whom God chose from his childhood, served God with the good way he conducted his life. <sup>15</sup> He told him to tell Eli, an old man and a servant, and Samuel’s work was well-received while he served in the temple of the LORD. <sup>16</sup> When he grew up, while they were serving in the tabernacle of the LORD and in the temple, he anointed him to appoint his people and to anoint their kings according to the will of the LORD. God chose the people from among the children of Israel to appoint him and, when he had fulfilled the will of God, the Creator, he gave him the anointing of the kingdom in his hand <sup>17</sup> And it came to pass, when Saul was king, that the LORD spoke to Samuel the prophet, saying, “Go and anoint David the son of Jesse, of the tribe of Judah; for, I have loved him.”

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<sup>14</sup> In place of ‘the good way he conducted his life’, Selassie has ‘his beautiful way of life’.

<sup>15</sup> One could also read ‘elder’ for ‘old man’.

<sup>16</sup> Throughout this paragraph, ‘the LORD’ translates እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>17</sup> Selassie has ‘kin’ in place of ‘tribe’.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፴

<sup>1</sup> ቃሌን ስለ ተደፋፈረ አሳዝኖኛልና የሳኦልግ ወገን ጠላሁ።  
<sup>2</sup> እኔም ቸል አልኩት ሕጌን አልጠበቅምና ደግመኛም ከወገኑ አላነግሥም። <sup>3</sup> ሕጌንና ቃሌን ሥርዓቴንም ያልጠበቁ ሰዎችም እንደሱ መንግሥቴንና ስጦታዬን እስከ ዘለዓለሙ ድረስ ከልጆቻቸው አጠፋለሁ። <sup>4</sup> ባገነንኳቸውም ጊዜ አላገነኑኝምና አጠፋቸዋለሁ እንጂ ዳግመኛ እንዳነሣቸው አልመለስም ባከብራቸውም አላከበሩኝም አላገናኛቸውም።  
<sup>5</sup> በጎ ነገርን ባደረግሁላቸው ጊዜ በጎ ነገርን አያደርጉልኝምና ይቅርም ባልኋቸው ጊዜ ይቅር አላሉኝምና። <sup>6</sup> በሁሉም ላይ ገዥ ባደረግኋቸው ጊዜ ገዥ አላደረጉኝምና ከሁሉ ይልቅ ባከበርኋቸው ጊዜ አላከበሩኝምና ዳግመኛ አላገናኛቸውም አላከብራቸውም ሕጌንም አልጠበቁምና።  
<sup>7</sup> እኔም የሰጠኋቸውን ስጦት ነሳታቸው ተቈጥቼም እንደ ማልሁ መጠን የነሳታቸውን ገንዘብ አልመልሰላቸውም ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር እንዲህ አለ ያከበሩኝት አከብራቸዋለሁ የወደዱኝም እወዳቸዋለሁ አለ። <sup>8</sup> ያላከበሩኝ ሕጌንም ያልጠበቁትን ከሰጠኋቸው ስጦታ እለያቸዋለሁ። <sup>9</sup> ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር አለ የወደደኝን እወደዋለሁ ያገነኑኝን

## 1 MEQABYAN 30

<sup>1</sup> I hated the house of Saul; for, I was grieved because he violated my word. <sup>2</sup> I ignored him for not keeping my law and I will not crown his house again. <sup>3</sup> And those like him, who do not keep my law, my words, and my statutes, I will remove my kingdom and my gifts from their sons forever. <sup>4</sup> And, when I exalted them, they did not exalt me; I will destroy them, because they did not exalt me. And, when I honoured them, they did not honour me, and I will not be with them. <sup>5</sup> For, when I benefit them, they do not thank me, and when I forgive them, they do not forgive me. <sup>6</sup> For, when I made them rulers of all, they did not make me ruler; and when I honoured them, they did not honour me; I won't restore them again, nor honour them; for, they did not keep my law.  
<sup>7</sup> I have taken back the gift that I gave them, and I will not restore the money that I took, as I swore in my anger. Thus says the LORD God Almighty: "Those who honour me I will honour, and those who love me I will love. <sup>8</sup> I will separate those who do not honour me and do not keep my law from the gifts I have given them." <sup>9</sup> The Almighty GOD said, "I love those who love

## 1 MEQABYAN 30

- <sup>1</sup> Selassie has 'kin' in place of 'house'.
- <sup>2</sup> It is not clear what 'house' here refers to – possibly, the whole Tribe of Benjamin?
- <sup>3</sup> For 'statutes', Selassie has 'Order'.
- <sup>4</sup> In place of 'exalt me', Selassie has 'make me famous'.
- <sup>5</sup> It is unclear how (or why) one would 'forgive' God.
- <sup>6</sup> One should probably read 'make me ruler' as 'make me *their* ruler'.
- <sup>7</sup> For 'the LORD God Almighty', Selassie has 'JAH Who rules all'.
- <sup>8</sup> Selassie has 'didn't honour' in place of 'do not honour'.
- <sup>9</sup> For 'exalt', Selassie has 'make famous'.

አገነዋለሁ አለ። <sup>10</sup> እኔ እግዚአብሔር ሁሉን የምገዛ ነኝና በምድርና በሰማይ ከሥልጣኔ የሚያመልጥ የለም የምገድል የማድን የማሳዝንና ይቅር የምል እኔ እግዚአብሔር ነኝና።  
<sup>11</sup> ገናንነት ክብርም የኔ ገንዘብ ነውና የወደድሁትን አከብረዋለሁ የምፈርድ ተበቅዬ የማጠፋ እኔ ነኝና የጠላሁትንም አጎሰቄለዋለሁ።  
<sup>12</sup> የሚወዱኝ ስሜንም ሁለጊዜ የሚጠሩትን ይቅር የምል እኔ ነኝና ለባለጠጋውና ለድኃው ምግብ የምመግብ እኔ ነኝና።  
<sup>13</sup> ወፎችንና እንስሶችንም በባሕር ያሉ ዓሣዎችንና አውሬዎችን እባቦችንም እመግባለሁ እንጂ ሰውን ብቻ የምመግብ አይደለሁም። <sup>14</sup> አዞዎችንና ዓሣ ነባሪዎችን አሽኮዎችና ጉማሬዎችን አቁስጣንም። <sup>15</sup> በውኃ ውስጥም የሚኖረውን ሁሉ በነፋስ ላይ የሚበረውን ሁሉ እመግባለሁ እንጂ ሰውን ብቻ የምመግብ አይደለሁም ይህ ሁሉ የኔ ገንዘብ ነው። <sup>16</sup> በሚገባ በሚወደድም ሁሉ ሁሉ እኔን የሚፈልጉኝን ሁሉ የምመግብ እኔ ነኝ።

me, and I will exalt those who exalt me. <sup>10</sup> For I, the LORD, am the Lord of all things. There is no one on earth or in heaven who escapes my power. For, I am the LORD, the One who kills, saves, makes sorry, and forgives. <sup>11</sup> For, glory and honour are mine to give, and I honour those I love, and I judge and make wretched those I hate.

<sup>12</sup> “For, I am he who forgives those who love me and call on my name forever, and I am the one who gives food to the rich and to the poor. <sup>13</sup> I feed not only humans, but the birds and the animals, the fish in the sea, the wild animals, and the serpents. <sup>14</sup> And I feed the crocodiles and the whales, the elephants and the hippos. <sup>15</sup> I feed not only humans, but also everything that lives in the water and everything that flies on the wind. All this is my money. <sup>16</sup> I am the one who feeds all who seek me, in all that is well-loved.”

<sup>10</sup> Selassie has ‘authority’ in place of ‘power’.

<sup>11</sup> In place of ‘glory’, Selassie has ‘famousness’.

<sup>12</sup> For ‘rich’, Selassie reads ‘wealthy’.

<sup>13</sup> Selassie has ‘flowers’ in place of ‘serpents’; the translation of the end of this verse is uncertain.

<sup>14</sup> Literally translated, this verse opens, “We have killed.”

<sup>15</sup> The meaning of ‘money’ here is unclear.

<sup>16</sup> The translation of this verse is uncertain – ‘seek’ could also be read as ‘need’.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፴፩

<sup>1</sup> ነገሥታቱም ያለኔ ፈቃድ አይነግሡም ጦም አዳራዎችም በትእዛዜ ነው እንጂ ያለ ትእዛዜ አይደሽዩም ኃይለኞችም በፈቃዴ ነው እንጂ ያለ ፈቃዴ አይበረቱም። <sup>2</sup> እኔ ለዳዊት መወደድን ለሰሎሞን ጥበብን ሰጠሁት ለሕዝቅያስም ዘመኖችን ጭምር ሁለት። <sup>3</sup> የጎልያድን ዘመን አሳነስሁ እኔ ለሶምሶንም ኃይልን ሰጠሁት ዳግመኛም ኃይሉን አደከምሁ። <sup>4</sup> ባሪያዬ ዳዊትንም እኔ አርበኛ ከሆነ ከጎልያድ እጅ አዳንኩት። <sup>5</sup> ዳግመኛም ከንጉሡ ከሳኦል እጅ ከተከራከረውም ከሁለተኛው አርበኛ አዳንሁት ትእዛዜንም ጠብቋልና ከሚከራከሩትም ከሚጠሉትም ሰዎች እጅ አዳንሁት። <sup>6</sup> እኔም እሱን ወደድሁ ሕጌን የሚጠብቁ መኳንንቱና ነገሥታቱም ሁሉ እወዳቸዋለሁ እነሳቸው ደስ አሰኝተውኛልና በጠላቶቻቸው ላይ ድል መንሣትንና ኃይልን እሰጣቸዋለሁ። <sup>7</sup> ዳግመኛም ያባቶቻቸውን ምድር ይወርሱ ዘንድ ላባቶቻቸው የማልኩላቸውን የነጻች የበራች ምድረ ርስትን እሰጣቸዋለሁ።

## 1 MEQABYAN 31

<sup>1</sup> Kings don't reign without my consent, and the poor aren't poor without my command but by my command, and the mighty do not become strong without my consent but by my will. <sup>2</sup> I gave David the love of God and Solomon the wisdom of God, and both to Hezekiah. <sup>3</sup> I shortened the days of Goliath, and I gave strength to Samson, and then I weakened his strength. <sup>4</sup> And I saved my servant David from the hand of Goliath, the warrior. <sup>5</sup> And I delivered him again from the hand of King Saul, and from the hand of the second captain that fought him; and I delivered him from the hand of his enemies, and from the hand of them that hated him, because he kept my commandments. <sup>6</sup> I love him, and I love all the princes and kings who keep my law. I will give them victory and strength over their enemies, because they have pleased me. <sup>7</sup> And I will give them again the pure and bright land that I swore their fathers would possess, that they may inherit the land of their fathers.

### 1 MEQABYAN 31

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- <sup>1</sup> The translation of this verse is not certain; Selassie opens, "An the kings don't reign without I Accord ~ an sufferahs are by I Command ~ yet them aren't poor without I Command."
- <sup>2</sup> Here, 'both' is a conjectural translation.
- <sup>3</sup> For 'Goliath', Selassie has 'Gwolyad'.
- <sup>4</sup> In place of 'servant', Selassie has 'slave'.
- <sup>5</sup> For 'captain', Selassie has 'warrior'; it is unclear who the referent is.
- <sup>6</sup> Selassie has 'nobles' in place of 'princes'.
- <sup>7</sup> In place of 'pure and bright', Selassie has 'cleansed and shining'.



## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፴፪

<sup>1</sup> ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር እናንተም መኳንንቱና ነገሥታቱም ቃሌን ስሙኝ ትእዛዜንም ጠብቁ አለ እኔ እግዚአብሔር ፈጣሪያቸው ስሆን የጠበቅኳቸው ያዳንኳቸው የእስራኤል ልጆች እንዳሳዘኑኝ ልዩ የሆኑ ጣዖቶችንም እንዳመለኩ እንዳታሳዝኑኝ እንዳታመልኩ ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር ቃሌን ስሙኝ አለ ካባት ከናታቸውም ከተወለዱ ጀምሮ ያሳደግኳቸው የወደዱትንም ሁሉ የመገብኳቸው። <sup>2</sup> ወደ ምድርም አዝመራ ያወጣኳቸው እንደሚገባም አድርጌ ከምድረ የተገኘውን ድልብ የመገብኳቸው ያልተከሉትንም የወይኑን ሐረግ የዘይቱንም ፍሮ ያልቆፈሩትን የጠራ የውኃውንም ጉድጓድ የሰጠኳቸው። <sup>3</sup> ፈጣሪያቸው እኔ እግዚአብሔር ስሆን ጣዖቶችን አምልከው የእስራኤል ልጆች እንዳሳዘኑኝ እንዳታሳዝኑኝ ቃሌን ስሙኝ አላቸው ከተፈተገው ስንዴ ጋራ የበጉን ወተትና የማሩን ወለላ የመገብኳቸው ጌጥ ያለበትንም ልብስ ያለበሰኳቸው የሚወደደውንም ሁሉ የሰጠኳቸው። <sup>4</sup> የለሙኝንም ሁሉ ያሳጣኳቸው ሳይኖር።

## 1 MEQABYAN 32

<sup>1</sup> The LORD Almighty says, "Listen to my words, you princes and also you kings, and keep my commandments. Do not let the children of Israel, whom I have preserved and redeemed, grieve me, their Creator, as they grieved me by serving strange idols, and I have brought them up from their birth, and I have fed them with all that they desired. <sup>2</sup> And I brought them out to the field of crops, and I gave them the produce of the land, as they should be, and the vineyards and olive trees that they had not planted, and the wells of fresh water that they had not dug. <sup>3</sup> Hear my voice, lest you grieve me, as the children of Israel grieved me by worshipping idols, when I am the LORD their Creator. I fed them with milk of the flock, and honey, and wheat of the field, and clothed them with fine garments, and gave them all that was desirable. <sup>4</sup> And I have deprived them of all that they have asked of me, without any success."

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## 1 MEQABYAN 32

<sup>1</sup> For 'princes', Selassie has 'nobles'.

<sup>2</sup> The translation, 'as they should be', is uncertain.

<sup>3</sup> The partial repetition of v. 1 is, no doubt, for emphasis.

<sup>4</sup> The meaning of this verse is not clear.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፴፫

<sup>1</sup> ዳዊት መላእክት ያወረዱትን መና የእስራኤል ልጆች ተመገቡ ብሎ እንደ ተናገረ ዳግመኛም የሚጣፍጥ መግናራን በምድረ በዳ ይመገብኋቸው እኔ ፈጣሪያቸው እግዚአብሔር ስሆን ጣዖታቱን አምልከው የእስራኤል ልጆች እንዳሳዘኑኝ እንዳታሳዘኑኝ ቃሌን ስሙኝ አለ በሚገባና በውነት ያመልኩኝ ዘንድ ይኸንን ሁሉ አደረግሁላቸው። <sup>2</sup> ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር እነሳቸው ግን አላመለኩኝም እኔም ቸል አልኋቸው አለ አሳዘኑኝ የኔ ሕግ ባልሆነ በሕገ ጣዖትም ጸንተው ኖረ። <sup>3</sup> እኔም እንደ ኃጢአታቸው ፍዳውን አመጣባቸዋለሁ አምልካቴን ቸል ብለዋልና በምክሬና በሥርዓቴም አልጸኑምና በእጃቸው እንደ ሠሩት ኃጢአት መጠን ቸል አልኋቸው በሰማይ በሚደረግ ቁርጥ ፍርድ ወደ ገሃነም አወርዳቸዋለሁ።

<sup>4</sup> ሕጌን አልጠበቁምና እኔም እቁጣቸዋለሁና በዚህ ዓለምም ዘመናቸውን አሳንሳለሁ። <sup>5</sup> አንተ ንጉሥን ብትሆን የምትሞት የምትፈርስ ነገ ትል ትቢያ የምትሆን ሰው አይደለህምን።

<sup>6</sup> ዛሬ ግን ለዘለዓለሙ እንደማይሞት ሰው ትመካለህ ትኮራለህ። <sup>7</sup> ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር ዛሬ ደኅና ሁኔታ የምትታይ አንተ ግን ነገ የምትሞት ሰው ነህ አለ።

## 1 MEQABYAN 33

<sup>1</sup> As David said, “The children of Israel ate the manna that the angels brought down.” And again, “I fed them with the sweet savour in the desert.” He said, “Do not anger me, as the children of Israel angered me by serving idols, when I, the LORD, am their Creator.” He said, “Listen to my voice, so that they may serve me in truth and in righteousness.” I have done all these things for them. <sup>2</sup> The Almighty GOD said, “But they did not worship me, and I ignored them. They grieved me, and they persisted in the law of idols, which is not my law.” <sup>3</sup> And I will bring on them according to their iniquity, because they have forsaken my worship, and have not stood in my counsels and my statutes; and I will bring them down to Gehenna with judgments from heaven, according to the iniquity of their hands.

<sup>4</sup> I will also cut short their days in this world, because they did not keep my law. <sup>5</sup> Even if you are a king, you are a mortal who will die and crumble tomorrow and become worms and dust?

<sup>6</sup> But today you are proud and boast that you will never die. <sup>7</sup> The Almighty GOD said, “You who appear healthy today are mortal men, but tomorrow you will die.”

## 1 MEQABYAN 33

<sup>1</sup> Here, ‘the LORD’ translates እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>2</sup> Here, ‘Almighty GOD’ translates እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>3</sup> Some have ‘hell’ in place of ‘Gehenna’.

<sup>4</sup> In place of ‘cut short’, Selassie has ‘diminish’.

<sup>5</sup> For ‘crumble’, Selassie has ‘be demolished’.

<sup>6</sup> For this verse, Selassie reads, “But today thou boast an are proud like unto a man who won’t dead foriva.”

<sup>7</sup> Here, ‘Almighty GOD’ translates እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>8</sup> ትእዛዜንና ቃሌን ብትጠብቁ ግን ማደሪያቸው ብርሃን ከሆነ  
ዘውዶቻቸውም ካማሩ ዙፋኖቻቸውም የብርና የወርቅ ከሆኑ  
በነሳቸውም ላይ የሚቀመጡ ሰዎች ያጌጡ ከሆነ ፈቃዴን  
ከደረጉ ከከበሩ ነገሥታት ጋራ የከበረች አገርን አወርስህለሁ  
አለ። <sup>9</sup> በጎ ሥራን ለሠሩ ሰዎች የቀረበች ቦታ በምትሆን  
ባገሩም ውስጥ ደስ ይላቸዋል <sup>10</sup> ሥርዓቴንና ሕጌን  
አልጠበቁምና ኃጢአት ለሚሠሩ ሰዎችን ግን ሁሉን የሚገዛ  
እግዚአብሔር የከበሩ ነገሥታት ወደሚገቡባት። <sup>11</sup> ወደዚያች  
አገር ይገቡ ዘንድ አይገባቸውም አለ።

<sup>8</sup> But, if you keep my commandments and my words, your dwellings will be bright, your crowns will be beautiful, your thrones will be silver and gold, and those who sit on them will be beautiful; if you do my will, then I will give you a glorious land with glorious kings. <sup>9</sup> They will rejoice in their land, which is near to those who do good, <sup>10</sup> but to those who sin, because they have not kept my statutes and my laws, to a place where glorious kings will enter, where the LORD Almighty will dwell. <sup>11</sup> He said, “They are not worthy to enter that country.”

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<sup>8</sup> In place of ‘glorious’ (twice in this verse), Selassie has ‘honoured’.

<sup>9</sup> The translation of this verse is uncertain.

<sup>10</sup> Here, ‘LORD Almighty’ translates እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>11</sup> At the end of this verse, Selassie adds, “where honoured kings shall enter.”

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፴፬

<sup>1</sup> የሜዶን መንግሥት ትጠፋለች የሮም መንግሥት ግን በመቄዶንያ መንግሥት ላይ ፈጽማ ትጸናለች የነነዌም መንግሥት በፋርስ መንግሥት ላይ ትጸናለች። <sup>2</sup> የኢትዮጵያ መንግሥትም በእስክንድርያ መንግሥት ላይ ትጸናለች አሕዛብ ይነሣሉና የሞዓብ መንግሥት በአማሌቅ መንግሥት ላይ ትጸናለች። <sup>3</sup> ወንድም በወንድሙ ላይ ይነሣል ይጠፋ ዘንድ እንደ ተናገረ እግዚአብሔርም ተበቅሎ ያጠፋል። <sup>4</sup> መንግሥት በመንግሥት ላይ ሕዝቡም በሕዝቡ ላይ አገርም በአገር ላይ ይነሣል አለ። <sup>5</sup> ክርክር ይደረጋል ሰልፍ ረኃብ ቸነፈር ንውጥውጥታ ድርቅ ይሆናል ከዚህ ዓለም ፍቅር ጠፍቷልና የእግዚአብሔር መቅሠፍት በርሷ ወረደ። <sup>6</sup> ከመሥራቅ እስከ ምዕራብ እንደሚታይ መብረቅ የምታስፈራ እግዚአብሔር የሚመጣባት ቀን ድንገት ደርሳለችና። <sup>7</sup> እሱ እግዚአብሔር ፍርድ በሚፈርድባት ቀን የዚያን ጊዜ ሰው ሁሉ እንደ እጁ ድካምና እንደ ኃጢአቱም ጽናት ፍዳውን ይቀበላል እሱ እግዚአብሔር ፍርድ በሚፈርድባት ቀን እግራቸውም በሚሰነካከልባት ቀን እበቀላቸዋለሁ ብሏልና

## 1 MEQABYAN 34

<sup>1</sup> The kingdom of Media will be destroyed, but the kingdom of Rome will be completely established against the kingdom of Macedonia, and the kingdom of Nineveh will be established against the kingdom of Persia. <sup>2</sup> The kingdom of Ethiopia will prevail over the kingdom of Alexandria, and the nations will rise up, and the kingdom of Moab will prevail over the kingdom of Amalek. <sup>3</sup> Brother will rise up against brother and be destroyed, as God has said, and God will take revenge and destroy. <sup>4</sup> He said, “Government will rise against government, people against people, and country against country.” <sup>5</sup> There will be arguments, wars, famines, pestilences, and droughts. The plague of God has fallen upon this world because love has disappeared. <sup>6</sup> For, the day of the LORD is coming suddenly, as the lightning flashes from the east to the west. <sup>7</sup> On the day of judgment, God will punish everyone according to the work of their hands and the persistence of their sins. For, the day has come when they will be counted to destruction; for, God has said, “I will punish them on the day of judgment, and

## 1 MEQABYAN 34

- <sup>1</sup> Selassie has ‘Fars’ in place of ‘Persia’.
- <sup>2</sup> It is unclear what ‘Alexandria’ here represents – there was never really a ‘kingdom’ with that name.
- <sup>3</sup> Here, Selassie has ‘JAH’ in place of ‘God’.
- <sup>4</sup> In place of ‘Government’, Selassie has ‘Kingdom’ (twice in this verse).
- <sup>5</sup> Selassie has ‘earthquakes’ in place of ‘wars’.
- <sup>6</sup> Here, ‘the LORD’ translates እግዚአብሔር.
- <sup>7</sup> For ‘work’, Selassie reads ‘weakness’.

ለጥፋት የሚቈጠሩባት ቀን ደርሷልና። <sup>8</sup> የዚያን ጊዜ እግዚአብሔር በሕጉ ጸንተው የማይኖሩ ኃጢአት የሚሠሩ ሰዎችን ለዘለዓለሙ በገሃነም ያጠፋቸዋል የቆጵሮስና የይሁዳ የደማስቆና የሰማርያም ሰዎች የባቢሎን ሰዎች። <sup>9</sup> በምዕራብ ደሴትም የሚኖሩ የኖባና የሕንደኬም የሳባ የኢትዮጵያና የግብጽም ሰዎች በነሳቸው የሚኖሩ ሰዎች ሁሉ። <sup>10</sup> ምድርና ሰማይን እምገዛ መወደድንና ክብርንም እምሰጥ እማድንና እምገድልም እግዚአብሔር እኔ እንደ ሆንኩ የዚያን ጊዜ ያውቁኛል። <sup>11</sup> ፀሐይን የማወጣ ወደ መግቢያው እምልከው ክፉውንና በጎውንም እማመጣ እኔ ነኝ። <sup>12</sup> እማታውቋቸውን የደከማችሁበትን ገንዘብ የበጎቻችሁንና የላሞቻችሁንም መንጋ አርደው የሚበሉ አሕዛብን እማመጣ እኔ ነኝ። <sup>13</sup> ልጆቻችሁንም በፊታችሁ እየቀጠቀጡ ይማርኳቸዋል እለሳቸውንም ማዳን አትችሉም። የእግዚአብሔር መንፈስ ረድኤት ስላላደረባችሁ የሰማችሁትን የእግዚአብሔርን ትእዛዝ አልፈራችሁምና ቅምጥላችሁ ድልድላችሁ ያጠፋሉ። <sup>14</sup> ባንተ ያደረገ የእግዚአብሔር መንፈስ ረድኤትን አያለሁና ብሎ ናቡከነፆር ለዳንኤል እንደ ነገረው የእግዚአብሔር መንፈስ ረድኤት ያደረበት ሰው ግን ሁሉን ያውቃል። <sup>15</sup> የእግዚአብሔርም መንፈስ ረድኤት ያደረበት ሰው ሁሉን

on the day when their feet stumble.” <sup>8</sup> At that time, God will destroy the people who commit sins and do not abide by the law forever in Gehenna: the people of Cyprus, Judaea, Damascus, Samaria, and Babylon. <sup>9</sup> And all the people who live in the western islands, the people of Noba, the people of India, the people of Sheba, the people of Ethiopia and Egypt, all the people who live in these countries. <sup>10</sup> At that time, they will know that I am GOD, the One who rules the earth and the heavens, who gives love and honour, who saves and who kills. <sup>11</sup> I am the one who brings the sun to its entrance, who sends it to its setting, and who brings in the evil and the good. <sup>12</sup> I will bring in nations you do not know, who will slaughter your flocks and herds and eat the money you have worked for. <sup>13</sup> They will crush your children before your eyes, and you will not be able to save them. And the Spirit of God will not support you, because you have not feared the commandments of God that you have heard, and all your works will be destroyed. <sup>14</sup> But a person in whom the Spirit of God has helped knows everything, as Nebuchadnezzar told Daniel, “I see the help of the Spirit of God that is in you.” <sup>15</sup> And the one who is led by the Spirit of God knows all things, and

<sup>8</sup> Selassie lacks, “the people of Cyprus, Judaea, Damascus, Samaria, and Babylon.”

<sup>9</sup> It is not certain what the ‘western islands’ are – possibly, the Aegean Islands.

<sup>10</sup> Here, ‘GOD’ translates እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>11</sup> The sun’s ‘entrance’ is its rising.

<sup>12</sup> The word translated as ‘money’ most likely has another meaning here but Selassie also reads as we do.

<sup>13</sup> The translation, ‘all your works’, is uncertain; Selassie has ‘lavishments and assignments’.

<sup>14</sup> The reference here is possibly to Dn 2:46–49.

<sup>15</sup> For ‘Spirit of God’, Selassie reads ‘JAH Spirit of Support’.



ያውቃል የተሠወረውም ይገለጥለታል የተገለጠውንና የተሠወረውንም ሁሉ ያውቃል እንጂ የእግዚአብሔር መንፈስ ረድኤት ካደረበት ሰው የሚሠወር የለም። <sup>16</sup> እኛ ግን ነገ የምንሞት ሰዎች ነንና ሠውረን የሠራነው ኃጢአታችን ይገለጣል። <sup>17</sup> ብርንና ወርቅንም በእሳት እንዲፈትኑት የእግዚአብሔርን ትእዛዝ አልጠበቁምና ኃጥአን እንዳሉ ኋላ በዕለተ ምጽአት ይመረመራሉ። <sup>18</sup> የዚያን ጊዜ የእሕዛብ ሁሉና የእስራኤል ልጆች ሁሉ ሥራዎቻቸው ይመረመራሉ።

everything hidden is revealed to him. He knows everything that is revealed and everything hidden. Nothing is hidden from the one who is led by the Spirit of God. <sup>16</sup> But we are people who will die tomorrow, so our sins that we have committed in secret will be revealed. <sup>17</sup> They will be examined later on the Day of Judgment as sinners because they did not keep God's command, tested like silver and gold with fire. <sup>18</sup> At that time, all the nations and all the children of Israel will be examined for their deeds.

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<sup>16</sup> For 'committed in secret', Selassie has 'hid and worked'.

<sup>17</sup> The order of clauses in this verse is rather awkward.

<sup>18</sup> Selassie ends, "all the Israelite children's works shall be examined."

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፴፭

<sup>1</sup> አባት እናቱ ለሞቱበት ልጅ እውነት ፍርድ ስላልፈረዳችሁ እግዚአብሔር በናንተ ላይ ይቈጣልና የእስራኤል መኳንንቶች ወዮላችሁ። <sup>2</sup> ጧትና ማታ ወደ መሸተኛ ቤት የምትሔዱ የምትሰከሩ ፍርድ የምታደሉ የባልቴቱና እናት አባቱ የሞቱበት ልጅ ፍርድንም የማትሰሙ በኃጢአትና በመዳራትም የምትኖሩ ሰዎች ወዮላችሁ። <sup>3</sup> እግዚአብሔር የእስራኤል መኳንንቶችን አንዲህ አላቸው በትእዛዜ ጸንታችሁ ካልኖራችሁ ሕጌንም ካለጠበቃችሁ እኔ የምወደውን ካልወደዳችሁ ወዮላችሁ አላቸው። <sup>4</sup> እኔም ጥፋትንና መቅሠፍትን መከራን አመጣባችኋለሁ ነቀዝና ብሎም እንደበላው ትጠፋላችሁ ፍለጋችሁና አውራጃችሁም አይገኝም አላቸው።

<sup>5</sup> አገራችሁም ምድረ በዳ ትሆናለች ቀድሞም ያያት ሰው ሁሉ እጁን ያጨበጭባል ይች አገር በረከቷን የሚወደውንም ሁሉ የተመላች አልነበረችምን እግዚአብሔር በማኖሩባት ሰዎች ኃጢአት እንዲህ አደረጋት እያለ በርሷ ይደነቃል።

<sup>6</sup> ልቧን አኩርታለችና ራሷንም ከፍ ከፍ አድርጋለችና እግዚአብሔር በመሬት እስኪያጐሳቁላት ድረስ ክሣደ ልቡናዋንም አጽንታለችና በማኖሩባት ሰዎች ትዕቢትም

## 1 MEQABYAN 35

<sup>1</sup> Woe to you, princes of Israel! For, the LORD is angry with you, because you have not judged truthfully the child whose father and mother are dead. <sup>2</sup> Woe to you, you who go to the drinking house morning and evening, who get drunk and judge unjustly, who do not hear the judgment of the widow and the fatherless, and who live in sin and debauchery. <sup>3</sup> The LORD said to the leaders of Israel, “Woe to you if you do not abide in my commandments and keep my laws and do not love what I love. <sup>4</sup> And I will bring upon you destruction, and pestilence, and distress; and you shall perish like wheat that weevils eat, and your roads and your territory shall not be found.

<sup>5</sup> “Your land will become a desert and all who see it will clap their hands and be astonished at it, saying, “Wasn’t this land full of blessings and full of everything it loved? God has done this to it because of the sin of the people who lived there.” <sup>6</sup> Because her heart is proud and her head is lifted up, she has hardened her heart and hardened her mind until God casts her down to the ground. She will become a desert to the arrogant who live in her,

## 1 MEQABYAN 35

- <sup>1</sup> Selassie has ‘nobles’ in place of ‘princes’.
- <sup>2</sup> In place of ‘debauchery’, Selassie has ‘seducing’.
- <sup>3</sup> Here, ‘The LORD’ translates እግዚአብሔር.
- <sup>4</sup> For ‘pestilence’, Selassie has ‘chastisement’.
- <sup>5</sup> The clapping of hands was a sign of astonishment and/or shock.
- <sup>6</sup> Selassie has ‘wilderness’ in place of ‘desert’ (as also in v. 5).

ምድረ በዳ ትሆናለችና ከአሜከላ ጋራ እሾህም በቅሎባታልና ወዮላት ይላሉ።

<sup>7</sup> ሙጃንና አስተናግርም አበቀለች ምድረ በዳና በረሃንም ሆነች አውሬዎችም በውስጧ ይኖሩባታል። <sup>8</sup> የእግዚአብሔር ፍርድ በርሷ ጸንቷልና በሚኖሩባትም ሰዎች ኃጢአት ስለ ልቡናዋ ትዕቢት የእግዚአብሔርን ፍርድ ጽዋ ተቀብላለችና ወደርሷ ለሚሔዱ ሰዎችም የምታስፈራ ሆነች።

and she will be thorny with thorns and briers, and they will say, “Woe to her.”

<sup>7</sup> It will produce both weeds and nettles, becoming a wilderness and desert, and wild animals will live in it. <sup>8</sup> For, the judgment of God is established on her and she has received the cup of God’s judgment because of the iniquity of her heart, and has become a terror to those who go to her.

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<sup>7</sup> The translation, ‘*weeds and nettles*’, follows Selassie; the Amharic text is uncertain.

<sup>8</sup> Selassie has ‘*Chalice*’ in place of ‘*cup*’.

## መቃብያን፡ ቀዳማዊ። ፴፮

<sup>1</sup> የመቄዶን ሰዎች አትመኩ ተበቅሎ የሚያጠፋችሁ እግዚአብሔር አለና አማሌቃውያን ክሣደ ልቡናችሁን አታጽኑ። <sup>2</sup> እስከ ሰማይ ከፍ ከፍ ትላላችሁና እስከ ገሃነም ትወርዳላችሁና። <sup>3</sup> እስራኤል ቀድሞ በሞዓብና በሜዶን መንግሥት ወደ ግብጽ አገር በገቡ ጊዜ ትገዳደሩት ዘንድ በእግዚአብሔር መገዳደር አይገባምና አትመኩ አለ። <sup>4</sup> አንተ የይስማኤል ወገን የባርያ ልጅ ያንተ ገንዘብ ባልሆነ ክሣደ ልቡናህን ለምን ታጽናለህ በምድርስ ይፈርዳባት ዘንድ በተነሣ ጊዜ በሚፈረድብህ ቀን እግዚአብሔር እንዲፈርብህ አታስብምን።

<sup>5</sup> ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔ የዚያን ጊዜ እንደጅህ ሥሪ ፍዳህን ትቀበላለህ ልቡና ህንስ ለምን ከፍ ከፍ ታደርጋለህ ክሣደ ልቡናህንስ ለምን ታፀናለህ አለ። <sup>6</sup> ወገኖችህ ላልሆኑ ሰዎች አንተ እንደተገዳደርህ እኔ አገዳደርህ አለህ ኃጢአትም ትሠራ ዘንድ የወደድኸውን ታደርጋለህና በላኩህም ቦታ ቸል እልሃለሁ። <sup>7</sup> ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር እኔም ባንተ ላይ አንዲህ አደርጋለሁ አለ አንተ ግን በጎ ሥራ ከሠራህ እኔ እምወደውን ከወደድህ እኔም የለመንኸውን ሁሉ እሰማሃለሁ

## 1 MEQABYAN 36

<sup>1</sup> Do not rejoice in the Macedonians; for, the LORD will destroy you. Do not let your hearts be troubled by the Amalekites. <sup>2</sup> For, you will be exalted to heaven and brought down to Gehenna. <sup>3</sup> When Israel first came to the land of Egypt through the kingdoms of Moab and Media, he said, “Do not be arrogant; for, you should not tempt the LORD. <sup>4</sup> You son of a slave, a descendant of Ishmael, why do you set your heart on a loss that is not yours? Do you not consider that God will punish you on the day he judges you when he rises to judge the earth?”

<sup>5</sup> God who rules all said, “At that time, you will receive your reward according to your deeds. Why do you exalt yourself and harden your heart when you are in trouble? <sup>6</sup> I have challenged you, just as you challenged people who are not your kin, and you will do whatever you like to sin, and I will neglect you in the place where I sent you” <sup>7</sup> The Almighty GOD said, “I will do the same to you. But if you do good deeds and love what I love, I will also listen to you in everything you ask. <sup>8</sup> If you do my will, I will

## 1 MEQABYAN 36

- <sup>1</sup> In place of ‘rejoice’, Selassie has ‘boast’.
- <sup>2</sup> Some read ‘hell’ in place of ‘Gehenna’.
- <sup>3</sup> For ‘Do not be arrogant’, Selassie has ‘Don’t boast’.
- <sup>4</sup> It is not clear who the addressee (the ‘descendant of Ishmael’) is, here.
- <sup>5</sup> ‘God who rules all’ translates ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔ.
- <sup>6</sup> For ‘have challenged’, Selassie as ‘will pretend upon’.
- <sup>7</sup> Here, the opening ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር is translated as ‘The Almighty GOD’.
- <sup>8</sup> For ‘sons’, Selassie has ‘children’; the word could also be read as ‘daughters’.

አለ። <sup>8</sup> የእኔን ፈቃድ ብትፈጽምልኝ ያንተንም ፈቃድ እፈጽምልሃለሁ ጠላቶችንም እስራከርልሃለሁ ልችህንና ዘርህንም እባርክልሃለሁ። <sup>9</sup> የበጎችህንና የላሞችህንንም መንጋ አበዛልሀለሁ በትዕዛዜ ፀንተህ ከኖርህ እኔም የምወደውንም ካደረግህ ሁሉም የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር በጅህ የያዝከውን ሁሉ እባርክሀለሁ አለ። <sup>10</sup> ፈቃዴን ባታደርግ በሕጎና በትዕዛዜ ፀንተህ ባትሆን ግን ቀድሞ የተነገረው ይህ ሁሉ መከራ ያገኝሃል በትእዛዜ ጸንተህ መከራን አልታገሥህምና በሕጌም ጸንተህ አልኖርክምና ሁሉ ጊዜ ከምትመጣብህ ቁጣዬም ማምለጥ አትችልም።

<sup>11</sup> እኔ የወደድሁትንም አልወደድህምና እኔ ካለመኖር ወደ መኖር አምጥቼ የፈጠርሁህ ሲሆን። <sup>12</sup> የወደድኸው ሁሉ ልታደርግ ትገድል ታድን ዘንድ ትሠራ ታፈርስ ዘንድ ታከብር ታጎሳቁል ዘንድ ከፍ ከፍ ታደርግ ታዋርድም ዘንድ ይህ ሁሉ ያንተ ገንዘብ ነበር በሥልጣንህ በታች ባሉ ሰዎች ዘንድም ጌትነትንና ክብርንም የሰጠሁ እኔ ስሆን አምልኮቴንና ምስጋናዬንም ቸል ብለሃልና ከምትመጣብህ ቁጣዬ ማምለጥ አትችልም። <sup>13</sup> የእግዚአብሔርንም ፈቃድ ካደረግህ በትእዛዙም ጸንተህ ከኖርህ በጌትነቱ ከሱ ጋራ ደስ ይልህ ዘንድ የከበረች አገርንም ከወረሱ ሰዎች ጋራ ተካፋይ ትሆን ዘንድ ይወድሃል። <sup>14</sup> ቢታገሡኝ መወደድንና ክብርን

do yours too. I will make your enemies slaves before you, and I will bless your sons and your seed. <sup>9</sup> I will multiply your flocks and herds and, if you will walk in my ways and do what is pleasing to me, then the LORD Almighty will bless you in all that you do. <sup>10</sup> If you do not do my will, and if you do not abide by my law and commandments, all these afflictions that have been spoken of before will come upon you. And you will endure afflictions by not adhering to my commandments and not abiding by my law; you will not be able to escape my wrath that will come upon you every time.

<sup>11</sup> “You did not love what I loved, I who created you, bringing you from non-existence into existence. <sup>12</sup> I gave you the power to do whatever you want, kill, save, build, destroy, honour, humiliate, exalt, and humiliate. All this was your property. You have neglected me, the one who gave you dominion and honour among those under your authority; you have neglected my worship and gratitude, so you cannot escape my wrath that will come upon you. <sup>13</sup> And, if you do the will of God and abide in his commandments, he will want you to rejoice with him in his kingdom and to be a sharer with those who inherit a glorious land. <sup>14</sup> For, if they endure me,

<sup>9</sup> Again, the Divine Title, **እግዚአብሔር**, is used here.

<sup>10</sup> The translation, ‘*every time*’, is uncertain.

<sup>11</sup> For ‘(non-)existence’, Selassie has ‘(not) living’.

<sup>12</sup> The literal translation of ‘*power*’ is ‘*money*’.

<sup>13</sup> In place of ‘*glorious land*’, Selassie has ‘*honoured country*’.

<sup>14</sup> The meaning (and possibly translation) of much of this verse is obscure and uncertain.



አወርሳቸዋለሁ ብሏልና ጸሎት በሚጸለይበት በቤተ መቅደስ ደስ አስኛቸዋለሁና ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር እንደ መሥዋዕት የተወደዱና የተመረጡንም ይሆናሉ ብሏልና።

<sup>15</sup> ከሞት ወደ ሕይወት ትሻገሩ ዘንድ ድኅነታችሁ በሚደረግባት ሥራንና በጎ ነገር ማድረግን ቸል አትበሉ።

<sup>16</sup> በጎ ሥራ የሚሠሩ ሰዎችን ግን እግዚአብሔር ከመከራው ሁሉ እንደ ጠበቀው እንደ ኢዮብ ቦሮቹን ይሆኑ ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር በበጎ ሥራው ሁሉ ይጠብቃቸዋል።

<sup>17</sup> ነገሥታቱን በገደላቸው ጊዜ እንደ አዳነው እንደ አብርሃም ጣዖት ያስመልኩት ዘንድ ማታና ጧት ሌትና ቀን ሰውነቱን ሲያውጧት ከነበሩ አብርሃም ካኖረባቸው ከከናኔዎን እጅና ከፈርዖን እጅ እንዳዳነው እንደ ሙሴም ባሮቹ ይሆኑት ዘንድ እግዚአብሔር በበጎ ሥራ ሁሉ ይጠብቃቸዋል። <sup>18</sup> እሱ ግን የላቸው ገንዘብ ወደ ሆኑ ወደ ጦዖታቱ ሲወስዱት እምቢ እያለ መከራውን ይታገሥ ነበረ።

<sup>19</sup> ከልጅነቱ ጀምሮ እሱን ያመነው አብርሃም ለእግዚአብሔር የታመነ ወዳጁ ነበርና እሱም እምቢ እያለ የፈጠረው እግዚአብሔርን ያመልከው ነበረ። <sup>20</sup> እግዚአብሔርን ፈጽሞ ይወደዋልና እስኪሞት ድረስ እግዚአብሔርን ማምለክ አልተወደውም እስከሚሞትበትም ድረስ ከሕጉም አልወጣም የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ ይጠብቁ ዘንድ ልጆቹንም አስተማረ።

I will give them love and honour, and I will make them joyful in the temple where prayer is offered, and they will be beloved and chosen by the Almighty God as a sacrifice.”

<sup>15</sup> Do not neglect to do good and to do work by which you will gain salvation, so that you may pass from death to life.

<sup>16</sup> But God preserves those who do good in all their good works, so that they may be like Job, whom God preserved through all his afflictions. <sup>17</sup> The LORD will keep them by all good works, that they may be like Abraham, whom he saved when he killed the kings, and like his servants Moses, who he saved from the hand of the Canaanites and the hand of Pharaoh, where Abraham lived, who pressured them morning, night and day to worship idols. <sup>18</sup> But he endured the suffering, refusing to let them take his money to the idols that they brought him before.

<sup>19</sup> Abraham, who had believed in him since his childhood, was a faithful friend of God; and, despite his refusal, he worshipped the God who created him. <sup>20</sup> Because he loved God completely, he did not abandon the worship of God until his death, and he did not deviate from the law until his death. And he also taught his children to keep the law of

<sup>15</sup> For ‘salvation’, Selassie has ‘welfare’.

<sup>16</sup> In place of ‘afflictions’, Selassie has ‘tribulations’.

<sup>17</sup> The translation of this verse, here loosely following Selassie is very uncertain – especially the order of the clauses.

<sup>18</sup> The use of the term, ‘money’, here is odd.

<sup>19</sup> The meaning of the phrase, ‘despite his refusal’, is unclear.

<sup>20</sup> Selassie has ‘totally’ in place of ‘completely’.

<sup>21</sup> አባታቸው አብርሃም ሕጉን እንደ ጠበቀ እነሳቸውም ከእግዚአብሔር ሕግ አልወጡም በዚህ ዓለም አብርሃም የሚባል ወዳጅ አለኝ ብሎ ለመላእክት እንደ ነገራቸው እግዚአብሔር ስለነሳቸው የተናገረ ባሮቹ የሚሆኑ የአብርሃም ልጆች ያዕቆብና ይስሐቅ ከእግዚአብሔር ሕግ አልወጡም።

<sup>22</sup> በነሳቸው ዘንድ የተመሰገነ ሁሉን የሚገዛ እግዚአብሔር አብርሃም ወዳጄ ነው ይስሐቅ ባለሟሉ ነው ያዕቆብም ልቡናዬ የወደደችለው ወዳጄ ነው አለ። <sup>23</sup> የእስራኤልን ልጆች ፈጽሞ ሲወዳቸው እነሳቸው ግን ዘወትር ሲያሳዝኑት ኖሩ እሱም ሲታገሣቸው በምድረ በዳም መና ሲመግባቸው ኖረ።

<sup>24</sup> ልብሳቸው አላረጀም ይውቀት እንጀራ የሚሆን መናን ተመግበዋልና እግራቸውም አልነቃም። <sup>25</sup> ልቡናቸው ግን ሁለጊዜ ከእግዚአብሔር ይርቅ ነበር ከጥንት ጀምሮ ኃጢአት የሚሠሩ ነበሩና ለመዳን ተስፋ አልነበራቸውም።

<sup>26</sup> እንደጠማማ ቀስት ሆኑ እንጂ ባማረ አነዋወራቸው እግዚአብሔርን እንዳገለገሉት እንደ አባቶቻቸው እንደ ይስሐቅና አንደ አብርሃም እንደ ያዕቆብም አልሆኑም በተራራውና በኮረፍታው ላይ ባሉ ጣዖቶቻቸው ሁለጊዜ ያሳዝኑት ነበር በተራራው ላይ በዋሻውና በዛፎቹም ሥር ይበሉ ነበር። <sup>27</sup> ፍሪዳ ያርዱ ነበር መሥዋዕት ይሠው ነበር

God, <sup>21</sup> just as their father Abraham kept the law, so they did not depart from the law of God. Just as he told the angels, “I have a friend in this world whose name is Abraham,” so did Abraham’s sons Jacob and Isaac, who became his servants, whom God spoke of because they were raised up.

<sup>22</sup> Praised be the LORD Almighty, who raised them up, and who said, “Abraham is my friend, and Isaac is my shepherd, and Jacob is my companion, whom my soul delights in.” <sup>23</sup> He loved the children of Israel dearly, but they continually disappointed him. He was patient with them and fed them with manna in the desert. <sup>24</sup> Their clothes did not wear out, and their feet did not become numb; for, they ate manna, the bread of knowledge. <sup>25</sup> But their hearts were always far from God, and they had no hope of salvation; for, they had been sinners from the beginning. <sup>26</sup> They became like a twisted arrow, not like their fathers Isaac and Abraham, who served God with their beautiful way of life. They always grieved him with their idols on the mountains and on the hills. They ate in the mountains, in the caves, and under the trees. <sup>27</sup> They slaughtered animals, offered

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<sup>21</sup> The translation of this verse is extremely uncertain.

<sup>22</sup> In place of ‘companion’, Selassie repeats ‘friend’.

<sup>23</sup> Like many translators, Selassie has ‘wilderness’ in place of ‘desert’.

<sup>24</sup> For ‘become numb’, Selassie has ‘awaken’.

<sup>25</sup> Selassie has ‘since Antiquity’ in place of ‘from the beginning’.

<sup>26</sup> This verse speaks of the pagan rites practised in the time of the latter kings of Israel and Judah.

<sup>27</sup> For ‘animals’, Selassie has ‘a steer’.

በእጃቸውም ሥራ ደስ ይላቸው ነበር ተረፈ መሥዋዕቱን ይበሉ ነበር የመሥዋዕታቸውን ይጠጡ ነበር እየዘፈኑም ከአጋንንት ጋራ ይጫወቱ ነበር።<sup>28</sup> አጋንንትም ጨዋታቸውንና ዘፈናቸውን ሁሉ የደንቁላቸው ነበር ስካራቸውንም ያለልክም ዝሙትን ይሠሩ ነበር እግዚአብሔር የማይወደው ቅሚያና ስስትንም ያደርጉ ነበር።<sup>29</sup> ለከነዓን ጣዖት ለምድም ጣዖትና ለበዓልም የኤሎፍሊ ጣዖቶች ለሚሆኑ ለአጵሎንና ለዳጋንም ለሰራጽዮንና ለአርጤማዴስም።<sup>30</sup> በዙሪያቸው ላሉ ለአሕዛብም ጣዖታት ሁሉ መሥዋዕት ይሠው ነበር ባዩ በሰሙ ገንዘብ አሕዛብ ጣዖት እንዲያመልኩ እስራኤልም ሁሉ ጣዖት ያመልኩ ነበር ጨዋታቸውንና ዘፈናቸውን አሕዛብም የሚያደርጉት ድንፋታቸውን ያደርጉ ነበር።<sup>31</sup> የእግዚአብሔርን ሕግ ይጠብቁ ዘንድ ጣዖትንም ከማምለክ ይርቁ ዘንድ ሙሴ በአሪት የነገራቸው ትእዛዙንና ሕጉን ሳይጠብቁ እግዚአብሔርን እናመልከዋለን የሚሉ የእስራኤል ወገን ሁሉ እንደዚሁ ያደርጋሉ።

<sup>32</sup> የኩዳዱን እህል ከመገባቸው ወደ ምድሩም አዝመራ ካወጣቸው ከማጋ የተገኘ ማሩንም የመገባቸው መናውንም የመገባቸው ካባቶቻቸው ፈጣሪ በቀር የተለዩ ጣዖታትን እንዳያመልኩ።<sup>33</sup> ሙሴ አታምልኩ ብሎ አዘዛቸው

sacrifices, and rejoiced in the work of their hands. They ate the leftovers of the sacrifices, drank the sacrifices, and sang and danced with the demons.<sup>28</sup> The demons were amazed by all their games and songs, and they were drunk and committed excessive fornication, and they practiced extortion and greed, which God does not like.<sup>29</sup> To the idols of Canaan, to the idols of the Medes and to the Baals, to the idols of the Philistines, to Apollo and to Dagon, to Serapion and to Artemis:<sup>30</sup> they offered sacrifices to all the idols of the nations round about and, with the money that they saw and heard that the Gentiles might worship idols; and all Israel worshipped idols, and the Gentiles played their games, and their songs, and the Gentiles indulged their lust.<sup>31</sup> All the people of Israel who claim to worship God without keeping the commandments and laws that Moses gave them in the Torah, so that they would keep God's law and avoid idolatry, did the same.

<sup>32</sup> They should not worship idols other than their fathers' Creator, who fed them with the grain of the field, who brought them out into the land, who fed them with honey from Maga, and who fed them with manna.<sup>33</sup> Moses told them not to worship them; for,

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<sup>28</sup> For 'excessive fornication', Selassie has 'adultery without measure'.  
<sup>29</sup> Here, 'Philistines' is a conjectural translation.  
<sup>30</sup> The translation of this verse is extremely speculative.  
<sup>31</sup> The 'Torah' is mentioned by name several times in this book.  
<sup>32</sup> The meaning of the word translated 'from Maga' (ከማጋ - here following Selassie) is not known.  
<sup>33</sup> In the first clause, 'them' refers to the idols of v. 32.

ፈጣሪያቸው ነውና የወደዱትንም ይመግባቸዋልና የወደዱትን የተመኙትንም አላሳጣቸውም።<sup>34</sup> እነሳቸው ግን እግዚአብሔርን ማሳዘን አልተውም ደስም ባሰኛቸው ጊዜ እግዚአብሔርን ያስዝኑት ነበር።<sup>35</sup> ባላዘናቸውም ጊዜ ወደሱ ይጮሁ ነበር ካገኛቸውም መከራ ያድናቸው ነበር ዳግመኛም ፈጽሞ ደስ ይላቸው ነበር ብዙ ዘመንም ይኖሩ ነበር።

<sup>36</sup> እንደ ቀድሞው እግዚአብሔርን ያሳዝኑት ዘንድ የዚያን ጊዜም ፈጽመው ልባቸውን ወደ ኃጢአት ይመልሱ ነበር ያጠፏቸው ዘንድ በዙሪያቸው ያሉ አሕዛብንም ያስነሣባቸው ነበር አስጨንቀውም ያስገብሩዋቸው ነበር።<sup>37</sup> ዳግመኛም ፈጽመው ተመልሰው ወደ ፈጣሪያቸው ወደ እግዚአብሔር ይጮሁ ነበር።<sup>38</sup> እሱም ይቅር ይላቸው ነበር ባማረ አነዋወራቸው ከጥነት ጀምሮ እግዚአብሔርን ስለ አገለገሉት መሐላውን ስለ አጸናላቸው ስለ አባቶቻቸው ስለ ኖሳ ስለ ይስሐቅና ስለ አብርሃም ስለ ያዕቆብም ነው እንጂ ይቀር የሚላቸው ስለ ራሳቸው ሥራ አይደለም።<sup>39</sup> እንደ ሰማይ ከዋክብትና እንደ ባሕር አሸዋ ልጆቻቸውን ያበዛ ዘንድ ወደው ሕጉን የጠበቁ ሰዎችንም ወደዳቸው።<sup>40</sup> እንደ ባሕር አሸዋ ያላቸው ግን ሙታን በተነሡ ጊዜ ከእስራኤል ልጆች ተለይተው ወደ ገሃነም የሚገቡ የኃጢአተኞች ሰዎች ነፍሳት

he was their Creator and he would feed them with what they loved and would not deprive them of what they loved or desired.

<sup>34</sup> But they did not cease to grieve God, and they grieved God even when he gave them joy. <sup>35</sup> And, when he afflicted them, they cried out to him, and he delivered them from their distress, and they were made to rejoice again, and they lived for a long time.

<sup>36</sup> And, at that time, they turned their hearts back to sin, so that they might grieve God, as before; and he stirred up against them the nations around them to destroy them, and he chastised them and oppressed them. <sup>37</sup> And they would once again turn back and cry out to their Creator, the LORD.

<sup>38</sup> He forgave them, not because of their own works, but because of their fathers Noah, and Isaac, and Abraham, and Jacob, who had served God faithfully from their youth, in antiquity, and he kept the oath he swore to them. <sup>39</sup> And he loved those who kept his law, desiring that he might multiply their children like the stars of the sky and like the sand of the sea. <sup>40</sup> But those who are like the sand of the sea are the souls of sinners who will be separated from the children of Israel and go down to Gehenna

<sup>34</sup> Selassie has ‘sadden(ed)’ in place of ‘grieve(d)’.

<sup>35</sup> Selassie ends, “and would live many eras.”

<sup>36</sup> The words, ‘at that time’, follow Selassie.

<sup>37</sup> Here, ‘the LORD’ translates the Divine Title, እግዚአብሔር.

<sup>38</sup> In place of ‘faithfully’, Selassie has ‘in a beautiful way’.

<sup>39</sup> For ‘the sky’, Selassie reads ‘heaven’.

<sup>40</sup> Some read ‘hell’ for ‘Gehenna’.



ናቸው። <sup>41</sup> እግዚአብሔር አብሃምን ሌሊት ወደ ሰማይ እይ መቁጠርም ትችል እንደ ሆነ የሰማይን ከዋክብት ቁጠራቸው ብሎታልና እንደዚሁ ልጆችህ ጻድቃንም እንደ ሰማይ ከዋክብት በመንግሥተ ሰማይ ያበራሉ ብሎታልና በሰማይ ላይ እንደሚያበሩ ከዋክብት ናቸው ያላቸው ግን ከአስራኤል የተወለዱ የደጋጎች ሰዎች ነፍሳት ናቸው።

<sup>42</sup> ዳግመኛም ወደ ወንዙ ዳግቻ ወደ ባሕሩ አስተውል ባሸዋው መካከል ያለውንም እይ መቁጠር ትችል እንደ ሆነ ቁጠር ሙታን በተነሡ ጊዜ ወደ ገሃነም የሚወርዱ ኃጢአተኞች ልጆችህም እንደዚሁ ናቸው ብሎታልና የኃጢአተኞች ሰዎች ነፍሳት ናቸው። <sup>43</sup> አብርሃም በእግዚአብሔር አመነ ስለዚህ ነገር እውነት ሆኖ ተቁጠረለት በዚህ ዓለም አለኝታውን አገኘ ሚስቱ ሳራም ካረጀች በኋላ ይስሐቅ የሚባል ልጅን ወለደች።

<sup>44</sup> በጎ ሥራ የሠሩ ሰዎች ተነሥተው ዘለዓለም ጸንቶ ወደ ሚኖር ወደ መንግሥተ ሰማያት እንዲሔዱ አምኗልና ዳግመኛም በሰማይ መንግሥትን ያገኛል። <sup>45</sup> ኃጢአትን የሠሩ ሰዎች ግን ሙታን በተነሡ ጊዜ ለዘለዓለም ጸንቶ ወደ ሚኖር ወደ ገሃነም እንዲሄዱ በጎ ሥራ የሠሩ ጻድቃን ግን ለዘለዓለሙ ከሱ ጋራ እንዲነግሡ አምኗልና። <sup>46</sup> ኃጢአት በሠሩ ሰዎች ግን በውነት ያለ ሐሰት ለዘለዓለሙ

when the dead are resurrected. <sup>41</sup> God told Abraham to look up to the sky at night and count the stars in the sky, and he said, “So your righteous children will shine like the stars in the sky in the kingdom of heaven.” But those who say they are like the stars that shine in the sky are the souls of the righteous people who were born of Israel.

<sup>42</sup> And again, look to the river, and to the sea, and see the sand that is in the midst of the sea, and count it, if you can. For, when the dead are raised, so shall be your children who are sinners, and who will go down to Gehenna; for, they are the souls of sinners. <sup>43</sup> Abraham believed God, and it was counted to him as true. He found his place in this world. His wife Sarah also gave birth to a son named Isaac when she was old.

<sup>44</sup> For, he believed people who do good deeds will be resurrected and go to the kingdom of heaven, where they will live forever. He will again find a kingdom in heaven. <sup>45</sup> For, he believed that those who commit sins will go to Gehenna, where they will be eternally punished, when the dead are resurrected, while the righteous who do good deeds will reign with him forever. <sup>46</sup> But those who have sinned will be judged eternally

<sup>41</sup> The translation of the last sentence is far from certain.

<sup>42</sup> Some read ‘hell’ for ‘Gehenna’.

<sup>43</sup> This verse seems to be a parenthetical note.

<sup>44</sup> In place of ‘will be resurrected’, Selassie has ‘shall arise’.

<sup>45</sup> See #42.

<sup>46</sup> The ‘he’ in the last clause refers to Abraham (presumably).



እንዲፈረድባቸው አምኗልና በሰማይ የሕይወት መንግሥት  
ያገኛልና።

<sup>47</sup> በውነት ያለ ሐሰት ለእግዚአብሔር ክብርና ምስጋና  
ይገባውና የመቃብያንን ነገር የሚናገር መጀመሪያ  
መጽሐፍ መላ ተፈጸመ።

without falsehood; and he will receive the kingdom of life in  
heaven.

<sup>47</sup> The first book of Meqabyan, which truly and without  
falsehood is worthy of the glory and praise of the LORD,  
has been completed.

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<sup>47</sup> Selassie includes this conclusion as part of v. 46.